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House of Representatives

The House met at 10 a.m. and was called to order by the Speaker pro tempore (Mr. CÁRDENAS).

DESIGNATION OF SPEAKER PRO TEMPORE

The SPEAKER pro tempore laid before the House the following communication from the Speaker:

WASHINGTON, DC,
June 14, 2022.

I hereby appoint the Honorable TONY CÁRDENAS to act as Speaker pro tempore on this day.

NANCY PELOSI,
Speaker of the House of Representatives.

MORNING-HOUR DEBATE

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Pursuant to the order of the House of January 10, 2022, the Chair will now recognize Members from lists submitted by the majority and minority leaders for morning-hour debate.

The Chair will alternate recognition between the parties, with time equally allocated between the parties and each Member other than the majority and minority leaders and the minority whip limited to 5 minutes, but in no event shall debate continue beyond 11:50 a.m.

HONORING THE LEGACY OF RUTH ELLIS

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The Chair recognizes the gentlewoman from Michigan (Ms. TLAIB) for 5 minutes.

Ms. TLAIB. Mr. Speaker, I rise today, during Pride Month, to honor the phenomenal Ruth Ellis, a former Detroit resident who was the oldest surviving open lesbian and an LGBTQ rights activist.

Born in 1899, and living until the age of 101, she came out as a lesbian around 1915. She took in LGBTQ-plus youth experiencing homelessness and displacement, and her home became known as ''the gay spot.''

Not only did she give refuge to our youth, but she provided them books, food, and even assistance with their college tuition. She was an icon.

Still today, LGBTQ-plus youth experience homelessness at a disproportionate rate. The Ruth Ellis Center in Highland Park was created in the 13 District Strong and was named after and in honor of Ms. Ellis. They provide safe, affordable, identity-affirming housing for marginalized Black and Brown Detroiters, especially our LGBTQ-plus youth. Join me today in honoring and recognizing Ruth Ellis and the incredible advocacy of the Ruth Ellis Center and their incredible team.

CELEBRATING THE LIFE OF GREG MUDGE

Ms. TLAIB. Mr. Speaker, today, I celebrate the memory of Greg Mudge, a longtime community advocate and businessowner in Detroit, who we tragically lost last year. Greg was a beloved member of our community, and his sudden death was a shock to us all.

When he first opened Mudgie's Deli back in 2008, Greg was already considered a member of our community. A food service veteran himself, he built and managed his own business with the heart and soul of family. His approach was ''all hands on deck,'' and he never shied away from any task and was always ready to give a helping hand.

Greg's commitment to serving homemade food, including incorporating family recipes, made Mudgie's Deli a neighborhood standout. More than that, Greg's enthusiasm and passion for his work shined through in all that he did. Greg Mudge embodied the spirit of our beautiful southwest Detroit community and our Corktown neighborhood. Please join me in honoring his memory.

REFORM THE MULTIEMPLOYER PENSION SYSTEM

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The Chair recognizes the gentlewoman from North Carolina (Ms. FOXX) for 5 minutes.

Ms. FOXX. Mr. Speaker, Democrats keep forcing taxpayers to bail out failing and mismanaged union-run multiemployer pension plans, and it needs to stop.

The Committee on Education and Labor has dedicated considerable time and held countless hearings on the problems posed by multiemployer pension plans and the Pension Benefit Guaranty Corporation's, PBGC's, multiemployer insurance program.

Unfortunately, unlike previous bipartisan legislation to address the failing system, our Democrat colleagues decided to go it alone by enacting the deceitful American Rescue Plan Act, ARPA.

Under the guise of COVID relief, ARPA included an irresponsible and uncapped taxpayer bailout of failing and insolvent multiemployer pension plans. Let me repeat, there is no cap on the amount of taxpayer dollars that PBGC may send to multiemployer plans.

This is especially concerning given that multiemployer plans are currently underfunded by $756 billion.

Unsurprisingly, the cost of ARPA's pension bailout program continues to grow. The Congressional Budget Office originally estimated it would cost taxpayers $86 billion. Five months later, PBGC estimated it would likely distribute $94.2 billion. After 2 more months, PBGC estimated it would likely distribute $97.2 billion and, in one scenario, could distribute upward of $147 billion.

To date, PBGC has disbursed $6.7 billion to 26 plans, and this is just the beginning.

In April, the Central States, Southeast and Southwest Areas Pension Plan

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requested a staggering $35 billion from taxpayers. PBGC is reviewing an additional eight applications requesting a total of $1.1 billion. In all, PBGC is expected to send money to over 250 pension plans.

PBGC has confirmed what we knew to be true, but others refused to admit: ARPA's taxpayer-funded bailout will not fix a thing.

In September, the agency stated the massive influx of taxpayer dollars will only delay the immediate insolvency of the multiemployer insurance program, and insolvency is still likely. Simply throwing money at plans will not solve the problem.

ARPA failed to address the underlying structural issues in the multiemployer system that contributed to the crisis, thus ensuring that plan mismanagement and underfunding will persist. In fact, ARPA includes a galling provision that explicitly bars PBGC from reforming plan governance or altering plan-funding rules of plans receiving a bailout.

It is clear to me that the mismanagement of multiemployer plans and the risks they pose to workers, retirees, and the taxpayer cannot be ignored. Congress must require multiemployer plans to measure their liabilities accurately and collect adequate contributions to fund benefits.

Failing and insolvent plans must stop making promises that they are unable and unwilling to keep. It is common practice for insolvent plans, which do not have enough funds to pay current retirees, to continue allowing active participants to accrue benefits and enroll new workers into the plan. This is deceptive. This is wrong. This must stop.

Congress should increase multiemployer insurance premiums to account for the risk that underfunded plans pose to PBGC.

Multiemployer plans pay a meager flat-rate premium of $31 per participant. In contrast, the single-employer program requires plans to pay an $88 flat-rate premium in addition to a variable rate premium based on a plan's level of underfunding.

Decades of chronic underfunding and false promises have put millions of workers and retirees at risk. By propping up this clearly unsustainable system without enacting reforms, ARPA continues to enable and encourage the irresponsible behaviors that caused this crisis.

Taxpayers saving for their own retirements should not be on the hook to pay for the broken promises of union-run multiemployer pension plans.

There must be accountability for this gross mismanagement and real reform to ensure the multiemployer pension system does not continue to deceive workers and the American people.

HONORING THE LIFE AND LEGACY OF ELTON DEAN

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The Chair recognizes the gentlewoman from Alabama (Ms. SEWELL) for 5 minutes.

Ms. SEWELL. Mr. Speaker, I rise today to honor the extraordinary life and legacy of Montgomery County Commissioner Elton Dean, who passed away at the age of 72 on June 7, 2022.

A native of Alabama's Seventh Congressional District, Chairman Dean graduated from Montgomery's own George Washington Carver High School before attending Selma University, where he received his associate's degree.

Returning to Montgomery, Chairman Dean pursued his bachelor of science at the Alabama State University, where he graduated in 1971 with a degree in business and economics.

Chairman Dean went on to become a successful businessman, putting to work his entrepreneurial spirit to serve and improve his community as owner of Dean Realty as well as 21st Century Hair Studio.

In November 2000, Chairman Dean was first elected to the Montgomery County Commission, where he humbly and faithfully served the Second District for over 20 years. Dean was elected vice chairman in November 2004 before making history in March 2009 as the first African American to serve as chair of the Montgomery County Commission. Montgomery County includes the historic city of Montgomery, Alabama.

Known as a dedicated public servant and passionate community leader, Chairman Dean's legacy lives on in the countless projects and initiatives that came into fruition under his leadership, including the implementation of Montgomery County's back-to-school sales tax holiday.

Chairman Dean is also known for bringing the commission meetings to the people by holding his ''On the Road'' initiative, which allowed constituents to meet directly with their representatives.

Chairman Dean worked tirelessly to improve Montgomery County's economic well-being. Among his most notable achievements, he oversaw the implementation of the 1 percent sales tax in 2001, which generated over $428 million for public education in Montgomery County, delivering critically needed resources to the children of our community.

Chairman Dean never missed an opportunity to give back. Throughout his adult life, he held countless positions, including serving on boards and organizations throughout Montgomery County, which included as executive board member of the South Central Alabama Boys and Girls Club as well as board member for the Montgomery Improvement Association, board member for the Central Alabama Community Foundation, and chairman of the trustee board and mass choir member of Mt. Zion African Methodist Episcopal Zion Church. He was commissioner of the Central Alabama Amateur Baseball League and commissioner of the Southern League Dixie Youth Baseball.

A very strong advocate for his alma mater, Chairman Dean returned to the Alabama State University later in life to serve as chairman of the board of trustees for the Alabama State University. In this role, he served for 9 years and generated $525 million worth of campus improvement.

In his role as chairman of the board of trustees for Alabama State University, I got to know Chairman Dean because he gave me, as a young bond lawyer, the opportunity to represent my parents' alma mater, the Alabama State University.

It was Chairman Dean who encouraged me to run for Congress, and for his mentorship and his friendship, I am forever grateful.

Chairman Dean rightfully received numerous awards throughout the community: the Pioneer Award by The Montgomery Tuskegee Times; the Montgomery County Area Chamber of Commerce Chairman's Award in 2012; the Citizen of the Year Award by the Sigma Phi Chapter of Omega Psi Phi Fraternity in 2004; the Citizen of the Year Award by Kappa Alpha Psi Fraternity, Montgomery's Alumni Chapter; as well as the Kershaw YMCA Man of the Year.

Chairman Dean was a true public servant and a servant leader. Though I know so many of us are heartbroken by his passing, I am eternally grateful for our partnership on behalf of the citizens of Montgomery County, Alabama, and blessed to have been guided by his mentorship as well as his friendship over the years.

May his family find comfort in knowing that Elton Dean's legacy will live on in the hearts of all those he impacted. As we mourn his passing, I ask my colleagues to join me in celebrating the extraordinary life and legacy of Montgomery County Commission Chairman Elton Dean.

□ 1015

RUNAWAY DEFICIT SPENDING

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The Chair recognizes the gentleman from Tennessee (Mr. ROSE) for 5 minutes.

Mr. ROSE. Mr. Speaker, inflation is at the highest level we have seen since Jimmy Carter was in the White House.

I have spoken many times about rising prices being fueled by out-of-control spending. Today, I rise with even more proof that this has been the case.

President Biden's 2021 COVID stimulus bill overheated the economy, just as I, and many other Republican Members of Congress, along with numerous economists from both sides of the political divide, predicted.

Now a report by the non-partisan Congressional Budget Office shows that spending did, in fact, create a worker shortage which strained supply chains and contributed to the economic crisis in which we find ourselves today.

One year ago, companies across middle Tennessee were struggling to find workers. More than 160,000 Tennesseans were unemployed; yet 218,000 jobs were

available. Folks were earning $15.75 an hour to stay home because of the unnecessary $2 trillion bill pushed through by congressional Democrats on a party line vote.

Employers became desperate. Many were forced to offer massive sign-on bonuses and other incentives just to find enough workers to continue operating as normal. Unfortunately, some had to close their doors.

Tennessee's Governor Bill Lee, a businessowner himself, recognized the damage enhanced Federal unemployment benefits were causing on restaurants and retail stores. He noticed many couldn't compete with $300 a week from the Federal Government on top of State unemployment benefits.

Fortunately, he put a stop to the flow of Federal unemployment dollars in Tennessee, and he was right. At last check, there were about 13,000 unemployment claims in Tennessee, compared to roughly 60,000 claims this time last year.

Still, the cost of living has increased every month under the Biden administration, and the nonpartisan Congressional Budget Office projects it will continue to impact Americans at least into 2023.

This is what happens when you do what is politically expedient. This is the direct result of runaway deficit spending.

The Federal Reserve is now having to be the adult in the room and raise interest rates to lower inflation. Raising interest rates is a harsh step, but one made necessary by the Biden administration's reckless handling of the economy.

It will make it harder and more expensive to borrow money for your first home or to buy a new car. Raising interest rates will also cause our economy to slow down. This means people will lose their jobs, their savings, and in many cases, even their small businesses.

Our economy already got 1.5 percent smaller in the first quarter of the year. It is why many economists are predicting a recession or worse in the next 12 months.

It didn't have to be this way. The President and congressional Democrats didn't have to borrow and spend so much money. This administration inherited one of the strongest economies in my life. It took fewer than 2 years for them to completely destroy it. President Biden must do better.

UNIVERSAL MEAL PROGRAM

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The Chair recognizes the gentlewoman from California (Ms. PORTER) for 5 minutes.

Ms. PORTER. Mr. Speaker, when the pandemic closed schools and left millions of children without meals they needed, our government took action. Emergency waivers eliminated income caps and gave meal providers flexibility in delivering food.

Even now, with schools reopened, these waivers are getting healthy meals to children without burying families under mountains of paperwork, but these provisions are set to expire on June 30.

As 97 percent of meal providers like schools struggle to pay soaring food prices, these protections should be strengthened, not stopped.

This year, California became the first State to provide free meals to any student. Offering no-cost meals to everyone, regardless of income, helps resources reach the kids who need them most.

This will also help California's kids in schools perform better. Free meals contribute to better attendance, fewer nurse visits, and higher test scores. California's universal meal program will benefit schools and families. The Nation should follow our example.

TAKING ACTION ON CLIMATE CHANGE

Ms. PORTER. Mr. Speaker, the greater our delay in taking action on climate change, the higher the price tag will be for families and our economy.

Last week, Californians suffered through an intense heat wave. Temperatures went over 100 degrees in parts of our State. That is bad for public health and bad for our economy.

A study by the Atlantic Council estimates that the total economic loss from excessive heat is at least $100 billion annually. They also estimate that this loss could double by 2030 and quintuple by 2050 if we don't take climate action.

Simply put, the fiscally responsible thing to do is for Congress to act quickly to prevent further losses. Taking climate action will lower and stabilize costs for families.

High temperatures aren't just bad for human health. They are bad for our economy. Heat waves push prices for electricity higher, costing us billions. We should not leave families in California and across the country to figure out their budgets while Washington figures out climate change.

The need for climate change is urgent, not just for our planet, but also for our pocketbooks.

PTSD AWARENESS MONTH

Ms. PORTER. Mr. Speaker, our Nation is failing people with post-traumatic stress disorder. During June, PTSD Awareness Month, we must commit to doing better.

Mental health affects many across our Nation, but I rise today to shine light on the brave young people dealing with PTSD.

Too many Americans, including many with PTSD, go without the mental healthcare they need because their insurance won't cover it. I wrote a bill, which is now Federal law, to crack down on insurance companies that break the rules and refuse to cover mental health the same way they cover physical health. I am proud the House is considering additional proposals I have worked on to strengthen the enforcement of protections for mental health coverage.

When a child experiences a traumatic event, like emotional or sexual abuse, it harms their emotional, social, and cognitive development. These adverse childhood experiences are linked to substance use disorder, chronic health issues, and PTSD.

We cannot let trauma or related challenges hold students back from getting high quality educations. The effect of these experiences doesn't end when children leave their homes for college. They bleed into their daily lives, including in the classroom.

I am proud to introduce legislation, the Student Mental Health Rights Act, which would direct the Department of Education to study mental health, issue guidance to help schools level the playing field, and support students in overcoming their mental health challenges so they can complete their schooling. Our students need this help.

For Americans with PTSD of all ages, awareness is not enough. They need action.

RETURNING TO FISCAL SANITY

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The Chair recognizes the gentleman from Virginia (Mr. CLINE) for 5 minutes.

Mr. CLINE. Mr. Speaker, I rise to discuss the chilling state of the American economy. The stock market is tanking. The American people know what a disaster President Biden and the majority's economic policies have been, and they are acting accordingly and expressing the lowest consumer confidence in a record 50 years of data.

Pumping trillions in spending through this body, including the so-called American Rescue Plan, has, in large part, caused a 40-year high in inflation as the CPI rose to 8.6 percent in May.

The Nation is $30 trillion in debt, and the CBO predicts $1.6 trillion in deficits over the next decade. The Federal Reserve will be forced to continue to raise interest rates, further exacerbating the beleaguered economy.

Gas prices are at $5 a gallon, due to the President's assaults on American oil drilling and fracking and domestic energy exploration, and the Green New Deal priorities of the majority and this administration are exacerbating the energy crisis.

As The Wall Street Journal recently asked: Has anyone, other than unsuccessful green energy subsidy firms, benefited from the Biden economy?

What is more, the President's $5.8 trillion tax-and-spend budget is fiscally irresponsible. Biden's budget cuts $428 million in Customs and Border Protection's budget in the midst of a border crisis.

It skyrockets Federal spending by a third, compared to prepandemic levels, calls for $2.5 trillion in tax hikes, and sets this country on a course of extended fiscal doom at a time when we are currently on the precipice of a recession.

The American economy cannot sustain a Federal Government that is

vacuuming tax dollars out of the pockets of the private sector at a record pace.

Still, today, the majority will not even propose a budget, much less one that achieves balance, and instead, funds the government and inflates the currency through massive omnibus bills and continuing resolutions.

We need to return to regular order in this House and return to fiscal sanity to rescue this economy from a recession that looms large in what is likely to be a long, hot summer for millions of American families.

OUR ECONOMY IS BOOMING

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The Chair recognizes the gentlewoman from Texas (Ms. GARCIA) for 5 minutes.

Ms. GARCIA of Texas. Mr. Speaker, I rise today to celebrate the record-breaking number of jobs created under President Biden's watch, his plan to lower costs for hard-working American families, and our plan to continue building a better America.

Since President Biden took office, the economy has added 8.7 million new jobs—8.7 million new jobs. That is staggering. Fun fact, Mr. Speaker, this is the most jobs added in any President's first 16 months. I repeat: The most jobs added in any President's first 16 months. This is historic.

The fact that the economy is booming is no accident. You see, President Biden laid the foundation for an amazing recovery through his American Rescue Plan and vaccination program. This plan got people back to work, kids back in schools, and helped the American economy bounce back.

Together, with President Biden, House Democrats are not only bringing back jobs, but we are growing paychecks for households across the country. Because of this, unemployment is near historic lows, and even better, the number of Americans relying on unemployment benefits has dropped by more than 90 percent. This is huge.

In short, our Nation has recovered 96 percent of the jobs lost during the pandemic and is on track to return to prepandemic employment levels before the end of the year.

Mr. Speaker, this is a direct result of President Biden's leadership, Congress' partnership, and the backing of the American people.

While many Americans are back at work, we have heard calls from hard-working families struggling with the cost of inflation. Sadly, Putin's war against Ukraine is now the biggest single driver of inflation, but we have a plan for this too.

I am proud to report that House Democrats and President Biden are acting to lower gas prices by fighting Putin's price hike. The United States is on track to produce a record amount of oil next year, and coming from Texas, that is music to our ears, and the President is working with the industry to accelerate this output.

Democrats are also laser focused on lowering everyday costs for families at the grocery store, and they are also improving the supply chain. We are fighting for everyday Americans by reducing the cost of everyday goods through the COMPETES Act.

This landmark legislation will lower costs and strengthen our supply chains by making more products right here in America: Made in USA. Again, this will create more jobs.

We also have great news on the Federal deficit. Biden is still on track to drop the budget deficit by $1.6 trillion this year alone.

Mr. Speaker, another fun fact, President Biden has cut the deficit more this year than any President in history. I repeat, more than any President in history. In contrast, Mr. Speaker, the Trump administration increased the Federal budget deficit every single year they were in office.

All things considered, President Biden and House Democrats are not only working together to continue building a better America for all Americans, but we are delivering on that promise, and we will continue to do just that—delivering on our promise.

□ 1030

PUTTING AMERICANS LAST

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The Chair recognizes the gentleman from California (Mr. LAMALFA) for 5 minutes.

Mr. LAMALFA. Mr. Speaker, as the 4-day tour occurs inside the Capitol on January 6, where a loaded, biased committee attempts to parse the words of the President on the day, we have many other crises to deal with in this country that are directly affecting and harming the American people, their ability to do their basic day-to-day operation of their homes, get to their jobs, get their kids to school.

So what are we doing? What are we doing? Chasing January 6. Look at our border right now, where under the current Biden policies, we are attracting the largest caravan ever of illegal aliens heading toward our border. The idea that we are going to get rid of title 42 or just the general porosity of the border anyway. It has been a giant magnet ever since January 20, 2021, when this President came in and started shredding our border policy.

We had success under President Trump, where we had the best control of the border we had in quite a while, with approximately 450 additional miles of rebuilt or new fence that was very effective in those zones.

So what do we have now? We have warehouses and stacks and pallets of fence material, millions of dollars' worth of it, lying about on our southern border being stored instead of installed.

We heard some chatter here a couple months ago from the Biden administration, well, maybe we should just go ahead and put up those additional pieces there where there are some obvious gaps.

I had a chance to visit Yuma, Arizona a few weeks ago. It was pretty incredible because there would be miles of fence, but there would be these gaps occasionally, and that is where people would pour through illegally. Amazing.

We could rectify that by just filling a lot of the gaps, thereby making our Customs and Border Patrol job much easier by being able to focus on fewer areas instead of wide-open spaces or gaps all along our border.

But, no, it seems to be about some other agenda. 15,000 people possibly will crowd the border here soon under the idea that we are going to possibly let title 42 go. Thankfully, two different courts have stopped that.

So what are we doing? The terrorists come across our border really almost unchecked. They capture a handful of them, but how many are getting by that get away? We don't know that. Are they starting cells right here in our country? Why not?

As we know, in April, there were over 230,000 encounters, they call them, at the southern border. That is the highest in U.S. history for one month. Why is this? Because we have a giant magnet, again, turned on by this administration saying, come on across. You only need to have a sliver of an excuse for asylum.

The asylum law needs to be changed if that is how they are going to enforce it because it has to be for a true threat. You also have to seek asylum in the country closest to you, if you are an asylum seeker and that is what you are really after, but one closest to you, not pick and choose what country you are going to move up to, basically the United States with all the benefits it hands out.

According to polling, when you ask the American people, who are worried about gas and groceries or whether another load of formula is going to come in from Europe on a military transport in time for their small children to be able to have the type of food that they are accustomed to, the majority of Americans disapprove of the Biden administration's operation of our borders, especially the elimination of title 42, which is a health risk issue.

When you talk about the issue of formula, we are putting Americans last, when the Biden administration prioritized shipments of pallets of baby formula to the border holding stations instead of across the fruited plain. It is pretty pathetic. Indeed, it was this administration whose FDA stepped in on the major producer of formula and said: We are going to shut you down because we had a couple of incidents that have been reported.

So what happens? The FDA didn't call back when the company that is the major producer of formula asks, What is it we need to do to be in compliance in your eyes? The administration knew about this, yet they prioritized what

formula was available to go down to the border stations there. Thankfully, recently, we passed legislation so that we could release more supplies to have them be eligible for those who are on assistance.

As we see the disaster on the border, I don't see a single remedy even being talked about by the Biden administration. They don't really care about the American people.

RECESS

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Pursuant to clause 12(a) of rule I, the Chair declares the House in recess until noon today.

Accordingly (at 10 o'clock and 35 minutes a.m.), the House stood in recess.

□ 1200

AFTER RECESS

The recess having expired, the House was called to order by the Speaker at noon.

PRAYER

The Chaplain, the Reverend Margaret Grun Kibben, offered the following prayer:

Eternal God, on this Flag Day, when we pause to acknowledge the symbol of liberty and democracy to which we pledge our allegiance, remind us of the significance of Your authority over this land of the free and the brave and the faithfulness to which we are called to give to You.

In this season when we celebrate with cookouts and patriotic festivities, when we stand and salute the national ensign held with great honor in the hands of scouts and veterans, may we pause first in homage to the author of our freedoms in whose hands our lives are held.

And as we consider the multitude of times this emblem of our country has draped the caskets of men and women who have worn the cloth of our Nation, having sacrificed their comforts, their security, their very lives in its defense, may we find strength in the covering of the peace You keep over our land and the solace You provide all those who grieve.

Almighty God, long may our flag wave under the banner of love You hold over us.

In Your sovereign name we pray.

Amen.

THE JOURNAL

The SPEAKER. Pursuant to section 11(a) of House Resolution 188, the Journal of the last day's proceedings is approved.

PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE

The SPEAKER. Will the gentleman from Texas (Mr. WILLIAMS) come forward and lead the House in the Pledge of Allegiance.

Mr. WILLIAMS of Texas led the Pledge of Allegiance as follows:

I pledge allegiance to the Flag of the United States of America, and to the Republic for which it stands, one nation under God, indivisible, with liberty and justice for all.

ANNOUNCEMENT BY THE SPEAKER

The SPEAKER. The Chair will entertain up to 15 requests for 1-minute speeches on each side of the aisle.

TAKING ACTION TO END GUN VIOLENCE

(Mr. HIGGINS of New York asked and was given permission to address the House for 1 minute.)

Mr. HIGGINS of New York. Madam Speaker, 1 month ago today, my community of Buffalo was targeted by a racist mass shooter. The lasting toll and trauma of gun violence is evident and perhaps most compelling through the words of Buffalo students in Ms. O'Rourke's class.

Taniya wrote, ''I want to be able to go to school and earn my education without the fear of possibly not making it back home because of the color of my skin.''

NasZair describes feeling vulnerable because he is Black and worries, ''Will my family be safe when we go to the supermarkets?''

Journey says, ''I am 13 years old. It is unfair for a middle schooler to regularly think about these things.'' She asks, ''What will you do and the government do to stop these attacks?''

Brianna pleads, ''I want someone to do something. I want the government to do their job. Too many mass shootings happened in such a small amount of time.''

For students and families in Buffalo and other communities forever changed by mass shootings, now is the time for Congress to do its job and take action to end gun violence.

ELECTING MEMBERS TO CERTAIN STANDING COMMITTEES OF THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Mr. JEFFRIES. Madam Speaker, by direction of the Democratic Caucus, I offer a privileged resolution and ask for its immediate consideration.

The Clerk read the resolution, as follows:

H. RES. 1173

Resolved, That the following named Members be, and are hereby, elected to the following standing committees of the House of Representatives:

COMMITTEE ON AGRICULTURE: Ms. Davids of Kansas.

COMMITTEE ON SMALL BUSINESS: Mr. Peters.

COMMITTEE ON TRANSPORTATION AND INFRASTRUCTURE: Mrs. Cherfilus-McCormick.

Mr. JEFFRIES (during the reading). Madam Speaker, I ask unanimous consent that the resolution be considered as read and printed in the RECORD.

The SPEAKER pro tempore (Mrs. DINGELL). Is there objection to the request of the gentleman from New York?

There was no objection.

The resolution was agreed to.

A motion to reconsider was laid on the table.

PROTECTION FOR SUPREME COURT JUSTICES

(Mr. MCCARTHY asked and was given permission to address the House for 1 minute and to revise and extend his remarks.)

Mr. MCCARTHY. Madam Speaker, after three unanimous consent requests of mine that were blocked, Congress will finally vote to provide Supreme Court Justices and their families with more security.

I am glad this bill is coming to the floor as is. The Senate passed it unanimously, 100–0, more than a month ago. Madam Speaker, the House Democrats have delayed it for more than a month.

The question the American public asks is why? Why would you delay it?

We have all known that additional security has been necessary since the Dobbs opinion was leaked last month. Justice Kavanaugh was targeted by an armed and dangerous man who flew clear across the country to kill him. He had zip ties. He had a plan.

Far-left groups have plans to target Justice Amy Coney Barrett and her children. They put out where their children go to school. But Congress kept it here for a month—for a month. These unnecessary delays put the safety of the Justices and their families in danger.

By passing the bill as is, we are sending a clear message to the leftwing radicals: You cannot intimidate the Supreme Court Justices. I hope we all take that message to heart.

How can we forget what Senator SCHUMER said? He didn't just say it—he screamed it—on the steps of the Supreme Court. ''You will pay the price. You won't know what hit you if you go forward with these awful decisions.''

I don't know what he meant by, ''You will pay the price,'' because the Supreme Court Justices aren't up for an election. It couldn't be that they would lose at the polls. They are lifetime appointments.

Now, I don't know if that young man who came all the way from California to kill a Justice, if that is what he thought SCHUMER was saying, but what was he saying, ''You will pay the price''?

I hope Senator SCHUMER understands that his words have consequences. I believe he should apologize for contributing to this heated climate.

With that said, again, I am glad this bill is finally coming to the floor. It should not have been this hard or taken this long. Every single person in the Senate voted for it: Republican, Democrat, Independent. It sat here for a whole month. Even though we came

to the floor and asked for unanimous consent to bring it forward, we were denied.

It should not have taken a threat against Justice Kavanaugh to force action, a threat that even Speaker PELOSI dismissed in her press conference. She said, ''Everybody will be fine.''

But at the end of the day, this is the better bill, and I am glad it will be heading to the President's desk without any poison pills to ping it back to the Senate, to delay it further. This is a big victory.

Now, let's work to defend our justice system for everyone by upholding the rule of law which is under attack daily in our cities. We can't uphold the rule of law when there is looting, when cities and police stations are being burned down, when criminals are coddled instead of locked up.

Now that this Congress has come together to condemn intimidation against Supreme Court Justices, let's take the next step to keep America safe. Let's support our police, not defund them. Let's enforce all the laws on the books like the law that prohibits protesting outside Justices' homes. Even President Biden encouraged people to do that.

Let's get tough on crime so that every American can feel safe in their homes and in their communities. Just in my home State, back in the home city of our Speaker, San Francisco, the people had a big voice. They have just recalled their district attorney because of crime.

It is not for me to give any political advice to the other side of the aisle, but if you want to know what the Republican registration in San Francisco is, it is 6.8 percent. I think your message of defunding the police by this majority party, and I think your message of not upholding the law, the American public doesn't want that.

They want to feel safe, just as a Supreme Court Justice does. They want to be able to go do their jobs and not feel they are being intimidated.

Let's get tough on crime. We want the American public to feel safe in their homes and their communities. They want to feel safe. Those are the things that would create a safer, stronger America, just like we had before.

I will make this one promise. If Democrats don't do it during this Congress, I promise you we will in the next Congress, because there is definitely going to be a change.

SERGEANTS MAJOR ACADEMY 50TH ANNIVERSARY

(Ms. ESCOBAR asked and was given permission to address the House for 1 minute.)

Ms. ESCOBAR. Madam Speaker, I rise today to recognize the 50th anniversary of the founding of the United States Sergeants Major Academy.

Fort Bliss is the home to the Sergeants Major Academy that trains our military leaders to address our country's challenges. Since 1972, the academy has expanded students' strategic level of thinking to become capable to address large-scale combat operations.

At the end of the academy, leaders leave as agile, adaptive senior leaders with the character, competence, and commitment to be effective leaders.

I am proud that my office's veterans' caseworker, Sergeant Major Benito Torres, graduated from the academy in 2009.

I commend the continuous education that the academy provides and their dedication for our military to be ready for future challenges. Please join me in recognizing the accomplishments of the last 50 years of the United States Sergeants Major Academy and wish them continued growth and success.

CONGRESSIONAL BASEBALL SHOOTING ANNIVERSARY

(Mr. WILLIAMS of Texas asked and was given permission to address the House for 1 minute.)

Mr. WILLIAMS of Texas. Five years ago today, the Republican baseball team took to the field for their regular morning practice. That morning took a dark turn when the team suddenly became a target of a BERNIE SANDERS' supporter with an agenda to shoot and kill Republicans.

It could have been the worst political massacre in American history, but we are alive today, thanks to those brave and honorable law enforcement officers who were at the field that day and willing to sacrifice themselves to protect us.

Every day, I wear this wristband stamped with the date of the shooting and the words, ''In God We Trust'' to remember the angels watching over us on that life-changing morning. It is a testament to that day, always living in our hearts and our minds.

There is no doubt that without quick action of Special Agents Griner and Bailey, along with the Alexandria Police Department, the team would not be here today. We forever owe a debt of gratitude to our law enforcement and our first responders who acted swiftly to take down the gunman and simply save our lives.

In God We Trust.

□ 1215

HONORING THE LIFE OF SHERIFF JOHN O'BRIEN

(Mr. SCHRADER asked and was given permission to address the House for 1 minute and to revise and extend his remarks.)

Mr. SCHRADER. Madam Speaker, I rise today to pay tribute to former Sheriff John O'Brien, who passed away on June 1 at the age of 74. John was a beloved fixture of the Lincoln County community in my district, where he was known for his dedication to the people he served.

A dedicated Oregon State Beaver, after graduating from OSU, John was drafted in the U.S. Army in 1970, and served in Vietnam where he earned a Vietnam Service Medal and Bronze Star. He returned home and joined the Lincoln County Sheriff's office as a patrol deputy in 1973. It was here that John would find his calling, serving his community and the department for 30 years, the last 9 as sheriff, until his retirement in 2003. After retiring from the Sheriff's office, John worked for the Pacific Northwest region of FEMA, assisting with disasters in Oregon, Alaska, Washington, and New York City.

All who were close to John could attest that he cared about people in an extraordinary way. His generous spirit touched everyone in his life. John dedicated his time to making life better for those he served. He will be missed by all who knew him.

He is survived by his wife of 50 years, Priscilla, as well as his kids, Eric and Erin, and his four grandchildren. I hope they can all find peace during this difficult time as well as mourn the loss of an extraordinary member of this great family.

BIDEN GAS PRICES BURDEN FAMILIES

(Mr. WILSON of South Carolina asked and was given permission to address the House for 1 minute and to revise and extend his remarks.)

Mr. WILSON of South Carolina. Madam Speaker, sadly, inflation has increased to over 8 percent, the highest rate in over 40 years. Now family budgets are draining at the pump.

The over $5 per gallon for gas is the highest ever, caused by failing Biden policies. The American Energy Alliance with Stephen Moore on the Unleash Prosperity Hotline has identified over 100 initiatives enacted by Biden to restrict American oil and gas development.

When Biden took office, gas was $2.39 a gallon. Now it has doubled. These extremist policies intentionally discourage gas usage without alternatives available to families. Declaring war on American energy subsidizes war criminal Putin's mass murder in Ukraine and allows Iran to proceed with nuclear weapons to fulfill ''Death to Israel. Death to America.''

America needs price relief through an all-of-the-above energy policy achieved by President Donald Trump.

In conclusion, God bless our troops who have successfully protected America for 20 years in the global war on terrorism as it continues moving from the Afghanistan safe haven to America.

Happy birthday, Donald Trump.

DONALD TRUMP LOST THE 2020 ELECTION

(Mr. LIEU asked and was given permission to address the House for 1 minute.)

Mr. LIEU. Madam Speaker, Donald Trump lost the 2020 Presidential popular vote by over 7 million votes. Trump lost the electoral college 306–232. Trump lost the State of Arizona. Trump lost Nevada. Trump lost Georgia. Trump lost Minnesota. Trump lost Wisconsin. Trump lost Michigan. Trump lost Pennsylvania. Donald Trump lost the 2020 Presidential election.

YET ANOTHER TRUCKING CRISIS

(Mr. LAMALFA asked and was given permission to address the House for 1 minute and to revise and extend his remarks.)

Mr. LAMALFA. Madam Speaker, as we endure more and more of the Biden-induced energy crisis in this country, I have to point out another aspect of that which is very important that we get a handle on soon. Our ability for our trucks to deliver the goods, the products we expect to be in the stores, is going to be hampered even more not just in my home State of California $7 diesel or $6 in the rest of the country, and the ability to get truck drivers, but also, interestingly enough, there is a product called diesel exhaust fluid that is part of the newer truck engines that is going to run out.

It is already in short supply. The railroads are having a hard time shipping it. It is not even produced enough in this country. We have to rely on one important component, urea, that the major exporters of it are China, Russia, and Qatar. We are going to run out of the DEF that you put in the trucks. The trucks will not run without it because the computers will not let the truck run without this fluid, which is a component in the diesel exhaust system.

If we run out of DEF, the trucks can't move, and they will not move the products you need, your food, your other supplies to the stores for you to purchase. So we have yet another crisis within a crisis if we run out of DEF. DEF needs to be produced in this country. We need to produce the urea in this country.

FENTANYL CRISIS DESERVES URGENCY

(Mr. MOORE of Alabama asked and was given permission to address the House for 1 minute.)

Mr. MOORE of Alabama. Madam Speaker, last year alone fentanyl killed more Americans than any weapon of mass destruction in our Nation's history.

Fentanyl is now the number one cause of death for Americans between the ages of 18 and 45. It is not guns. It is not COVID–19. It is not even car accidents. It is fentanyl.

CDC numbers show more total drug overdose deaths last year in the U.S. than those killed by the atomic bomb blast that ended World War II.

The direct cause of so many American deaths from fentanyl is the Biden administration's surrender on our southern border. In 2021 alone, more than 11,000 pounds of fentanyl was seized at our southern border. So just imagine how much fentanyl got across the border and into our communities.

Fentanyl is a drug so deadly poisonous that the Russian military has reportedly weaponized it. Countless families who have lost loved ones to fentanyl deserve better than what we are getting from this administration.

That is why I cosponsored Congresswoman BOEBERT's Fentanyl is a WMD Act, a designation that follows the 2019 proposal from the Trump administration that would enable our government to treat the fentanyl crisis with the urgency that it deserves.

We can't turn the other way as the Mexican drug cartels kill thousands of young Americans. We must take the fentanyl threat seriously, and we must secure our border.

ANNOUNCEMENT BY THE SPEAKER PRO TEMPORE

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Pursuant to clause 8 of rule XX, the Chair will postpone further proceedings today on motions to suspend the rules on which the yeas and nays are ordered.

The House will resume proceedings on postponed questions at a later time.

SUPREME COURT POLICE PARITY ACT OF 2022

Mr. LIEU. Madam Speaker, I move to suspend the rules and pass the bill (S. 4160) to amend title 40, United States Code, to grant the Supreme Court of the United States security-related authorities equivalent to the legislative and executive branches.

The Clerk read the title of the bill.

The text of the bill is as follows:

S. 4160

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives of the United States of America in Congress assembled,

SECTION 1. SHORT TITLE.

This Act may be cited as the ''Supreme Court Police Parity Act of 2022''.

SEC. 2. AUTHORITY TO PROTECT FAMILY MEMBERS.

Section 6121(a)(2) of title 40, United States Code, is amended—

(1) in subparagraph (A), by striking ''and'' at the end;

(2) in subparagraph (B), by adding ''and'' after the semicolon; and

(3) by adding at the end the following:

''(C) any member of the immediate family of the Chief Justice, any Associate Justice, or any officer of the Supreme Court if the Marshal determines such protection is necessary.''.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Pursuant to the rule, the gentleman from California (Mr. LIEU) and the gentleman from Ohio (Mr. JORDAN) each will control 20 minutes.

The Chair recognizes the gentleman from California.

GENERAL LEAVE

Mr. LIEU. Madam Speaker, I ask unanimous consent that all Members may have 5 legislative days in which to revise and extend their remarks and include extraneous material on S. 4160.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Is there objection to the request of the gentleman from California?

There was no objection.

Mr. LIEU. Madam Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

Madam Speaker, I rise in support of S. 4160, the Supreme Court Police Parity Act of 2022.

While the Supreme Court police force is currently authorized to provide protection to the Justices of the Supreme Court, this bill would unequivocally extend their authority to provide protection to family members of Justices if there is reason to believe they are at risk.

It is imperative that the Justices are free from fear of violence or physical intimidation to make decisions based on the Constitution and law as applied to the facts of the cases before them. This is essential to the rule of law. Assailants like the man arrested recently for allegedly plotting against the life of one of our Justices are a threat to our democracy, but with the right security, they can also be stopped before they inflict harm.

I thank Senators COONS and CORNYN for their work on this issue in the Senate, and Representatives STANTON, CORREA, and ISSA for their work in the House, likewise introducing bills that would extend protection to the families of Justices. I also thank Congresswoman SHEILA JACKSON LEE as well.

I further note that Mr. STANTON's bill would have also extended protection to the families of Court employees. We understand that there was Republican opposition to that aspect of the bill, and in the interest of protecting the Justices' families, we could no longer delay in passing the only version of the bill they would apparently agree to. But I hope we will swiftly move another bill to extend protection to families of employees as well.

I hope my colleagues will join me in passing this straightforward measure to ensure that the families of Supreme Court Justices have the necessary protection from any threats they may face.

Madam Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. JORDAN. Madam Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

Madam Speaker, why did it take so long? Why did it take so long to bring this legislation to the floor? It has been over a month since the leak of the draft opinion, over a month of threats on Supreme Court Justices and their families, over a month of protests at their homes. Why did it take so long? I mean, the protests at their homes are a direct violation of the law, 18 U.S.C. section 1507. Over a month.

It has been over a week, or actually a week, since an assassination attempt on a Supreme Court Justice, on Justice

Kavanaugh. Think about that for a second. An assassination attempt on a sitting United States Supreme Court Justice.

And what did the Speaker of the House say last week? No one is in danger. No rush on this legislation. No concern here.

The Senate passed this bill a month ago. Why hasn't the House? Why did it take so long? I think the answer is obvious. Because they have always wanted to intimidate the Court. That has been their goal since the get-go. Their goal was to intimidate the Court. That has been their objective all along.

Think about the history first. We had the Kavanaugh confirmation mess where the left has made up things about Justice Kavanaugh and his family. Then we had the leader of the Senate, the Democrat leader of the Senate on the Supreme Court steps say to two Justices, Mr. Kavanaugh and Mr. Gorsuch: You have released the whirlwind, and you will pay the price.

Last April, the Democrat chair of the Judiciary Committee introduced legislation to do what? To pack the Court, to add four Associate Justices to the United States Supreme Court. Why four? Why not one? Why not two? Why not three? Why four? Because four would give them a majority on the Court.

Then there was the sustained attack on Justice Thomas and his wife over the last several weeks. The Democrats on the Judiciary Committee even had hearings about Justice Thomas.

Then, of course, there was the leak of the draft opinion itself, something that has never happened. And then there were the protests at Supreme Court Justices' homes, again in direct violation of the statute.

And then, finally, there was the hearing the Democrats had in the Judiciary Committee about the abortion issue while the Dobbs decision is pending in front of the Court. You remember that hearing. That was the one where the Democrat witness said men could get pregnant. That is the history here.

And then, of course, last week, we had an assassination attempt on Justice Kavanaugh. Intimidation is their goal. It is the same reason the Department of Homeland Security stood up the Disinformation Governance Board. It is the same reason the Department of Justice is targeting parents who have the nerve to show up at a school board meeting and speak up for their kids. It is all about intimidation. That is how the left operates, and we have seen it play out now against the Supreme Court.

But the good news is, finally, this bill is going to pass and give the Justices of the highest Court in our land the protection they and their families deserve. I say better late than never. We support this legislation. It should have passed a darn long time ago.

Madam Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. LIEU. Madam Speaker, let me tell you why it took us a few weeks rather than just 1 week to pass this legislation. It is because Republicans refused to protect the families of Supreme Court employees who are at risk. Shame on you for not doing that.

And, by the way, there are threats to Justices across the board. I support this legislation. I just note that recently there was an article on CNN titled ''Justice Sonia Sotomayor was targeted by gunman, Federal judge tells '60 Minutes,' '' dated February 19, 2021. Intimidation goes on both sides.

Madam Speaker, I support this legislation, and I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. JORDAN. Madam Speaker, that is why Republicans have condemned violence every single time it happened. We condemned it when it happened on January 6. But guess what? We also condemned it when it happened in the summer of 2020.

It hasn't been a few weeks since the leak of the draft opinion. It has been 6 weeks. The Senate passed this legislation unanimously, and they wouldn't bring it up. They wouldn't bring it up. In fact, the Speaker of the House, as I said before, the Speaker of the House said last week there was no need to bring it up, but now we are going to. Thank goodness for that.

Madam Speaker, I yield 4 minutes to the gentleman from California (Mr. ISSA), my friend.

Mr. ISSA. Madam Speaker, listening to the initial debate here, you would believe that there was a legitimate difference of opinion here on the floor about protecting the Justices. Clearly, there was no such difference in the U.S. Senate. What there is, though, is a story that I think needs to be told.

□ 1230

When I authored this legislation a month ago, I knew that we had support in the Senate, and I knew that we would have support in the House. The first thing I did was I called up the most senior member of the Judiciary Committee on the other side of the aisle and said to him that I believe we should do this. He agreed. Not checking with staff, he agreed to this simple bill of protecting those who would be intimidated and those who would be threatened and those whose lives could not be replaced in a timely fashion without changing the outcome of the Court. And that was it; I had my cosponsor.

A day later, mysteriously, another bill, very different, was dropped in the hopper by the Speaker's staff. It was done so without a Republican cosponsor, without a call to the ranking member who stands here today. That was done because they wanted to play message with it. They wanted to delay, and the Speaker has delayed for a month.

Madam Speaker, 18 U.S.C. 1507 is not a suggestion that you prevent intimidation of the Court. It is a law. It is a law that the President of the United States has sworn to uphold and, through his Attorney General, has not, has negated the responsibility.

This legislation is not only essential to protect against another assassination attempt of a Justice or their family, but it is even more important because this administration, as we speak, is not obeying the law that they have sworn to obey, one that the Attorney General is required to. So, it is a double-edged sword that I come with today.

Democrats took 30 days and waited a week after the attempted assassination of a Supreme Court Justice before they would bring a commonsense, noncontroversial piece of legislation to the floor. I applaud all of those who will vote for it today, and I suspect that it will be voted for unanimously here on the floor.

But justice delayed, or protection of our Justice delayed, could have led to the death of a Justice and, even as we speak, still could.

Let's pass it. Let's pass it without further controversy. And let's never again do something as shameful as ignore the law and delay protection of people who are being intimidated.

Mr. LIEU. Madam Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

The Republicans are misleading you. Supreme Court Justices already have protection. Let me say that again. Supreme Court Justices already have protection.

This is about families of Supreme Court Justices, which I support them having protection, and Democrats are fighting for families of law clerks and employees of the Supreme Court. They should have protection, too.

Let me tell you the threats to employees of the Supreme Court. Soon after the draft decision leaked, a rightwing activist posted the personal details of a law clerk who he baselessly claimed had leaked Justice Alito's draft opinion overturning Roe v. Wade. This rightwing activist even posted the clerk's wedding announcement and singled out the clerk's spouse. Republicans don't want to protect that person or their family.

After another Republican strategist claimed a different law clerk had leaked the opinion, an extremist antiabortion rights group issued a press release targeting that clerk and the Justice the clerk worked for. The author of the press release had served years in prison for conspiring to blow up an abortion clinic. Referring to the people in the Justice's office, the group's leader said that he could smell their fear.

Republicans don't want to protect the families of Supreme Court employees. Shame on them.

Recently, a news outlet obtained a DHS intelligence report identifying threats to murder Justices and their clerks. Why don't Republicans want to protect the families of Supreme Court employees?

Madam Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. JORDAN. Madam Speaker, I yield 2 minutes to the gentleman from Georgia (Mr. HICE).

Mr. HICE of Georgia. Madam Speaker, unfortunately, this bill is necessary because we have a radical and unhinged leftwing activist group of individuals that also have been encouraged by the slow-walking Democratic Party in hopes of intimidation being used to influence the courts. That is why we are here today.

We have assassination attempts on Judge Kavanaugh. We have fire bombings of women's resource centers and healthcare facilities. We have U.S. Senators, sitting U.S. Senators, encouraging violence against the children and families of Supreme Court Justices.

Ever since the leak took place some 6 weeks ago, there have been at least 14 coordinated attacks on women's pregnancy care facilities, and Democratic leadership has endorsed and encouraged physical threats to their political opposition. This is totally unacceptable. It is un-American.

The unhinged left is not the party that empowers women. If that were true, they would not be trying to destroy women's resource centers, nor would they be trying to attack and intimidate those who work there. They would not be threatening the life of and encouraging violence toward the children of the fourth woman to serve on the United States Supreme Court.

The protests that have been taking place outside the Justices' homes this past month are unacceptable, and Democratic leadership has refused to condemn the threats of violence.

One great example of this is, despite the law and the prohibition against such protests, Jen Psaki, while she was White House press secretary, stated: ''. . . we certainly continue to encourage that outside of judges' homes, and that is the President's position.''

This is the position of the Democratic Party: intimidation and fear. Now it is getting out of control. It is about time the Democrats are coming to admit it. I encourage my colleagues to support this legislation.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Members are reminded to refrain from engaging in personalities toward the Senate or its Members.

Mr. LIEU. Madam Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. JORDAN. Madam Speaker, I yield 2 minutes to the gentleman from Pennsylvania (Mr. PERRY).

Mr. PERRY. Madam Speaker, Supreme Court Justices are already protected. Really? Really? They are already protected?

The Speaker said no one is in danger, no one is in danger after an assassination attempt. I don't know if I would feel very protected. On the very day of the assassination attempt, in violation of the law, protesters are at the very house of the Supreme Court Justice being intimidated by protesters.

The Speaker says that no one is in danger. I don't want to engage in personalities, so I might say a high-ranking official on the other side of the Capitol here said: You have released the whirlwind; you don't know what will hit you. And then down the street, Pennsylvania Avenue, a high-ranking official said there might be a mini-revolution.

Does that not sound like intimidation to you? It sure sounds like it to me. I don't know what my friends on the other side of the aisle want to happen. I don't know. I am not in their heads, and I am not in their hearts. But I listen to what they say, and I watch what they do. We should have passed this much longer ago when it was available to us, and the fact that we didn't might be the cause for people to come to assassinate a United States Supreme Court Justice.

This is not a third-world country. If you don't get your way, you don't blow up the Court and kill the Justices. But, apparently, that is what some people in America think is appropriate. It is not appropriate. I urge my colleagues to support this legislation.

Mr. LIEU. Madam Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. JORDAN. Madam Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

Let me say this. Reading from a headline here, this group, Ruth Sent Us, ''. . . hinted at targeting Supreme Court Justice Barrett's children, church.'' Let me read the headline here. ''Group gave details on Barrett's routine, her children's school, and family's spiritual life.''

In plain English, this group was saying where Justice Coney Barrett goes each day, where her kids go to school, and where her family goes to church. They gave those details.

Last week, the Democrats said no one is in danger. After an assassination attempt on Justice Barrett's colleague, Justice Kavanaugh, they said not to worry. Everything is fine. We don't need to pass this legislation after the Senate had done it unanimously. That is the position of the Democrats in this body.

That is why we are saying: Why did it take so long? Six weeks ago was when the draft leak happened, and the protests started at Justices' homes almost immediately after the leak of that draft, that unprecedented leak of that draft opinion. They have been doing it now for weeks and weeks and weeks.

Here is the email from this organization, this Ruth Sent Us organization. Here is one of the messages: ''If you are in the D.C. metro area, join us. Our protests at Barrett's home moved the needle to this coverage. Falls Church is a People of Praise stronghold. She sends her seven kids to a People of Praise school that she sat on the board of directors for. She attends church daily,'' as if that is bad to go to church daily. I think that is a good thing. But this is what they are saying, this group, giving the details of where her kids go to school, where they go to church, and her daily routine.

And the Democrats said: Nothing to worry about.

That is our concern. So thank goodness this bill is here.

Madam Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. LIEU. Madam Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

I am going to respond to that because what he just said is a lie. The fact that he is saying Democrats think there is nothing wrong, there is no danger to Supreme Court Justices, is a lie. Why? Because we are the majority party, and we just put this bill up, and we are about to vote on it. We clearly care about Supreme Court Justices.

But we also care about the families and employees of the Supreme Court, and that is what we are talking about today. Again, I just want to remind you, Republicans are misleading you. Supreme Court Justices right now have law enforcement protection details. They are protected by law enforcement. This bill has to do with the families of Supreme Court Justices. I support protecting them. I also support protecting the employees and their families of the Supreme Court.

That is the dispute. The Democrats want to also protect the employees and families who are getting threats from rightwing activists, intimidation from the far right.

Do you want to talk about intimidation? I will tell you what intimidation is. It is Trump supporters assaulting the Capitol on January 6, brutalizing 140 police officers. That is intimidation.

Madam Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. JORDAN. Madam Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

We condemned what took place on January 6. It would have been nice if Democrats would have done the same thing in the summer of 2020 or passed this legislation 6 weeks ago or a month ago when the Senate passed it.

Let me just recite a few things here that have been said by our colleagues on the other side.

Former Attorney General Eric Holder said in 2018, at a campaign event in Georgia, to kick Republicans. ''No. No. When they go low, we kick them.'' That is what this new Democratic Party is about.

It sure is. It is all about intimidation: intimidating the court, intimidating parents who have the nerve to show up at school board meetings, setting up a Disinformation Governance Board to intimidate free speech rights of all Americans. That is what the new Democratic Party is about.

We have seen it time and time again. In the summer of 2018, we saw one of our colleagues from California, a Democrat Member, say: Let's make sure we show up wherever we have to show up. And if you see anybody from the Trump Cabinet in a restaurant, in a department store, at a gasoline station, out in a crowd, you create a crowd and push back on them, and you tell them—think about this. This is a Member of Congress saying this to a Cabinet member—you tell them they are

not welcome anymore, anywhere. A Cabinet member of the administration not welcome in their own darn country? That is what a Member of Congress said on the Democrat side.

We had another Member of Congress on the Democrat side say this: There needs to be ''unrest on the streets,'' calling for unrest on the streets while there was unrest on the streets in the summer of 2020.

That is why this legislation is so darn important and why we cannot figure out—the gentleman just said something that wasn't accurate. The Speaker of the House last week said no one is in danger. I just read you what they are posting about Justice Coney Barrett and her family and where they go to church and where her seven kids go to school. Of course, this is in the context of everything they have done to intimidate the Court and an assassination attempt on another Justice, Justice Kavanaugh.

Madam Speaker, I yield such time as he may consume to the gentleman from North Carolina (Mr. BISHOP).

□ 1245

Mr. BISHOP of North Carolina. Madam Speaker, I thank the gentleman from Ohio for yielding.

I have missed most of the debate on the floor. Mr. JORDAN just made reference to an item that bowls me over. You wonder after you have been in Washington for a little while whether anything will surprise you. Yes, Madam Speaker, that tweet by the proabortion group, Ruth Sent Us, that identified Justice Barrett's church and identified the school that her children attend and encouraged protestors to ''voice your anger'' by demonstrating there, is a new low.

Not just the identification of Justices' home addresses, which I never thought we would see, not just the crowds materializing there, which I never thought we would see, not just the appearance of an assassin at the home of a Justice, which we have never seen, and yet, the response is: What about January 6?

As the gentleman from Ohio made the point, I have never encountered any Republican who declined to condemn the violence and rioting at the Capitol that day. I have never found one. I have never heard one. And yet, I never hear condemnation of such conduct as I have described from Democrats. I might be missing it. I am not hearing it now. I am hearing this, What about January 6?

I condemn the rioting and the violence at the Capitol on January 6.

I condemn the Democrat leader of the Senate standing in front of the Supreme Court to say to two specific Justices that, You have released the whirlwind. You will suffer the result. I don't remember the exact words. And then what I do remember, the phrase that sticks in my mind: ''You won't know what hit you if you go forward with these awful decisions.'' I never hear condemnation for that. I don't know why.

I do think I know why this bill had to be delayed from last week when we were here and could have passed it. That is because you want to protect the leaker. That implies that although this has been pending for a month and a half and the Nation doesn't know who the leaker is, somebody knows who the leaker is; and that is who you want to protect, amazing as that is, unprecedented as that is.

We certainly ought to pass this legislation and protect the Justices of the United States Supreme Court from assassins, assassins responding to the unprecedented advocacy on the left.

Mr. LIEU. Madam Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

I condemn violence whether it is from rightwing groups or leftwing groups or white supremacist groups or any other group. Democrats say this all the time.

I will tell you why Republicans don't hear it. Because they are in their bubble watching just Fox News, who won't even show the January 6 hearings. That is why they don't hear any of this stuff because it is never played to them or their base. Democrats condemn violence all the time.

By the way, last year—I am just going to tell you the headline of this article again: ''Justice Sonia Sotomayor was targeted by gunmen . . .'' Did Republicans jump up in outrage? No, no, they didn't.

So let's just be clear here what we are talking about today, once again: Supreme Court Justices get law enforcement protection right now, as we speak.

This is actually a dispute about employees. So I am going to ask Republicans a question, and I bet you they will not answer it: Why do they not want to protect the employees and their families of the Supreme Court?

Madam Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. JORDAN. Madam Speaker, the employees of the Supreme Court are already protected. This is about protecting the Justices' families, and we know that is needed based on the headline I read and the email that Mr. BISHOP just talked about.

The gentleman said that Democrats condemn violence. No, they don't. No, they don't. They called rioters and looters the entire summer of 2020, they called them ''peaceful protestors.'' And that same summer, then-Senator now-Vice President HARRIS raised money to bail those rioters and looters and people who went after the police out of jail. So you have got to stick with the facts here, and that is just not accurate what was stated earlier.

For all the reasons we have highlighted, Madam Speaker, we are glad this bill is finally going to pass. We just wish it would have happened when it should have, weeks and weeks ago when this threat was first present for Supreme Court Justices.

Madam Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. LIEU. Madam Speaker, I yield 2 minutes to the gentlewoman from Texas (Ms. ESCOBAR).

Ms. ESCOBAR. Madam Speaker, it is incredible to stand here and listen to our Republican colleagues talk about the risks and the dangers that exist to the Supreme Court.

I want to know where they were when the risks and the dangers existed for my community, El Paso, Texas, where 23 innocent people were slaughtered by a white supremacist with an AK–47? Where were they then? How about Uvalde? Where were they then? How about every other mass shooting? Buffalo? You name it.

Last week, we brought to the floor legislation intended to protect millions of Americans, especially and including children. The vast majority of our Republican colleagues voted against those protections for vulnerable people who don't have access to 24-hour, round-the-clock U.S. Marshal protection. They don't have access to round-the-clock, 24/7 Capitol Police protection, which Supreme Court Justices have today. Supreme Court Justices have far more protections than Members of Congress do, but more importantly they have more than those innocent lives that were taken in innumerable cities across America.

And as they rail about and clutch their pearls over the fact that it took House Democrats some time to get this bill to the floor, the reason it took that much time is because it was House Democrats that at least wanted to get one itty-bitty concession out of this bill to protect the staff of that institution, the United States Supreme Court. But they refused.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The time of the gentlewoman has expired.

Mr. LIEU. Madam Speaker, I yield an additional 30 seconds to the gentlewoman from Texas.

Ms. ESCOBAR. Madam Speaker, I remind the American public why they brought this bill to the floor, both in the Senate and here; it is a talking point. It is not because it really does anything, it is simply a talking point. It came as a result of a leaked decision on the Justices' desire to take away women's reproductive care.

Guess who else doesn't get protections in America the way that they would like to protect others? It is those healthcare providers and patients and staff who are vulnerable every day, especially because of the actions of the Supreme Court.

Mr. JORDAN. Madam Speaker, a talking point? The left is telling people where Justice Barrett's kids go to school. That is not a talking point, that is a fact. That is one of the craziest things I have heard said on this floor.

A talking point? Every single Senator voted for this package. That includes Democrats. Every single one.

A talking point? You have got to be kidding me.

They are reporting where a Supreme Court Justice's kids go to school, where her family goes to church, her daily routine, and the left calls it a talking point?

Madam Speaker, I urge a ''yes'' vote on this bill, and I yield back the balance of my time.

Mr. LIEU. Madam Speaker, S. 4160 is a straightforward bill that will protect the families of the Justices. Democrats also fought to try to protect the families of Supreme Court employees. Republicans objected and won't do that, so this is the best we can get.

Madam Speaker, I urge my colleagues to support the bill, and I yield back the balance of my time.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The question is on the motion offered by the gentleman from California (Mr. LIEU) that the House suspend the rules and pass the bill, S. 4160.

The question was taken.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. In the opinion of the Chair, two-thirds being in the affirmative, the ayes have it.

Mr. LIEU. Madam Speaker, on that I demand the yeas and nays.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Pursuant to section 3(s) of House Resolution 8, the yeas and nays are ordered.

Pursuant to clause 8 of rule XX, further proceedings on this motion are postponed.

PROVIDING FOR CONSIDERATION OF H.R. 2543, FEDERAL RESERVE RACIAL AND ECONOMIC EQUITY ACT; PROVIDING FOR CONSIDERATION OF H.R. 2773, RECOVERING AMERICA'S WILDLIFE ACT OF 2021; AND PROVIDING FOR CONSIDERATION OF H.R. 7606, MEAT AND POULTRY SPECIAL INVESTIGATOR ACT OF 2022; AND FOR OTHER PURPOSES

Mr. DESAULNIER. Madam Speaker, by direction of the Committee on Rules, I call up House Resolution 1170 and ask for its immediate consideration.

The Clerk read the resolution, as follows:

H. RES. 1170

Resolved, That upon adoption of this resolution it shall be in order to consider in the House the bill (H.R. 2543) to amend the Federal Reserve Act to add additional demographic reporting requirements, to modify the goals of the Federal Reserve System, and for other purposes. All points of order against consideration of the bill are waived. In lieu of the amendment in the nature of a substitute recommended by the Committee on Financial Services now printed in the bill, an amendment in the nature of a substitute consisting of the text of Rules Committee Print 117–49, modified by the amendment printed in part A of the report of the Committee on Rules accompanying this resolution, shall be considered as adopted. The bill, as amended, shall be considered as read. All points of order against provisions in the bill, as amended, are waived. The previous question shall be considered as ordered on the bill, as amended, and on any further amendment thereto, to final passage without intervening motion except: (1) one hour of debate equally divided and controlled by the chair and ranking minority member of the Committee on Financial Services or their respective designees; (2) the further amendments described in section 2 of this resolution; (3) the amendments en bloc described in section 3 of this resolution; and (4) one motion to recommit.

SEC. 2. After debate pursuant to the first section of this resolution, each further amendment printed in part B of the report of the Committee on Rules not earlier considered as part of amendments en bloc pursuant to section 3 of this resolution shall be considered only in the order printed in the report, may be offered only by a Member designated in the report, shall be considered as read, shall be debatable for the time specified in the report equally divided and controlled by the proponent and an opponent, may be withdrawn by the proponent at any time before the question is put thereon, shall not be subject to amendment, and shall not be subject to a demand for division of the question.

SEC. 3. It shall be in order at any time after debate pursuant to the first section of this resolution for the chair of the Committee on Financial Services or her designee to offer amendments en bloc consisting of further amendments printed in part B of the report of the Committee on Rules accompanying this resolution not earlier disposed of. Amendments en bloc offered pursuant to this section shall be considered as read, shall be debatable for 20 minutes equally divided and controlled by the chair and ranking minority member of the Committee on Financial Services or their respective designees, shall not be subject to amendment, and shall not be subject to a demand for division of the question.

SEC. 4. All points of order against the further amendments printed in part B of the report of the Committee on Rules or amendments en bloc described in section 3 of this resolution are waived.

SEC. 5. Upon adoption of this resolution it shall be in order to consider in the House the bill (H.R. 2773) to amend the Pittman-Robertson Wildlife Restoration Act to make supplemental funds available for management of fish and wildlife species of greatest conservation need as determined by State fish and wildlife agencies, and for other purposes. All points of order against consideration of the bill are waived. In lieu of the amendment in the nature of a substitute recommended by the Committee on Natural Resources now printed in the bill, an amendment in the nature of a substitute consisting of the text of Rules Committee Print 117–47, modified by the amendment printed in part C of the report of the Committee on Rules accompanying this resolution, shall be considered as adopted. The bill, as amended, shall be considered as read. All points of order against provisions in the bill, as amended, are waived. The previous question shall be considered as ordered on the bill, as amended, and on any further amendment thereto, to final passage without intervening motion except: (1) one hour of debate equally divided and controlled by the chair and ranking minority member of the Committee on Natural Resources or their respective designees; (2) the further amendments described in section 6 of this resolution; (3) the amendments en bloc described in section 7 of this resolution; and (4) one motion to recommit.

SEC. 6. After debate pursuant to section 5 of this resolution, each further amendment printed in part D of the report of the Committee on Rules not earlier considered as part of amendments en bloc pursuant to section 7 of this resolution shall be considered only in the order printed in the report, may be offered only by a Member designated in the report, shall be considered as read, shall be debatable for the time specified in the report equally divided and controlled by the proponent and an opponent, may be withdrawn by the proponent at any time before the question is put thereon, shall not be subject to amendment, and shall not be subject to a demand for division of the question.

SEC. 7. It shall be in order at any time after debate pursuant to section 5 of this resolution for the chair of the Committee on Natural Resources or his designee to offer amendments en bloc consisting of further amendments printed in part D of the report of the Committee on Rules accompanying this resolution not earlier disposed of. Amendments en bloc offered pursuant to this section shall be considered as read, shall be debatable for 20 minutes equally divided and controlled by the chair and ranking minority member of the Committee on Natural Resources or their respective designees, shall not be subject to amendment, and shall not be subject to a demand for division of the question.

SEC. 8. All points of order against the further amendments printed in part D of the report of the Committee on Rules or amendments en bloc described in section 7 of this resolution are waived.

SEC. 9. Upon adoption of this resolution it shall be in order to consider in the House the bill (H.R. 7606) to establish the Office of the Special Investigator for Competition Matters within the Department of Agriculture. All points of order against consideration of the bill are waived. In lieu of the amendment in the nature of a substitute recommended by the Committee on Agriculture now printed in the bill, an amendment in the nature of a substitute consisting of the text of Rules Committee Print 117–50, modified by the amendment printed in part E of the report of the Committee on Rules accompanying this resolution, shall be considered as adopted. The bill, as amended, shall be considered as read. All points of order against provisions in the bill, as amended, are waived. The previous question shall be considered as ordered on the bill, as amended, and on any further amendment thereto, to final passage without intervening motion except: (1) one hour of debate equally divided and controlled by the chair and ranking minority member of the Committee on Agriculture or their respective designees; (2) the further amendments described in section 10 of this resolution; and (3) one motion to recommit.

SEC. 10. After debate pursuant to section 9 of this resolution, each further amendment printed in part F of the report of the Committee on Rules shall be considered only in the order printed in the report, may be offered only by a Member designated in the report, shall be considered as read, shall be debatable for the time specified in the report equally divided and controlled by the proponent and an opponent, may be withdrawn by the proponent at any time before the question is put thereon, shall not be subject to amendment, and shall not be subject to a demand for division of the question. All points of order against the further amendments printed in part F of the report of the Committee on Rules are waived.

SEC. 11. House Resolution 188, agreed to March 8, 2021 (as most recently amended by House Resolution 1153, agreed to June 8, 2022), is amended by striking ''June 17, 2022'' each place it appears and inserting (in each instance) ''June 22, 2022''.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The gentleman from California is recognized for 1 hour.

Mr. DESAULNIER. Madam Speaker, for the purpose of debate only, I yield the customary 30 minutes to the gentleman from Pennsylvania (Mr.

RESCHENTHALER), pending which I yield myself such time as I may consume. During consideration of this resolution, all time yielded is for the debate only.

GENERAL LEAVE

Mr. DESAULNIER. Madam Speaker, I ask unanimous consent that all Members be given 5 legislative days in which to revise and extend their remarks.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Is there objection to the request of the gentleman from California?

There was no objection.

□ 1300

Mr. DESAULNIER. Madam Speaker, yesterday, the Rules Committee met and reported a rule, House Resolution 1170, for three measures.

First, it provides for consideration of H.R. 2543 under a structured rule. The rule self-executes a manager's amendment, provides 1 hour of general debate equally divided and controlled by the chair and ranking member of the Committee on Financial Services, makes in order 27 amendments, and provides one motion to recommit.

Second, the rule provides for consideration of H.R. 2773 under a structured rule. The rule self-executes a manager's amendment, provides 1 hour of general debate equally divided and controlled by the chair and the ranking member of the Committee on Natural Resources, makes in order eight amendments, and provides one motion to recommit.

Third, the rule provides for consideration of H.R. 7606 under a structured rule. The rule self-executes a manager's amendment, provides 1 hour of general debate equally divided and controlled by the chair and ranking member of the Committee on Agriculture, makes in order two amendments, and provides one motion to recommit.

Finally, the rule extends recess instructions, suspension authority, and same day authority through June 22, 2022.

First, I will say a few words about the Lower Food and Fuel Costs Act. Times are tough for working families across our country. Food prices are rising and gas prices are at an all-time high. At the same time, food companies and Big Oil are making record profits at the expense of these same hard-working Americans.

Costs are rising up and down the supply chain. The cost of fertilizer and pesticides has risen 50 percent over the past year, in part due to the ongoing war in Ukraine. Rising energy prices, increasing trucking costs, and the worst outbreak of avian flu in 7 years are all contributing to the higher prices consumers are paying at the grocery store.

Plus, combine oil companies' irresponsibility with Putin's war in Ukraine, and you have an unbearable situation for American consumers. The Lower Food and Fuel Costs Act will help us look out for working families, not just big corporations and their billionaire CEOs. This package of bipartisan legislation supports farmers and lowers prices for America's families at the grocery store and at the gas pump.

This rule also allows us to consider a package of legislation aimed at addressing racial and economic inequities that limit opportunities for Americans to buy homes, access loans, and earn fair wages.

Income and wealth inequality is higher in the United States than in any other developed country, and there are examples of it in almost all parts of our lives. The reforms in this package will help us better target and measure outcomes for underserved populations.

Finally, the Recovering America's Wildlife Act helps protect the more than one-third of all fish and wildlife species in the United States that are at risk of extinction.

This legislation funds conservation efforts for more than 12,000 species of wildlife and plants, and the recovery of 1,600 species already listed as threatened or endangered.

Taken together and taken separately, these bills will all lead to real important change for Americans.

Madam Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. RESCHENTHALER. Madam Speaker, I thank the distinguished gentleman from California for yielding me the customary 30 minutes, and I yield myself such time as I may consume.

Madam Speaker, the rule before us provides for consideration of three pieces of legislation that are, once again, missed opportunities to provide real relief to the American people.

Rather than working with Republicans to address the serious issues facing our Nation, Democrats again prioritize the interests of far-left special interest groups and their radical progressive base over the needs of American workers and American families.

Look no further than H.R. 2543, a compilation of 13 Committee on Financial Services' bills that prioritize woke policies and unnecessary reporting over actually fixing Biden's economic crisis.

As my friends across the aisle will remember, under President Trump, U.S. employment reached a 50-year low of 3.5 percent. Additionally, under President Trump, minority unemployment dropped to the lowest levels on record.

Compare that with the economy under the Democrats' one-party rule. Inflation is now at a 40-year high. Gas prices are now over $5 a gallon. Americans can expect to pay an extra $5,200 this year compared to last year for the same goods and services.

Once again, rather than just working with Republicans to provide real economic relief, the Democrats continue to double down on reckless spending, far-left policies, and have prioritized their Big Government socialism over free market principles. What has this led to?

It has led to economic instability. It threatens the stability of our Federal Reserve. It piles regulatory costs on small businesses. It emboldens unelected and unaccountable career bureaucrats.

Ultimately, H.R. 2543 will make it more difficult for low-income and minority borrowers to start a business, to buy a home, and to build credit. It actually does the opposite of the intended effect.

This will also provide for consideration of H.R. 7606, a bill that claims to lower food costs by appointing a ''special investigator,'' and this special investigator will investigate American meat packers and live poultry dealers.

Let's be clear, this legislation is a weak attempt to lay the blame for President Biden's economic crisis on American job creators. In reality, this is just another unfunded mandate that empowers Washington bureaucrats and places new burdens on American food producers.

Alarmingly, these compliance costs may actually raise the price of food even higher, making life in Joe Biden's America even harder on average American families.

Finally, this bill provides for consideration of H.R. 2773, the Recovering America's Wildlife Act of 2022. While I support conservation efforts, I am incredibly disappointed once again by the majority walking away from talks with Republicans to find offsets and to try to resolve spending concerns for the $1.34 billion in new annual mandatory spending authorized by this bill.

In fact, according to the CBO, this legislation spends $12.7 billion just in the first 10 years alone.

Madam Speaker, 80 percent of Americans say inflation is the most important issue facing this country. You wouldn't know it by looking at the bills Democrats are prioritizing for floor action this week.

□ 1315

Perhaps it is time that my Big Government, Democratic colleagues actually listen to the American people and work with Republicans on real economic solutions rather than doubling down on the out-of-control spending and reckless far-left policies that created Biden's economic crisis in the first place.

Madam Speaker, I strongly urge my colleagues to vote ''no'' to oppose this rule, and I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. DESAULNIER. Madam Speaker, I always, as we have these debates with my good friend from Pennsylvania, encourage that we do work together acknowledging that we have differences of opinion and reminding people who are maybe watching that we are in a global economy that has inflation globally and that what we are doing in this package is to try to provide some small instruments for oversight accountability so that we can have as much control as we can in a global economy that is impacting this inflation that is so hard for working Americans.

So with all due respect to my friend from Pennsylvania, I am always willing to work with him. But this package is intended to provide more accountability, not more bureaucracy.

Madam Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. RESCHENTHALER. Madam Speaker, I hear about this being a global issue. It is a global issue, but the reason it is a global issue—quick economics lesson—we are still the reserve currency. We also are the largest GDP. We are exporting the inflation to other countries.

Let's be clear. The inflation is caused by Joe Biden's reckless, Big Government, socialist agenda and, unfortunately, the American people as well as the world have to deal with this recklessness.

Madam Speaker, I yield 5 minutes to the gentlewoman from Minnesota (Mrs. FISCHBACH), who is my good friend on the Rules Committee.

Mrs. FISCHBACH. Madam Speaker, I thank my colleague and friend from Pennsylvania for yielding me the time.

Madam Speaker, I would like to start off by saying that I am going to specifically talk about H.R. 7606. Many of the bills included in that bill, in H.R. 7606, I supported and helped introduce. The Butcher Block Act, year-round E–15, and the PRECISE Act are all pieces of legislation I have long supported and are included in this package.

I find it stunning that my colleagues in the majority after many months of sitting on these thoughtful, bipartisan bills are finally bringing them forward attached to a poison pill that is duplicative and unnecessary.

Perhaps most disappointing is that this bill is being advertised as an immediate solution to skyrocketing food and fuel prices. But many of these bills are simply codifications of existing programs or duplicative of other efforts all packaged with a feel-good title.

Let me be clear. These will not address the underlying drivers of inflation or increasing input costs. If the majority were serious about bringing down the cost of our food and fuel, they would check their incessant spending habits far beyond the Federal Government's means. They would roll back the Biden administration's regulatory war on agriculture.

But that is not what this bill does.

Madam Speaker, the Packers and Stockyards Division already has enforcement tools at their disposal to address uncompetitive behavior in the meatpacking sector. However, by the Packers and Stockyards Division's own estimates, the agency is chronically understaffed and underfunded. If my colleagues were serious about combating uncompetitive behavior in the meatpacking industry, they would have included robust resources to enhance enforcement under the Packers and Stockyard Act.

This legislation is unfunded and creates an unnecessary and duplicative special investigator appointed by an administration that blames rising costs of goods and services on everyone but themselves and is empowered with nearly unlimited authority to harass market participants when convenient for the politics of this administration.

Further, the Department of Justice has already been in the process of investigating meatpackers with respect to this exact issue.

I would ask my colleague if they have yet to receive any update regarding this effort? And if so, what can we expect from it? I know many of my Republican colleagues and I have been seeking an update for months to no avail. Absent such investigation, it is inappropriate for this bill to move forward.

Much of this package does have bipartisan support, but when I asked why the majority didn't focus on the bills with strong bipartisan consensus, I was essentially told that this is the package, this is what the majority wants. The message to me was, Take it or leave it. This shows, once again, the majority's unwillingness to work in a bipartisan manner and really, really address the issues facing Americans.

That is unfortunate, and I urge my colleagues in the majority to work with Republicans in addressing these issues in a thoughtful and bipartisan manner and to stop playing politics while our country suffers.

Madam Speaker, I urge my colleagues to oppose this rule and the underlying bill.

Mr. DESAULNIER. Madam Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. RESCHENTHALER. Madam Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

Madam Speaker, Americans are now paying an average of over $5 for a gallon of gas. This is the first time in history this has happened. Let me repeat that: over $5 for a gallon of gas.

The pain at the pump is a direct result of President Biden's and congressional Democrats' radical Green New Deal agenda and a war on American energy producers.

Let's just be blunt about something: the base of the Democratic Party—the bunch of woke yuppies sitting at home on Zooms all day—don't care about gas prices. But if you are someone who has to swing a hammer for a living and drive to a jobsite, if you are a waitress at a diner and you have to drive to your shift, that affects you.

Republicans care about working families and working men and women. That is why we believe Americans deserve affordable, American-made energy. That is why if we defeat the previous question, I will personally offer an amendment to the rule to immediately consider H.R. 6858, the American Energy Independence from Russia Act.

Madam Speaker, I ask unanimous consent to insert the text of my amendment in the RECORD, along with extraneous material, immediately prior to the vote on the previous question.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Is there objection to the request of the gentleman from Pennsylvania?

There was no objection.

Mr. RESCHENTHALER. Madam Speaker, here to explain this amendment is my good friend and a member of the Energy and Commerce Committee, Congressman JEFF DUNCAN from South Carolina.

Madam Speaker, I yield 4 minutes to the gentleman from South Carolina (Mr. DUNCAN).

Mr. DUNCAN. Madam Speaker, I rise in opposition to the previous question so that we can amend the rule to immediately consider H.R. 6858, the American Energy Independence from Russia Act.

As a direct result of President Biden's war on American energy, average national gas prices have hit $5 per gallon. I don't know what they are in Michigan. I know I pay more than $5 a gallon for diesel fuel in South Carolina.

This is the worst energy crisis we have seen since 1973. Why we had an energy crisis in the seventies was supply and demand. We had lessening global supply and increased demand as the economy was growing.

When will we learn?

The American people are feeling the pain directly due to the policies of the Biden administration. This shouldn't come as any surprise to the American people. It really doesn't because the President said during a Presidential debate that he would phase out oil and gas production in the United States, and that is exactly what they are doing. It is costing moms and dads around the country, and Democrats are wondering why gas prices are so high. It is unbelievable.

What is even more unbelievable is that President Biden killed American energy at the same time green-lighting Vladimir Putin's Nord Stream 2 project to allow Vladimir Putin to produce energy and sell it to Europe. We can't do that here at home.

The logic of Joe Biden and the Democrats: kill American energy while promoting energy development of tyrants in Russia, Iran, and Venezuela is unbelievable.

It is simple. You are playing politics with this country's energy crisis. Democrats want high gas prices so they can push their fallacy of a utopian world of wind, solar, and EVs for all. Meanwhile, American families are choosing between filling up their tank, feeding their families, and not doing other things they are used to doing because they are having to pay more at the pump.

Energy prices hurt low-income Americans the hardest. They are seeing their savings erode in a volatile stock market. More of their paychecks are going for basic commodities due to rampant high inflation, and they are paying record-high prices nationwide to fuel their vehicles.

Energy Secretary Granholm's solution for high gas prices? Buy a $55,000

electric vehicle. They can range up to $90,000.

How many American families can afford that?

Even the Biden administration knows that is a failed approach.

I saw a Democrat plan recently that we are going to use more of the Strategic Petroleum Reserve to increase supply. Okay. You acknowledge there is a supply-and-demand issue. They are currently tapping the SPR at record levels to meet rising demand. The SPR fell to 538 billion barrels just last month, and that is the lowest level since 1987.

Madam Speaker, that is a finite commodity that once we drain the SPR, unless you produce more energy or buy oil from Iran, Venezuela, or Russia to replenish it—it is not an infinite supply—what are you going to do then?

What are we going to do then when that runs out?

If Americans want to blame someone for record-high gas prices, then look no further than House Democrats who have already blocked Representative CATHY MCMORRIS RODGERS' bill, the American Energy Independence from Russia Act, six times. If Democrats block it today, then it will be the seventh time they have blocked a commonsense piece of legislation that is a Republican solution. Now, this bill will approve the Keystone XL pipeline, remove all restrictions on LNG exports, and restart oil and gas leasing on Federal lands and waters.

It is well past time for the Democrats to wake up and follow the science, as they like to say. Stop putting special interest groups before the American people.

Let's flip the switch. Let's support American energy and America first policies. Let's support the American Energy Independence from Russia Act to unleash American energy production and security. Let's take the first step toward lowering gas prices for Americans and quit playing games. We are going to release the SPR oil to increase supply to lower the price at the pump because that is temporary, because once that supply is used up, we are not going to have that to put back into the market. Quit doing that.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The time of the gentleman has expired.

Mr. RESCHENTHALER. Madam Speaker, I yield the gentleman from South Carolina an additional 30 seconds.

Mr. DUNCAN. Flip the switch, folks. Let's support American energy independence.

Madam Speaker, I urge a ''no'' vote on the previous question so the House can immediately consider this commonsense legislation by CATHY MCMORRIS RODGERS.

Mr. DESAULNIER. Madam Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

Madam Speaker, I just want to remind folks that 50 percent of inflation is caused by the war in Ukraine and actions by Vladimir Putin. In terms of energy, we believe in supporting American energy, but we also accept the reality that we are transitioning to more choices in energy like we do in California.

Madam Speaker, I include in the RECORD a June 10, 2021, USA Today article titled: ''Fact check: Rising gas prices due to high demand and low supply, not Biden's policies.''

[From USA Today, June 10, 2021]

FACT CHECK: RISING GAS PRICES DUE TO HIGH DEMAND AND LOW SUPPLY, NOT BIDEN'S POLICIES

(By Miriam Fauzia)

THE CLAIM: JOE BIDEN IS TO BLAME FOR HIGHER GAS PRICES

The rising cost of gasoline is being felt across the U.S., as the national average price has gone up from $2 per gallon last year to $3 per gallon as of June 9, according to data from the American Automobile Association.

Many on social media claim President Joe Biden is to blame for this change. A June 1 Instagram post put the title ''Joe Biden's America'' atop a graphic showing the price jump from January to May 2021.

''Man I haven't seen gas prices this high since the last time (a) Democrat was in office!'' claims one meme shared to Facebook on May 22.

''It's called the Biden effect,'' commented one Facebook user under a similar May 18 Facebook post. Blaming Biden for this uptick isn't a new phenomenon. These claims have been in circulation since January and particularly allege Biden's cancellation of the Keystone XL pipeline significantly impacted gasoline, ''ensur(ing) a huge increase in gas prices for millions of us.'' USA TODAY has reached out to the posters for comment.

While it's true gasoline prices have risen significantly since Biden took office on Jan. 20 the upward trend predates Biden's time in office and is related to COVID–19 and market factors, not who occupies the White House.

PANDEMIC'S EFFECT ON SUPPLY AND DEMAND

As with any commodity, the price of gasoline is determined by the simple balance of supply and demand: a high supply and low demand means low prices, while a low supply and high demand mean prices rise.

The most important driver of this fluctuation is crude oil, from which gasoline is derived. This fossil fuel typically accounts for between 50 percent and 60 percent of the price at the pump, said Jeanette McGee, a spokesperson for AAA.

In 2020, crude oil prices became extremely cheap, so much so it was being traded at negative prices, McGee told USA TODAY. Brent crude oil, for example, a blend supplying most of Europe, was being sold at $9 a barrel, its lowest price in decades, the U.S. Energy Information Administration (EIA) reported.

The primary reason for this drop in crude oil prices was the pandemic, said McGee and Mark Finley, a fellow at Rice University's Center for Energy Studies.

''The pandemic drove the world's oil market to become massively oversupplied, inventory dramatically increased and prices collapsed,'' Finley told USA TODAY.

In response to the low demand due to reduced travel and lockdown restrictions, Finley said major oil-producing countries like Russia, Saudi Arabia and member countries of the Organization of the Petroleum Exporting Countries, or OPEC, decided to cut down on their own oil production. But the cut meant oil producers weren't ready to meet the demand for crude oil once it renewed this year thanks to easing of COVID–19-related restrictions.

''This year, demand has so far increased more quickly than production rates, which means the United States had to draw more on its gasoline storage inventories, which has contributed to prices going up,'' EIA spokesperson Chris Higginbotham said in an email to USA TODAY. ''We expect oil producers in the United States and globally to increase their production levels through 2022, which we expect to contribute to lower crude oil prices, and lower gasoline prices.''

GAS PRICE UPTREND PREDATES BIDEN

While presidential actions and policies can have some impact on the crude oil market, they don't have as much influence over gasoline prices as one might think.

''Some of (a president's) decisions can impact or contribute to market changes, which can then impact (future) crude oil, but they don't dictate gas prices,'' said McGee. ''If you go back and look at historical data, whether it was Bush, Obama, Trump or Biden, (gas prices) go up and down no matter who's in office.''

During former President Donald Trump's term, the national average for gasoline had gone up to nearly $3 a gallon in May 2018 and hovered close to that price until fall 2018, according to data maintained by AAA. The cost rose yet again to nearly $3 a gallon in May 2019 before dropping slightly below $2 per gallon when state and local governments mandated lockdowns in March 2020.

Gas prices slowly crept from $2.20 per gallon in September 2020 to $2.40 by the time Biden took office in January 2021. McGee said elections typically drive gasoline prices up.

This upward trend was expected to continue due to pandemic recovery, reduced crude oil supply and the approach of summer—historically considered a peak travel season—but arrived sooner due to the ransomware attack on the Colonial Pipeline, the East Coast's major fuel supplier.

''We have expected gas prices to hit $3 a gallon around Memorial Day, but with the (Colonial) pipeline offline, it actually jumped the national average to $3 and more prior to Memorial Day,'' said McGee.

KEYSTONE XL, OTHER BIDEN POLICIES DON'T AFFECT TODAY'S GASOLINE COSTS

Many critics point to Biden's decision on the Keystone XL pipeline as fueling the gas price spike, but experts say there's no such connection.

The extension of the Keystone pipeline, first proposed in 2008 by TC Energy based in Calgary, Canada, was rejected by former President Barack Obama in November 2015 but later approved by Trump in March 2017. Biden then suspended the project in January. And on June 9, TC Energy announced it was terminating the project.

Even if construction wasn't halted, the Keystone XL pipeline wasn't in operation and therefore wouldn't have an impact on current gas prices, said Finley of Rice University.

''That was something that would impact down the road,'' he said.

David Dismukes, economist and executive director of Lousiana State University's Center for Energy Studies, agreed, telling USA TODAY the pipeline would have had a ''longer-run impact in providing a diversity of supply for refineries in the Gulf Coast.''

Similarly, other energy policies rolled out by President Biden, such as postponing oil lease sales, have a long-term, but not short-term, effect.

''If you look at some of the actions taken by the administration with regard to offshore drilling, drilling on federal lands, the outlook for fossil fuel energies in general, those are impacting the price of crude and expectations about crude oil,'' said

Diskmukes. ''(Biden's policies do) have an impact, but that's not what you're seeing at the pump right now.''

OUR RATING: FALSE

Based on our research, we rate FALSE the claim President Joe Biden is to blame for the current higher gas prices. The upward trend in gas costs we see now began months before Biden took office. Because of reduced demand amid the COVID–19 pandemic, oil companies had to cut back on the amount of crude oil produced. Now with restrictions being lifted and more travel happening, the demand has increased, which, coupled with lagging supply, has led to increased gasoline prices. Canceling the Keystone XL pipeline and other energy policies enacted by Biden have a long-term effect on crude oil supply but no present impact on gasoline prices.

Mr. DESAULNIER. Madam Speaker, President Biden nor his administration have direct control of setting gas prices. The real issue is Big Oil's desire to pad their profits.

The CEO of Occidental Petroleum said it herself, ''I feel now that we do need to return cash to the shareholders in the form of dividends or buybacks, especially during the better cycles.''

They are thinking in their shareholders' best interest, not the interest of the American people.

Madam Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. RESCHENTHALER. Madam Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

Madam Speaker, Democrats and their allies on the left can blame Putin all they want, and it is partially true that Putin's war in Ukraine is partially to blame. But gas prices have risen every month of this administration. Every month they were up a dollar a gallon before Putin even invaded Ukraine.

The real issue here is supply.

Why do we have the supply issue?

It is because Joe Biden on day number one canceled the Keystone XL pipeline. That dried up all capital investment into hydrocarbon infrastructure. Maybe it is a problem because we cannot get the oil and gas to refineries to make sure that we have a supply.

So what does Joe Biden do instead?

He blames everybody else. He goes to Venezuela and elsewhere, and begs them to produce more oil when just one administration before under President Trump, we were actually a net exporter of energy. Biden and House Democrats have created this mess, and the American people know that.

Are you ready for this fact, Madam Speaker?

The American people will also spend $5,000 this year on gas—$5,000 for the average American. That is a 78 percent increase from a year ago. In other words, Americans are spending over $2,000 extra a year on gas under Joe Biden.

Blame who you want, Madam Speaker, but every time an American looks up and sees $100-plus on that gas tank that he or she just filled up, they know who to blame—Joe Biden and Democrats.

Madam Speaker, I yield 3 minutes to the gentlewoman from the great State of Texas (Ms. VAN DUYNE).

Ms. VAN DUYNE. Madam Speaker, I rise to oppose the previous question so that we can immediately consider H.R. 6858, the American Energy Independence from Russia Act, to address U.S. energy security, the production of oil and gas, and the importation and exportation of oil and gas.

Gas prices have already topped $5 per gallon, and economists are predicting they will be $6 per gallon by August. Every American driver is paying nearly double since Biden took office, and the crisis is only getting worse.

□ 1330

This administration should have seen this coming. You can say what you want. You can blame whoever you want. This administration is failing to recognize that its policies have had a direct result on gas prices.

You don't block crucial pipelines. You don't block domestic infrastructure. You don't shut down drilling on Federal lands, declare war on the oil and gas industry, and become reliant on Russian oil and not expect prices to skyrocket and our global standing to weaken.

This administration is obviously not going to do anything but make this crisis worse, so this body must act.

The American Energy Independence from Russia Act will strengthen U.S. energy security, counter Russia, create American jobs, and protect domestic oil and gas dependency and production.

Republicans have proposed countless pragmatic bills, including the Strategy to Secure Offshore Energy Act, which I recently introduced. This directs the Department of the Interior to publish the next 5-year plan for offshore oil and gas lease sales.

We must hold this administration accountable as they continue to throw their hands up and blame everyone else for the energy crisis that they created. This bill will help provide the certainty necessary for continued investment in offshore production and support our domestic energy security.

In my colleague's home State of California, gas has reached $9.60 a gallon. Surely, we can all agree that that is unconscionable and must be addressed.

Madam Speaker, I urge opposition to the previous question so that we can pass needed legislation to put us back on course to unlocking American energy independence.

Mr. DESAULNIER. Madam Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. RESCHENTHALER. Madam Speaker, just some quick facts. As Mr. DUNCAN stated, House Democrats have blocked consideration of legislation to unleash America's energy independence six times. Six times we have been down this road, and House Democrats have blocked it.

Gas prices have gone up 49 cents since the last time Republicans asked Democrats to bring this bill to the floor. Here we are again.

To talk more about this issue, I yield 3 minutes to the gentlewoman from Arizona (Mrs. LESKO).

Mrs. LESKO. Madam Speaker, I rise to oppose the previous question so that we can immediately consider H.R. 6858 to unleash American domestic energy production.

Americans across the country are paying sky-high prices at the gas pump. Almost every single day for the past month, gas prices have hit a new record high.

The national average for a gallon of gas is now over $5 per gallon. In Phoenix, my home State, Arizonans are paying over $5.60 per gallon. I think yesterday it was $5.63 per gallon.

Filling up at the pump is becoming increasingly unaffordable for many Americans. As Members of Congress, many of us can afford to spend $5 for a single gallon of gas. But many Americans, like my own kids, who are working hard, and my senior citizens in my district who live on fixed incomes, simply can't afford to pay this high price.

Republicans have a solution. We have a plan to increase American energy production today and lower prices tomorrow, if only my colleagues across the aisle would agree to take up this legislation.

H.R. 6858 requires the President to submit an energy security plan to Congress and requires the Energy Secretary to develop a plan to increase oil and gas production on U.S. Federal lands. This legislation reinstates the Keystone XL pipeline, unleashes American natural gas production and oil production, and reverses the oil and gas moratorium on Federal lands and waters so we can harness our U.S.-abundant energy resources.

Republicans have brought up this legislation, as has been said before, for consideration several times, but the energy crisis just keeps getting worse and worse, and gas prices keep getting higher.

Madam Speaker, I urge my colleagues to vote ''no'' on the previous question.

Mr. DESAULNIER. Madam Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. RESCHENTHALER. Madam Speaker, I yield 3 minutes to the gentleman from Minnesota (Mr. STAUBER), my friend and a former police officer.

Mr. STAUBER. Madam Speaker, I rise to oppose the previous question so that we can immediately consider H.R. 6858, the American Energy Independence from Russia Act, which I am proud to cosponsor with my colleagues, Representatives MCMORRIS RODGERS and WESTERMAN.

The national average price for a gallon of gasoline today is $5 and climbing. Let that sink in. It is $5 and going up. Diesel fuel is skyrocketing at an even scarier rate.

This is a self-imposed crisis on the American people. As a candidate, Joe Biden pledged again and again to ban development on America's Federal lands and waters. He followed through

on that promise, with the House Democrats following suit no matter the pain they cause Americans at the pump, no matter the costs they impose on businesses reliant on shipping, trucking, and more.

In contrast, we Republicans are here offering solutions. H.R. 6858 takes away Joe Biden's power to ruin our energy security and our economy by prohibiting harmful drilling bans. The bill creates a minimum number of annual lease sales, both onshore and offshore. It reauthorizes the Keystone XL pipeline so we can resume moving energy throughout our country.

Democrats here are calculating that, to reduce emissions, it is a necessary evil to make gas expensive for Americans and punish the middle class.

Madam Speaker, let me tell you why that is dead wrong. Under President Trump, when we were net exporters of American energy, we averaged emission reductions of 2.5 percent every year. Under President Biden, his first year in office, we saw a 6 percent jump in domestic emissions.

These policies Democrats push every day, again, are punishing the American families, the American workers, and the American middle class. It makes it harder for businesses to turn a profit. It is the leading cause of why our economy officially became a bear market just yesterday.

Biden's solution? Trips to Venezuela and Saudi Arabia, pleading with communists and human rights violators to bail him out of a problem that he caused. Let that sink in. He is going to Venezuela and Saudi Arabia, pleading with communists and human rights violators to bail him out of a problem that he caused.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The time of the gentleman has expired.

Mr. RESCHENTHALER. Madam Speaker, I yield an additional 30 seconds to my good friend to close.

Mr. STAUBER. Madam Speaker, it does not have to be this way. We can bring gas prices down with Republican solutions.

As the ranking member of the Energy and Mineral Resources Subcommittee, I call on my colleagues in this body today to do the right thing and vote for H.R. 6858 to bring relief to the American people.

Let's produce our energy right here in America. We have the resources, technology, and the workforce, and we absolutely have the need.

Madam Speaker, I urge defeat of the previous question.

Mr. DESAULNIER. Madam Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. RESCHENTHALER. Madam Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume. I still find it somewhat amusing that my friends across the aisle continue to blame all this on foreign nations and their actions.

Let me give a quick history lesson on how President Joe Biden and Democrats actually caused this crisis.

Number one, day number one, Joe Biden canceled the Keystone XL pipeline.

Number two, he emboldened Putin with Nord Stream 2. I would actually argue he emboldened Putin to invade Ukraine when he recklessly pulled us out of Afghanistan, which served zero military purpose. But I digress.

Additionally, Joe Biden suspended oil and gas leasing on Federal lands. He delayed permits for energy and infrastructure pipelines. He drained the Strategic Petroleum Reserve. He revoked permits for critical mineral projects. He canceled oil leases in Alaska and the Gulf of Mexico.

What has this done to gas prices? Well, in California, gas prices are now $9 a gallon.

Madam Speaker, I yield 2 minutes to the gentleman from California (Mr. LAMALFA).

Mr. LAMALFA. Madam Speaker, I appreciate my neighbor from Pennsylvania for the time here today and for this effort.

I also oppose the previous question and want to, instead, bring forward H.R. 6858, the American Energy Independence from Russia Act. It really begs the question: With what is going on in the world, why are we dependent upon Russia for anything, especially our energy?

If the number was somewhere around 7 percent of the barrels of oil we use, we can easily make it up by our own production in this country, the amazing hydraulic fracturing that put America back on the map for being an exporter of natural gas and all the other development that we can be doing to bring prices back down.

This administration just seems impervious to the suffering of the American people right now on the cost of energy and the cost of just about everything else.

Well, there is another crisis that is going to be coming out of this, too. We are dependent on Russia and China for a product called urea. Now, what is that? Well, it is made into a fertilizer, basically, that is used extensively in American crops. Also, urea has a use as a component in what is called diesel exhaust fluid. That is a part of making our diesel engines run clean on our trucks and tractors and whatever else uses a diesel engine with DEF in it.

We are going to run out of DEF pretty soon. The railroads are having a hard time delivering it. When that happens, that means our trucks don't run anymore because they will not run without this fluid.

So, we are dependent on Russia for urea, dependent on Russia for energy, and want to blame Russia for everything. No. We blame this administration because we are not doing the steps it takes to make ourselves independent that we easily have within our grasp to do in order to go for what is this great reset or the incredible transition the President talks about.

We are being transitioned by this administration, and it is very dangerous. It is harmful to families, harmful to people's bottom lines on running their households, going to work, getting their kids to school, all because we don't have an energy policy that works.

Whether the trucks don't have DEF to be able to deliver the goods to the store or get it out of the field, whatever it is, because we are dependent on Russia for energy and all these things, we are putting ourselves in a real bad spot.

Mr. DESAULNIER. Madam Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. RESCHENTHALER. Madam Speaker, I have no further speakers at this time, and I am prepared to close.

I yield myself the balance of my time and remind everybody that, in Joe Biden's America, gas prices are averaging more than $5 a gallon; inflation is at a 40-year high; and real wages have decreased 10 out of the last 12 months.

Yet, with today's rule, House Democrats are doubling down on far-left, radical policies, really failed policies, that created Joe Biden's economic crisis in the first place.

It is well past time that the Biden administration and congressional Democrats admit that they are to blame for the economic pain families are facing and workers are facing, and work with Republicans on solutions to immediately help the American people.

Madam Speaker, I urge my colleagues to vote ''no'' on the previous question and ''no'' on the rule, and I yield back the balance of my time.

Mr. DESAULNIER. Madam Speaker, I yield myself the balance of my time.

I thank my friend from Pennsylvania and the Rules Committee for his remarks.

I remind folks that the economy under Joe Biden has created over 8 million jobs since he took office. The unemployment rate has dropped from 6.4 percent to 3.6 percent under President Biden. And his first year was the greatest year of job creation in American history.

The Federal Reserve has found that household financial well-being reached an all-time high last year. GDP grew in the President's first year by 5.2 percent, the fastest rate since 1984.

The U.S. was the first advanced economy that reached prepandemic rates of growth, and we are seeing wages increase for workers.

□ 1345

There is no doubt that inflation and the high cost of gasoline are a challenge. That is the purpose of some of our actions today. It is to hold the private sector accountable, to be responsible to their consumers and the American people. That is why these bills are on the floor, to do something about inflation and the high cost of energy.

At the same time, we are preparing for an energy transition. Michigan, California, we are aware of the realities of the current energy economy, but we are getting ready for the new one.

In the area I represent, Madam Speaker—you have been out to visit me—I have five refineries. I have represented them in local, State, and Federal Government. Two of them are closed because of the pandemic. They are about to reopen using biofuels that will help everybody, and they are a better business model, according to the oil industry. So all of these things have combined for a challenge.

I would agree with my colleague. This is too important, although we have our differences about the approach, that we should engage in problem-solving for Americans.

I thank all of my colleagues for these bills and their ideas to deal with inflation and the challenges to American workers. Each of these bills in this rule are worthwhile and impactful, and I look forward to voting for them all soon.

I urge a ''yes'' vote on the rule and the previous question.

The text of the material previously referred to by Mr. RESCHENTHALER is as follows:

AMENDMENT TO HOUSE RESOLUTION 1170

At the end of the resolution, add the following:

SEC. 12. Immediately upon adoption of this resolution, the House shall proceed to the consideration in the House of the bill (H.R. 6858) to strengthen United States energy security, encourage domestic production of crude oil, petroleum products, and natural gas, and for other purposes. All points of order against consideration of the bill are waived. The bill shall be considered as read. All points of order against provisions in the bill are waived. The previous question shall be considered as ordered on the bill and on any amendment thereto to final passage without intervening motion except: (1) one hour of debate equally divided and controlled by the chair and ranking minority member of the Committee on Energy and Commerce; and (2) one motion to recommit.

SEC. 13. Clause 1(c) of rule XIX shall not apply to the consideration of H.R. 6858.

Mr. DESAULNIER. Madam Speaker, I yield back the balance of my time, and I move the previous question on the resolution.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The question is on ordering the previous question.

The question was taken; and the Speaker pro tempore announced that the ayes appeared to have it.

Mr. RESCHENTHALER. Madam Speaker, on that I demand the yeas and nays.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Pursuant to section 3(s) of House Resolution 8, the yeas and nays are ordered.

Pursuant to clause 9 of rule XX, the 15-minute vote on ordering the previous question will be followed by 5-minute votes on:

Adoption of the resolution, if ordered; and

Motion to suspend the rules and pass S. 4160.

The vote was taken by electronic device, and there were—yeas 216, nays 199, not voting 12, as follows:

[Roll No. 259]

YEAS—216

Adams
Aguilar
Allred
Auchincloss
Axne
Barragán
Bass
Beatty
Bera
Beyer
Bishop (GA)
Blumenauer
Blunt Rochester
Bonamici
Bourdeaux
Bowman
Boyle, Brendan F.
Brown (MD)
Brown (OH)
Brownley
Bush
Bustos
Butterfield
Carbajal
Cárdenas
Carson
Carter (LA)
Cartwright
Case
Castro (TX)
Cherfilus-McCormick
Chu
Cicilline
Clark (MA)
Clarke (NY)
Cleaver
Cohen
Connolly
Cooper
Correa
Costa
Courtney
Craig
Crist
Crow
Cuellar
Davids (KS)
Davis, Danny K.
Dean
DeFazio
DeGette
DeLauro
DelBene
Demings
DeSaulnier
Deutch
Dingell
Doggett
Doyle, Michael F.
Escobar
Eshoo
Espaillat
Evans
Fletcher
Foster
Frankel, Lois
Gaetz
Gallego
Garamendi
García (IL)
Garcia (TX)
Golden
Gomez
Gonzalez, Vicente
Gottheimer
Green, Al (TX)
Grijalva
Harder (CA)
Hayes
Higgins (NY)
Himes
Horsford
Houlahan
Hoyer
Huffman
Jackson Lee
Jacobs (CA)
Jayapal
Jeffries
Johnson (GA)
Johnson (TX)
Jones
Kahele
Kaptur
Keating
Kelly (IL)
Khanna
Kildee
Kilmer
Kim (NJ)
Kind
Kirkpatrick
Krishnamoorthi
Kuster
Lamb
Langevin
Larsen (WA)
Larson (CT)
Lawrence
Lawson (FL)
Lee (CA)
Lee (NV)
Leger Fernandez
Levin (CA)
Levin (MI)
Lieu
Lofgren
Lowenthal
Luria
Lynch
Malinowski
Maloney, Carolyn B.
Maloney, Sean
Manning
Matsui
McBath
McCollum
McEachin
McGovern
McNerney
Meeks
Meng
Mfume
Moore (WI)
Morelle
Moulton
Mrvan
Murphy (FL)
Nadler
Napolitano
Neal
Neguse
Newman
Norcross
O'Halleran
Ocasio-Cortez
Omar
Pallone
Panetta
Pappas
Pascrell
Payne
Perlmutter
Peters
Phillips
Pingree
Pocan
Porter
Pressley
Price (NC)
Quigley
Raskin
Rice (NY)
Ross
Roybal-Allard
Ruiz
Ruppersberger
Rush
Ryan
Sánchez
Sarbanes
Scanlon
Schakowsky
Schiff
Schneider
Schrader
Schrier
Scott (VA)
Scott, David
Sherman
Sherrill
Sires
Slotkin
Smith (WA)
Soto
Spanberger
Speier
Stansbury
Stanton
Stevens
Strickland
Suozzi
Swalwell
Takano
Thompson (CA)
Thompson (MS)
Titus
Tlaib
Tonko
Torres (CA)
Torres (NY)
Trahan
Trone
Underwood
Vargas
Veasey
Velázquez
Wasserman Schultz
Waters
Watson Coleman
Welch
Wexton
Wild
Williams (GA)
Wilson (FL)
Yarmuth

NAYS—199

Aderholt
Allen
Amodei
Armstrong
Babin
Bacon
Baird
Balderson
Banks
Barr
Bentz
Bergman
Bice (OK)
Biggs
Bilirakis
Bishop (NC)
Boebert
Bost
Brooks
Buchanan
Buck
Bucshon
Budd
Burchett
Burgess
Calvert
Cammack
Carey
Carl
Carter (GA)
Carter (TX)
Cawthorn
Chabot
Cheney
Cline
Cloud
Clyde
Cole
Comer
Crawford
Curtis
Davidson
Davis, Rodney
DesJarlais
Diaz-Balart
Donalds
Duncan
Dunn
Ellzey
Emmer
Estes
Fallon
Feenstra
Ferguson
Fischbach
Fitzgerald
Fitzpatrick
Fleischmann
Foxx
Franklin, C. Scott
Fulcher
Gallagher
Garbarino
Garcia (CA)
Gibbs
Gimenez
Gohmert
Gonzales, Tony
Gonzalez (OH)
Good (VA)
Gooden (TX)
Gosar
Granger
Graves (LA)
Graves (MO)
Green (TN)
Greene (GA)
Griffith
Grothman
Guthrie
Harris
Harshbarger
Hartzler
Hern
Herrell
Herrera Beutler
Hice (GA)
Higgins (LA)
Hill
Hinson
Hollingsworth
Hudson
Huizenga
Issa
Jackson
Jacobs (NY)
Johnson (LA)
Johnson (OH)
Johnson (SD)
Jordan
Joyce (OH)
Joyce (PA)
Katko
Keller
Kelly (MS)
Kelly (PA)
Kim (CA)
Kinzinger
Kustoff
LaHood
LaMalfa
Lamborn
Latta
LaTurner
Lesko
Letlow
Long
Loudermilk
Lucas
Luetkemeyer
Mace
Malliotakis
Mann
Massie
Mast
McCarthy
McCaul
McClain
McClintock
McHenry
McKinley
Meijer
Meuser
Miller (WV)
Miller-Meeks
Moolenaar
Mooney
Moore (AL)
Moore (UT)
Mullin
Murphy (NC)
Nehls
Newhouse
Norman
Obernolte
Owens
Palazzo
Palmer
Pence
Perry
Posey
Reschenthaler
Rice (SC)
Rodgers (WA)
Rogers (AL)
Rogers (KY)
Rose
Rosendale
Rouzer
Roy
Rutherford
Salazar
Scalise
Schweikert
Scott, Austin
Sessions
Simpson
Smith (MO)
Smith (NE)
Smith (NJ)
Smucker
Spartz
Stauber
Steel
Stefanik
Steil
Steube
Stewart
Taylor
Tenney
Thompson (PA)
Tiffany
Timmons
Turner
Upton
Valadao
Van Drew
Van Duyne
Wagner
Walberg
Waltz
Weber (TX)
Webster (FL)
Wenstrup
Westerman
Williams (TX)
Wittman
Womack
Zeldin

NOT VOTING—12

Arrington
Brady
Casten
Castor (FL)
Clyburn
Crenshaw
Guest
Miller (IL)
Pfluger
Sewell
Walorski
Wilson (SC)

□ 1427

Mr. GREEN of Tennessee changed his vote from ''yea'' to ''nay.''

So the previous question was ordered.

The result of the vote was announced as above recorded.

MEMBERS RECORDED PURSUANT TO HOUSE RESOLUTION 8, 117TH CONGRESS

Amodei (Balderson)
Bustos (Mrvan)
Carter (TX) (Weber (TX))
Correa (Huffman)
Crist (Wasserman Schultz)
Davids (KS) (Neguse)
Deutch (Rice (NY))
Evans (Beyer)
Gonzalez (OH) (Meijer)
Johnson (GA) (Manning)
Johnson (TX) (Jeffries)
Kahele (Mrvan)
Kelly (IL) (Neguse)
Khanna (Watson Coleman)
Lamb (Blunt Rochester)
Lawrence (Stevens)
Lawson (FL) (Wasserman Schultz)
Lynch (Langevin)
Mace (Carter (GA))
McEachin (Beyer)
Moore (WI) (Beyer)
Nadler (Pallone)
Newman (Beyer)
O'Halleran (Schrader)
Palazzo (Fleischmann)
Payne (Pallone)
Peters (Jeffries)
Pingree (Wasserman Schultz)
Price (NC) (Manning)
Rice (SC) (Meijer)
Schneider (Stevens)
Speier (Huffman)
Stansbury (García (IL))
Stanton (Huffman)
Suozzi (Beyer)
Taylor (Van Duyne)
Tenney (Jackson)
Titus (Pallone)
Waters (Takano)
Welch (Pallone)
Wilson (FL) (Neguse)

The SPEAKER pro tempore (Mr. CARTER of Louisiana). The question is on the resolution.

The question was taken; and the Speaker pro tempore announced that the ayes appeared to have it.

Mr. RESCHENTHALER. Mr. Speaker, on that I demand the yeas and nays.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Pursuant to section 3(s) of House Resolution 8, the yeas and nays are ordered.

This will be a 5-minute vote.

The vote was taken by electronic device, and there were—yeas 218, nays 204, not voting 5, as follows:

[Roll No. 260]

YEAS—218

Adams
Aguilar
Allred
Auchincloss
Axne
Barragán
Bass
Beatty
Bera
Beyer
Bishop (GA)
Blumenauer
Blunt Rochester
Bonamici
Bourdeaux
Bowman
Boyle, Brendan F.
Brown (MD)
Brown (OH)
Brownley
Bush
Bustos
Butterfield
Carbajal
Cárdenas
Carson
Carter (LA)
Cartwright
Case
Castor (FL)
Castro (TX)
Cherfilus-McCormick
Chu
Cicilline
Clark (MA)
Clarke (NY)
Cleaver
Clyburn
Cohen
Connolly
Cooper
Correa
Costa
Courtney
Craig
Crist
Crow
Cuellar
Davids (KS)
Davis, Danny K.
Dean
DeFazio
DeGette
DeLauro
DelBene
Demings
DeSaulnier
Deutch
Dingell
Doggett
Doyle, Michael F.
Escobar
Eshoo
Espaillat
Evans
Fletcher
Foster
Frankel, Lois
Gallego
Garamendi
García (IL)
Garcia (TX)
Golden
Gomez
Gonzalez, Vicente
Gottheimer
Green, Al (TX)
Grijalva
Harder (CA)
Hayes
Higgins (NY)
Himes
Horsford
Houlahan
Hoyer
Huffman
Jackson Lee
Jacobs (CA)
Jayapal
Jeffries
Johnson (GA)
Johnson (TX)
Jones
Kahele
Kaptur
Keating
Kelly (IL)
Khanna
Kildee
Kilmer
Kim (NJ)
Kind
Kirkpatrick
Krishnamoorthi
Kuster
Lamb
Langevin
Larsen (WA)
Larson (CT)
Lawrence
Lawson (FL)
Lee (CA)
Lee (NV)
Leger Fernandez
Levin (CA)
Levin (MI)
Lieu
Lofgren
Lowenthal
Luria
Lynch
Malinowski
Maloney, Carolyn B.
Maloney, Sean
Manning
Matsui
McBath
McCollum
McEachin
McGovern
McNerney
Meeks
Meng
Mfume
Moore (WI)
Morelle
Moulton
Mrvan
Murphy (FL)
Nadler
Napolitano
Neal
Neguse
Newman
Norcross
O'Halleran
Ocasio-Cortez
Omar
Pallone
Panetta
Pappas
Pascrell
Payne
Perlmutter
Peters
Phillips
Pingree
Pocan
Porter
Pressley
Price (NC)
Quigley
Raskin
Rice (NY)
Ross
Roybal-Allard
Ruiz
Ruppersberger
Rush
Ryan
Sánchez
Sarbanes
Scanlon
Schakowsky
Schiff
Schneider
Schrader
Schrier
Scott (VA)
Scott, David
Sewell
Sherman
Sherrill
Sires
Slotkin
Smith (WA)
Soto
Spanberger
Speier
Stansbury
Stanton
Stevens
Strickland
Suozzi
Swalwell
Takano
Thompson (CA)
Thompson (MS)
Titus
Tlaib
Tonko
Torres (CA)
Torres (NY)
Trahan
Trone
Underwood
Vargas
Veasey
Velázquez
Wasserman Schultz
Waters
Watson Coleman
Welch
Wexton
Wild
Williams (GA)
Wilson (FL)
Yarmuth

NAYS—204

Aderholt
Allen
Amodei
Armstrong
Arrington
Babin
Bacon
Baird
Balderson
Banks
Barr
Bentz
Bergman
Bice (OK)
Biggs
Bilirakis
Bishop (NC)
Boebert
Bost
Brady
Brooks
Buchanan
Buck
Bucshon
Budd
Burchett
Burgess
Calvert
Cammack
Carey
Carl
Carter (GA)
Carter (TX)
Cawthorn
Chabot
Cheney
Cline
Cloud
Clyde
Cole
Comer
Crawford
Crenshaw
Curtis
Davidson
Davis, Rodney
DesJarlais
Diaz-Balart
Donalds
Duncan
Dunn
Ellzey
Emmer
Estes
Fallon
Feenstra
Ferguson
Fischbach
Fitzgerald
Fitzpatrick
Fleischmann
Foxx
Franklin, C. Scott
Fulcher
Gaetz
Gallagher
Garbarino
Garcia (CA)
Gibbs
Gimenez
Gohmert
Gonzales, Tony
Gonzalez (OH)
Good (VA)
Gooden (TX)
Gosar
Granger
Graves (LA)
Graves (MO)
Green (TN)
Greene (GA)
Griffith
Grothman
Guthrie
Harris
Harshbarger
Hartzler
Hern
Herrell
Herrera Beutler
Hice (GA)
Higgins (LA)
Hill
Hinson
Hollingsworth
Hudson
Huizenga
Issa
Jackson
Jacobs (NY)
Johnson (LA)
Johnson (OH)
Johnson (SD)
Jordan
Joyce (OH)
Joyce (PA)
Katko
Keller
Kelly (MS)
Kelly (PA)
Kim (CA)
Kinzinger
Kustoff
LaHood
LaMalfa
Lamborn
Latta
LaTurner
Lesko
Letlow
Long
Lucas
Luetkemeyer
Mace
Malliotakis
Mann
Massie
Mast
McCarthy
McCaul
McClain
McClintock
McHenry
McKinley
Meijer
Meuser
Miller (WV)
Miller-Meeks
Moolenaar
Mooney
Moore (AL)
Moore (UT)
Mullin
Murphy (NC)
Nehls
Newhouse
Norman
Obernolte
Owens
Palazzo
Palmer
Pence
Perry
Pfluger
Posey
Reschenthaler
Rice (SC)
Rodgers (WA)
Rogers (AL)
Rogers (KY)
Rose
Rosendale
Rouzer
Roy
Rutherford
Salazar
Scalise
Scott, Austin
Sessions
Simpson
Smith (MO)
Smith (NE)
Smith (NJ)
Smucker
Spartz
Stauber
Steel
Stefanik
Steil
Steube
Stewart
Taylor
Tenney
Thompson (PA)
Tiffany
Timmons
Turner
Upton
Valadao
Van Drew
Van Duyne
Wagner
Walberg
Walorski
Waltz
Weber (TX)
Webster (FL)
Wenstrup
Westerman
Williams (TX)
Wilson (SC)
Wittman
Womack
Zeldin

NOT VOTING—5

Casten
Guest
Loudermilk
Miller (IL)
Schweikert

□ 1437

So the resolution was agreed to.

The result of the vote was announced as above recorded.

A motion to reconsider was laid on the table.

MEMBERS RECORDED PURSUANT TO HOUSE RESOLUTION 8, 117TH CONGRESS

Amodei (Balderson)
Bustos (Mrvan)
Carter (TX) (Weber (TX))
Correa (Huffman)
Crist (Wasserman Schultz)
Davids (KS) (Neguse)
Deutch (Rice (NY))
Evans (Beyer)
Gonzalez (OH) (Meijer)
Johnson (GA) (Manning)
Johnson (TX) (Jeffries)
Kahele (Mrvan)
Kelly (IL) (Neguse)
Khanna (Watson Coleman)
Lamb (Blunt Rochester)
Lawrence (Stevens)
Lawson (FL) (Wasserman Schultz)
Lynch (Langevin)
Mace (Carter (GA))
McEachin (Beyer)
Moore (WI) (Beyer)
Nadler (Pallone)
Newman (Beyer)
O'Halleran (Schrader)
Palazzo (Fleischmann)
Payne (Pallone)
Peters (Jeffries)
Pingree (Wasserman Schultz)
Price (NC) (Manning)
Rice (SC) (Meijer)
Schneider (Stevens)
Speier (Huffman)
Stansbury (García (IL))
Stanton (Huffman)
Suozzi (Beyer)
Taylor (Van Duyne)
Tenney (Jackson)
Titus (Pallone)
Walorski (Bucshon)
Waters (Takano)
Welch (Pallone)
Wilson (FL) (Neguse)
Wilson (SC) (Timmons)

SUPREME COURT POLICE PARITY ACT OF 2022

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Pursuant to clause 8 of rule XX, the unfinished business is the vote on the motion to suspend the rules and pass the bill (S. 4160) to amend title 40, United States Code, to grant the Supreme Court of the United States security-related authorities equivalent to the legislative and executive branches, on which the yeas and nays were ordered.

The Clerk read the title of the bill.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The question is on the motion offered by the gentleman from California (Mr. LIEU) that the House suspend the rules and pass the bill.

This is a 5-minute vote.

The vote was taken by electronic device, and there were—yeas 396, nays 27, not voting 4, as follows:

[Roll No. 261]

YEAS—396

Adams
Aderholt
Aguilar
Allen
Allred
Amodei
Armstrong
Arrington
Auchincloss
Axne
Babin
Bacon
Baird
Balderson
Banks
Barr
Barragán
Bass
Bentz
Bera
Bergman
Beyer
Bice (OK)
Biggs
Bilirakis
Bishop (GA)
Bishop (NC)
Blumenauer
Blunt Rochester
Boebert
Bonamici
Bost
Bourdeaux
Boyle, Brendan F.
Brady
Brooks
Brown (MD)
Brown (OH)
Brownley
Buchanan
Buck
Bucshon
Budd
Burchett
Burgess
Bustos
Butterfield
Calvert
Cammack
Carbajal
Cárdenas
Carey
Carl
Carson
Carter (GA)
Carter (LA)
Carter (TX)
Cartwright
Case
Castor (FL)
Castro (TX)
Cawthorn
Chabot
Cheney
Cherfilus-McCormick
Chu
Cicilline
Clark (MA)
Clarke (NY)
Cleaver
Cline
Cloud
Clyburn
Clyde
Cohen
Cole
Comer
Connolly
Cooper
Correa
Costa
Courtney
Craig
Crawford
Crenshaw
Crist
Crow
Cuellar
Curtis
Davids (KS)
Davidson
Davis, Danny K.
Davis, Rodney
Dean
DeFazio
DeGette
DeLauro
DelBene
Demings
DeSaulnier
DesJarlais
Deutch
Diaz-Balart
Dingell
Doggett
Donalds
Doyle, Michael F.
Duncan
Dunn
Ellzey
Emmer
Eshoo
Estes
Evans
Fallon
Feenstra
Ferguson
Fischbach
Fitzgerald
Fitzpatrick
Fleischmann
Fletcher
Foster
Foxx
Frankel, Lois
Franklin, C. Scott
Fulcher
Gaetz
Gallagher
Gallego
Garamendi
Garbarino
Garcia (CA)
Gibbs
Gimenez
Gohmert
Golden
Gomez
Gonzales, Tony
Gonzalez (OH)
Gonzalez, Vicente
Good (VA)
Gooden (TX)
Gosar
Granger
Graves (LA)
Graves (MO)
Green (TN)
Green, Al (TX)
Greene (GA)
Griffith
Grothman
Guthrie
Harder (CA)
Harris
Harshbarger
Hartzler
Hayes
Hern
Herrera Beutler
Hice (GA)
Higgins (LA)
Higgins (NY)
Hill
Himes
Hinson
Hollingsworth
Houlahan
Hoyer
Hudson
Huffman
Huizenga
Issa
Jackson
Jackson Lee

Jacobs (CA)
Jacobs (NY)
Jeffries
Johnson (GA)
Johnson (LA)
Johnson (OH)
Johnson (SD)
Johnson (TX)
Jones
Jordan
Joyce (OH)
Joyce (PA)
Kahele
Kaptur
Katko
Keating
Keller
Kelly (IL)
Kelly (MS)
Kelly (PA)
Khanna
Kildee
Kilmer
Kim (CA)
Kim (NJ)
Kind
Kinzinger
Kirkpatrick
Krishnamoorthi
Kuster
Kustoff
LaHood
LaMalfa
Lamb
Lamborn
Langevin
Larsen (WA)
Larson (CT)
Latta
LaTurner
Lawson (FL)
Lee (NV)
Leger Fernandez
Lesko
Letlow
Levin (CA)
Levin (MI)
Lieu
Lofgren
Long
Loudermilk
Lowenthal
Lucas
Luetkemeyer
Luria
Lynch
Mace
Malliotakis
Maloney, Carolyn B.
Maloney, Sean
Mann
Manning
Massie
Mast
Matsui
McBath
McCarthy
McCaul
McClain
McClintock
McCollum
McEachin
McGovern
McHenry
McKinley
McNerney
Meeks
Meijer
Meng
Meuser
Mfume
Miller (WV)
Miller-Meeks
Moolenaar
Mooney
Moore (AL)
Moore (UT)
Moore (WI)
Morelle
Moulton
Mrvan
Mullin
Murphy (FL)
Murphy (NC)
Nadler
Napolitano
Neal
Neguse
Nehls
Newhouse
Norcross
Norman
O'Halleran
Obernolte
Omar
Owens
Palazzo
Pallone
Palmer
Panetta
Pappas
Pence
Perry
Peters
Pfluger
Phillips
Pingree
Pocan
Porter
Posey
Price (NC)
Quigley
Raskin
Reschenthaler
Rice (NY)
Rice (SC)
Rodgers (WA)
Rogers (AL)
Rogers (KY)
Rose
Rosendale
Ross
Rouzer
Roy
Roybal-Allard
Ruiz
Ruppersberger
Rush
Rutherford
Ryan
Salazar
Sánchez
Sarbanes
Scalise
Scanlon
Schakowsky
Schiff
Schneider
Schrader
Schrier
Schweikert
Scott (VA)
Scott, Austin
Scott, David
Sessions
Sewell
Sherman
Simpson
Slotkin
Smith (MO)
Smith (NE)
Smith (NJ)
Smith (WA)
Smucker
Soto
Spanberger
Spartz
Speier
Stansbury
Stanton
Stauber
Steel
Stefanik
Steil
Steube
Stevens
Stewart
Strickland
Suozzi
Swalwell
Takano
Taylor
Tenney
Thompson (CA)
Thompson (MS)
Thompson (PA)
Tiffany
Timmons
Titus
Tonko
Torres (NY)
Trahan
Trone
Turner
Underwood
Upton
Valadao
Van Drew
Van Duyne
Vargas
Veasey
Wagner
Walberg
Walorski
Waltz
Wasserman Schultz
Weber (TX)
Webster (FL)
Welch
Wenstrup
Westerman
Wexton
Wild
Williams (GA)
Williams (TX)
Wilson (FL)
Wilson (SC)
Wittman
Womack
Yarmuth
Zeldin

NAYS—27

Beatty
Bowman
Bush
Escobar
Espaillat
García (IL)
Garcia (TX)
Gottheimer
Grijalva
Horsford
Jayapal
Lawrence
Lee (CA)
Malinowski
Newman
Ocasio-Cortez
Pascrell
Payne
Perlmutter
Pressley
Sherrill
Sires
Tlaib
Torres (CA)
Velázquez
Waters
Watson Coleman

NOT VOTING—4

Casten
Guest
Herrell
Miller (IL)

□ 1449

Mses. LEE of California and NEWMAN changed their vote from ''yea'' to ''nay.''

So (two-thirds being in the affirmative) the rules were suspended and the bill was passed.

The result of the vote was announced as above recorded.

A motion to reconsider was laid on the table.

PERSONAL EXPLANATION

Mrs. MILLER of Illinois. Mr. Speaker, had I been present, I would have voted "nay" on rollcall No. 259, "nay" on rollcall No. 260, and "yea" on rollcall No. 261.

MEMBERS RECORDED PURSUANT TO HOUSE RESOLUTION 8, 117TH CONGRESS

Amodei (Balderson)
Bustos (Mrvan)
Carter (TX) (Weber (TX))
Correa (Huffman)
Crist (Wasserman Schultz)
Davids (KS) (Neguse)
Deutch (Rice (NY))
Evans (Beyer)
Gonzalez (OH) (Meijer)
Johnson (GA) (Manning)
Johnson (TX) (Jeffries)
Kahele (Mrvan)
Kelly (IL) (Neguse)
Khanna (Watson Coleman)
Lamb (Blunt Rochester)
Lawrence (Stevens)
Lawson (FL) (Wasserman Schultz)
Lynch (Langevin)
Mace (Carter (GA))
McEachin (Beyer)
Moore (WI) (Beyer)
Nadler (Pallone)
Newman (Beyer)
O'Halleran (Schrader)
Palazzo (Fleischmann)
Payne (Pallone)
Peters (Jeffries)
Pingree (Wasserman Schultz)
Price (NC) (Manning)
Rice (SC) (Meijer)
Schneider (Stevens)
Speier (Huffman)
Stansbury (García (IL))
Stanton (Huffman)
Suozzi (Beyer)
Taylor (Van Duyne)
Tenney (Jackson)
Titus (Pallone)
Walorski (Bucshon)
Waters (Takano)
Welch (Pallone)
Wilson (FL) (Neguse)
Wilson (SC) (Timmons)

RECOVERING AMERICA'S WILDLIFE ACT OF 2021

Mrs. DINGELL. Mr. Speaker, pursuant to House Resolution 1170, I call up the bill (H.R. 2773) to amend the Pittman-Robertson Wildlife Restoration Act to make supplemental funds available for management of fish and wildlife species of greatest conservation need as determined by State fish and wildlife agencies, and for other purposes, and ask for its immediate consideration in the House.

The Clerk read the title of the bill.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Pursuant to House Resolution 1170, in lieu of the amendment in the nature of a substitute recommended by the Committee on Natural Resources, printed in the bill, an amendment in the nature of a substitute consisting of the text of Rules Committee Print 117–47, modified by the amendment printed in part C of House Report 117–366, is adopted and the bill, as amended, is considered read.

The text of the bill, as amended, is as follows:

H.R. 2773

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives of the United States of America in Congress assembled,

SECTION 1. SHORT TITLE.

This Act may be cited as the ''Recovering America's Wildlife Act of 2022''.

SEC. 2. STATEMENT OF PURPOSE.

The purpose of this Act is to extend financial and technical assistance to States, territories, the District of Columbia, and Indian Tribes, including under the Pittman-Robertson Wildlife Restoration Act (16 U.S.C. 669 et seq.), for the purpose of avoiding the need to list species, or recovering species currently listed as a threatened species or an endangered species, under the Endangered Species Act of 1973 (16 U.S.C. 1531 et seq.) or under State law.

TITLE I—WILDLIFE CONSERVATION AND RESTORATION

SEC. 101. WILDLIFE CONSERVATION AND RESTORATION SUBACCOUNT.

(a) IN GENERAL.—Section 3 of the Pittman-Robertson Wildlife Restoration Act (16 U.S.C. 669b) is amended in subsection (c)—

(1) by redesignating paragraphs (2) and (3) as paragraphs (9) and (10); and

(2) by striking paragraph (1) and inserting the following:

''(1) ESTABLISHMENT OF SUBACCOUNT.—

''(A) IN GENERAL.—There is established in the fund a subaccount to be known as the 'Wildlife Conservation and Restoration Subaccount' (referred to in this section as the 'Subaccount').

''(B) AVAILABILITY.—Amounts in the Subaccount shall be available without further appropriation, for each fiscal year, for apportionment in accordance with this Act.

''(C) DEPOSITS INTO SUBACCOUNT.—The Secretary of the Treasury shall transfer from the general fund of the Treasury to the Subaccount—

''(i) for fiscal year 2023, $850,000,000;

''(ii) for fiscal year 2024, $1,100,000,000;

''(iii) for fiscal year 2025, $1,200,000,000; and

''(iv) for fiscal year 2026 and each fiscal year thereafter, $1,300,000,000.

''(2) SUPPLEMENT NOT SUPPLANT.—Amounts transferred to the Subaccount shall supplement, but not replace, existing funds available to the States from—

''(A) the funds distributed pursuant to the Dingell-Johnson Sport Fish Restoration Act (16 U.S.C. 777 et seq.); and

''(B) the fund.

''(3) INNOVATION GRANTS.—

''(A) IN GENERAL.—The Secretary shall distribute 10 percent of funds apportioned from the Subaccount through a competitive grant program to State fish and wildlife departments, the District of Columbia fish and wildlife department, fish and wildlife departments of territories, or to regional associations of fish and wildlife departments (or any group composed of more than 1 such entity).

''(B) PURPOSE.—Such grants shall be provided for the purpose of catalyzing innovation of techniques, tools, strategies, or collaborative partnerships that accelerate, expand, or replicate effective and measurable recovery efforts for species of greatest conservation need and species listed under the Endangered Species Act of 1973 (16 U.S.C. 1531 et seq.) and the habitats of such species.

''(C) REVIEW COMMITTEE.—The Secretary shall appoint a review committee comprised of—

''(i) a State Director from each regional association of State fish and wildlife departments;

''(ii) the head of a department responsible for fish and wildlife management in a territory;

''(iii) one delegate from the United States Fish and Wildlife Service, for the purpose of providing technical assistance; and

''(iv) beginning in fiscal year 2023, four individuals representing four different nonprofit organizations each of which is actively participating in carrying out wildlife conservation restoration activities using funds apportioned from the Subaccount.

''(D) SUPPORT FROM UNITED STATES FISH AND WILDLIFE SERVICE.—Using not more than 3 percent of the amounts apportioned under subparagraph (A) to carry out a competitive grant program, the United States Fish and Wildlife Service shall provide any personnel or administrative support services necessary for such committee to carry out its responsibilities under this Act.

''(E) EVALUATION.—Such committee shall evaluate each proposal submitted under this paragraph and recommend projects for funding, giving preference to solutions that accelerate the recovery of species identified as priorities through regional scientific assessments of species of greatest conservation need.

''(4) USE OF FUNDS.—Funds apportioned from the Subaccount shall be used for purposes consistent with section 2 of the Recovering America's Wildlife Act of 2022 and—

''(A) shall be used to implement the Wildlife Conservation Strategy of a State, territory, or the District of Columbia, as required under section 4(e), by carrying out, revising, or enhancing existing wildlife and habitat conservation and restoration programs and developing and implementing new wildlife conservation and restoration programs to recover and manage species of greatest conservation need and the key habitats and plant community types essential to the conservation of those species, as determined by the appropriate State fish and wildlife department;

''(B) shall be used to develop, revise, and enhance the Wildlife Conservation Strategy of a State, territory, or the District of Columbia, as may be required by this Act;

''(C) shall be used to assist in the recovery of species found in the State, territory, or the District of Columbia that are listed as endangered species, threatened species, candidate species or species proposed for listing, or species petitioned for listing under the Endangered Species Act of 1973 (16 U.S.C. 1531 et seq.) or under State law;

''(D) may be used for wildlife conservation education and wildlife-associated recreation projects, especially in historically underserved communities;

''(E) may be used to manage a species of greatest conservation need whose range is shared with another State, territory, Indian Tribe, or foreign government and for the conservation of the habitat of such species;

''(F) may be used to manage, control, and prevent invasive species, disease, and other risks to species of greatest conservation need; and

''(G) may be used for law enforcement activities that are directly related to the protection and conservation of a species of greatest conservation need and the habitat of such species.

''(5) MINIMUM REQUIRED SPENDING FOR ENDANGERED SPECIES RECOVERY.—Not less than an average of 15 percent over a 5-year period of amounts apportioned to a State, territory, or the District of Columbia from the Subaccount shall be used for purposes described in paragraph (4)(C). The Secretary may reduce the minimum requirement of a State, territory, or the District of Columbia on an annual basis if the Secretary determines that the State, territory, or the District of Columbia is meeting the conservation and recovery needs of all species described in paragraph (4)(C).

''(6) PUBLIC ACCESS TO PRIVATE LANDS NOT REQUIRED.—Funds apportioned from the Subaccount shall not be conditioned upon the provision of public access to private lands, waters, or holdings.

''(7) REQUIREMENTS FOR MATCHING FUNDS.—

''(A) For the purposes of the non-Federal fund matching requirement for a wildlife conservation or restoration program or project funded by the Subaccount, a State, territory, or the District of Columbia may use as matching non-Federal funds—

''(i) funds from Federal agencies other than the Department of the Interior and the Department of Agriculture;

''(ii) donated private lands and waters, including privately owned easements;

''(iii) in circumstances described in subparagraph (B), revenue generated through the sale of State hunting and fishing licenses; and

''(iv) other sources consistent with part 80 of title 50, Code of Federal Regulations, in effect on the date of enactment of the Recovering America's Wildlife Act of 2022.

''(B) Revenue described in subparagraph (A)(iii) may only be used to fulfill the requirements of such non-Federal fund matching requirement if—

''(i) no Federal funds apportioned to the State fish and wildlife department of such State from the Wildlife Restoration Program or the Sport Fish Restoration Program have been reverted because of a failure to fulfill such non-Federal fund matching requirement by such State during the previous 2 years; and

''(ii) the project or program being funded benefits the habitat of a hunted or fished species and a species of greatest conservation need.

''(8) DEFINITIONS.—In this subsection, the following definitions apply:

''(A) PARTNERSHIPS.—The term 'partnerships' may include collaborative efforts with Federal agencies, State agencies, local agencies, Indian Tribes, nonprofit organizations, academic institutions, industry groups, and private individuals to implement a State's Wildlife Conservation Strategy.

''(B) SPECIES OF GREATEST CONSERVATION NEED.—The term 'species of greatest conservation need' may be fauna or flora, and may include terrestrial, aquatic, marine, and invertebrate species that are of low population, declining, rare, or facing threats and in need of conservation attention, as determined by each State fish and wildlife department, with respect to funds apportioned to such State.

''(C) TERRITORY AND TERRITORIES.—The terms 'territory' and 'territories' mean the Commonwealth of Puerto Rico, Guam, American Samoa, the Commonwealth of the Northern Mariana Islands, and the United States Virgin Islands.

''(D) WILDLIFE.—The term 'wildlife' means any species of wild, freeranging fauna, including fish, and also fauna in captive breeding programs the object of which is to reintroduce individuals of a depleted indigenous species into previously occupied range.''.

(b) Section 3 of the Pittman-Robertson Wildlife Restoration Act (16 U.S.C. 669b) is amended by adding at the end the following:

''(e) AUTHORIZATION OF APPROPRIATIONS TO INSPECTOR GENERAL.—There is authorized to be appropriated to the Office of the Inspector General of the Department of the Interior ½ of 1 percent of the amounts made available under subsection (c) for the purposes of providing oversight and accountability with respect to expenditure of funds authorized under such subsection, to remain available until September 30, 2029.''.

(c) ALLOCATION AND APPORTIONMENT OF AVAILABLE AMOUNTS.—Section 4 of the Pittman-Robertson Wildlife Restoration Act (16 U.S.C. 669c) is amended—

(1) in subsection (d)—

(A) in paragraph (1)—

(i) in subparagraph (A), by striking ''to the District of Columbia and to the Commonwealth of Puerto Rico, each'' and inserting ''To the District of Columbia'';

(ii) in subparagraph (B)—

(I) by striking ''to Guam'' and inserting ''To Guam''; and

(II) by striking ''not more than one-fourth of one percent'' and inserting ''not less than one-third of one percent''; and

(iii) by adding at the end the following:

''(C) To the Commonwealth of Puerto Rico, a sum equal to not less than 1 percent thereof.'';

(B) in paragraph (2)(A)—

(i) by amending clause (i) to read as follows:

''(i) one-half of which is based on the ratio to which the land and water area of such State bears to the total land and water area of all such States;'';

(ii) in clause (ii)—

(I) by striking ''two-thirds'' and inserting ''one-quarter''; and

(II) by striking the period and inserting ''; and''; and

(iii) by adding at the end the following:

''(iii) one-quarter of which is based upon the ratio to which the number of species listed as endangered or threatened under the Endangered Species Act of 1973 (16 U.S.C. 1531 et seq.) in such State bears to the total number of such species listed in all such States.'';

(C) by amending paragraph (2)(B) to read as follows:

''(B) The amounts apportioned under this paragraph shall be adjusted equitably so that no such State, unless otherwise designated, shall be apportioned a sum which is less than 1 percent or more than 5 percent of the amount available for apportionment under—

''(i) subparagraph (A)(i);

''(ii) subparagraph (A)(ii); and

''(iii) the overall amount available for subparagraph (A).''; and

(D) in paragraph (3), by striking ''3 percent'' and inserting ''1.85 percent'';

(2) in subsection (e)(4)—

(A) by amending subparagraph (B) to read as follows:

''(B) Not more than an average of 15 percent over a 5-year period of amounts apportioned to each State, territory, or the District of Columbia under this section for a wildlife conservation and restoration program may be used for wildlife conservation education and wildlife-associated recreation.''; and

(B) by inserting after subparagraph (B), as so amended, the following:

''(C) 5 percent of amounts apportioned to each State, each territory, or the District of Columbia under this section for a wildlife conservation and restoration program shall be reserved for States and territories that include plants among their species of greatest conservation need and in the conservation planning and habitat prioritization efforts of their Wildlife Conservation Strategy. Each eligible State, territory, or the District of Columbia shall receive an additional 5 percent of their apportioned amount. Any unallocated resources shall be allocated proportionally among all States and territories under the formulas of this section.''; and

(3) by adding at the end following:

''(f) MINIMIZATION OF PLANNING AND REPORTING.—Nothing in this Act shall be interpreted to require a State to create a comprehensive strategy related to conservation education or outdoor recreation.

''(g) ACCOUNTABILITY.—

''(1) IN GENERAL.—Not more than one year after the date of enactment of the Recovering America's Wildlife Act of 2022 and every 3 years thereafter, each State fish and wildlife department shall submit a 3-year work plan and budget for implementing its Wildlife Conservation Strategy and a report describing the results derived from activities accomplished under subsection (e) during the previous 3 years to the United States Fish and Wildlife Service for review, which shall summarize such findings and submit a report to—

''(A) the Committee on Environment and Public Works of the Senate; and

''(B) the Committee on Natural Resources of the House of Representatives.

''(2) REQUIREMENTS.—The format of the 3-year work plans, budgets, and reports required under paragraph (1) shall be established by the United States Fish and Wildlife Service, in consultation with the Association of Fish and Wildlife Agencies.

''(3) GAO STUDY.—Not later than 7 years after the date of enactment of the Recovering America's Wildlife Act of 2022, the Comptroller General of the United States shall conduct a study to examine the progress of States, territories, the District of Columbia, and Indian Tribes towards achieving the purpose described in section 2 of that Act.''.

SEC. 102. TECHNICAL AMENDMENTS.

(a) DEFINITIONS.—Section 2 of the Pittman-Robertson Wildlife Restoration Act (16 U.S.C. 669a) is amended—

(1) in paragraph (7), by striking ''including fish,''; and

(2) in paragraph (9), by inserting ''Indian Tribes, academic institutions,'' before ''wildlife conservation organizations''.

(b) CONFORMING AMENDMENTS.—The Pittman-Robertson Wildlife Restoration Act (16 U.S.C. 669 et seq.) is amended—

(1) in section 3—

(A) in subsection (a)—

(i) by striking ''(1) An amount equal to'' and inserting ''An amount equal to''; and

(ii) by striking paragraph (2);

(B) in subsection (c)—

(i) in paragraph (9), as redesignated by section 101(a)(1), by striking ''or an Indian tribe''; and

(ii) in paragraph (10), as redesignated by section 101(a)(1), by striking ''Wildlife Conservation and Restoration Account'' and inserting ''Subaccount''; and

(C) in subsection (d), by striking ''Wildlife Conservation and Restoration Account'' and inserting ''Subaccount'';

(2) in section 4 (16 U.S.C. 669c)—

(A) in subsection (d)—

(i) in the heading, by striking ''ACCOUNT'' and inserting ''SUBACCOUNT''; and

(ii) by striking ''Account'' each place it appears and inserting ''Subaccount''; and

(B) in subsection (e)(1), by striking ''Account'' and inserting ''Subaccount''; and

(3) in section 8 (16 U.S.C. 669g), in subsection (a), by striking ''Account'' and inserting ''Subaccount''.

SEC. 103. SAVINGS CLAUSE.

The Pittman-Robertson Wildlife Restoration Act (16 U.S.C. 669 et seq.) is amended—

(1) by redesignating section 14 as section 16; and

(2) by inserting after section 13 the following:

''SEC. 14. SAVINGS CLAUSE.

''Nothing in this Act shall be construed to enlarge or diminish the authority, jurisdiction, or responsibility of a State to manage, control, or regulate fish and wildlife under the law and regulations of the State on lands and waters within the State, including on Federal lands and waters.

''SEC. 15. STATUTORY CONSTRUCTION WITH RESPECT TO ALASKA.

''If any conflict arises between any provision of this Act and any provision of the Alaska National Interest Lands Conservation Act (16 U.S.C. 3101 et seq.) or the Alaska Native Claims Settlement Act (43 U.S.C. 1601 et seq.), then the provision in the Alaska National Interest Lands Conservation Act or the Alaska Native Claims Settlement Act shall prevail.''.

TITLE II—TRIBAL WILDLIFE CONSERVATION AND RESTORATION

SEC. 201. INDIAN TRIBES.

(a) DEFINITIONS.—In this section:

(1) ACCOUNT.—The term ''Account'' means the Tribal Wildlife Conservation and Restoration Account established by subsection (b)(1).

(2) INDIAN TRIBE.—The term ''Indian Tribe'' has the meaning given such term in section 4 of the Indian Self-Determination and Education Assistance Act (25 U.S.C. 5304).

(3) SECRETARY.—The term ''Secretary'' means the Secretary of the Interior.

(4) TRIBAL SPECIES OF GREATEST CONSERVATION NEED.—The term ''Tribal species of greatest conservation need'' means any species identified by an Indian Tribe as requiring conservation management because of declining population, habitat loss, or other threats, or because of their biological or cultural importance to such Tribe.

(5) WILDLIFE.—The term ''wildlife'' means—

(A) any species of wild flora or fauna including fish and marine mammals;

(B) flora or fauna in a captive breeding, rehabilitation, and holding or quarantine program, the object of which is to reintroduce individuals of a depleted indigenous species into previously occupied range or to maintain a species for conservation purposes; and

(C) does not include game farm animals.

(b) TRIBAL WILDLIFE CONSERVATION AND RESTORATION ACCOUNT.—

(1) IN GENERAL.—There is established in the Treasury an account to be known as the ''Tribal Wildlife Conservation and Restoration Account''.

(2) AVAILABILITY.—Amounts in the Account shall be available for each fiscal year without further appropriation for apportionment in accordance with this title.

(3) DEPOSITS INTO ACCOUNT.—

Beginning in fiscal year 2023, and for each fiscal year thereafter, the Secretary of the Treasury shall transfer $97,500,000 from the general fund of the Treasury to the Account.

(c) DISTRIBUTION OF FUNDS TO INDIAN TRIBES.—Each fiscal year, the Secretary of the Treasury shall deposit funds into the Account and distribute such funds through a noncompetitive application process according to guidelines and criteria, and reporting requirements determined by the Secretary of the Interior, acting through the Director of the Bureau of Indian Affairs, in consultation with Indian Tribes. Such funds shall remain available until expended.

(d) WILDLIFE MANAGEMENT RESPONSIBILITIES.—The distribution guidelines and criteria described in subsection (c) shall be based, in part, upon an Indian Tribe's wildlife management responsibilities. Any funding allocated to an Indian Tribe in Alaska may only be used in a manner consistent with the Alaska Native Claims Settlement Act (43 U.S.C. 1601 et seq.), the Alaska National Interest Lands Conservation Act (16 U.S.C. 3101 et seq.), and Public Law 85–508 (commonly known as the ''Alaska Statehood Act'') (48 U.S.C. note prec. 21). Alaska Native Corporations or Tribes may enter into cooperative agreements with the State of Alaska on conservation projects of mutual concern.

(e) USE OF FUNDS.—

(1) IN GENERAL.—Except as provided in paragraph (2), the Secretary may distribute funds from the Account to an Indian Tribe for any of the following purposes:

(A) To develop, carry out, revise, or enhance wildlife conservation and restoration programs to manage Tribal species of greatest conservation need and the habitats of such species, as determined by the Indian Tribe.

(B) To assist in the recovery of species listed as an endangered or threatened species under the Endangered Species Act of 1973 (16 U.S.C. 1531 et seq.).

(C) For wildlife conservation education and wildlife-associated recreation projects.

(D) To manage a Tribal species of greatest conservation need and the habitat of such species, the range of which may be shared with a foreign country, State, or other Indian Tribe.

(E) To manage, control, and prevent invasive species as well as diseases and other risks to wildlife.

(F) For law enforcement activities that are directly related to the protection and conservation of wildlife.

(G) To develop, revise, and implement comprehensive wildlife conservation strategies and plans for such Tribe.

(H) For the hiring and training of wildlife conservation and restoration program staff.

(2) CONDITIONS ON THE USE OF FUNDS.—

(A) REQUIRED USE OF FUNDS.—In order to be eligible to receive funds under subsection (c), a Tribe's application must include a proposal to use funds for at least one of the purposes described in subparagraphs (A) and (B) of paragraph (1).

(B) IMPERILED SPECIES RECOVERY.—In distributing funds under this section, the Secretary shall distribute not less than 15 percent of the total funds distributed to proposals to fund the recovery of a species, subspecies, or distinct population segment listed as a threatened species, endangered species, or candidate species under the Endangered Species Act of 1973 (16 U.S.C. 1531 et seq.) or Tribal law.

(C) LIMITATION.—In distributing funds under this section, the Secretary shall distribute not more than 15 percent of all funds distributed under this section for the purpose described in paragraph (1)(C).

(f) NO MATCHING FUNDS REQUIRED.—No Indian Tribe shall be required to provide matching funds to be eligible to receive funds under this Act.

(g) PUBLIC ACCESS NOT REQUIRED.—Funds apportioned from the Tribal Wildlife Conservation and Restoration Account shall not be conditioned upon the provision of public or non-Tribal access to Tribal or private lands, waters, or holdings.

(h) ADMINISTRATIVE COSTS.—Of the funds deposited under subsection (b)(3) for each fiscal year, not more than 3 percent shall be used by the Secretary for administrative costs.

(i) AUTHORIZATION OF APPROPRIATIONS TO INSPECTOR GENERAL.—There is authorized to be appropriated to the Office of the Inspector General of the Department of the Interior ½ of 1 percent of the amounts made available this section for the purposes of providing oversight and accountability with respect to expenditure of funds authorized under this section, to remain available until September 30, 2029.

(j) SAVINGS CLAUSE.—Nothing in this Act shall be construed as modifying or abrogating a treaty with any Indian Tribe, or as enlarging or diminishing the authority, jurisdiction, or responsibility of an Indian Tribe to manage, control, or regulate wildlife.

(k) STATUTORY CONSTRUCTION WITH RESPECT TO ALASKA.—If any conflict arises between any provision of this Act and any provision of the Alaska National Interest Lands Conservation Act (16 U.S.C. 3101 et seq.) or the Alaska Native Claims Settlement Act (43 U.S.C. 1601 et seq.), then the provision in the Alaska National Interest Lands Conservation Act or the Alaska Native Claims Settlement Act shall prevail.

TITLE III—ENDANGERED SPECIES RECOVERY AND HABITAT CONSERVATION LEGACY FUND

SEC. 301. ENDANGERED SPECIES RECOVERY AND HABITAT CONSERVATION LEGACY FUND.

(a) ESTABLISHMENT.—There is established in the Treasury of the United States a fund, to be known as the ''Endangered Species Recovery and Habitat Conservation Legacy Fund'' (referred to in this section as the ''Fund'').

(b) FUNDING.—For each of fiscal years 2023 through 2026, the Secretary of the Treasury shall transfer from the general fund of the Treasury to the Fund $187,500,000.

(c) AVAILABILITY OF FUNDS.—Amounts in the Fund shall be available to the Secretary of the Interior, acting through the Director of the United States Fish and Wildlife Service (referred to in this section as the ''Secretary''), as provided in subsection (e), without further appropriation or fiscal year limitation.

(d) INVESTMENT OF AMOUNTS.—

(1) IN GENERAL.—The Secretary may request the Secretary of the Treasury to invest any portion of the Fund that is not, as determined by the Secretary, required to meet the current needs of the Fund.

(2) REQUIREMENT.—An investment requested under paragraph (1) shall be made by the Secretary of the Treasury in a public debt security—

(A) with a maturity suitable to the needs of the Fund, as determined by the Secretary; and

(B) bearing interest at a rate determined by the Secretary of the Treasury, taking into consideration current market yields on outstanding marketable obligations of the United States of comparable maturity.

(3) CREDITS TO FUND.—The income on investments of the Fund under this subsection shall be credited to, and form a part of, the Fund.

(e) USE OF FUNDS.—Amounts in the Fund shall be used for recovering the species managed under the Endangered Species Act of 1973 (16 U.S.C. 1531 et seq.), in addition to amounts otherwise available for such purposes, as follows:

(1) ENDANGERED SPECIES RECOVERY GRANT PROGRAM.—$75,000,000 for each of fiscal years 2023 through 2026, to remain available until expended, shall be used to establish and implement

a grant and technical assistance program, to be known as the ''Endangered Species Recovery Grant Program'', to provide competitive matching grants for the purpose of recovering species listed as a threatened species or an endangered species under section 4 of the Endangered Species Act of 1973 (16 U.S.C. 1533) by addressing the backlog in the development of recovery plans, and implementing the backlog of activities identified in existing recovery plans, under subsection (f) of that section (16 U.S.C. 1533(f)). The Secretary shall enter into an agreement with the National Fish and Wildlife Foundation to establish and cooperatively manage the Endangered Species Recovery Grant Program in accordance with the Endangered Species Act of 1973 (16 U.S.C. 1531 et seq.) and the National Fish and Wildlife Foundation Establishment Act (16 U.S.C. 3701 et seq.).

(2) INTERAGENCY CONSULTATION RESPONSIBILITIES.—$75,000,000 for each of fiscal years 2023 through 2026, to remain available until expended, shall be used for the United States Fish and Wildlife Service to address interagency consultation responsibilities under section 7 of the Endangered Species Act of 1973 (16 U.S.C. 1536).

(3) CONSERVATION ACTIVITIES.—$28,125,000 for each of fiscal years 2023 through 2026, to remain available until expended, shall be used for the United States Fish and Wildlife Service to work with non-Federal entities, including through, but not limited to, the Partners for Fish and Wildlife Program, the Coastal Program, and the North American Wetlands Conservation Act (16 U.S.C. 4401 et seq.)—

(A) to conserve at risk species, species that are candidates or proposed for listing, and species that are listed as threatened or endangered species under section 4 of the Endangered Species Act of 1973 (16 U.S.C. 1533), including through rescue and rehabilitation efforts; and

(B) to conserve wildlife habitat.

(4) VOLUNTARY CONSERVATION AGREEMENTS.—$9,375,000 for each of fiscal years 2023 through 2026, to remain available until expended, shall be used for the United States Fish and Wildlife Service to address the development and permitting of voluntary conservation agreements under section 10 of the Endangered Species Act of 1973 (16 U.S.C. 1539).

(f) SUPPLEMENT, NOT SUPPLANT.—Amounts made available under this section shall supplement and not supplant any other Federal amounts made available to carry out activities described in this section in an annual appropriations Act of Congress.

(g) SUBMISSION OF SPECIES LISTS TO CONGRESS.—

(1) PRIORITY LIST OF SPECIES.—Not later than 90 days after the date of enactment of this Act, the Secretary, shall submit to the Committees on Environment and Public Works and Appropriations of the Senate and the Committees on Natural Resources and Appropriations of the House of Representatives a list of threatened species and endangered species for which recovery plans described in subsection (e)(1) will be developed or implemented for fiscal year 2023.

(2) ANNUAL LIST OF SPECIES.—Until the date on which all of the amounts in the Fund are expended, the President shall annually submit to Congress, together with the annual budget of the United States, a list of threatened species and endangered species for which recovery plans described in subsection (e)(1) will be developed or implemented with amounts from the Fund.

(h) PUBLIC DONATIONS.—

(1) IN GENERAL.—The Secretary may accept public cash donations that advance efforts—

(A) to address the backlog in the development and implementation of recovery plans; and

(B) to encourage relevant public-private partnerships.

(2) CREDITS TO FUND.—Any cash donations accepted under paragraph (1) shall be credited to, and form a part of, the Fund.

(3) REJECTION OF DONATIONS.—The Secretary may reject a donation under this section when the rejection is in the interest of the Federal Government, as determined by the Secretary.

(i) ALLOCATION AUTHORITY.—

(1) SUBMISSION OF COST ESTIMATES.—The President shall submit to Congress detailed allocations by program element of the amount recommended for allocation in a fiscal year from amounts made available under subsection (c), consistent with the use of funds under subsection (e), as follows:

(A) For fiscal year 2023, not later than 90 days after the date of enactment of this Act.

(B) For each fiscal year thereafter, until the date on which all of the amounts in the Fund are allocated, as part of the annual budget submission of the President under section 1105(a) of title 31, United States Code.

(2) ALTERNATE ALLOCATION.—

(A) IN GENERAL.—The Committees on Appropriations of the Senate and House of Representatives may provide for alternate allocation of amounts recommended for allocation in a given fiscal year from amounts made available under subsection (c), consistent with the use of funds under subsection (e), including allocations by program element.

(B) ALLOCATION BY PRESIDENT.—

(i) NO ALTERNATE ALLOCATIONS.—If Congress has not enacted legislation establishing alternate allocations, including by program, by the date on which the Act making full-year appropriations for the Department of the Interior, Environment, and Related Agencies for the applicable fiscal year is enacted into law, only then shall amounts recommended for allocation for that fiscal year from amounts made available under subsection (c), consistent with the use of funds under subsection (e), be allocated by the President or apportioned or allotted by program pursuant to title 31, United States Code.

(ii) INSUFFICIENT ALTERNATE ALLOCATION.—If Congress enacts legislation establishing alternate allocations, including by program, for amounts recommended for allocation in a given fiscal year from amounts made available under subsection (c), consistent with the use of funds under subsection (e), that are less than the full amount recommended for allocation for that fiscal year, the difference between the amount recommended for allocation and the alternate allocation shall be allocated by the President and apportioned and allotted by program pursuant to title 31, United States Code.

(j) PROHIBITIONS.—No amounts from the Fund shall be used—

(1) to make any listing determination relating to the endangered or threatened status of any species pursuant to section 4(a) of the Endangered Species Act of 1973 (16 U.S.C. 1533(a));

(2) on any experimental population (as defined in paragraph (1) of section 10(j) of the Endangered Species Act of 1973 (16 U.S.C. 1539(j))) of a threatened or endangered species that is determined to be nonessential under that section;

(3) outside of the United States (as defined in section 3 of the Endangered Species Act of 1973 (16 U.S.C. 1532)); and

(4) to acquire any Federal land.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The bill, as amended, is debatable for 1 hour equally divided and controlled by the chair and ranking minority member of the Committee on Natural Resources or their respective designees.

The gentlewoman from Michigan (Mrs. DINGELL) and the gentleman from Arkansas (Mr. WESTERMAN), each will control 30 minutes.

The Chair recognizes the gentlewoman from Michigan (Mrs. DINGELL).

GENERAL LEAVE

Mrs. DINGELL. Mr. Speaker, I ask unanimous consent that all Members may have 5 legislative days in which to revise and extend their remarks and include extraneous material on H.R. 2773.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Is there objection to the request of the gentlewoman from Michigan?

There was no objection.

Mrs. DINGELL. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

Mr. Speaker, I rise today in strong support of H.R. 2773, the Recovering America's Wildlife Act. This legislation has been years in the making, and this moment is the culmination of the collected works of a bipartisan group of Members, a strong, diverse coalition of advocates, and grassroots support from across the country.

This work began in 2015 when the Association of Fish and Wildlife Agencies—which represents State fish and wildlife agencies across the country—established a blue ribbon panel on sustaining America's diverse fish and wildlife resources.

After working closely with hunting and fishing organizations, as well as partners in the sportsmen's community, businesses, and other advocates, it was decided that we needed a 21st century model of funding conservation to address the current shortfalls in wildlife conservation.

Right now, the United States is facing an unprecedented biodiversity crisis. One-third of all bird species are in need of urgent conservation action. In fact, the number of birds in the United States and Canada have fallen by 29 percent since 1970; a decline of almost 3 billion fewer birds.

We have seen similar declines across the board. For example, 40 percent of freshwater fish species are also at risk. One-third of all U.S. wildlife species are currently imperiled or vulnerable.

These developments threaten our common environmental heritage, reduce opportunities for outdoor recreation, and will require costly and aggressive interventions if not addressed soon.

This legislation is particularly critical for the sportsmen's community. As one of the co-chairs of the Congressional Sportsmen's Caucus, I have always said that sportsmen and women are some of our best conservation advocates, as they understand the on-the-ground reality of the decline in wildlife and the importance of cost-effective conservation.

Their input has been critical to the historic and innovative legislation before us today. Without a change in the way we finance fish and wildlife conservation, the list of Federally threatened and endangered species will balloon from nearly 1,600 species today to thousands more in the future.

□ 1500

The cost of inaction is immense. The longer we wait to address this issue, the more resources we will ultimately need to safeguard our Nation's wildlife and environment. And we cannot keep waiting. We must take the bold, urgent action that addresses the scale of the threat. We need strong, proactive conservation measures to address these

unmet needs, and that is why the Recovering America's Wildlife Act is necessary.

The legislation provides approximately $1.4 billion in dedicated, annual funding to the States, territories, and Native American Tribes for proactive conservation efforts for the approximately 12,000 species of wildlife and plants identified under State wildlife action plans.

This bold investment in our Nation's wildlife will pay significant dividends. It will allow States to take proactive action that will prevent at-risk species from becoming endangered. This is critical not only to preserving our common environmental heritage, but for supporting hunters, anglers, and the almost $900 billion outdoor recreation economy.

As I have said previously, as one of the co-chairs of the Congressional Sportsmen's Caucus, I understand the importance of these measures to support fishermen and hunters across the country.

I thank my three fellow co-chairs of the Congressional Sportsmen's Caucus who have sponsored the Recovering America's Wildlife Act as well. It shows the strong, bipartisan support for this bill.

The broad group of stakeholders supporting the Recovering America's Wildlife Act underscores the need for action and the support for this approach. Hundreds of leading sportsmen's groups, hunting and fishing advocates across the country, conservation organizations, environmental organizations, and businesses, all support the legislation for good reason: it utilizes proven funding mechanisms, boldly addresses pressing conservation needs, and prevents the need for more costly interventions in the future.

The Recovering America's Wildlife Act is the product of years and years of work and consultation with these stakeholders and has broad bipartisan support. This legislation has received bipartisan support in both the House and Senate, and the thoughtful input of my colleagues has resulted in strong consensus legislation that will benefit every single congressional district in the country.

We have a conservation, economic, and moral rationale to act in order to protect and recover America's wildlife for future generations. This is an opportunity to take historic action to address a pressing conservation need, and I ask my colleagues that they support the Recovering America's Wildlife Act.

Mr. Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. WESTERMAN. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

Mr. Speaker, I rise today in reluctant opposition to H.R. 2773, as drafted. The goal of this bill is commendable. Republicans and Democrats alike want to see America's wildlife thrive. Unfortunately, the legislation as written contains partisan provisions that I simply cannot support.

State and Tribal fish and wildlife agencies have long been recognized as the primary and most well-equipped managers of local species and habitat in the United States. After all, those on the ground are more attuned to what is happening in their backyards than the Federal Government. That is why State and Tribal wildlife agencies, as well as prominent sportsmen's groups support this bill.

While the bill would provide financial resources to States and Tribes to help meet wildlife recovery goals, the spending is mandatory and lacks any offset. This spending is not pocket change. The Congressional Budget Office estimated the Rules Committee Print would lead to more than $12 billion—that is $12 billion—in direct spending in the first decade of the program alone. And I say the first decade, because that is only what is in the so-called scoring window. In reality, this program and its mandatory spending would last forever since there is no sunset in titles I and II of the bill.

Mr. Speaker, this is not the modern-day funding models suggested by the blue ribbon commission. This is an important issue, and we should make the responsible, tough decisions on how to fund it.

This funding model has no offset ever, and it has an average expenditure of $1.4 billion per year. It is the most irresponsible, lazy way to fund the program, especially with the record government spending that is contributing to record inflation. At a time of rampant inflation, it would be wildly irresponsible to drive inflation even higher and saddle future generations with the consequences. The debt created by this bill will only add to our Nation's current $30 trillion debt.

This bill also lacks a sunset provision. Without a sunset, there is no mechanism to ensure oversight or proper review of the program to fix flaws that may arise. Mandating a permanent new program is poor governance, and it ignores precedent. Congress routinely passes legislation like the Farm Bill or the Water Resources Development Act which have proper sunsets. Those sunsets require us to come back and do our jobs by assessing what is working, what is not working, and making tweaks and changes to the law.

The bill does not allow Congress the opportunity to perform the needed oversight. Instead, it requires spending $1.4 billion per year in perpetuity. I, and my fellow Republican committee members, tried to resolve these fiscal issues with amendments at the committee markup. We were told by the Democrat majority that, although they opposed these amendments at the time, they would work with us on finding a funding offset before this bill would be considered on the floor.

We stayed at the negotiating table, as did the bill's sponsor, Mrs. DINGELL, whom I have a lot of respect for and commend her for her efforts on this bill. But larger forces decided to ram this bill forward without fixing anything. In fact, the majority made the bill worse than it was when it left our committee.

They decided to airdrop provisions into a new title III that would siphon money away from States and Tribes and give it to the U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service. That is in direct contrast to the spirit of this bill to give money to the State and Tribal agencies so that they could do the management.

We never even had the chance to debate this terrible title in the committee. The whole point of this bill was to empower States and Tribes who are the ones, again, who are closest to our lands and waters, not to increase the Washington, D.C., Federal bureaucracy, which is now what this bill will do.

A number of Republican amendments proposed to the Rules Committee tried to fix these problems and several other issues but they were similarly ignored, depriving us of ways to improve the bill and debate these issues today. As a result of all of this, we have a regrettably flawed bill. The situation we are now in was avoidable. The bill before us represents a lost opportunity to forge significant bipartisan compromise. It didn't have to be this way, and I hope that this is not a partisan sign of the future of conservation.

I will remain at the table and hope that my Democratic colleagues come back and work together with us on a lasting solution. Until then, I am opposed to H.R. 2773, and I reluctantly encourage my colleagues to vote ''no'' on the resolution.

Mr. Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

Mrs. DINGELL. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

Mr. Speaker, I appreciate my colleague's perspective on permanent funding, and I have a great deal of respect for him. We have and will always continue to work together on conservation issues. But the fact is we know that stable and predictable funding is critical to effective conservation efforts, and that is what the blue ribbon panel on sustaining America's diverse fish and wildlife resources—which included 26 members from the hunting and fishing business and outdoor recreation communities—found in their 2016 report whose recommendations formed the basis of this legislation. We have seen that this funding structure has been fundamental to the success of Pittman-Robertson and Dingell-Johnson conservation programs upon which this is built.

I appreciate my colleague's views on oversight. This legislation contains robust guardrails to ensure that there is appropriate use of public funds, including reporting requirements and other oversight provisions.

So the Recovering America's Wildlife Act does meet the moment because of its funding structure and because of the strong oversight language which is

supported by the coalitions of hundreds of organizations.

Mr. Speaker, I yield 3 minutes to the gentleman from California (Mr. HUFFMAN).

Mr. HUFFMAN. Mr. Speaker, I thank Representative DINGELL for the time and for her great work on this landmark bipartisan legislation, the Recovering America's Wildlife Act, or RAWA, as we call it.

This is a bright spot amidst so many problems facing our Nation. As our constituents are well aware, the climate crisis and other human impacts have dramatically harmed our Nation's wildlife, and, in fact, State agencies have identified 12,000 wildlife species that are in need of conservation assistance. In the United States alone, there are currently 1,300 species that are either threatened or endangered. If we fail to act, these profound and irreversible losses will continue to have devastating ecosystem impacts.

States, territories, and Tribes are doing great work to address threats to wildlife, but their conservation efforts have been chronically underfunded for decades. This stream of dedicated funding from RAWA is a lifeline for local wildlife agencies.

This bill also provides local governments the resources to address key elements impacting biodiversity loss such as wildfire and drought which are worsening as the climate crisis accelerates. RAWA lays the groundwork for wildfire threat mitigation on a number of fronts, including managing vegetation and creating wildlife-friendly fire management plans on the front end, performing emergency rescues during the fires, and restoring critical habitat after fires.

RAWA funding will also allow local communities to restore habitats that have been harmed by drought and protect vulnerable ecosystems from further damage because we know these drought conditions are going to continue.

We cannot lose sight of the cultural implications of this legislation. The funding in this bill for Tribal nations to recover fish and wildlife is critical to protecting the species that have been integral to their cultures since time immemorial. Biodiversity is declining at a rate not seen since the last mass extinction. Tackling this crisis simply cannot wait.

As chairman of the Water, Oceans, and Wildlife Subcommittee of the House Natural Resources Committee, I am incredibly glad to see this bill on the floor today with strong bipartisan support—42 Republican cosponsors, and 152 Democrats.

Madam Speaker, I urge all of my colleagues to vote ''yes.''

Mr. WESTERMAN. Mr. Speaker, I will point out that even though there is a reporting requirement in the legislation, once you approve mandatory, permanent spending, then Congress loses our leverage. Creating a permanent program doesn't bode well for oversight from Congress. Programs that were mentioned like Pittman-Robinson, think about the land and water conservation fund, all of those had dedicated funding streams. This funding is coming straight out of the Treasury. It is coming out of our kids' and our grandkids' piggy banks.

Mr. Speaker, I yield 3 minutes to the gentleman from Oregon (Mr. BENTZ).

Mr. BENTZ. Mr. Speaker, I include in the RECORD an article from Claremont Review of Books, spring, 2022, titled ''In the Red,'' by Jeffrey H. Anderson.

IN THE RED

Our glidepath to insolvency.

When Ross Perot won an impressive 19 percent of the popular vote as an independent candidate for president in 1992, his main issue was the national debt. In one of his unusual, half-hour-long campaign ads, Perot declared, ''Just this year, we ran up $341 billion in new debt . . . . That's *our* legislators and *our* president trying to buy *our* vote, *this* year, with what used to be *our* money.''

Three decades later, our national debt—which reached $4 trillion the year that Perot ran—has hit $30 trillion. If our debt were to keep rising at that rate over the next 60 years, it would increase more than 50-fold and surpass $1.5 quadrillion (a quadrillion, which sounds like a made-up number, is a thousand trillions).

The portion of the national debt that really matters is the almost 80 percent that's held by entities—whether foreign or stateside—other than the federal government. Such ''debt held by the public,'' which is fueled by deficit spending, has to be paid back to outside entities, whereas debt *not* held by the public merely involves intragovernmental transfers. Foreign holdings compose about a third of all debt held by the public. Japan and China hold by far the most (over $1 trillion each), some of which belongs to private investors and some to government entities. Put another way, China—an increasingly hostile world superpower—has more than $1 trillion of leverage over us.

It's getting worse, fast. Our recent deficit spending has been truly historic. In 2020, based on official federal tallies (the basis for all figures in this essay), the federal government brought in $3.4 trillion in tax revenues and dished our $6.6 trillion in spending—so, for every $10 that came in, $19 went out. This lavish expenditure smashed the deficit record like New York's Bob Beamon smashed the long-jump record in the 1968 Olympics. Beamon soared past the previous record—27 feet, 4¾ inches—to make an astounding 29-foot, 2½-inch jump. In similar fashion, with the deficit record sitting at $1.4 trillion, the federal government in 2020 spent a spectacular $3.1 trillion that it didn't have. In 2020 alone, the government racked up more deficit spending than it had during the first 36 fiscal years of the postwar era (1947 through 1982), and that's after adjusting for inflation.

Even before our blowout spending during COVID, our deficits had already reached breathtaking levels. In constant 2012 dollars (to adjust for inflation), the average annual deficit during the four years from 2016 through 2019—a stretch of relative peace and prosperity—was $700 billion. In comparison, during the four years from 1942 through 1945—during which we funded and fought a two-front war against Nazi Germany and Imperial Japan—the average annual deficit was $505 billion in constant 2012 dollars. After the war (using the Office of Management and Budget's composite deflator), we owed $3 trillion of debt held by the public in constant 2012 dollars (four times what we owed when the war began). Subsequent statesmen succeeded in cutting that tally in half by 1974 (to $1.5 trillion), but it rose back to end-of-World-War-II levels by 1986 (to $3 trillion), doubled end-of-World-War-II levels by 2008 ($6 trillion), tripled them by 2010 ($9 trillion), quadrupled them by 2014 ($12 trillion), quintupled them by 2019 ($15 trillion), and sextupled them by 2020 ($18 trillion).

In other words, we added as much debt held by the public in 2020 alone as we did from the end of World War II to the end of 2008, and we racked up more debt in the 12 months of 2020 than we did during the four years of the Second World War. That's after adjusting for inflation.

NO BIG DEAL

And yet, incredibly, many politicians and commentators claim that our staggering indebtedness is nothing much to worry about. Unwilling to face the challenge of reining in the budget, we seem to have thrown up our hands in recent years and chosen to treat our ballooning deficits as funny money.

Debt apologists like to measure taxes, spending, and debt in relation to the gross domestic product (GDP), rather than in relation to inflation or population growth. That way, if Americans' tax bills double, but the economy doubles in size over that same span, it can be said that Americans aren't paying any more in taxes (as a percentage of GDP). The same thing is true with the debt, which only rises by this measure if it increases faster than economic output.

This way of talking partially masks the magnitude of our debt problem by assuming that our government should grow every bit as fast as our economy. Even so, by the percent-of-GDP measure, debt held by the public is now at approximately end-of-World War II levels. But whereas it fell dramatically after World War II, there is no reason to think it will do so now. It more than tripled from 2001 (32 percent of GDP) to 2020 (100 percent of GDP), putting us on course to surpass 300 percent of GDP if it grows at the same rate from 2020 to 2039.

For all of the myriad cultural, technological, and moral problems we face, few things would guarantee the undoing of the founders' experiment in self-government more surely than continuing to pile on the burden, to ourselves and our posterity, of runaway debt. Thomas Jefferson described fiscal profligacy as a precursor to inevitable misery and suffering, the first in a stampede of apocalyptic horsemen. ''[T]he fore horse of this frightful team is public debt,'' he wrote. ''Taxation follows that, and in its train wretchedness and oppression.'' This wretchedness will only be more keenly felt as interest rates rise. Too much debt puts power in the hands of our enemies and renders the average American poorer every year.

MANDATORY BANKRUPTCY

The first step in avoiding a truly calamitous, debt-ridden future is to understand bow we got ourselves into this predicament to begin with. It is not national defense or even the New Deal but rather the Great Society that is bankrupting us.

A fundamental preliminary question is whether our government taxes too little or spends too much. The answer is easy to determine. In 2021, the federal government collected more than three-and-a-half times as much money, in real dollars per capita—that is, above and beyond inflation and population growth—as it did at the start of the postwar period. But it spent nearly seven times as much. From 1947 (the first postwar fiscal year, as FY 1946 began in July of 1945) through 2021, the population of the United States rose 2.3-fold, while prices rose nearly 13-fold. Combining these two factors, the federal government could have collected and

spent 29 times as much in nominal dollars in 2021 as it did in 1947 without collecting or spending any more in real (inflation-adjusted) dollars per capita. Instead, the federal government taxed more than 100 times as much in 2021 as in 1947 and spent almost 200 times as much. By any reasonable standard, our government isn't afflicted by a shortage of tax revenues but by an almost endless appetite for spending.

What are we spending all of that money on? *Contra* the Left's repeated claims, it isn't defense—and our debt problem wasn't created by Ronald Reagan. We actually spend less per capita on defense now, after adjusting for inflation, than we did during the Kennedy Administration. Real per-capita defense spending fell from $2,283 in 1962 to $1,953 in 2020, a drop of 14 percent. Even at the height of the Reagan defense buildup, we exceeded the 1962 level by only 2 percent. Meanwhile, real per-capita spending on everything but defense increased more than eight-fold (from $1,930 in 1962 to $15,646 in 2020). If overall federal spending had followed the same trajectory as defense spending, we would have had a surplus in 2020 of $2.1 trillion instead of a deficit of $3.1 trillion.

The problem isn't defense: it's health care. More specifically, it was Lyndon Johnson and his (mostly) Democratic congressional allies who put us on a glidepath toward insolvency with the passage of their Great Society programs. The New Deal put strain on the federal budget, to be sure, but not enough to break it. By 1964, over three decades after Franklin Roosevelt had taken office, federal debt held by the public had fallen more than 40 percent from the end of World War II, in real (inflation-adjusted) dollars. The real deficit was 1/68th as large as it would be in 2020. As the first Ford Mustangs rolled off the assembly line, the country's debt was manageable and dropping, its deficits were minimal, and seven of the postwar years had actually produced surpluses. The next year, Johnson signed legislation creating Medicare and Medicaid.

Broadly speaking, there are two ways to fund federal programs. Congress either decides how much funding a program will get (''discretionary'' spending), or just puts a program on autopilot and finds out later how much it turned out to cost (''mandatory'' spending). With discretionary spending, Congress decides each year how much money to appropriate (for something like national defense), taking into account such quaint notions as what we need and what we can afford. With ''mandatory'' spending, Congress creates a program and pledges to fund it at the same time, even though no one knows what its price tag will be.

Within ''mandatory'' spending, there are programs that have a dedicated and generally sufficient revenue stream (such as Social Security), and there are those that do *not* have a dedicated revenue stream that comes anywhere near covering their costs—such as Medicare and Medicaid (and Obamacare, part of which expanded Medicaid). Payroll taxes cover only about a third of Medicare's costs and none of Medicaid's. In other words, no one who launched these programs had any idea how to pay for them.

This has had extraordinary consequences. The first year that Medicare spending visibly hit the books was 1967. From that point through 2020, Medicare and Medicaid cost a combined $17.8 trillion, while our combined federal deficits over that same span were $17.9 trillion. In essence, our deficit problem is a Medicare and Medicaid problem.

THE FATHER OF OUR DEBT

By 1975, a decade after they were created, Medicare and Medicaid were entrenched. From that point through 2019—the most recent ''normal'' (pre-COVID) spending year—real per-capita Medicare and Medicaid spending rose nine-fold (more than triple the rise in Social Security costs over that period). In 1975, we spent more than five times as much on defense as on Medicare and Medicaid combined. By 2019, we spent 56 percent more on Medicare and Medicaid than on defense.

In 2019, the federal government collected about $10,500 in revenues per capita and spent about $13,500. Here's how Americans' contributions to the federal treasury were allocated. The first $1,000 essentially just went into the trash—it was used to pay interest on the debt, not to buy anything. About $2,000 was spent on defense and another $2,000 on non-defense discretionary spending. Roughly $3,000 was spent on Social Security, $3,000 on Medicare and Medicaid (with about a 60 percent–40 percent split between them), and $2,500 on other ''mandatory'' spending, to include much of Obamacare, unemployment, welfare, etc. So, in all, about $4,000 (or roughly 30 percent) was discretionary spending, actually voted upon by Congress, and about $9,500 (roughly 70 percent) was either ''mandatory'' spending or payments on the national debt.

If we had a Mount Rushmore of deficit spending, then, Lyndon Johnson would merit George Washington's place of honor as the father of our debt. Beside him would be the three most recent presidents. For we have run up more debt under Barack Obama, Donald Trump, and Joe Biden—even after adjusting for inflation—than we did under the previous 42 presidents combined. After a brief period of fiscal responsibility under Bill Clinton, the average annual deficit soared to $455 billion under George W. Bush ($41 billion more than under his father), $857 billion under Obama, and $1.462 trillion under Trump (who was averaging $805 billion even before COVID hit).

Again—amazingly—these figures are adjusted for inflation. They are based on each president's having been responsible for the deficit the year after he took office—for example, Obama, who took office when fiscal year 2009 was already underway, was responsible for fiscal years 2010 through 2017. But note the following exceptions: the $179 billion in Obama-signed ''stimulus'' funds spent in 2009, and the $1.115 trillion in Biden-signed COVID ''stimulus'' funds spent in 2021 are treated as part of Obama's and Biden's deficit tallies, respectively; and the $147 billion in TARP loans repaid in 2010 ($110 billion) and 2011 ($37 billion) are counted as reductions in George W. Bush's deficit tallies, as they paid back money that was counted as deficit spending when it was loaned out on Bush's watch.

Clinton is the obvious outlier, having managed an average annual surplus of $3 billion during his eight years in office, six of them with a Republican Congress. After Perot sounded the alarm and Republicans won the House for the first time in four decades, Speaker Newt Gingrich and his Republican colleagues—working with Clinton—made good on the Contract with America's pledge to balance the budget. They cut defense spending, passed welfare reform, benefitted from a strong economy that increased revenues, and were able to lower federal interest payments as the debt fell. Most surprisingly, however, they managed to cut Medicare spending, via reforms passed through the Balanced Budget Act of 1997 (BBA). After Medicare's costs had quadrupled from 1982 to 1997, they actually dropped from 1998 to 1999—not just in comparison to inflation, but in terms of the actual number of dollars that went out the door.

It was around this time that the ''experts'' decided the work was done and the free-spending days could return once again. In 2002, after the George W. Bush tax cues had been enacted, the Congressional Budget Office (CBO) projected that the federal government would run a surplus in nine out of the ten years from 2003 through 2012 and a decade-long surplus of $2.3 trillion. It turned out that the federal government ran a deficit in all ten of those years and a decade-long deficit of $7.1 trillion. The CBO also projected that debt held by the public at the end of 2012 would be $1.3 trillion. It turned out to be $11.3 trillion, so the CBO was off by $10 trillion and a factor of nearly nine.

Despite this subsequent debt explosion, the Clinton-Gingrich era was a successful one in terms of fiscal responsibility. Indeed, over the past 40 years, deficits have been lowest when a Democrat has been in the White House and Republicans have controlled both houses of Congress. The second-best scenario has been a Republican president with either party controlling both houses of Congress. Next-best has been a Democratic president paired with a mixed Congress (with each party controlling one house), followed by a Republican president paired with a mixed Congress. The worst scenario has been Democratic control of the whole government. Over the past four decades, Democratic control (average deficit of $1.1 trillion in constant 2012 dollars) has been more than twice as costly as Republican control ($490 billion).

No matter who is in power, however, about 70 percent of our spending—consuming about 90 percent of our tax revenues—is on autopilot. To balance the budget by focusing solely on cutting those portions of the budget that Congress actively controls through the appropriations process, we would have to cut discretionary spending—which includes defense—by about 75 percent. Any realistic effort to balance the budget, therefore, must focus on ''mandatory'' spending.

FIXING OUR MESS

Medicare absolutely must be reformed. Its autopilot has malfunctioned and is flying not only the plane but also the country into the ground. We came tantalizingly close to fixing things back in 1999, when the National Bipartisan Commission on the Future of Medicare grew out of the BBA and drafted an appealing blueprint for reform. The Commission, chaired by Democratic Senator John Breaux and Republican Congressman Bill Thomas, floated a variety of proposals, most notably ''premium support,'' which would utilize private competition to keep public costs down. But events intervened: Politico healthcare editor Adriel Bettelheim writes that ''with the Monica Lewinsky scandal festering and the threat . . . of impeachment growing, [Clinton] took a very public turn to appease his left flank'' and turned against the commission just as it was wrapping up its 11 months of work.

Nevertheless, the commission was a serious effort at exploring promising ideas, many of which Congressman Paul Ryan picked up during his Obamacare-fighting era. Ryan's advocacy of premium support did not keep him from being tapped as Mitt Romney's 2012 running mate, nor did it hurt the Romney-Ryan ticket (Romney did that all on his own). This suggests that Medicare reform can be politically viable when advanced with determination and skill.

Medicaid also cannot go on in its present form. Its funding system, whereby every $1 of state funding is matched by between $1 and $9 of federal funding, invites waste and inefficiency. The more a state spends on Medicaid, the more federal money it gets. If it manages to reform its Medicaid program, it gets at most half of the savings—usually far less. Also, states often hire consultants who concoct elaborate shell games to exaggerate states' Medicaid funding, thereby

bringing in even more federal money, much of which funds non-Medicaid ventures. If Medicaid were reformed so that each stare simply received a given amount of federal funding, independent of the state's level of funding, that would presumably remove most of these perverse incentives and reduce Medicaid's costs.

Social Security has always been self-funded, but it too is projected to dip into the red about a dozen years from now. It poses nowhere near the threat to our fiscal solvency that Medicare and Medicaid do, bur its costs have still risen faster than overall federal spending, and it does need to be sensibly revised. The percentage of the U.S. population that is over age 75 is roughly the same as the percentage that was over age 65 when Social Security was created, yet the eligibility age for receiving full retirement benefits has been raised just two years (from 65 to 67) over the past eight decades. Gradually (but not too gradually) raising that age to reflect current biological and fiscal realities is an obvious and necessary fix.

In addition to changing individual programs, there are measures we can take to promote fiscal responsibility more generally. Simply demanding a balanced budget, either as a matter of policy or through a constitutional amendment, will not do: the state could still spend as much as it accrued, which might encourage ever-greater levels of taxation to fund an ever-larger government, as in many European countries. Instead, we ought to focus on measures that can keep spending itself low.

For instance, the American citizenry would be more apt to view the debt as a shared concern if nearly everyone paid at least some income tax, as Florida Senator Rick Scott has proposed. At the least, no one's income tax bill should go negative, as it does when tax credits are made ''refundable''—available not as a tax cut but as a payment to those who don't pay income tax. A few years ago, I released ''The Main Street Tax Plan'' (Hudson Institute, 2016), which the Tax Foundation said would reduce deficits. It declared, ''Nearly everyone should be paying something in income tax, however small, and Americans shouldn't regard April 15 as a payday.''

Some, such as Senator Mitch McConnell, oppose Scott's proposal because—in McConnell's words—it ''raises taxes'' (for people who don't pay income taxes). Those who share this concern should consider pairing refund reform with an end to the Medicare payroll tax. Unlike the Social Security payroll tax, which is viral and funds Social Security as a (more or less) pay-in-for-yourself program, the Medicare payroll tax funds only about a third of Medicare and helps perpetuate the false notion that Medicare too is mostly pay-in-for-yourself. Eliminating the Medicare payroll tax would soften the perception of Medicare as an entitlement, simplify the tax code, and ease the tax burden of the working poor. Combining this with Scott's plan would encourage more people to care about the size and scope of the federal government.

In 2010, back when the Tea Party was ascendant and the national debt was $13 trillion rather than $30 trillion, I proposed (in National Affairs) a Limited Government Amendment to the Constitution. Such an amendment would limit annual increases in federal spending to inflation plus two percentage points, except during a formally declared war, or if two-thirds of Congress and three-quarters of state legislatures authorized additional spending for other reasons. An amendment in this spirit could greatly facilitate fiscal restraint.

It has become fashionable to think of constitutional amendments as relics from the past. But then, so are fiscal responsibility and—increasingly—representative government. The founders made the Constitution amendable for a reason, and we should take our cues from them. In the late 1990s, we showed—briefly—that it's possible to take action to reverse our course and help save our country from the tragic fate that Jefferson described. But the first step is to recognize that the $30 trillion elephant in the room isn't going away. It's just growing bigger.

Mr. BENTZ. Mr. Speaker, I rise in opposition, sadly, to H.R. 2773. Although protecting our endangered species is truly a worthy cause, our country is not fiscally sound, and to commit $1.4 billion a year in perpetuity is exactly the kind of spending that has landed us in the mess we are now in.

Let me be clear: we do not have the money. In the 30 years since 1992, the national debt has increased from $4 trillion to $30 trillion. Mr. Anderson notes in his article that:

> At that rate over the next 60 years, our debt would increase by more than 50-fold to surpass $1.5 quadrillion. In case one is wondering, a quadrillion is 1,000 trillions.

Mr. Speaker, some might say: Just raise taxes. But, Mr. Speaker, the author of the article points out that, in fact, the Federal Government last year taxed over 100 times what it did in the first postwar year and spent nearly 200 times as much. So taxes are not the problem. Spending is the problem.

The $1.4 billion per year is perpetual. Now, under anyone's measure, perpetuity is a long time. Since this money will never be paid back, some might say like those deep in credit card debt: We will just pay the interest.

The interest on $1.5 billion for 30 years at current rates of 3.4 percent is $51 million a year. But, Mr. Speaker, we have to look at the current total interest bill. It is estimated to be almost $400 billion a year or about 8.7 percent of everything we spend.

Why would we add to this enormous obligation?

There is a quote by Ernest Hemingway: How did you go bankrupt?

The answer is: Gradually, then suddenly.

Mr. Speaker, this is exactly how bankruptcy works. You can keep spending recklessly and rack up debts for a while—even a long while—but at some point, it comes to an end abruptly. We have ignored our Nation's spending problems for far too long. We have been going bankrupt gradually, and I fear the day will come when we will go bankrupt immediately.

We must correct this course. For this reason, I cannot support, sadly, this bill.

□ 1515

Mrs. DINGELL. Mr. Speaker, I would like to note that hunting and angling collectively support over $200 billion in economic activity annually, including over 1.5 million jobs as well as almost $15 billion in Federal tax revenue.

My home State of Michigan, the Great Lakes State, is home to almost 650,000 licensed hunters and over 1.1 million licensed fishermen and -women as of last year. However, with over 40 percent of freshwater fish at risk, and significant declines in game and nongame species that support local ecosystems, we need RAWA's investments in on-the-ground conservation to support hunting and fishing for future generations, which is why the major sportsmen's groups, like the Congressional Sportsmen's Foundation and Ducks Unlimited, have endorsed this legislation.

Mr. Speaker, I yield 3 minutes to the gentleman from California (Mr. PANETTA).

Mr. PANETTA. Mr. Speaker, I rise in support of Recovering America's Wildlife Act.

This is a proactive piece of bipartisan legislation that would help our State and Tribal fish and wildlife agencies with the recovery and conservation of close to 12,000 species of fish, wildlife, and plants.

Now, I support this bill not only as the United States Representative for the central coast of California, a district that values and cherishes our wildlife, but also as the vice chair of the Congressional Sportsmen's Caucus.

As some of the most passionate wildlife conservationists across our country, many sportsmen and -women, including those in the Congressional Sportsmen's Foundation, no matter what their political persuasion, support this critical piece of legislation.

In addition to enhancing the Pittman-Robertson and Dingell-Johnson Acts, sportsmen and -women want to ensure that our species are protected and perpetuated. From bighorn sheep to the Sierra Nevada red fox, from the California condors to the coho salmon, and from moose to monarch butterflies, the intent of this legislation is to protect those and thousands of other iconic animals well before they need to be listed as endangered or threatened.

This way, rather than impose burdensome and costly regulations on fish and wildlife managers, sportsmen and -women, and private businesses, those species can be recovered and renewed well before any measures are mandated.

Look, it is estimated that it costs the Federal Government more than $19 million, on average, to recover a single species once it is listed, including $1 million to just list the species and $18 million for the science and habitat work. Let's simply take 2,000 of the 12,000 species this bill would help conserve, and it would cost the Federal Government at least $38 billion. This bill is a preventative measure to ensure that does not happen.

Through this legislation, we would not only save billions of dollars by not having to list species, but we would save thousands of plants and animals by ensuring that they are protected.

By providing millions of dollars in funding for the on-the-ground efforts,

we could recover, reintroduce, and restore wildlife, fish, flora, and fauna throughout our Nation.

As many species face the growing threat of becoming extinct at accelerated rates, due to changing global weather events and our climate crisis, this legislation and its proposed funding would protect those species well before they become endangered.

That is why sportsmen, community members, and my country members support this bill, and that is why I urge my colleagues to do the same by voting for and passing the Recovering America's Wildlife Act.

Mr. WESTERMAN. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

I know that we all like the idea of dynamic scoring, and I spend a lot of money on hunting and fishing myself, as do a lot of other Members of Congress. But CBO, unfortunately, does not take that into account.

I know we all think that this bill could help not have listings of endangered species. But case studies clearly show that Federal money alone will not keep species off the endangered species list.

Mr. Speaker, I include in the record the CBO score from the Senate version of the language that is in this bill.

U.S. CONGRESS,
CONGRESSIONAL BUDGET OFFICE,
Washington, DC, May 26, 2022.

Hon. THOMAS CARPER,
Chairman, Committee on Environment and Public Works, U.S. Senate, Washington, DC.

DEAR MR. CHAIRMAN: The Congressional Budget Office has prepared the enclosed cost estimate for S. 2372, the Recovering America's Wildlife Act of 2022.

If you wish further details on this estimate, we will be pleased to provide them. The CBO staff contact is Madeleine Fox.

Sincerely,

PHILLIP L. SWAGEL,
Director.

Enclosure.

S. 2372, RECOVERING AMERICA'S WILDLIFE ACT OF 2022—AS REPORTED BY THE SENATE COMMITTEE ON ENVIRONMENT AND PUBLIC WORKS ON APRIL 27, 2022

	By fiscal year, millions of dollars—		
	2022	2022–2027	2022–2032
Direct Spending (Outlays) ..	0	7,049	14,082
Revenues	0	0	0
Increase or Decrease (−) in the Deficit	0	7,049	14,082
Spending Subject to Appropriation (Outlays)	0	1	not estimated

Statutory pay-as-you-go procedures apply? Yes.

Increases on-budget deficits in any of the four consecutive 10-year periods beginning in 2033? $5 billion.

Mandate Effects:

Contains intergovernmental mandate? No.

Contains private-sector mandate? No.

The bill would:

Make funds available to the Department of the Interior for grants and other support for wildlife conservation by states, territories, and Indian tribes.

Allow the department to spend interest accrued on certain unspent balances for wildlife conservation.

Estimated budgetary effects would mainly stem from:

Spending without further appropriation on authorized activities.

Spending of interest credited from amounts invested in Treasury securities.

Bill summary: S. 2372 would amend the Pittman-Robertson Wildlife Restoration Act and appropriate funds for the Department of the Interior to support efforts by state, local, and tribal governments to conserve endangered and threatened species. The bill also would allow interest accrued on unspent balances in one account to be available without further appropriation for those activities.

The bill would require the President to provide the Congress each year with a list of threatened or endangered species and to estimate the amount of funding allocated for their conservation. S. 2372 also would direct the Government Accountability Office to study the progress of states, territories, the District of Columbia, and Indian tribes in protecting endangered and threatened species and to report its findings seven years after enactment.

Estimated Federal cost: The estimated budgetary effect of S. 2372 is shown in Table 1. The costs of the legislation fall within budget function 300 (natural resources and environment).

Basis of estimate: For this estimate, CBO assumes that S. 2372 will be enacted near the end of fiscal year 2022. On that basis, CBO expects that outlays from funds provided in 2022 would occur in 2023. Using information from the affected agencies and historical spending patterns for similar activities, CBO estimates that enacting S. 2372 would increase direct spending by $14.1 billion over the 2022–2032 period.

TABLE 1.—ESTIMATED BUDGETARY EFFECTS OF S. 2372

	By fiscal year, millions of dollars—												
	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030	2031	2032	2022–2027	2022–2032
Increases in Direct Spending													
Title I, U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service:													
Budget Authority	850	1,100	1,200	1,300	1,300	1,300	1,300	1,300	1,300	1,300	1,300	7,050	13,550
Estimated Outlays	0	645	1,218	1,336	1,359	1,293	1,300	1,300	1,300	1,300	1,300	5,851	12,351
Title II, Bureau of Indian Affairs:													
Budget Authority	98	98	98	98	98	98	98	98	98	98	98	585	1,073
Estimated Outlays	0	98	78	94	107	99	98	98	98	98	98	476	963
Title III, U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service:													
Estimated Budget Authority	188	191	192	193	3	1	*	0	0	0	0	767	768
Estimated Outlays	0	191	154	185	120	73	38	8	0	0	0	722	768
Total Changes in Direct Spending:													
Estimated Budget Authority	1,135	1,388	1,489	1,590	1,401	1,399	1,398	1,398	1,398	1,398	1,398	8,402	15,390
Estimated Outlays	0	933	1,450	1,615	1,586	1,465	1,435	1,405	1,398	1,398	1,398	7,049	14,082

Components may not sum to totals because of rounding; * = between zero and $500,000.
S. 2372 would require annual reports whose cost would total $1 million over the 2022–2027 period, subject to the availability of appropriated funds.

Direct spending: S. 2372 would establish new accounts in the Treasury, specify the amounts to be deposited into those accounts each year, and make the funds in those accounts available to the Secretary of the Interior to spend without further appropriation. In 2021, the U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service (USFWS) spent $713 million for similar activities.

Title I would make $850 million available in 2022 for USFWS to make grants to state, local, and tribal governments for wildlife conservation. The amounts made available would increase in 2023 and 2024. In 2025 and every year thereafter, title I would make $1.3 billion available for those purposes. CBO estimates that enacting this title would increase direct spending by $12.4 billion over the 2022–2032 period.

Title II would make $97.5 million available in 2022 and every year thereafter for the Bureau of Indian Affairs to help Indian tribes conserve species on tribal land that have the greatest need for conservation. CBO estimates that enacting this title would increase direct spending by $963 million over the 2022–2032 period.

Title III would make $187.5 million available each year from 2022 through 2025 for USFWS to make grants to states and Indian tribes for the conservation of endangered and threatened species and to carry out other authorities under the Endangered Species Act. A portion of those amounts—$75 million each year—would be made available to the National Fish and Wildlife Foundation to recover threatened or endangered species. CBO estimates that enacting this provision in title III would increase direct spending by $750 million over the 2022–2032 period.

In addition, title III would direct the Department of the Treasury to credit interest on unspent balances made available under that title to USFWS. That interest would be available to spend without further appropriation for recovery efforts under the Endangered Species Act. (Crediting interest to an account in the Treasury is an intragovemmental transfer and thus would have no budgetary effect but allowing the agency to spend the accrued amounts would increase direct spending.) Using the interest rates underlying the May 2022 baseline projections, CBO estimates that under this provision, $18 million would be accrued and spent over the 2022–2032 period.

The bill would permit USFWS to accept and spend donations. CBO estimates that the effect on net direct spending from donations would be negligible over the 2022–2032 period.

The bill would authorize the transfer of some penalties collected under current law to the accounts established under title I and title II, but S. 2372 would not authorize any new penalty collections.

Spending subject to appropriation: S. 2372 would require the President to submit to the Congress lists of threatened or endangered species for which recovery efforts would be funded under the bill and to report annually on the amounts allocated for endangered species recovery, interagency consultation, and conservation activities. Using information about similar activities, CBO estimates that producing the annual reports would cost $1 million over the 2022–2027 period; any spending would be subject to the availability of appropriated funds.

Under the bill, the Government Accountability Office would report in 2029 or 2030 on conservation efforts authorized in the bill. Based on the cost of similar reports, CBO estimates that the cost of that report would be insignificant.

Pay-As-You-Go considerations: The Statutory Pay-As-You-Go Act of 2010 establishes budget-reporting and enforcement procedures for legislation affecting direct spending or revenues. The net changes in outlays that are subject to those pay-as-you-go procedures are shown in Table 2.

TABLE 2.—CBO'S ESTIMATE OF THE STATUTORY PAY-AS-YOU-GO EFFECTS OF S. 2372, THE RECOVERING AMERICA'S WILDLIFE ACT, AS REPORTED BY THE SENATE COMMITTEE ON THE ENVIRONMENT AND PUBLIC WORKS ON APRIL 27, 2022

	By fiscal year, millions of dollars—												
	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030	2031	2032	2022–2027	22022–2032
Net Increase in the Deficit													
Pay-As-You-Go Effect	0	933	1,450	1,615	1,586	1,465	1,435	1,405	1,398	1,398	1,398	7,049	14,082

Increase in long-term deficits: CBO estimates that enacting S. 2372 would increase on-budget deficits by more than $5 billion in all of the four consecutive 10-year periods beginning in 2033.

Mandates: None.

Estimate prepared by: Federal Costs: Madeleine Fox, Mandates: Lilia Ledezma.

Estimate reviewed by: Susan Willie, Chief, Natural and Physical Resources Cost Estimates Unit; H. Samuel Papenfuss, Deputy Director of Budget Analysis; Theresa Gullo, Director of Budget Analysis.

Mr. WESTERMAN. Mr. Speaker, this report does show that it will cost over $12 billion in the first 10 years and $1.4 billion thereafter.

Mr. Speaker, I yield 3 minutes to the gentleman from Minnesota (Mr. STAUBER).

Mr. STAUBER. Mr. Speaker, I rise today opposed to the underlying bill.

Americans are living in paralyzing fear, watching all of their household income get eaten up by the price of gas and household needs and watching their retirement security disappear in our new bear market.

The Biden and House Democrat approach has been to spend their way out of every problem, and look where it has gotten us.

The Recovering America's Wildlife Act is well intended. Of course, we conservationists support investments in our species. But there is still no pay-for. This is $1.4 billion in perpetuity, with no pay-for or offset.

During committee markup, Republicans on the Natural Resources Committee simply asked to offset the spending that continues to punish Americans. But Democrats declined to negotiate in good faith and are choosing to aggravate inflation instead.

However, I offer legislation that will actually help fix the problem. The Endangered Species Act Flexibility Act will give the Interior Secretary options to help endangered species without crippling our economy.

Too often, the ESA is abused. Science is ignored, and the law is used as a weapon to stop much-needed development. Take, for example, the northern long-eared bat. The bat's massive range runs from Maine to Texas to Montana, with everything in between. You can see it on the map right here.

Northern long-eared bats are, sadly, afflicted with white-nose syndrome, a disease caused by a fungus that interrupts hibernation, leading to their death. The science is clear: This disease has nothing to do with human activity.

But because of declining population, the Fish and Wildlife Service is deciding whether to uplist the species, which would severely restrict logging, mining, and infrastructure building, like roads, bridges, ports, and more.

Would you like to spend that infrastructure money on upgrading projects anywhere on this map? Good luck if the northern long-eared bat is listed as endangered.

My ESA Flexibility Act will give the Interior Department the latitude to make species-specific habitat plans for endangered species, so we don't punish Americans who need a transmission line to get reliable power or need a bridge upgrade to drive to work.

I don't think a single Member of Congress here, across both aisles, would disagree that the Endangered Species Act is an imperfect law in desperate need of tweaks.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The time of the gentleman has expired.

Mr. WESTERMAN. Mr. Speaker, I yield an additional 30 seconds to the gentleman.

Mr. STAUBER. Therefore, I regret that my ESA Flexibility Act was not accepted as an amendment, but I look forward to the eventual passage of the ESA Flexibility Act into law.

Mrs. DINGELL. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

Before recognizing my colleague, I would like to talk about these costs and address the fact that dollars invested properly do save dollars.

I note that the droughts in the American West cost $8.6 billion just last year, according to NOAA, and that the impact of wildfire cost over $10 billion last year alone.

Restoration efforts, which this bill would help do, that make habitats and communities more resilient to climate change have an exceptionally high return on investment, such as reducing drought and wildfire risks, increasing job opportunities, and growing local economies.

Conservation and restoration of key habitats help reduce the threats of wildfires and help States conserve water and improve water quality, making their water systems more resilient to the drought.

Finally, full implementation of State and Tribal wildlife plans will help species recover and be removed and even stay off the endangered species list, which is what we want, saving the U.S. taxpayers millions of dollars each year.

The large economic and social benefits of this legislation would boost our economy and help us deliver on our climate commitments for years to come as well.

Mr. Speaker, I yield 3 minutes to my distinguished colleague from Oregon (Mr. BLUMENAUER).

Mr. BLUMENAUER. Mr. Speaker, I appreciate the gentlewoman's courtesy, and I appreciate her leadership on this. And she is right.

Looking at these issues in a comprehensive fashion, we see opportunities to not just save species, but to save money, and to deal with serious consequences that we are seeing.

I am from the Pacific Northwest. We are in the middle of a climate crisis. Last year, we had all-time records 3 days in a row for temperatures. And that same week, in British Columbia, they set an all-time record for Canada. And in the city that they set it, it burned down the next day.

Climate change, loss of habitat, severe weather, including wildfires, and the spread of invasive species, are taking their toll on animals, from fish and amphibians to birds and mammals.

As co-chair of the Animal Protection Caucus, I am particularly aware of the importance of saving our at-risk wildlife species.

More than 1,600 are already listed as threatened or endangered under the Endangered Species Act because of our failure to act.

Oregon alone is home to more than 50 of these threatened and endangered species.

In States like Oregon, in partnership with Tribes, we have identified thousands more species that are at-risk and need conservation assistance.

With States and conservation partners working diligently to pass and develop conservation plans, we can make a significant difference. But we lack dedicated annual comprehensive funding to implement the plans which would be cost-effective.

With this bill, the Federal Government is stepping up in full partnership with the Tribes, with the conservation communities, and wildlife advocates.

The Recovering America's Wildlife Act will provide more than a billion dollars in dedicated annual funding for proactive, cost-effective model efforts, collaborative efforts by the States and Tribes to recover and protect at-risk species.

I fear it is a false economy to sometimes engage in shortchanging these efforts. The long-term cost to the environment, to our communities, is immense. And I am pleased to support this legislation because I think we can change this dynamic. I strongly urge people to support its passage.

Mr. WESTERMAN. Mr. Speaker, I encourage the majority to put their estimates to the test. Let's make this a bill with a 7-year sunset like the amendment that I proposed. Let's come back, look at it, and see if it really did save money. If it really did save species, maybe we should fund it at more than $1.4 billion a year. Maybe we can find that funding with an offset.

But the simple truth is it is all speculation right now, and we are getting ready to put a permanent mandatory spending program in place with no way to come back and have checks and balances on it without repealing the law. And how many times does that happen when Congress passes a law?

Mr. Speaker, I yield 5 minutes to the gentleman from Wisconsin (Mr. TIFFANY).

□ 1530

Mr. TIFFANY. Mr. Speaker, I thank the gentleman for yielding.

Regrettably, I will not be able to support this bill either. It is another $1.4 billion of mandatory spending—no offsets, no sunset. This is another case of the runaway Biden inflation train gaining speed. The only question at this point to the American people is how spectacular the crack-up is going to be, and the American people know that.

When I go out and talk to them, I hear about two things: energy prices and inflation.

Well, here we have got another $1.4 billion that are going to be poured into the tinderbox of the train to send it careening down the rails even faster. The only question is how spectacular the crack-up is going to be. Unfortunately, the American people are going to suffer the consequences.

The author of this bill just said that she would like to take some species off the endangered species list. There is one that can come off right now—right now—that has recovered.

Representative BOEBERT and I proposed an amendment to de-list the gray wolf. It has recovered. The gray wolf is in the ESA ''Hotel California.'' They can enter, but they never leave.

Twenty-five wildlife scientists from the upper Midwest a decade ago said, you need to de-list the wolf. We put together an amendment for this bill, and it was not considered.

Terribly unfortunate, because it is time for the Endangered Species Act to either be used properly and de-list a species like the gray wolf that is fully recovered, according to wildlife scientists, or else the ESA itself has to be reformed.

Those scientists, when you read their document that they wrote, specifically said, the Endangered Species Act is endangered because it is not being used properly.

Also, there is no language in this bill that prohibits funds from going to acquiring new Federal lands. Think about it this way: If you have a neighbor that doesn't repair their roof, it is leaking into their house, and they say we are going to go buy that lot next door. That, in effect, is what this bill will allow the Federal Government to do.

We are seeing across America, including in my district, that the Federal Government is not taking care of their lands appropriately. The Federal Government is becoming America's slumlord.

This bill has grant programs that even the most extreme environmental groups can apply for. Every time some taxpayer-funded, so-called corporate green group runs an ad, and you are going to see a lot of them here in 2022, claiming the sky is falling, just remember: You may have paid for it, and you may pay twice because you will get hit with inflation as a result of spending that the American people cannot afford.

I thank the gentleman for the opportunity to be able to testify on this bill. Unfortunately, I will not be able to support it, and I hope in the future that we can do better.

Mrs. DINGELL. Mr. Speaker, I yield 3 minutes to the gentleman from Washington (Mr. KILMER).

Mr. KILMER. Mr. Speaker, I thank the gentlewoman for yielding and for her leadership on this issue.

I rise in support of the Recovering America's Wildlife Act, bipartisan legislation I am proud to cosponsor, that aims to make the most significant investment in wildlife and habitat conservation in a generation.

Across Washington State, across our whole country, we are facing widespread species decline that doesn't just threaten the health of our ecosystems. It threatens the recreation and tourism and fishing industries that our communities rely on.

That is why Democrats and Republicans support taking bold action to implement conservation efforts to conserve and restore habitat, to reintroduce native species, and to mitigate wildlife risk.

This bill is critical to helping our State and our Tribal wildlife managers put conservation measures in place to protect species before they become threatened or endangered.

On top of that, this bill will help us combat threats to ecosystems, including the European green crab, an invasive species that is destroying essential marine habitat for Dungeness crab and Pacific salmon and threatening our shellfish industry that so many of the families that I represent depend on.

Get this: Last year, more than 102,000 European green crabs were caught in Puget Sound and along Washington's coast. That was an astronomical 5,500 percent increase from 2019.

In response to that explosion in the green crab population, a series of disaster declarations were made by the Lummi Nation and the Makah Tribe concerning the green crabs' impact on Tribal culture and on their economies, and another a disaster was declared by the State of Washington to mobilize more resources.

While our Tribes and States and local partners and small businesses are working diligently to protect our region against the explosion of these invasive species, they need more resources to improve detection, increase control efforts, and pursue eradication of this invasive species.

This burden shouldn't fall entirely on the backs of our Tribes or on local taxpayers' backs. The Federal Government can and should step up and be a better partner in this effort, and this bill will do that. That is why I encourage my colleagues to support this bipartisan legislation.

Mr. WESTERMAN. Mr. Speaker, I yield 5 minutes to the gentleman from Idaho (Mr. FULCHER).

Mr. FULCHER. Mr. Speaker, I thank the chairman for yielding the time.

As I speak, the West is literally burning. Major infernos are devastating States like California, Arizona, and Alaska.

In New Mexico, the Hermit's Peak fire became the largest in State history nearly 1 month ago and is still not fully contained. This catastrophic fire has burned over 320,000 acres and cost taxpayers a whopping $224 million in fire suppression costs.

In total, over 2.6 million acres have burned this year already, putting us on a pace to surpass every wildfire season in the past decade.

Homes have burned to the ground. Thousands of brave wildland firefighters have put their lives on the line. Hundreds of millions of dollars have been spent trying to tame fires so intense, they create their own weather systems known as firenados. Why?

The answer is simple. The lack of active forest management and decades of fire suppression and mismanagement have left our Nation's forests as dry as

powder kegs and ready to ignite from a single spark.

In the last decade, mismanagement caused over 70 million acres to burn, and we have no signs of it slowing down. According to the U.S. Forest Service, over one billion—that is billion with a b—acres across the country are at risk of experiencing severe wildfires.

That is why I am offering this amendment. My amendment seeks to add forest management activities such as mechanical thinning and prescribed burning that enhance or create wildlife habitat—that is, enhance or create wildlife habitat—or reduce the risk of destruction to wildlife habitat due to wildfires as acceptable projects under the Recovering America's Wildlife Act.

Catastrophic fires remain one of the single greatest threats to wildlife in Western States, such as my home State of Idaho.

In California, the Los Angeles Times reported in 2020 that the Bobcat fire turned one of the most abundant wildlife habitats with lush canyons and a mixture of rare and endangered species into an ''apocalypse'' that looked like ground zero after a nuclear explosion. Experts believe this fire would reverse decades of conservation efforts.

In Oregon, the 2020 wildfires have burned over 360,000 acres of critical spotted owl habitat, pushing the species into what researchers call an extinction vortex.

Catastrophic wildfires recently forced the State of Washington Department of Fish and Wildlife to recommend moving the greater sage-grouse from threatened to endangered status in their State. This is the very action that RAWA seeks to prevent.

These wildfires also killed nearly half of the State's endangered pigmy rabbit population. A Seattle Times report stated that rabbits had asphyxiated as the fire, in its fury, devoured oxygen from the atmosphere. There was nothing but ash and dust. No movement. No footprints. There was no chance anything survived.

Is this what recovering America's wildlife looks like, choking animals in suffocating smoke, burning them alive?

These catastrophic wildland fires are polluting our air, degrading our water, releasing massive amounts of carbon into the atmosphere, and turning rich and diverse wildlife habitat into barren moonscapes.

Incentivizing better, more active forest management through my amendment will create healthier ecosystems and abundant habitat for diverse wildlife. That is exactly what this bill is intended to do. If we truly care about recovering America's wildlife, then you will support my amendment.

If we adopt this, we will instruct the Committee on Natural Resources to add my amendment to include the forest management activities that modify, improve, enhance, or create wildlife habitat or protect wildlife habitat from wildfires as acceptable uses of funding under this bill.

Mr. Speaker, I ask unanimous consent to include the text of my amendment in the RECORD immediately prior to the vote on the motion to recommit.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Is there objection to the request of the gentleman from Idaho?

There was no objection.

Mrs. DINGELL. I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. WESTERMAN. Mr. Speaker, I thank the gentleman from Idaho for making a point that it is really the underlying reason that we should be—or the underlying question we should be talking about is, Why do we need to recover America's wildlife?

It is because we have messed up badly. We have mismanaged our Federal lands. Catastrophic wildfires run rampant. That does nothing to help wildlife habitat, and it is sad that we are actually here looking for funding and ways to fix something that we should have already fixed, something that we shouldn't have broken in the first place.

I think there is a way to recover wildlife, if we would just simply manage the habitat that the wildlife lives in. That is the purpose of this bill, but it is going to take some worldview changes, and the so-called environmental groups that are pushing to stop the management activity are going to have to allow this activity to take place.

It doesn't matter how much funding we put out from the Federal Government; we are going to continue to see wildlife habitat destroyed, and we are going to continue to see the loss of wildlife.

So it is not a problem that simply throwing money at will fix, and it is, again, a problem where we should put a program in place, come back and evaluate it, and decide whether we want to continue the program based on the merits of the successes of it.

Mr. Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

Mrs. DINGELL. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

I say to my colleague, I deeply agree that these fires are horrific in what they are doing to our natural resources and our habitat, but that is why this bill is so important.

It is not Washington telling the States or the Native lands or territories in the Native lands what to do. It is the State wildlife plans that are being drafted at the local level where they know what needs to be done that we will be funding and trying to prevent fires like that.

Mr. Speaker, I yield such time as he may consume to the very distinguished gentleman from Arizona (Mr. GRIJALVA), the chairman of the Committee on Natural Resources, who leads all of us on so many of these issues.

Mr. GRIJALVA. Mr. Speaker, I rise in support of H.R. 2773, Recovering America's Wildlife Act. I thank Representative DINGELL and her colleagues that have worked diligently on this legislation for a considerable amount of time.

In the midst of the species extinction crisis that we have, accelerated climate change, the loss of biodiversity, droughts, the wildfires that we just heard about, it is important to note that this legislation was built from the ground up; 1,800 organizations, as diverse as Duke Energy on one side of the political spectrum and the Environmental Defense Fund on the other side, both agreeing that the approach of this legislation is the right approach; 180-plus cosponsors represented in a bipartisan fashion.

This bill before us today will transform the state of wildlife conservation in our country.

As we know, America's wildlife faces numerous threats, including habitat loss, pollution, climate change, wildfire, drought, invasive species, and emerging diseases.

It provides a historic $1.3 billion of dedicated funding for States and territories and $97 million for Tribes to assist in their efforts to conserve, restore, and protect wildlife and habitat each year.

With that protection comes the resiliency for habitat and the overall resiliency for communities and our environment.

In the long run, this investment will save taxpayers money. It creates jobs, promotes tourism, and provides safety and resilience to those communities across our country.

Through habitat conservation and restoration, this bill makes habitats and communities much more resilient to the ongoing and accelerated issue of climate change. This is an important piece of legislation for each and every State, territory, and Tribe in our country, and I urge my colleagues to support it.

□ 1545

My friends on the other side of the aisle, my Republican colleagues are fiscal conservatives when they are not in the majority. When they are in the majority, that is not the pattern of behavior.

At the present time, nothing should be done is what is being preached:

Nothing should be done about the climate crisis.

Nothing should be done about wildlife extinction.

Nothing should be done about January 6 and our democracy. That was merely a mirage, a walk in the park that we should all forget.

Nothing should be done about our children and the danger that they are exposed to in our very schools.

Nothing should be done about the rising healthcare costs and prescription drug costs.

We can't do anything because of inflation and the rising gas prices, so the best thing to do is to do nothing.

Well, my colleagues, I support H.R. 2773 because it does something. It does something in a bipartisan, comprehensive way. If my colleagues want to talk

about climate change, if they want to talk about droughts, if they want to talk about wildfire, if they want to talk about fiscally prudent things to do, let's talk about this bill today. Support it with dedicated funding. Make the investment that will guarantee the dividends for ourselves and future generations.

I applaud Representative DINGELL and all the work of her colleagues and this piece of legislation, and I urge its support and urge a ''yes'' vote.

Mr. WESTERMAN. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

Mr. Speaker, there has been a lot of talk about this bill being bipartisan. The original House version of the text did have 42 Republican cosponsors on it, which is a sizable number. That is a bipartisan bill.

There will still be Republicans who vote for this version, but as long as we are in the business of estimating today, I am going to estimate that it won't be the 42 cosponsors of the original text, which, again, was supplanted by the Senate version that didn't send all the money to the State and Tribal governments. It sent the money to U.S. Fish and Wildlife, part of the funding to U.S. Fish and Wildlife.

I have talked to some of the Republican Members who have cosponsored the bill, and their understanding was that the pay-for was going to be worked out. If we would just sponsor the bill, we would get the pay-fors worked out. We were told the bill will go to the floor, and we will work out the pay-fors. Well, here is the bill on the floor and there is still no pay-fors. It is still permanent mandatory spending, $1.4 billion a year.

If this bill passes out of the House, and if for some reason it doesn't make it through the Senate and become law, then I hope to come back and work on a bill that has the same objectives but is fiscally responsible, a bill that has pay-fors, a bill that is not borrowing from our children, and a bill that is not permanent, one that actually gives Congress the authority to have oversight and to come back and analyze the language, to analyze the success of it, and make changes as needed as we go on.

We do this with the farm bill, we do it with other bills. I am not sure why we can't do it with Recovering America's Wildlife Act because it is a very important subject.

Mr. Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

Mrs. DINGELL. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

I say to my colleague, we have worked in good faith. We will continue to work in good faith.

The Senate, which doesn't work together as closely at times the way we do, has negotiated a legacy fund that is a bipartisan negotiated provision by the chairman and the ranking member of the Senate Committee on Environment and Public Works. Actually, more Republicans voted for that than Democrats did.

This bill has been supported by a broad cross-section of Senate Republicans and Senate Democrats. Quite frankly, there are some of your Senate Republican colleagues who will only support it the way it is now. I have talked to many Republicans who want to see this bill go through. I don't know how the final vote will be today. I know people want to support it.

By the way, it addresses a shared goal, what the Senate did, that third provision helping to move species off of the ESA listings more quickly. It contains guardrails on the use of funds that I know were important to my Republican colleagues. These include prohibitions on the use of funds to make any listing or critical habitat determination relating to the endangered or threatened status of any species or to acquire any Federal land, which I know is really important on your side.

The broad coalition supporting the bill, including the State wildlife agencies and sportsmen's groups, have also backed all these provisions. We are not done. If the bill passes the House, we will go to conference with the Senate. We will all be at that table. But the time is now. We need to get this done. We have lost almost 3 billion birds since 1970. We are losing 40 percent of our fish. You and I both fish. I am not as great a hunter as you guys are, but I was married to one. But they know what is happening. The time for action is now.

Mr. Speaker, we are prepared to close, and I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. WESTERMAN. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume. In closing, I just want to go back through the facts as we know them.

We know that we need to do better habitat management, whether it is forest, rangelands, oceans, rivers, or lakes. We know there are areas where we need to manage better. The intent of this bill is to let those management activities be done by the people who do it best, State and Tribal agencies.

I think there is a huge agreement in the House, both Republicans and Democrats alike, but that is a good thing. The problem we have with the bill, though, is the way that we are going to implement it in the financial times that we are in now, and looking back at history and seeing how we got in the condition that we are in. The spending problem in this country is not discretionary spending. It is not the appropriation bills that we should be debating and approving every year.

It is the mandatory spending. It is the cruise control programs that previous Congresses have put in place that are driving the deficit. Over 70 percent of our debt is due to mandatory spending. And here we are with record debt, record inflation, and we are talking about putting more on the mandatory side of the equation.

There is a path where we could get huge support. We could probably do this, maybe even do it on a unanimous consent bill, and that would be if the majority would accept the amendment that I offered in the Rules Committee.

As the ranking member on the committee, I offered an amendment that would bring a lot of our Members on board, and it simply put a 7-year sunset in, make it an authorization and let the Appropriations Committee do their work.

We are not even going to vote on that. We are not even going to put it on the floor to see where the Members of the body are at. The Rules Committee took that off of the table. So we have no choice. No choice but to recommend that we vote ''no'' on this bill, that we come back to the table, that we look at something that everybody can agree on. Not just on the authorization, but on how we fund the bill. I think we can get there.

I hate to take it out of the House's hands and put it into the Senate's hands when we didn't give it a full effort on how to not only craft the legislation on what needs to be done on the ground, but how to pay for it, how to be fiscally responsible going forward.

So, again, I support the idea. I don't support the way we are paying for it. I have to recommend a ''no'' vote. I encourage my colleagues to vote ''no,'' and I yield back the balance of my time.

Mrs. DINGELL. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume to close.

I thank my colleagues on both sides of the aisle for the constructive debate and input that we have had to date on Recovering America's Wildlife Act. This legislation is historic, and our shared efforts today will help move us one step closer to a bold solution to the biodiversity crisis and will establish conservation measures that will endure for generations, which I know we both care about.

The Recovering America's Wildlife Act has strong bipartisan support, the backing of hundreds of meetings of sportsmen's groups, hunting and fishing advocates, conservation organizations, environmental advocates, businesses, and countless others.

It will fund proactive conservation measures that will benefit every State and territory and contains a strong Tribal title to support Tribal organizations' efforts to protect wildlife on tens of millions of acres of land.

I urge my colleagues to join me in supporting the Recovering America's Wildlife Act. It will make a difference in every congressional district in this country.

Mr. Speaker, I yield back the balance of my time.

Mr. CASE. Mr. Speaker, I rise today in strong support of H.R. 2773, the Recovering America's Wildlife Act. I thank the gentlewoman from Michigan, Congresswoman DINGELL, and Chairman GRIJALVA for their leadership in moving this critical legislation through our Natural Resources Committee and to the Floor.

The world is in the middle of an extinction crisis and, unfortunately, my state is at its center. As a result of climate change, invasive species and other environmental stressors, our islands have earned the unfortunate distinction of becoming the endangered species capitol of the world. Of the 1,225 endangered species listed by the U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service, nearly 500 are found in Hawaii. Just last year, nine more of Hawaii's endemic species were officially reclassified as extinct.

The Recovering America's Wildlife Act will provide $1.3 billion in support to states, territories and tribes to address wildlife conservation. The estimated $60 million in annual funding to Hawaii will be essential to my state's ability to save our imperiled biodiversity and will increase the chance that species like the 'I'iwi (a Hawaiian Honeycreeper), 'Ōpe'ape'a (the Hawaiian Hoary Bat) and Kāhuli (Hawaiian tree snail) survive.

I urge my colleagues to vote yes on this legislation. Mahalo.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. All time for debate has expired.

Each further amendment printed in part D of House Report 117–366 not earlier considered as part of the amendments en bloc pursuant to section 7 of House Resolution 1170 shall be considered only in the order printed in the report, may be offered only by a Member designated in the report, shall be considered as read, shall be debatable for the time specified in the report equally divided and controlled by the proponent and opponent, may be withdrawn by the proponent at any time before the question is put thereon, shall not be subject to amendment, and shall not be subject to a demand for division of the question.

It shall be in order at any time for the chair of the Committee on Natural Resources or his designee to offer amendments en bloc consisting of further amendments in part D of House Report 117–366 not earlier disposed of. Amendments en bloc shall be considered as read, shall be debatable for 20 minutes equally divided and controlled by the chair and ranking minority member of the Committee on Natural Resources or their respective designees, shall not be subject to amendment, and shall not be subject to a demand for division of the question.

AMENDMENTS EN BLOC NO. 1 OFFERED BY MRS. DINGELL OF MICHIGAN

Mrs. DINGELL. Mr. Speaker, pursuant to House Resolution 1170, I offer amendments en bloc.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The Clerk will designate the amendments en bloc.

Amendments en bloc No. 1 consisting of amendment Nos. 1, 3, 6, and 7, printed in part D of House Report 117–366, offered by Mrs. DINGELL of Michigan:

AMENDMENT NO. 1 OFFERED BY MRS. CHERFILUS-MCCORMICK OF FLORIDA

Page 7, line 15, strike ''and''.

Page 7, line 20, strike the period and insert ''; and''.

Page 7, after line 20, inert the following:

(H) may be used to expand the use of innovative technologies, tools, strategies, or collaborative partnerships that accelerate, expand, or replicate effective and measurable recovery efforts for species of greatest conservation need and species listed as threatened or endangered under section 4 of the Endangered Species Act of 1973 and the habitats of such species.

AMENDMENT NO. 3 OFFERED BY MS. JACKSON LEE OF TEXAS

TITLE IV—REPORT

SEC. 401. REPORT.

The Secretary of the Interior shall, not later than 1 year after the date of enactment of this section, and annually thereafter, submit a report to the Committee on Environment and Public Works of the Senate and the Committee on Natural Resources of the House of Representatives providing detailed information on the dollar amount of grants and contracts (including subcontracts), and the percentage of total awards and grants, that were awarded or allocated under this Act to Historically Black Colleges and Universities, Hispanic-serving educational institutions, Tribally-controlled colleges and universities, minority-serving educational institutions, minority-owned business enterprises, women-owned business enterprises, and community-based organizations that are principally administered by, operated by, or serving minority communities.

AMENDMENT NO. 6 OFFERED BY MS. SCHRIER OF WASHINGTON

Page 7, line 15, strike ''and''.

Page 7, line 20, strike the period at the end and insert ''; and''.

Page 7, after line 20, insert the following new subparagraph:

''(H) may be used for conservation infrastructure projects related to the protection and conservation of a species of greatest conservation need and the habitat of such species.''.

AMENDMENT NO. 7 OFFERED BY MR. DAVID SCOTT OF GEORGIA

Page 7, line 15, strike ''and''.

Page 7, line 20, strike the period and insert ''; and''.

Page 7, after line 20, insert the following new subparagraph:

''(H) may be used to conserve and restore a native pollinator species which is a species of greatest conservation need.''.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Pursuant to House Resolution 1170, the gentlewoman from Michigan (Mrs. DINGELL) and the gentleman from Arkansas (Mr. WESTERMAN) each will control 10 minutes.

The Chair recognizes the gentlewoman from Michigan.

Mrs. DINGELL. Mr. Speaker, this en bloc consists of four amendments: Amendment No. 3, offered by the gentlewoman from Texas; amendment No. 7, offered by the gentleman from Georgia; amendment No. 6, offered by the gentlewoman from Washington; and amendment No. 1, offered by the gentlewoman from Florida.

Amendment No. 3, offered by the gentlewoman from Texas, requires the Secretary of the Interior to submit a report to the House Committee on Natural Resources and the Senate Committee on Environment and Public Works outlining the dollar amount of grants, contracts, and subcontracts, and the percent of total awards and grants that were awarded or allocated under RAWA to HBCUs and minority-serving institutions, minority- and women-owned businesses, and community-based organizations serving minority communities.

Current conservation and restoration practices underutilize the breadth of traditional, indigenous, and local knowledge found in our communities. To be successful in our restoration and conservation goals, we must use all of the tools at our disposal.

Amendment No. 7, offered by the gentleman from Georgia, adds activities that support native pollinator conservation and restoration to the list of appropriate uses of funds from the Wildlife Conservation and Restoration Subaccount.

While many State wildlife action plans already include projects that will conserve and restore native pollinator species and habitat, we recognize the important role that pollinators play in ecosystem functionality.

Twenty-seven States included monarch butterflies in their State wildlife action plans, and thousands of other pollinators are identified as species of greatest conservation need.

Our pollinators are at risk, and it is important that we not forget the important impact they have on our landscape.

Amendment No. 6, offered by the gentlewoman from Washington, clarifies that the Wildlife Conservation and Restoration Subaccount funds may include conservation infrastructure projects related to the protection and conservation of a species of greatest conservation need and the habitat of those species.

Conservation infrastructure projects are cost-effective methods to enhance conservation and build climate resiliency. They can protect against excessive heat and coastal storms while improving wildlife habitat and carbon sequestration.

Conservation infrastructure projects improve the health and management of ecosystems so that they provide important benefits and services. Examples include managing stormwater runoff, improving water quality for wildlife, restoring wildlife habitat in the built environment, and attracting beneficial species.

□ 1600

Finally, amendment No. 1, offered by the gentlewoman from Florida, broadens the appropriate uses of Wildlife Conservation and Restoration Subaccount funds to include using innovative technologies, tools, strategies, or collaborative partnerships that accelerate, expand, or replicate effective and measurable recovery efforts for species of the greatest conservation need and endangered species.

Supporting the implementation and expansion of new, creative conservation methods is of the utmost importance if we wish to interrupt the ongoing mass extinction event. In this time of need, our species and ecosystems need all the help we can provide. Funding innovative ideas will fill the gaps left by traditional conservation methods while spurring research and creating jobs.

Mr. Speaker, I urge my colleagues to vote ''yes,'' and I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. WESTERMAN. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume. I also rise in support of this amendment en bloc.

None of the amendments included in this amendment en bloc would add more spending to this bill. Three of the amendments in this en bloc amend title I by adding more flexibility for State fish and wildlife agencies when they make conservation investments funded under this bill.

These amendments do not impose new mandates, but rather, provide States more tools to manage wildlife as they see fit.

Mr. SCOTT's amendment on helping pollinators and their habitats will enhance ongoing efforts aimed at helping the monarch butterfly. Pollinators are critical to ecosystem conservation around the world. That is why my Republican colleagues and I have continuously supported the Candidate Conservation Agreement with Assurances for the monarch butterfly, which allows private companies and landowners to contribute to proactive conservation.

The amendment from Congresswoman CHERFILUS-MCCORMICK recommends that States prioritize funding toward innovative strategies and partnerships to recover species. I believe that innovation is critical for ensuring widespread species recovery. The current species recovery framework under the Endangered Species Act is not only outdated, but it is broken and needs innovation.

Republicans have offered numerous ideas to use innovation to spur species recovery. One idea from Representative HERRELL of New Mexico would help incentivize proactive Candidate Conservation Agreements that allow private companies and landowners to contribute toward at-risk species conservation through their own dollars and efforts. Sounds like a good, commonsense idea.

The outdated Endangered Species Act has become a top-down government approach that rarely works to help species or people. Innovative approaches like Ms. HERRELL's are much needed.

I was disappointed to see that the majority discarded amendments like Ms. HERRELL's without even giving us the chance to debate its merits on the House floor.

Representative STAUBER also had an innovative idea to update the Endangered Species Act that he offered as an amendment. His amendment would have provided the U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service with the flexibility to utilize so-called 4(d) rules for endangered species. Under a 4(d) rule, the Secretary of the Interior can issue a rule for individual species that tailors protections to that species' conservation and recovery. Unfortunately, again, the majority also ignored that amendment.

The amendment by Congresswoman SCHRIER is also included in this en bloc by encouraging States to invest in ''conservation infrastructure projects.'' While States already have flexibility to decide how to spend the funding provided in title I of the bill, this amendment would give them the option to invest in natural solutions, such as buffer strips, wetlands—one of my favorite things—planting trees, and other natural solutions to environmental challenges.

Lastly, Congresswoman JACKSON LEE's amendment would require the Secretary of the Interior to issue a report within 1 year of this bill's enactment, detailing the percentage of total awards and grants that were awarded or allocated to institutions serving minority communities.

While I support this amendment and its reporting requirement, I have bad news for the sponsor. Because the bill lacks a sunset provision, there is little incentive and recourse for Congress to fix any problems. In other words, if the reports required by this amendment highlight a glaring flaw with the programs being carried out under this bill, there will be no guarantee that Congress will fix the problem. The same is true for the State reports required under the bill.

For that reason, I offered a commonsense amendment that would have included a 7-year sunset to ensure that Congress would have to fix any flaws associated with this new program. Unfortunately, as I stated earlier, my amendment was also blocked by the majority.

This bill and the process to rush this bill to the floor today are unfortunate. It could have been avoided, but at least the amendments included in this en bloc do not spend any more taxpayer money and provide some needed accountability.

Mr. Speaker, I support the en bloc, and I reserve the balance of my time.

Mrs. DINGELL. Mr. Speaker, I am glad we found an area of agreement this afternoon. I think we have more agreement than people realize.

Mr. Speaker, I yield 3 minutes to the gentlewoman from Texas (Ms. JACKSON LEE), the author of one of these very critical amendments.

Ms. JACKSON LEE. Mr. Speaker, I am delighted to be yielded to by the gentlewoman. I thank her for championing this outstanding legislation, and I thank my good friend for acknowledging the en bloc.

I will say that there is good news. The good news is that the Recovering America's Wildlife Act is once-in-a-generation funding for the conservation of threatened species of animals and plants as well as habitat preservation. I will discuss the importance of it as I also present to the body my amendment.

Let me, first of all, say I pay tribute to Ellison, 7 years old, and to Roy, 7 years old, my twin grandchildren who love every species that they can find within their backyard or anyplace else that you would take them. I see in their lifetime the vision of this legislation. They love the outdoors. They love to see crawling things, and they are a boy and a girl.

Yet, what are we facing today? The world is facing an unprecedented loss of wildlife. Bird populations have declined almost 30 percent in the U.S. and Canada since 1970. Over 40 percent of America's freshwater fish are at risk of extinction, and State agencies have identified 12,000 species of wildlife in need of conservation.

The Speaker pro tempore knows that Texas and Louisiana experienced a catastrophic oil spill some years ago. I remember visiting oyster fishermen and others who were devastated. We need to get in there and make a difference.

Mr. Speaker, 12,000 species are currently identified as endangered in the United States, and 1,300 of them are in my State of Texas. As I said, fishermen are still crying out for help. Climate change poses an unprecedented challenge to plant and animal species due to wildfires, droughts, floods, and temperature shifts. Hurricane Harvey devastated the coast and the opportunities for wildlife. The resulting threat to biodiversity has the potential to disrupt our ecosystem and, with it, human quality of life and sustainability.

Urban sprawl as well as development of suburbs and exurbs also encroach on the habitat that supports biodiversity, and it has ripple effects that compound the gradation of our environment from climate change.

We want to be hanging in there with fisherman, sportsmen, bikers, hikers—bikers in the appropriate atmosphere, but hikers in particular.

Our children deserve to know the natural beauty of their country. They deserve to see the beauty of wildlife. They deserve to be good custodians of that, and the children need to be diverse.

So the amendment that I offer is to ensure that children will continue to spend their days fishing, gardening alongside bees, watching the migratory birds, but also looking at the wilds and the species that are in them.

The Recovering America's Wildlife Act provides $1.3 billion in funding to protect our Nation's wildlife, $50 million of which will go to Texas.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The time of the gentlewoman has expired.

Mrs. DINGELL. Mr. Speaker, I yield an additional 1 minute to the gentlewoman from Texas.

Ms. JACKSON LEE. Mr. Speaker, this is a great effort. My amendment fixes and adds to this. By adding title IV, we stipulate the Secretary of the Interior must, no later than 1 year after passage, provide a report on the dollar amount of grants, contracts, and subcontracts that were allocated to historically Black colleges and universities, Hispanic-serving educational institutions, tribally controlled colleges and universities, and women- and minority-owned businesses.

My amendment goes into the broad span of Americans, brings them into

the arena, and gives a needed investment in people of color who deserve to be not only included but intentionally targeted in new conservation investments to open their eyes, to give them the opportunity, and to ensure our Native American friends are included as well along with women- and minority-owned businesses. Let them have an investment as well.

In addition, with the enactment of this legislation, my amendment would create a framework for prioritizing historically disadvantaged groups in environmental efforts, bring them, again, into the fold, which should be replicated in future efforts. This is an important step.

I want you to listen to me, historically Black colleges and Hispanic-serving institutions, this is also a day for you. Support this legislation, and we will expand and build and support America.

Mr. Speaker, as a staunch advocate for the environment I rise in support of the Recovering America's Wildlife Act of 2021.

This bill provides once-in-a-generation funding for the conservation of threatened species of animals and plants, as well as habitat preservation.

12,000 species are currently identified as endangered in the United States. 1,300 of those are in my home state of Texas.

In addition to providing $1.3 billion in funding to protect our nation's wildlife—$50 million of which will go to Texas—the Recovering America's Wildlife Act of 2021 designates portion of this federal funding for special projects that revitalize species facing a conservation need.

In addition to my support of H.R. 2773, I rise to put forth an important amendment to today's legislation.

Firstly, this legislation does not stipulate significant transparency regarding the handling of these funds.

Secondly, nowhere in this bill does it require the Department of the Interior to include people of color.

My amendment fixes both of those issues. By adding Title IV, we stipulate the Secretary of the Interior must, no later than one year after passage, provide a report on the dollar amount of grants, contracts, and subcontracts that were allocated to Historically Black Colleges and Universities, Hispanic-serving educational institutions, Tribally controlled colleges and universities, and women and minority owned business.

My amendment addresses a needed investment in people of color who deserve to be not only included, but intentionally targeted in new conservation investments.

Passage of this bill will encourage fairness in the allocation of contract, subcontract, and grant dollars, as well as greater transparency into the details of those allocations.

Climate change poses unprecedented challenges to plant and animal species due to wildfires, droughts, floods, and temperature shifts.

The resulting threat to biodiversity has the potential to disrupt our ecosystem, and with it, human quality-of-life and sustainability.

Urban sprawl as well as development of suburbs and exurbs also encroach on the habitat that supports biodiversity, and it has ripple effects that compound the degradation of our environment from climate change.

This bill takes these problems seriously and provides funding for programs that are essential for human sustainability as well as the resilience of plants and animals.

Our children deserve to know the natural beauty of their country.

They deserve to grow up in an America teeming with wild strength, diversity, and beauty.

They deserve to embrace the long American history of wildlife sportsmanship, recreation, and appreciation.

By supporting H.R. 2773, we ensure that childhood days spent fishing at the lake, gardening alongside bees, or watching the flight of migratory birds are not things of the past.

Through this bill we preserve the heritage of our country.

Additionally, enactment of this legislation would create a framework for prioritizing historically disadvantaged groups in environmental efforts that should be replicated in future efforts.

Mr. WESTERMAN. Mr. Speaker, again, I support this group of amendments en bloc and encourage a ''yes'' vote, and I yield back the balance of my time.

Mrs. DINGELL. Mr. Speaker, I encourage my colleagues to support this en bloc package as well as the bill upon final passage, and I yield back the balance of my time.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Pursuant to House Resolution 1170, the previous question is ordered on the amendments en bloc offered by the gentlewoman from Michigan (Mrs. DINGELL).

The question is on the amendments en bloc.

The question was taken; and the Speaker pro tempore announced that the ayes appeared to have it.

Mr. TIFFANY. Mr. Speaker, on that I demand the yeas and nays.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Pursuant to section 3(s) of House Resolution 8, the yeas and nays are ordered.

Pursuant to clause 8 of rule XX, further proceedings on this question are postponed.

AMENDMENTS EN BLOC NO. 2 OFFERED BY MRS. DINGELL OF MICHIGAN

Mrs. DINGELL. Mr. Speaker, pursuant to House Resolution 1170, I offer amendments en bloc.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The Clerk will designate the amendments en bloc.

Amendments en bloc No. 2 consisting of amendment Nos. 2 and 8, printed in part D of House Report 117–366, offered by Mrs. DINGELL of Michigan:

AMENDMENT NO. 2 OFFERED BY MR. BENTZ OF OREGON

Page 34, after line 13, add the following new subsection:

(k) ADMINISTRATIVE COSTS.—Of the funds made available under each of paragraphs (1) and (3) of subsection (e), not more than 1.85 percent may be used by the Secretary for administrative costs.

AMENDMENT NO. 8 OFFERED BY MR. TIFFANY OF WISCONSIN

Page 34, after line 13, add the following new subsection:

(k) INSPECTOR GENERAL.—There is authorized to be appropriated to the Office of the Inspector General of the Department of the Interior ½ of 1 percent of the amounts made available under subsection (c) for the purposes of providing oversight and accountability with respect to expenditure of funds authorized under such subsection, to remain available until September 30, 2029.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Pursuant to House Resolution 1170, the gentlewoman from Michigan (Mrs. DINGELL) and the gentleman from Arkansas (Mr. WESTERMAN) each will control 10 minutes.

The Chair recognizes the gentlewoman from Michigan.

Mrs. DINGELL. Mr. Speaker, en bloc No. 2 consists of two good-government amendments offered by my Republican colleagues: amendment No. 2 offered by the gentleman from Oregon and amendment No. 8 offered by the gentleman from Wisconsin.

Amendment No. 2 stipulates that no more than 1.85 percent of funds can be used for administrative costs in the grant programs authorized by title III.

The purpose of the Recovering America's Wildlife Act is to fund on-the-ground efforts that are focused on conserving and restoring wildlife and habitat. This 1.85 percent cap will ensure that these dollars are being used toward actions that create the most impact.

Amendment No. 8 offered by the gentleman from Wisconsin requires that half of 1 percent of the money in the Endangered Species Recovery and Habitat Conservation Legacy Fund be directed to the Office of the Inspector General of the Department of the Interior to oversee the expenditure of the fund.

This amendment will ensure that money from the Endangered Species Recovery and Habitat Conservation Legacy Fund is used appropriately and in a manner that is in line with the spirit of this legislation.

Madam Speaker, I urge my colleagues to vote ''yes'' on en bloc No. 2, and I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. WESTERMAN. Madam Speaker, I rise in wholehearted support of these amendments en bloc, which include amendments from our colleagues from Oregon (Mr. BENTZ) and from Wisconsin (Mr. TIFFANY).

These amendments would ensure that the funds provided in title III are subject to the same overhead cap requirements and oversight measures as title I.

The original point of this bill was to empower States and Tribes to carry out species conservation, not set up another Washington, D.C.-based Federal program, which is now what the bill does. Not only does title III change that intent by giving more than $180 million annually in the first 4 years to the U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service, but it was also added at the Rules Committee and was not part of the bill that the Committee on Natural Resources marked up. Because the Committee on Natural Resources never had the

chance to debate this title when we marked up the original bill, we did not have the opportunity to add these good-governance amendments to it like we did for titles I and II.

I believe that title III should be removed altogether. Unfortunately, Representative MOORE's amendment, which would have removed title III, was not made in order, so we didn't even get the chance to debate it, much less vote on it today.

□ 1615

In the absence of that amendment, the least we can do is ensure funds allocated by title III are being spent responsibly and with some oversight.

I urge my colleagues to join me in support of the amendments, and I reserve the balance of my time.

Mrs. DINGELL. Madam Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. WESTERMAN. Madam Speaker, I yield 2 minutes to the gentleman from Wisconsin (Mr. TIFFANY).

Mr. TIFFANY. Madam Speaker, I thank the ranking member for saying it quite well. The least we can do here is make sure that with these funds we try to have some oversight and responsibility in terms of how they are going to be spent. I thank the author for including this amendment in the bill.

If there is no pay-for, then there must be some measure of accountability for the expenditure of these funds ensuring the Department of the Interior Inspector General's office has the proper resources to monitor this spending.

Unfortunately, the bill in its current form has no sunset on the mandatory spending of $1.4 billion, so I thank the gentlewoman for including this in the package.

Mrs. DINGELL. Madam Speaker, I am prepared to close, and I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. WESTERMAN. Madam Speaker, I yield 3 minutes to the gentleman from Oregon (Mr. BENTZ).

Mr. BENTZ. Madam Speaker, I rise in support of my amendment No. 8.

This fiscally responsible amendment would establish a 1.85 percent administrative cap for the Department of the Interior when implementing title III of this bill.

Title I of the bill, which provides funding to State fish and wildlife departments for species conservation, includes a 1.85 percent administrative cap.

Title II of the bill, which covers Tribal Wildlife Conservation and Restoration, includes a 3 percent administrative cap for the Department of the Interior.

However, as currently drafted, title III does not have an administrative cap.

The original intent of this bill was to provide States with funding to conserve species of greatest conservation need.

Unfortunately, the majority decided to ignore the committee process by airdropping in title III to give more funding to the U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service.

Not only did they circumvent process to add the entire title to the bill, they didn't carry over any of the good government amendments made in committee.

Under the current text, the State and Tribal portions of the bill would be subject to strict administrative caps, but the Federal Government would not be. This is backwards, as the U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service needs much more oversight since the agency is part of the reason we find ourselves in the position we are currently in with respect to the broken Endangered Species Act.

Additionally, the programs funded in title III already receive existing appropriations, and if the majority would like to increase them, they should do it through the appropriations process instead of airdropping in another layer of statute and bureaucracy into the legislation.

For these reasons, title III should be struck from the bill. Unfortunately, the majority refused to allow a vote on my colleague from Utah's amendment that would have done just that.

The very least we can do is at least ensure that title III is subject to the same administrative requirements as the other titles.

I urge my colleagues to support this amendment.

Mr. WESTERMAN. Madam Speaker, I again encourage adoption of these amendments, and I yield back the balance of my time.

Mrs. DINGELL. Madam Speaker, I encourage my colleagues to support the en bloc package as well as the bill upon final passage, and I yield back the balance of my time.

The SPEAKER pro tempore (Ms. JACKSON LEE). Pursuant to House Resolution Number 1170, the previous question is ordered on the amendments en bloc offered by the gentlewoman from Michigan (Mrs. DINGELL).

The question is on the amendments en bloc.

The question was taken; and the Speaker pro tempore announced that the ayes appeared to have it.

Mrs. DINGELL. Madam Speaker, on that I demand the yeas and nays.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Pursuant to section 3(s) of House Resolution 8, the yeas and nays are ordered.

Pursuant to clause 8 of rule XX, further proceedings on this question are postponed.

AMENDMENT NO. 4 OFFERED BY MR. KILDEE.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. It is now in order to consider amendment No. 4 printed in part D of House Report 117–366.

Mr. KILDEE. Madam Speaker, I have an amendment at the desk.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The Clerk will designate the amendment.

The text of the amendment is as follows:

Page 29, line 18, insert ''and efforts to manage, control, and prevent invasive species, disease, and other risks to such species'' after ''efforts''.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Pursuant to House Resolution 1170, the gentleman from Michigan (Mr. KILDEE) and a Member opposed each will control 5 minutes.

The Chair recognizes the gentleman from Michigan.

Mr. KILDEE. Madam Speaker, I thank the gentlewoman from Michigan (Mrs. DINGELL) for offering this very important piece of legislation and to the gentleman from Michigan (Mr. MEIJER) for his support on the amendment that I am offering and all of our dedication to the Great Lakes being quite evident by this work.

Growing up in Michigan, my family would camp and fish every year in East Tawas, Michigan. We grew up on the Great Lakes. These are really fond memories I have from my childhood, and it is a particular honor as a result to represent 118 miles of Lake Huron shoreline in Congress.

Over the past couple of centuries, nearly 200 non-native species have established populations in the Great Lakes. In my home State, invasive species like Asian carp, zebra mussels, and phragmites threaten the health of our Great Lakes. Zebra mussels have clogged our water infrastructure costing millions in cleanup. Asian carp eat the wetland plants that are critical habitats for native fish and waterfowl. We have to prevent the spread of invasive species in our Great Lakes, we have an obligation to do that.

This bipartisan amendment would expand the ability of the Fish and Wildlife Service Endangered Species Recovery and Habitat Conservation Legacy Fund to manage and prevent invasive species. We believe this simple amendment makes this very good bill stronger and will have a positive impact on the Great Lakes economy.

When we protect our wildlife and natural resources, we strengthen our economy and we preserve our way of life. The Great Lakes are a source of drinking water for millions, a critical wildlife habitat, and help support 1 million jobs in boating, fishing, and tourism industries.

Madam Speaker, I urge my colleagues to vote ''yes'' on this bipartisan amendment to protect our Great Lakes and strengthen our natural resources, and I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. WESTERMAN. Madam Speaker, I rise in opposition to the amendment.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The gentleman from Arkansas is recognized for 5 minutes.

Mr. WESTERMAN. Madam Speaker, I rise in opposition to this amendment, which adds more responsibilities to the already duplicative and expensive title III portion of this bill, which was never debated in the Committee on Natural Resources.

I have no objection to efforts aimed at controlling invasive species, and these efforts are already being carried

out by many Federal agencies. For example, the U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service, the agency funded by title III at the expense of State and Tribal funding, already administers invasive species control programs, including the Coastal Program and the Partners for Fish and Wildlife Program, two programs that title III would duplicate.

The Animal and Plant Health Inspection Service, or APHIS, at USDA monitors, responds to, and conducts control and eradication programs to address invasive species that pose a threat to U.S. agriculture.

These and other similar programs are subject to Federal appropriations, which is what title III should be subject to as well—not permanent mandatory funding. If the majority would like to increase Federal funding for invasive species control, they should do it through the appropriations process instead of airdropping another layer of bureaucracy into this bill.

For these reasons, we should be striking title III from the bill, at least until the committee of jurisdiction has a chance to consider and mark up its provisions. Unfortunately, the majority refused to allow a vote on my colleague from Utah, Mr. MOORE's amendment, which would have done just that.

I oppose this amendment to allow the funding for title III to be used for even more duplicative Federal bureaucracy.

Madam Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. KILDEE. Madam Speaker, I appreciate the gentleman's comments, and I agree that we ought to do everything we can to address this issue of invasive species. I just happen to believe that this bill is a very appropriate approach to this.

Coming from the Great Lakes, I will say we need every tool we can get our hands on to protect this incredible resource. I welcome the opportunity to include this language in this legislation.

Madam Speaker, I yield 2 minutes to the gentlewoman from Michigan (Mrs. DINGELL), my colleague, friend, and the sponsor of this legislation.

Mrs. DINGELL. Madam Speaker, I thank my colleague and friend from Michigan for this amendment.

This bipartisan amendment offered by the gentleman from Michigan and cosponsored by the Republican gentleman from northern Michigan makes it clear—or western Michigan, not from where DAN and I are, but it is Michigan—makes it clear that eligible funding for conservation activities under the Endangered Species Recovery and Habitat Conservation Legacy Fund include invasive species and disease management control and prevention efforts.

Invasive species and diseases pose severe threats to our Nation's wildlife population, especially for species that are already threatened or endangered.

Few places in the United States are more familiar with invasive species than the Great Lakes region which has been battling sea lampreys, zebra and quagga mussels, and now Asian carp. Native fish species are smaller and less plentiful than they once were thanks to these invasive species.

On the disease front, chronic waste and disease, a fatal disease for North America's deer, elk, and moose have spread to 25 States posing significant risks to those populations.

To properly recover native species, we must provide the resources and coordinate efforts to eradicate or control invasive species, prevent new introductions, and better understand emerging diseases.

I urge my colleagues to support this amendment.

Mr. KILDEE. Madam Speaker, I have no more speakers, and I am prepared to close.

Madam Speaker, I appreciate the debate and the conversation, but for me and I think for Congresswoman DINGELL, and certainly for Congressman MEIJER and anybody else who has grown up knowing and loving the Great Lakes, this is an important economic resource. It is an important cultural resource. It is literally the definition of the lines of our State.

Protecting the Great Lakes is an incredibly high priority for Democrats and Republicans, liberals and conservatives, people all across the spectrum. And every opportunity we have to take even a small step to do more to protect this precious water resource we are going to take that opportunity.

For that reason, I support the underlying legislation. I advocate on behalf of my amendment. I hope my colleagues will join me, Mr. MEIJER and Mrs. DINGELL in supporting it, and I yield back the balance of my time.

Mr. WESTERMAN. Madam Speaker, once again, we all have invasive species that we deal with. It is something we should be focusing on. We just don't need another duplicative Federal program to do that.

Madam Speaker, I encourage a ''no'' vote on the amendment, and I yield back the balance of my time.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Pursuant to House Resolution 1170, the previous question is ordered on the amendment offered by the gentleman from Michigan (Mr. KILDEE).

The question is on the amendment offered by the gentleman from Michigan (Mr. KILDEE).

The question was taken; and the Speaker pro tempore announced that the ayes appeared to have it.

Mr. WESTERMAN. Madam Speaker, on that I demand the yeas and nays.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Pursuant to section 3(s) of House Resolution 8, the yeas and nays are ordered.

Pursuant to clause 8 of rule XX, further proceedings on this question are postponed.

AMENDMENT NO. 5 OFFERED BY MR. BUTTERFIELD

The SPEAKER pro tempore. It is now in order to consider amendment No. 5 printed in part D of House Report 117–366.

Mr. BUTTERFIELD: Madam Speaker, as the designee of Mrs. KIRKPATRICK, I have an amendment at the desk.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The Clerk will designate the amendment.

The text of the amendment is as follows:

Page 3, line 24, insert ''nonprofit organizations,'' after ''territories,''.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Pursuant to House Resolution 1170, the gentleman from North Carolina (Mr. BUTTERFIELD) and a Member opposed each will control 5 minutes.

The Chair recognizes the gentleman from North Carolina.

□ 1630

Mr. BUTTERFIELD. Madam Speaker, I thank Mrs. DINGELL and the ranking member for their courtesy, and I also thank the Natural Resources Committee for all the work they do. I am not on that committee, but I have great respect and admiration for the committee and its chairman. I thank you for letting me have 5 minutes to present this amendment.

Madam Speaker, this amendment is rather simple. It is straightforward. The underlying bill establishes a new, competitive grant program to support innovative strategies to help species recovery. That is the underlying bill we have been debating all afternoon. However, as drafted, the bill limits those competitive grants to only State wildlife agencies.

Specifically, my amendment expands the eligibility of the grant program to include nonprofit organizations like the North Carolina Wildlife Resources Commission, the North Carolina Wildlife Federation, the Pamlico Albemarle Wildlife Conservationists, and so many more wonderful organizations in my State, and perhaps in your States all across the country.

Many of these nonprofits have tremendous expertise in helping species recover and they should be eligible to participate in this new program under this amendment.

Madam Speaker, I urge all of my colleagues to support this amendment, which will strengthen our species recovery efforts.

Madam Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. WESTERMAN. Madam Speaker, I rise in opposition to the amendment.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The gentleman from Arkansas is recognized for 5 minutes.

Mr. WESTERMAN. Madam Speaker, this amendment would actually make the bill worse by authorizing nonprofit organizations to receive funding under title I.

This amendment is in direct contravention to the original intent of this legislation, which is to empower States and Tribes in species conservation.

The current bill directs funds provided under this program to State and Tribal fish and wildlife departments or

to regional associations of fish and wildlife departments.

The amendment would allow activist environmental groups, many of whom are serial litigants against the kinds of projects this bill aims to support, to receive funding under title I, decreasing money available for State fish and game departments.

Radical special interest groups have weaponized the Endangered Species Act by continuously suing the U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service. This sue-and-settle process overwhelms regulatory agencies, resulting in settlement agreements and consent decrees that require agencies to promulgate major regulations within an arbitrarily imposed timeline.

These agreements are often negotiated behind closed doors with little or no transparency or public input, allowing radical special interest groups to promote their own Federal policy agendas, outside of the normal processes.

To make matters worse, these groups are financially rewarded for suing the government, for suing the American taxpayer. According to the Government Accountability Office, from 2000 to 2010, ESA lawsuits cost taxpayers nearly $24 million in attorneys' fees and associated costs.

Private citizens with a net worth of $2 million and for-profit businesses with a net worth of $7 million cannot receive attorneys' fees under the Equal Access to Justice Act. However, there is no such cap for nonprofit organizations, which allows these wealthy groups to rake in taxpayer money.

According to the U.S. Chamber of Commerce, from 2009 to 2017, there were 109 Endangered Species Act settlements. The majority of these settlements came from just three groups: the Center for Biological Diversity, Defenders of Wildlife, and the WildEarth Guardians. The Center for Biological Diversity was individually responsible for 41 of the 109 settlements.

This is not surprising after the Center for Biological Diversity's director said, in 2009, that ''When we stop the same timber sale three or four times running, the timber planners want to tear their hair out. They feel like their careers are being mocked and destroyed—and they are. Psychological warfare is a very underappreciated aspect of environmental campaigning.'' We are paying them to do that.

Today we can see the legacy of this mentality and these lawsuits out West where we have had two of our worst fire years back-to-back, and this year is not looking any better.

I cannot in good conscience support allowing these radical groups to receive funding under this bill, especially since it will pull money away from State fish and wildlife agencies and Tribes, as the bill was intended to fund.

Madam Speaker, I oppose this amendment, and I urge my colleagues to join me in opposition.

Madam Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. BUTTERFIELD. Madam Speaker, I listened very carefully to the gentleman from Arkansas, and I respect his position, but I just want to remind my colleagues that in my State and most States these organizations that are not nonprofits who care about the environment and care about protecting endangered species—in most States and in all of your States—these are not radical groups. These are good grassroots nonprofit organizations who really care about the environment and want to do their part in protecting our economy and our environmental economy.

Madam Speaker, I ask my colleagues to please vote for this amendment. I understand the gentleman's concern, but I assure him that the nonprofits that I speak of are not radical groups, they are good environmental organizations.

Madam Speaker, I yield as much time as she may consume to the gentlewoman from Michigan (Mrs. DINGELL).

Mrs. DINGELL. Madam Speaker, this amendment offered by the gentlewoman from Arizona and the gentleman from North Carolina adds nonprofit organizations to the list of entities that are eligible to compete for innovation grants funded by the Wildlife Conservation and Restoration Subaccount.

Ten percent of subaccount funds are used to fund innovation grants. These grants are meant to catalyze the innovation of techniques, tools, and strategies while fostering collaborative partnerships that accelerate, expand, or replicate effective and measurable recovery efforts for species of greatest conservation need and species listed under the Endangered Species Act.

Including nonprofit organizations in this competitive grant process will foster collaboration and ensure that the best strategies and efforts are being funded.

Madam Speaker, I am sure that none of the groups are the radical groups that you are referring to, but I don't know. It is a competitive process that will be carefully managed.

Madam Speaker, I support my colleague's amendment.

Mr. WESTERMAN. Madam Speaker, there are some wonderful groups out there that do great work, but this bill is not about funding private groups or nonprofit groups. This bill is about funding State and Tribal entities. It is what it was originally about. It has changed, it is now funding the U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service as well. I guess the majority is thinking, why not just throw in some of these environmental groups. Who else will this bill be putting funding out to before it is said and done?

There are groups that abuse the process. They abuse it greatly. They abuse it at the expense of the American taxpayer. They abuse it at the expense of the environment. They claim they are wanting to help the environment and they are destroying the environment.

Madam Speaker, I am opposed to this amendment, and I hope my colleagues will join me in opposing it.

Madam Speaker, I yield back the balance of my time.

Mr. BUTTERFIELD. Madam Speaker, in closing, let me thank the gentlewoman from Michigan for supporting this amendment. It is a very simple amendment. It is a very commonsense amendment. It will allow and authorize nonprofit organizations, as Mrs. DINGELL said, to compete for funding.

It will not be a guarantee of funding. It will be an opportunity to compete for funding. It is a worthwhile amendment, and I ask my colleagues to vote ''yea.''

Madam Speaker, I yield back the balance of my time.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Pursuant to House Resolution 1170, the previous question is ordered on the amendment offered by the gentleman from North Carolina (Mr. BUTTERFIELD).

The question is on the amendment offered by the gentleman from North Carolina (Mr. BUTTERFIELD).

The question was taken; and the Speaker pro tempore announced that the ayes appeared to have it.

Mr. WESTERMAN. Madam Speaker, on that I demand the yeas and nays.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Pursuant to section 3(s) of House Resolution 8, the yeas and nays are ordered.

Pursuant to clause 8 of rule XX, further proceedings on this question are postponed.

ANNOUNCEMENT BY THE SPEAKER PRO TEMPORE

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Proceedings will now resume on questions previously postponed.

Votes will be taken in the following order:

The following amendments to H.R. 2773:

Amendments En Bloc No. 1;

Amendments En Bloc No. 2;

Amendment No. 4, offered by Mr. KILDEE of Michigan; and

Amendment No. 5, offered by Mr. BUTTERFIELD of North Carolina.

A motion to recommit H.R. 2773, if offered;

Passage of H.R. 2773, if ordered; and

Motions to suspend the rules and pass:

S. 516; and

H.R. 7211.

The first vote in the series will be a 15-minute vote. Remaining electronic votes will be 5-minute votes.

AMENDMENTS EN BLOC NO. 1 OFFERED BY MRS. DINGELL OF MICHIGAN

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Pursuant to clause 8 of rule XX, the unfinished business is the question on the adoption of amendments en bloc No. 1, printed in part D of House Report 117–366, on which further proceedings were postponed and on which the yeas and nays were ordered.

The Clerk will redesignate the amendments en bloc.

The Clerk redesignated the amendments en bloc.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The question is on the amendments en bloc offered by the gentlewoman from Michigan (Mrs. DINGELL).

The vote was taken by electronic device, and there were—yeas 276, nays 147, answered ''present'' 1, not voting 3, as follows:

[Roll No. 262]

YEAS—276

Adams
Aguilar
Allred
Auchincloss
Axne
Bacon
Barr
Barragán
Bass
Beatty
Bentz
Bera
Beyer
Bishop (GA)
Blumenauer
Blunt Rochester
Bonamici
Bost
Bourdeaux
Bowman
Boyle, Brendan F.
Brown (MD)
Brown (OH)
Brownley
Bucshon
Bush
Bustos
Butterfield
Calvert
Carbajal
Cárdenas
Carl
Carson
Carter (GA)
Carter (LA)
Carter (TX)
Cartwright
Case
Castor (FL)
Castro (TX)
Chabot
Cherfilus-McCormick
Chu
Cicilline
Clark (MA)
Clarke (NY)
Cleaver
Clyburn
Cohen
Cole
Connolly
Cooper
Correa
Costa
Courtney
Craig
Crist
Crow
Cuellar
Davids (KS)
Davis, Danny K.
Davis, Rodney
Dean
DeFazio
DeGette
DelBene
Demings
DeSaulnier
Deutch
Diaz-Balart
Dingell
Doggett
Doyle, Michael F.
Escobar
Eshoo
Espaillat
Evans
Feenstra
Fitzpatrick
Fletcher
Foster
Frankel, Lois
Gallego
Garamendi
Garbarino
García (IL)
Garcia (TX)
Gimenez
Golden
Gomez
Gonzales, Tony
Gonzalez (OH)
Gonzalez, Vicente
Gottheimer
Granger
Graves (LA)
Green, Al (TX)
Griffith
Grijalva
Harder (CA)
Hayes
Herrera Beutler
Higgins (NY)
Hill
Himes
Hinson
Horsford
Houlahan
Hoyer
Hudson
Huffman
Jackson Lee
Jacobs (CA)
Jacobs (NY)
Jayapal
Jeffries
Johnson (GA)
Johnson (SD)
Johnson (TX)
Jones
Joyce (OH)
Kahele
Kaptur
Katko
Keating
Kelly (IL)
Kelly (PA)
Khanna
Kildee
Kilmer
Kim (CA)
Kim (NJ)
Kind
Kinzinger
Kirkpatrick
Krishnamoorthi
Kuster
Lamb
Langevin
Larsen (WA)
Lawrence
Lawson (FL)
Lee (CA)
Lee (NV)
Leger Fernandez
Levin (CA)
Levin (MI)
Lieu
Lofgren
Lowenthal
Luria
Lynch
Mace
Malinowski
Maloney, Carolyn B.
Maloney, Sean
Manning
Matsui
McBath
McCarthy
McCaul
McEachin
McGovern
McHenry
McKinley
McNerney
Meeks
Meijer
Meng
Mfume
Miller-Meeks
Moore (UT)
Moore (WI)
Morelle
Moulton
Mrvan
Murphy (FL)
Nadler
Napolitano
Neal
Neguse
Newhouse
Newman
Norcross
O'Halleran
Obernolte
Ocasio-Cortez
Omar
Pallone
Panetta
Pappas
Pascrell
Payne
Perlmutter
Peters
Phillips
Pingree
Pocan
Porter
Pressley
Price (NC)
Quigley
Raskin
Reschenthaler
Rice (NY)
Rice (SC)
Rodgers (WA)
Rogers (AL)
Rogers (KY)
Ross
Roybal-Allard
Ruiz
Ruppersberger
Rush
Rutherford
Ryan
Salazar
Sánchez
Sarbanes
Scanlon
Schakowsky
Schiff
Schneider
Schrader
Schrier
Scott (VA)
Scott, David
Sewell
Sherman
Sherrill
Simpson
Sires
Slotkin
Smith (WA)
Soto
Spanberger
Speier
Stansbury
Stanton
Stefanik
Stevens
Strickland
Suozzi
Swalwell
Takano
Thompson (CA)
Thompson (MS)
Thompson (PA)
Titus
Tlaib
Tonko
Torres (CA)
Torres (NY)
Trahan
Trone
Turner
Underwood
Upton
Valadao
Vargas
Veasey
Velázquez
Walberg
Waltz
Wasserman Schultz
Waters
Watson Coleman
Welch
Westerman
Wexton
Wild
Williams (GA)
Wilson (FL)
Wittman
Womack
Yarmuth

NAYS—147

Aderholt
Allen
Amodei
Armstrong
Arrington
Babin
Baird
Balderson
Banks
Bergman
Bice (OK)
Biggs
Bilirakis
Bishop (NC)
Boebert
Brady
Brooks
Buchanan
Buck
Budd
Burchett
Burgess
Cammack
Carey
Cawthorn
Cheney
Cline
Cloud
Clyde
Comer
Crawford
Crenshaw
Curtis
Davidson
DeLauro
DesJarlais
Donalds
Duncan
Dunn
Ellzey
Emmer
Estes
Fallon
Ferguson
Fischbach
Fitzgerald
Fleischmann
Foxx
Franklin, C. Scott
Fulcher
Gaetz
Gallagher
Garcia (CA)
Gibbs
Gohmert
Good (VA)
Gooden (TX)
Gosar
Graves (MO)
Green (TN)
Greene (GA)
Grothman
Guthrie
Harris
Harshbarger
Hartzler
Hern
Herrell
Hice (GA)
Higgins (LA)
Hollingsworth
Huizenga
Issa
Jackson
Johnson (LA)
Johnson (OH)
Jordan
Joyce (PA)
Keller
Kelly (MS)
Kustoff
LaHood
LaMalfa
Lamborn
Larson (CT)
Latta
LaTurner
Lesko
Letlow
Long
Loudermilk
Lucas
Luetkemeyer
Malliotakis
Mann
Massie
Mast
McClain
McClintock
Meuser
Miller (WV)
Moolenaar
Mooney
Moore (AL)
Mullin
Murphy (NC)
Nehls
Norman
Owens
Palazzo
Palmer
Pence
Perry
Pfluger
Posey
Rose
Rosendale
Rouzer
Roy
Scalise
Schweikert
Scott, Austin
Sessions
Smith (MO)
Smith (NE)
Smith (NJ)
Smucker
Spartz
Stauber
Steel
Steil
Steube
Stewart
Taylor
Tenney
Tiffany
Timmons
Van Drew
Van Duyne
Wagner
Walorski
Weber (TX)
Webster (FL)
Wenstrup
Williams (TX)
Wilson (SC)
Zeldin

ANSWERED ''PRESENT''—1

McCollum

NOT VOTING—3

Casten
Guest
Miller (IL)

□ 1723

Messrs. MULLIN, BERGMAN, Mrs. HARTZLER, Messrs. ZELDIN, AMODEI, LARSON of Connecticut, JOHNSON of Louisiana, GALLAGHER, and Ms. MALLIOTAKIS changed their vote from ''yea'' to ''nay.''

Mr. CALVERT, Ms. HERRERA BEUTLER, Mr. MCHENRY, and Mrs. RODGERS of Washington changed their vote from ''nay'' to ''yea.''

So the en bloc amendments were agreed to.

The result of the vote was announced as above recorded.

MEMBERS RECORDED PURSUANT TO HOUSE RESOLUTION 8, 117TH CONGRESS

Amodei (Balderson)
Bustos (Mrvan)
Carter (TX) (Weber (TX))
Correa (Huffman)
Crist (Wasserman Schultz)
Davids (KS) (Neguse)
Davis, Danny K. (Beyer)
Deutch (Rice (NY))
Evans (Beyer)
Gonzalez (OH) (Meijer)
Granger (Weber (TX))
Johnson (GA) (Manning)
Johnson (TX) (Jeffries)
Kahele (Mrvan)
Kelly (IL) (Neguse)
Khanna (Watson Coleman)
Lamb (Blunt Rochester)
Lawrence (Stevens)
Lawson (FL) (Wasserman Schultz)
Lynch (Langevin)
Mace (Carter (GA))
McEachin (Beyer)
Moore (WI) (Beyer)
Nadler (Pallone)
Newman (Beyer)
O'Halleran (Schrader)
Palazzo (Fleischmann)
Payne (Pallone)
Peters (Jeffries)
Pingree (Wasserman Schultz)
Price (NC) (Manning)
Rice (SC) (Meijer)
Schneider (Stevens)
Speier (Huffman)
Stanton (Huffman)
Suozzi (Beyer)
Taylor (Van Duyne)
Tenney (Jackson)
Titus (Pallone)
Walorski (Bucshon)
Waters (Takano)
Wilson (FL) (Neguse)

AMENDMENTS EN BLOC NO. 2 OFFERED BY MRS. DINGELL OF MICHIGAN

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Pursuant to clause 8 of rule XX, the unfinished business is the question on the adoption of amendments en bloc No. 2, printed in part D of House Report 117–366, on which further proceedings were postponed and on which the yeas and nays were ordered.

The Clerk will redesignate the amendments en bloc.

The Clerk redesignated the amendments en bloc.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The question is on the amendments en bloc offered by the gentlewoman from Michigan (Mrs. DINGELL).

This is a 5-minute vote.

The vote was taken by electronic device, and there were—yeas 412, nays 8, not voting 7, as follows:

[Roll No. 263]

YEAS—412

Adams
Aderholt
Aguilar
Allen
Allred
Amodei
Armstrong
Arrington
Auchincloss
Axne
Babin
Bacon
Baird
Balderson
Banks
Barr
Barragán
Bass
Beatty
Bentz
Bera
Bergman
Beyer
Bice (OK)
Biggs
Bilirakis
Bishop (GA)
Bishop (NC)
Blumenauer
Blunt Rochester
Boebert
Bonamici
Bost
Bourdeaux
Bowman
Boyle, Brendan F.
Brady
Brooks
Brown (MD)
Brown (OH)
Brownley
Buchanan
Buck
Bucshon
Budd
Burchett
Burgess
Bush
Bustos
Butterfield
Cammack
Carbajal
Cárdenas
Carey
Carl
Carson
Carter (GA)
Carter (LA)
Carter (TX)
Cartwright
Case
Castor (FL)
Castro (TX)
Cawthorn
Chabot
Cheney
Cherfilus-McCormick
Chu
Cicilline
Clark (MA)
Clarke (NY)
Cleaver
Cline
Cloud
Clyburn
Clyde
Cohen
Cole
Comer
Connolly
Cooper
Correa
Costa
Courtney
Craig
Crawford
Crenshaw
Crist
Crow
Cuellar
Curtis
Davids (KS)
Davidson
Davis, Danny K.
Davis, Rodney
Dean
DeFazio
DeGette
DelBene
Demings
DeSaulnier
DesJarlais
Deutch
Diaz-Balart
Dingell
Doggett
Donalds
Doyle, Michael F.
Duncan
Dunn
Ellzey
Emmer
Escobar
Eshoo
Espaillat
Evans
Fallon
Feenstra
Ferguson
Fischbach
Fitzgerald
Fitzpatrick
Fleischmann
Fletcher
Foster
Foxx
Frankel, Lois
Franklin, C. Scott
Fulcher
Gaetz
Gallagher
Gallego
Garamendi
Garbarino
Garcia (CA)
García (IL)
Garcia (TX)

Gibbs
Gimenez
Gohmert
Golden
Gomez
Gonzales, Tony
Gonzalez (OH)
Gonzalez, Vicente
Good (VA)
Gooden (TX)
Gosar
Gottheimer
Granger
Graves (LA)
Graves (MO)
Green (TN)
Green, Al (TX)
Greene (GA)
Griffith
Grijalva
Grothman
Guthrie
Harder (CA)
Harris
Harshbarger
Hartzler
Hayes
Hern
Herrell
Herrera Beutler
Hice (GA)
Higgins (LA)
Higgins (NY)
Hill
Himes
Hinson
Hollingsworth
Horsford
Houlahan
Hoyer
Hudson
Huffman
Huizenga
Issa
Jackson
Jackson Lee
Jacobs (NY)
Jayapal
Jeffries
Johnson (GA)
Johnson (LA)
Johnson (OH)
Johnson (SD)
Johnson (TX)
Jones
Jordan
Joyce (OH)
Joyce (PA)
Kahele
Kaptur
Katko
Keating
Keller
Kelly (IL)
Kelly (MS)
Kelly (PA)
Khanna
Kildee
Kilmer
Kim (CA)
Kim (NJ)
Kinzinger
Kirkpatrick
Krishnamoorthi
Kuster
Kustoff
LaHood
LaMalfa
Lamb
Lamborn
Langevin
Larsen (WA)
Latta
LaTurner
Lawrence
Lawson (FL)
Lee (CA)
Lee (NV)
Leger Fernandez
Lesko
Letlow
Levin (CA)
Levin (MI)
Lieu
Lofgren
Long
Loudermilk
Lowenthal
Lucas
Luetkemeyer
Luria
Lynch
Mace
Malinowski
Malliotakis
Maloney, Carolyn B.
Maloney, Sean
Mann
Manning
Massie
Mast
Matsui
McBath
McCarthy
McCaul
McClain
McClintock
McCollum
McEachin
McGovern
McHenry
McKinley
McNerney
Meijer
Meng
Meuser
Mfume
Miller (WV)
Miller-Meeks
Moolenaar
Mooney
Moore (AL)
Moore (UT)
Moore (WI)
Morelle
Moulton
Mrvan
Mullin
Murphy (FL)
Murphy (NC)
Nadler
Napolitano
Neal
Neguse
Nehls
Newhouse
Newman
Norcross
Norman
Obernolte
Ocasio-Cortez
Omar
Owens
Palazzo
Pallone
Palmer
Panetta
Pappas
Pascrell
Payne
Pence
Perlmutter
Perry
Peters
Pfluger
Phillips
Pingree
Porter
Posey
Pressley
Price (NC)
Quigley
Raskin
Reschenthaler
Rice (NY)
Rice (SC)
Rodgers (WA)
Rogers (AL)
Rogers (KY)
Rose
Rosendale
Ross
Rouzer
Roy
Roybal-Allard
Ruiz
Ruppersberger
Rush
Rutherford
Ryan
Salazar
Sánchez
Sarbanes
Scalise
Scanlon
Schakowsky
Schiff
Schneider
Schrader
Schrier
Schweikert
Scott (VA)
Scott, Austin
Scott, David
Sessions
Sewell
Sherman
Sherrill
Simpson
Sires
Slotkin
Smith (MO)
Smith (NE)
Smith (NJ)
Smith (WA)
Smucker
Soto
Spartz
Speier
Stansbury
Stanton
Stauber
Steel
Stefanik
Steil
Steube
Stevens
Stewart
Strickland
Suozzi
Swalwell
Takano
Taylor
Tenney
Thompson (CA)
Thompson (MS)
Thompson (PA)
Tiffany
Timmons
Titus
Tlaib
Tonko
Torres (CA)
Torres (NY)
Trahan
Trone
Turner
Underwood
Upton
Valadao
Van Drew
Van Duyne
Vargas
Veasey
Velázquez
Wagner
Walberg
Walorski
Waltz
Wasserman Schultz
Watson Coleman
Weber (TX)
Webster (FL)
Welch
Wenstrup
Westerman
Wexton
Wild
Williams (GA)
Williams (TX)
Wilson (SC)
Wittman
Womack
Yarmuth
Zeldin

NAYS—8

DeLauro
Kind
Larson (CT)
O'Halleran
Pocan
Spanberger
Waters
Wilson (FL)

NOT VOTING—7

Calvert
Casten
Estes
Guest
Jacobs (CA)
Meeks
Miller (IL)

□ 1733

So the en bloc amendments were agreed to.

The result of the vote was announced as above recorded.

MEMBERS RECORDED PURSUANT TO HOUSE RESOLUTION 8, 117TH CONGRESS

Amodei (Balderson)
Bustos (Mrvan)
Carter (TX) (Weber (TX))
Correa (Huffman)
Crist (Wasserman Schultz)
Davids (KS) (Neguse)
Davis, Danny K. (Beyer)
Deutch (Rice (NY))
Evans (Beyer)
Gonzalez (OH) (Meijer)
Granger (Weber (TX))
Johnson (GA) (Manning)
Johnson (TX) (Jeffries)
Kahele (Mrvan)
Kelly (IL) (Neguse)
Khanna (Watson Coleman)
Lamb (Blunt Rochester)
Lawrence (Stevens)
Lawson (FL) (Wasserman Schultz)
Lynch (Langevin)
Mace (Carter (GA))
McEachin (Beyer)
Moore (WI) (Beyer)
Nadler (Pallone)
Newman (Beyer)
O'Halleran (Schrader)
Palazzo (Fleischmann)
Payne (Pallone)
Peters (Jeffries)
Pingree (Wasserman Schultz)
Price (NC) (Manning)
Rice (SC) (Meijer)
Schneider (Stevens)
Stanton (Huffman)
Suozzi (Beyer)
Taylor (Van Duyne)
Tenney (Jackson)
Titus (Pallone)
Walorski (Bucshon)
Waters (Takano)
Wilson (FL) (Neguse)

AMENDMENT NO. 4 OFFERED BY MR. KILDEE

The SPEAKER pro tempore (Mr. PANETTA). Pursuant to clause 8 of rule XX, the unfinished business is the question on amendment No. 4, printed in part D of House Report 117–366, on which further proceedings were postponed and on which the yeas and nays were ordered.

The Clerk will redesignate the amendment.

The Clerk redesignated the amendment.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The question is on the amendment offered by the gentleman from Michigan (Mr. KILDEE).

This is a 5-minute vote.

The vote was taken by electronic device, and there were—yeas 231, nays 189, not voting 7, as follows:

[Roll No. 264]

YEAS—231

Adams
Aguilar
Allred
Auchincloss
Axne
Barragán
Bass
Beatty
Bera
Bergman
Beyer
Bishop (GA)
Blumenauer
Blunt Rochester
Bonamici
Bourdeaux
Bowman
Boyle, Brendan F.
Brown (MD)
Brown (OH)
Brownley
Bush
Bustos
Butterfield
Carbajal
Cárdenas
Carson
Carter (LA)
Cartwright
Case
Castor (FL)
Castro (TX)
Cherfilus-McCormick
Chu
Cicilline
Clark (MA)
Clarke (NY)
Cleaver
Clyburn
Cohen
Connolly
Cooper
Correa
Costa
Courtney
Craig
Crist
Crow
Cuellar
Davids (KS)
Davis, Danny K.
Dean
DeFazio
DeGette
DelBene
Demings
DeSaulnier
Deutch
Dingell
Doggett
Doyle, Michael F.
Escobar
Eshoo
Espaillat
Evans
Fitzpatrick
Fletcher
Foster
Frankel, Lois
Gaetz
Gallego
Garamendi
García (IL)
Garcia (TX)
Gohmert
Golden
Gomez
Gonzalez, Vicente
Gottheimer
Green, Al (TX)
Grijalva
Harder (CA)
Harris
Hayes
Higgins (NY)
Hill
Himes
Horsford
Houlahan
Hoyer
Huffman
Huizenga
Jackson Lee
Jacobs (NY)
Jayapal
Jeffries
Johnson (GA)
Johnson (TX)
Jones
Kahele
Kaptur
Katko
Keating
Kelly (IL)
Khanna
Kildee
Kilmer
Kim (NJ)
Kind
Kinzinger
Kirkpatrick
Krishnamoorthi
Kuster
Lamb
Langevin
Larsen (WA)
Larson (CT)
Lawrence
Lawson (FL)
Lee (CA)
Lee (NV)
Leger Fernandez
Levin (CA)
Levin (MI)
Lieu
Lofgren
Lowenthal
Luria
Lynch
Malinowski
Maloney, Carolyn B.
Maloney, Sean
Manning
Matsui
McBath
McClintock
McCollum
McEachin
McGovern
McKinley
McNerney
Meijer
Meng
Mfume
Moore (WI)
Morelle
Moulton
Mrvan
Murphy (FL)
Nadler
Napolitano
Neal
Neguse
Newman
Norcross
O'Halleran
Ocasio-Cortez
Omar
Pallone
Panetta
Pappas
Pascrell
Payne
Perlmutter
Peters
Phillips
Pingree
Pocan
Porter
Pressley
Price (NC)
Quigley
Raskin
Rice (NY)
Ross
Roybal-Allard
Ruiz
Ruppersberger
Rush
Ryan
Salazar
Sánchez
Sarbanes
Scanlon
Schakowsky
Schiff
Schneider
Schrader
Schrier
Scott (VA)
Scott, David
Sewell
Sherman
Sherrill
Sires
Slotkin
Smith (WA)
Soto
Spanberger
Speier
Stansbury
Stanton
Stevens
Strickland
Suozzi
Swalwell
Takano
Thompson (CA)
Thompson (MS)
Titus
Tlaib
Tonko
Torres (CA)
Torres (NY)
Trahan
Trone
Underwood
Upton
Vargas
Veasey
Velázquez
Walberg
Wasserman Schultz
Waters
Watson Coleman
Welch
Wexton
Wild
Williams (GA)
Wilson (FL)
Yarmuth

NAYS—189

Aderholt
Allen
Amodei
Armstrong
Arrington
Babin
Bacon
Baird
Balderson
Banks
Barr
Bentz
Bice (OK)
Biggs
Bilirakis
Bishop (NC)
Boebert
Bost
Brady
Brooks
Buchanan
Buck
Bucshon
Budd
Burchett
Burgess
Calvert
Cammack
Carey
Carl
Carter (GA)
Carter (TX)
Cawthorn
Chabot
Cheney
Cline
Cloud
Clyde
Cole
Comer
Crawford
Crenshaw
Curtis
Davidson
Davis, Rodney
DeLauro
DesJarlais
Diaz-Balart
Duncan
Dunn
Ellzey
Emmer
Fallon
Feenstra
Ferguson
Fischbach
Fitzgerald
Fleischmann
Foxx
Franklin, C. Scott
Fulcher
Gallagher
Garbarino
Garcia (CA)
Gibbs
Gimenez
Gonzales, Tony
Gonzalez (OH)
Good (VA)
Gooden (TX)
Gosar
Granger
Graves (LA)
Graves (MO)
Green (TN)
Greene (GA)
Griffith
Grothman
Guthrie
Harshbarger
Hartzler
Hern
Herrell
Herrera Beutler
Hice (GA)
Higgins (LA)
Hinson
Hollingsworth
Hudson
Issa
Jackson
Johnson (LA)
Johnson (OH)
Johnson (SD)
Jordan
Joyce (OH)
Joyce (PA)
Keller
Kelly (MS)
Kelly (PA)
Kim (CA)
Kustoff
LaHood
LaMalfa
Lamborn
Latta
LaTurner
Lesko
Letlow
Long
Loudermilk
Lucas
Luetkemeyer
Mace
Malliotakis
Mann
Massie
Mast
McCarthy
McCaul
McClain
McHenry
Meuser
Miller (WV)
Miller-Meeks
Moolenaar
Mooney
Moore (AL)
Moore (UT)
Mullin
Murphy (NC)
Nehls
Newhouse
Norman

Obernolte
Owens
Palazzo
Palmer
Pence
Perry
Pfluger
Posey
Reschenthaler
Rice (SC)
Rodgers (WA)
Rogers (AL)
Rogers (KY)
Rose
Rosendale
Rouzer
Roy
Rutherford
Scalise
Schweikert
Scott, Austin
Sessions
Simpson
Smith (MO)
Smith (NE)
Smith (NJ)
Smucker
Spartz
Stauber
Steel
Stefanik
Steil
Steube
Stewart
Taylor
Tenney
Thompson (PA)
Tiffany
Timmons
Turner
Valadao
Van Drew
Van Duyne
Wagner
Walorski
Waltz
Weber (TX)
Webster (FL)
Wenstrup
Westerman
Williams (TX)
Wilson (SC)
Wittman
Womack
Zeldin

NOT VOTING—7

Casten
Donalds
Estes
Guest
Jacobs (CA)
Meeks
Miller (IL)

□ 1742

Mr. BACON changed his vote from ''yea'' to ''nay.''

So the amendment was agreed to.

The result of the vote was announced as above recorded.

MEMBERS RECORDED PURSUANT TO HOUSE RESOLUTION 8, 117TH CONGRESS

Amodei (Balderson)
Bustos (Mrvan)
Carter (TX) (Weber (TX))
Correa (Huffman)
Crist (Wasserman Schultz)
Davids (KS) (Neguse)
Davis, Danny K. (Beyer)
Deutch (Rice (NY))
Evans (Beyer)
Gonzalez (OH) (Meijer)
Granger (Weber (TX))
Johnson (GA) (Manning)
Johnson (TX) (Jeffries)
Kahele (Mrvan)
Kelly (IL) (Neguse)
Khanna (Watson Coleman)
Lamb (Blunt Rochester)
Lawrence (Stevens)
Lawson (FL) (Wasserman Schultz)
Lynch (Langevin)
Mace (Carter (GA))
McEachin (Beyer)
Moore (WI) (Beyer)
Nadler (Pallone)
Newman (Beyer)
O'Halleran (Schrader)
Palazzo (Fleischmann)
Payne (Pallone)
Peters (Jeffries)
Pingree (Wasserman Schultz)
Price (NC) (Manning)
Rice (SC) (Meijer)
Schneider (Stevens)
Stanton (Huffman)
Suozzi (Beyer)
Taylor (Van Duyne)
Tenney (Jackson)
Titus (Pallone)
Walorski (Bucshon)
Waters (Takano)
Wilson (FL) (Neguse)

AMENDMENT NO. 5 OFFERED BY MR. BUTTERFIELD

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Pursuant to clause 8 of rule XX, the unfinished business is the question on amendment No. 5, printed in part D of House Report 117–366, on which further proceedings were postponed and on which the yeas and nays were ordered.

The Clerk will redesignate the amendment.

The Clerk redesignated the amendment.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The question is on the amendment offered by the gentleman from North Carolina (Mr. BUTTERFIELD).

This is a 5-minute vote.

The vote was taken by electronic device, and there were—yeas 216, nays 206, not voting 5, as follows:

[Roll No. 265]

YEAS—216

Adams
Aguilar
Allred
Auchincloss
Axne
Barragán
Bass
Beatty
Bera
Beyer
Bishop (GA)
Blumenauer
Blunt Rochester
Bonamici
Bourdeaux
Bowman
Boyle, Brendan F.
Brown (MD)
Brown (OH)
Brownley
Bush
Bustos
Butterfield
Carbajal
Cárdenas
Carson
Carter (LA)
Cartwright
Case
Castor (FL)
Castro (TX)
Cherfilus-McCormick
Chu
Cicilline
Clark (MA)
Clarke (NY)
Cleaver
Clyburn
Cohen
Connolly
Cooper
Correa
Costa
Courtney
Craig
Crist
Crow
Cuellar
Davids (KS)
Davis, Danny K.
Dean
DeFazio
DeGette
DelBene
Demings
DeSaulnier
Deutch
Dingell
Doggett
Doyle, Michael F.
Escobar
Eshoo
Espaillat
Evans
Fitzpatrick
Fletcher
Foster
Frankel, Lois
Gallego
Garamendi
García (IL)
Garcia (TX)
Gohmert
Gomez
Gonzalez, Vicente
Gottheimer
Green, Al (TX)
Grijalva
Harder (CA)
Hayes
Higgins (NY)
Himes
Horsford
Houlahan
Hoyer
Huffman
Jackson Lee
Jacobs (NY)
Jayapal
Jeffries
Johnson (GA)
Johnson (TX)
Jones
Kahele
Kaptur
Katko
Keating
Kelly (IL)
Khanna
Kildee
Kilmer
Kim (NJ)
Kind
Kirkpatrick
Krishnamoorthi
Kuster
Lamb
Langevin
Larsen (WA)
Larson (CT)
Lawrence
Lawson (FL)
Lee (CA)
Lee (NV)
Leger Fernandez
Levin (CA)
Levin (MI)
Lieu
Lofgren
Lowenthal
Luria
Lynch
Malinowski
Maloney, Carolyn B.
Maloney, Sean
Manning
Matsui
McBath
McCollum
McEachin
McGovern
McNerney
Meeks
Meng
Mfume
Moore (WI)
Morelle
Moulton
Mrvan
Murphy (FL)
Nadler
Napolitano
Neal
Neguse
Newman
Norcross
O'Halleran
Ocasio-Cortez
Omar
Pallone
Panetta
Pappas
Pascrell
Payne
Perlmutter
Peters
Phillips
Pingree
Pocan
Porter
Pressley
Price (NC)
Quigley
Raskin
Rice (NY)
Ross
Roybal-Allard
Ruiz
Ruppersberger
Rush
Ryan
Sánchez
Sarbanes
Scanlon
Schakowsky
Schiff
Schneider
Schrier
Scott (VA)
Scott, David
Sewell
Sherman
Sherrill
Sires
Smith (WA)
Soto
Spanberger
Speier
Stansbury
Stanton
Stevens
Strickland
Suozzi
Swalwell
Takano
Thompson (CA)
Thompson (MS)
Titus
Tlaib
Tonko
Torres (CA)
Torres (NY)
Trahan
Trone
Underwood
Vargas
Veasey
Velázquez
Wasserman Schultz
Waters
Watson Coleman
Welch
Wexton
Williams (GA)
Wilson (FL)
Yarmuth

NAYS—206

Aderholt
Allen
Amodei
Armstrong
Arrington
Babin
Bacon
Baird
Balderson
Banks
Barr
Bentz
Bergman
Bice (OK)
Biggs
Bilirakis
Bishop (NC)
Boebert
Bost
Brady
Brooks
Buchanan
Buck
Bucshon
Budd
Burchett
Burgess
Calvert
Cammack
Carey
Carl
Carter (GA)
Carter (TX)
Cawthorn
Chabot
Cheney
Cline
Cloud
Clyde
Cole
Comer
Crawford
Crenshaw
Curtis
Davidson
Davis, Rodney
DeLauro
DesJarlais
Diaz-Balart
Donalds
Duncan
Dunn
Ellzey
Emmer
Fallon
Feenstra
Ferguson
Fischbach
Fitzgerald
Fleischmann
Foxx
Franklin, C. Scott
Fulcher
Gaetz
Gallagher
Garbarino
Garcia (CA)
Gibbs
Gimenez
Golden
Gonzales, Tony
Gonzalez (OH)
Good (VA)
Gooden (TX)
Gosar
Granger
Graves (LA)
Graves (MO)
Green (TN)
Greene (GA)
Griffith
Grothman
Guthrie
Harris
Harshbarger
Hartzler
Hern
Herrell
Herrera Beutler
Hice (GA)
Higgins (LA)
Hill
Hinson
Hollingsworth
Hudson
Huizenga
Issa
Jackson
Johnson (LA)
Johnson (OH)
Johnson (SD)
Jordan
Joyce (OH)
Joyce (PA)
Keller
Kelly (MS)
Kelly (PA)
Kim (CA)
Kinzinger
Kustoff
LaHood
LaMalfa
Lamborn
Latta
LaTurner
Lesko
Letlow
Long
Loudermilk
Lucas
Luetkemeyer
Mace
Malliotakis
Mann
Massie
Mast
McCarthy
McCaul
McClain
McClintock
McHenry
McKinley
Meijer
Meuser
Miller (WV)
Miller-Meeks
Moolenaar
Mooney
Moore (AL)
Moore (UT)
Mullin
Murphy (NC)
Nehls
Newhouse
Norman
Obernolte
Owens
Palazzo
Palmer
Pence
Perry
Pfluger
Posey
Reschenthaler
Rice (SC)
Rodgers (WA)
Rogers (AL)
Rogers (KY)
Rose
Rosendale
Rouzer
Roy
Rutherford
Salazar
Scalise
Schrader
Schweikert
Scott, Austin
Sessions
Simpson
Slotkin
Smith (MO)
Smith (NE)
Smith (NJ)
Smucker
Spartz
Stauber
Steel
Stefanik
Steil
Steube
Stewart
Taylor
Tenney
Thompson (PA)
Tiffany
Timmons
Turner
Upton
Valadao
Van Drew
Van Duyne
Wagner
Walberg
Walorski
Waltz
Weber (TX)
Webster (FL)
Wenstrup
Westerman
Wild
Williams (TX)
Wilson (SC)
Wittman
Womack
Zeldin

NOT VOTING—5

Casten
Estes
Guest
Jacobs (CA)
Miller (IL)

□ 1750

So the amendment was agreed to.

The result of the vote was announced as above recorded.

MEMBERS RECORDED PURSUANT TO HOUSE RESOLUTION 8, 117TH CONGRESS

Amodei (Balderson)
Bustos (Mrvan)
Carter (TX) (Weber (TX))
Correa (Huffman)
Crist (Wasserman Schultz)
Davids (KS) (Neguse)
Davis, Danny K. (Beyer)
Deutch (Rice (NY))
Evans (Beyer)
Gonzalez (OH) (Meijer)
Granger (Weber (TX))
Johnson (GA) (Manning)
Johnson (TX) (Jeffries)
Kahele (Mrvan)
Kelly (IL) (Neguse)
Khanna (Watson Coleman)
Lamb (Blunt Rochester)
Lawrence (Stevens)
Lawson (FL) (Wasserman Schultz)
Lynch (Langevin)
Mace (Carter (GA))
McEachin (Beyer)
Meeks (Jeffries)
Moore (WI) (Beyer)
Nadler (Pallone)
Newman (Beyer)
O'Halleran (Schrader)
Palazzo (Fleischmann)
Payne (Pallone)
Peters (Jeffries)
Pingree (Wasserman Schultz)
Price (NC) (Manning)
Rice (SC) (Meijer)
Schneider (Stevens)
Stanton (Huffman)
Suozzi (Beyer)
Taylor (Van Duyne)
Tenney (Jackson)
Titus (Pallone)
Walorski (Bucshon)
Waters (Takano)
Wilson (FL) (Neguse)

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The previous question is ordered on the bill, as amended.

The question is on the engrossment and third reading of the bill.

The bill was ordered to be engrossed and read a third time, and was read the third time.

MOTION TO RECOMMIT

Mr. FULCHER. Mr. Speaker, I have a motion to recommit at the desk.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The Clerk will report the motion to recommit.

The Clerk read as follows:

Mr. Fulcher of Idaho moves to recommit the bill H.R. 2773 to the Committee on Natural Resources.

The material previously referred to by Mr. RESCHENTHALER is as follows:

Page 7, line 15, strike ''and''.

page 7, line 20, strike the period and insert ''; and''.

Page 7, after line 20, insert the following new subparagraph:

''(H) may be used for forest management activities, including mechanical thinning and prescribed burning, where the primary purpose of such activity is to modify, improve, enhance, or create wildlife habitat or reduce the risk of damage or destruction to wildlife habitat due to wildfires, insects, or disease.''.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Pursuant to clause 2(b) of rule XIX, the previous question is ordered on the motion to recommit.

The question is on the motion to recommit.

The question was taken; and the Speaker pro tempore announced that the noes appeared to have it.

Mr. FULCHER. Mr. Speaker, on that I demand the yeas and nays.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Pursuant to section 3(s) of House Resolution 8, the yeas and nays are ordered.

This will be a 5-minute vote.

The vote was taken by electronic device, and there were—yeas 202, nays 220, not voting 5, as follows:

[Roll No. 266]

YEAS—202

Aderholt
Allen
Amodei
Armstrong
Arrington
Babin
Bacon
Baird
Balderson
Banks
Barr
Bentz
Bergman
Bice (OK)
Biggs
Bilirakis
Bishop (NC)
Boebert
Bost
Brady
Brooks
Buchanan
Buck
Bucshon
Budd
Burchett
Burgess
Calvert
Cammack
Carey
Carl
Carter (GA)
Carter (TX)
Cawthorn
Chabot
Cheney
Cline
Cloud
Clyde
Cole
Comer
Crawford
Crenshaw
Curtis
Davidson
Davis, Rodney
DesJarlais
Diaz-Balart
Donalds
Duncan
Dunn
Ellzey
Emmer
Fallon
Feenstra
Ferguson
Fischbach
Fitzgerald
Fitzpatrick
Fleischmann
Foxx
Franklin, C. Scott
Fulcher
Gaetz
Gallagher
Garbarino
Garcia (CA)
Gibbs
Gimenez
Gohmert
Gonzales, Tony
Gonzalez (OH)
Good (VA)
Gooden (TX)
Gosar
Granger
Graves (LA)
Graves (MO)
Green (TN)
Greene (GA)
Griffith
Grothman
Guthrie
Harris
Harshbarger
Hartzler
Hern
Herrell
Herrera Beutler
Higgins (LA)
Hill
Hinson
Hollingsworth
Hudson
Huizenga
Issa
Jackson
Jacobs (NY)
Johnson (LA)
Johnson (OH)
Johnson (SD)
Jordan
Joyce (OH)
Joyce (PA)
Katko
Keller
Kelly (MS)
Kelly (PA)
Kim (CA)
Kinzinger
Kustoff
LaMalfa
Lamborn
Latta
LaTurner
Lesko
Letlow
Long
Loudermilk
Lucas
Luetkemeyer
Mace
Malliotakis
Mann
Massie
Mast
McCarthy
McCaul
McClain
McClintock
McHenry
McKinley
Meijer
Meuser
Miller (WV)
Miller-Meeks
Moolenaar
Mooney
Moore (AL)
Moore (UT)
Mullin
Murphy (NC)
Nehls
Newhouse
Norman
Obernolte
Owens
Palazzo
Palmer
Pence
Perry
Pfluger
Posey
Reschenthaler
Rice (SC)
Rodgers (WA)
Rogers (AL)
Rogers (KY)
Rose
Rosendale
Rouzer
Rutherford
Salazar
Scalise
Schweikert
Scott, Austin
Sessions
Simpson
Smith (MO)
Smith (NE)
Smith (NJ)
Smucker
Spartz
Stauber
Steel
Stefanik
Steil
Steube
Stewart
Taylor
Tenney
Thompson (PA)
Tiffany
Timmons
Turner
Upton
Valadao
Van Drew
Van Duyne
Wagner
Walberg
Walorski
Waltz
Weber (TX)
Webster (FL)
Wenstrup
Westerman
Williams (TX)
Wilson (SC)
Wittman
Womack
Zeldin

NAYS—220

Adams
Aguilar
Allred
Auchincloss
Axne
Barragán
Bass
Beatty
Bera
Beyer
Bishop (GA)
Blumenauer
Blunt Rochester
Bonamici
Bourdeaux
Bowman
Boyle, Brendan F.
Brown (MD)
Brown (OH)
Brownley
Bush
Bustos
Butterfield
Carbajal
Cárdenas
Carson
Carter (LA)
Cartwright
Case
Castor (FL)
Castro (TX)
Cherfilus-McCormick
Chu
Cicilline
Clark (MA)
Clarke (NY)
Cleaver
Clyburn
Cohen
Connolly
Cooper
Correa
Costa
Courtney
Craig
Crist
Crow
Cuellar
Davids (KS)
Davis, Danny K.
Dean
DeFazio
DeGette
DeLauro
DelBene
Demings
DeSaulnier
Deutch
Dingell
Doggett
Doyle, Michael F.
Escobar
Eshoo
Espaillat
Evans
Fletcher
Foster
Frankel, Lois
Gallego
Garamendi
García (IL)
Garcia (TX)
Golden
Gomez
Gonzalez, Vicente
Gottheimer
Green, Al (TX)
Grijalva
Harder (CA)
Hayes
Hice (GA)
Higgins (NY)
Himes
Horsford
Houlahan
Hoyer
Huffman
Jackson Lee
Jayapal
Jeffries
Johnson (GA)
Johnson (TX)
Jones
Kahele
Kaptur
Keating
Kelly (IL)
Khanna
Kildee
Kilmer
Kim (NJ)
Kind
Kirkpatrick
Krishnamoorthi
Kuster
LaHood
Lamb
Langevin
Larsen (WA)
Larson (CT)
Lawrence
Lawson (FL)
Lee (CA)
Lee (NV)
Leger Fernandez
Levin (CA)
Levin (MI)
Lieu
Lofgren
Lowenthal
Luria
Lynch
Malinowski
Maloney, Carolyn B.
Maloney, Sean
Manning
Matsui
McBath
McCollum
McEachin
McGovern
McNerney
Meeks
Meng
Mfume
Moore (WI)
Morelle
Moulton
Mrvan
Murphy (FL)
Nadler
Napolitano
Neal
Neguse
Newman
Norcross
O'Halleran
Ocasio-Cortez
Omar
Pallone
Panetta
Pappas
Pascrell
Payne
Perlmutter
Peters
Phillips
Pingree
Pocan
Porter
Pressley
Price (NC)
Quigley
Raskin
Rice (NY)
Ross
Roy
Roybal-Allard
Ruiz
Ruppersberger
Rush
Ryan
Sánchez
Sarbanes
Scanlon
Schakowsky
Schiff
Schneider
Schrader
Schrier
Scott (VA)
Scott, David
Sewell
Sherman
Sherrill
Sires
Slotkin
Smith (WA)
Soto
Spanberger
Speier
Stansbury
Stanton
Stevens
Strickland
Suozzi
Swalwell
Takano
Thompson (CA)
Thompson (MS)
Titus
Tlaib
Tonko
Torres (CA)
Torres (NY)
Trahan
Trone
Underwood
Vargas
Veasey
Velázquez
Wasserman Schultz
Waters
Watson Coleman
Welch
Wexton
Wild
Williams (GA)
Wilson (FL)
Yarmuth

NOT VOTING—5

Casten
Estes
Guest
Jacobs (CA)
Miller (IL)

□ 1759

So the motion to recommit was rejected.

The result of the vote was announced as above recorded.

MEMBERS RECORDED PURSUANT TO HOUSE RESOLUTION 8, 117TH CONGRESS

Amodei (Balderson)
Bustos (Mrvan)
Carter (TX) (Weber (TX))
Correa (Huffman)
Crist (Wasserman Schultz)
Davids (KS) (Neguse)
Davis, Danny K. (Beyer)
Deutch (Rice (NY))
Evans (Beyer)
Gonzalez (OH) (Meijer)
Granger (Weber (TX))
Johnson (GA) (Manning)
Johnson (TX) (Jeffries)
Kahele (Mrvan)
Kelly (IL) (Neguse)
Khanna (Watson Coleman)
Lamb (Blunt Rochester)
Lawrence (Stevens)
Lawson (FL) (Wasserman Schultz)
Lynch (Langevin)
Mace (Carter (GA))
McEachin (Beyer)
Meeks (Jeffries)
Moore (WI) (Beyer)
Nadler (Pallone)
Newman (Beyer)
O'Halleran (Schrader)
Palazzo (Fleischmann)
Payne (Pallone)
Peters (Jeffries)
Pingree (Wasserman Schultz)
Price (NC) (Manning)
Rice (SC) (Meijer)
Schneider (Stevens)
Stanton (Huffman)
Suozzi (Beyer)
Taylor (Van Duyne)
Tenney (Jackson)
Titus (Pallone)
Walorski (Bucshon)
Waters (Takano)
Wilson (FL) (Neguse)

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The question is on the passage of the bill.

The question was taken; and the Speaker pro tempore announced that the ayes appeared to have it.

Mr. WESTERMAN. Mr. Speaker, on that I demand the yeas and nays.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Pursuant to section 3(s) of House Resolution 8, the yeas and nays are ordered.

This is a 5-minute vote.

The vote was taken by electronic device, and there were—yeas 231, nays 190, not voting 6, as follows:

[Roll No. 267]

YEAS—231

Adams
Aguilar
Allred
Auchincloss
Axne
Barragán
Bass
Beatty
Bera
Beyer
Bishop (GA)
Blumenauer
Blunt Rochester
Bonamici
Bourdeaux
Bowman
Boyle, Brendan F.
Brown (MD)
Brown (OH)
Brownley
Bush
Bustos
Butterfield
Carbajal
Cárdenas
Carson
Carter (LA)
Cartwright
Case
Castor (FL)
Castro (TX)
Cherfilus-McCormick
Chu
Cicilline
Clark (MA)
Clarke (NY)
Cleaver
Clyburn
Cohen
Cole
Connolly
Cooper
Correa
Costa
Courtney
Craig
Crist
Crow
Cuellar
Davids (KS)
Davis, Danny K.
Dean
DeFazio
DeGette
DelBene
Demings
DeSaulnier
Deutch
Dingell
Doggett
Doyle, Michael F.
Escobar
Eshoo
Espaillat
Evans
Fitzpatrick
Fletcher
Foster
Frankel, Lois
Gallego
Garamendi
Garbarino
Garcia (IL)
Garcia (TX)
Golden
Gomez
Gonzalez, Vicente
Gottheimer
Green, Al (TX)
Grijalva
Harder (CA)
Hayes
Higgins (NY)
Hill
Himes
Horsford
Houlahan
Hoyer
Huffman
Jackson Lee
Jacobs (NY)
Jayapal
Jeffries
Johnson (GA)
Johnson (TX)
Jones
Joyce (OH)
Kahele
Kaptur
Katko
Keating
Kelly (IL)
Khanna
Kildee
Kilmer
Kim (CA)
Kim (NJ)
Kind
Kinzinger
Kirkpatrick
Krishnamoorthi
Kuster
Lamb
Langevin
Larsen (WA)
Lawrence
Lawson (FL)
Lee (CA)
Lee (NV)

Leger Fernandez
Levin (CA)
Levin (MI)
Lieu
Lofgren
Lowenthal
Luria
Lynch
Malinowski
Maloney, Carolyn B.
Maloney, Sean
Manning
Matsui
McBath
McCaul
McCollum
McEachin
McGovern
McKinley
McNerney
Meeks
Meijer
Meng
Mfume
Moore (WI)
Morelle
Moulton
Mrvan
Murphy (FL)
Nadler
Napolitano
Neal
Neguse
Newman
Norcross
O'Halleran
Ocasio-Cortez
Omar
Pallone
Panetta
Pappas
Pascrell
Payne
Perlmutter
Peters
Phillips
Pingree
Pocan
Porter
Pressley
Price (NC)
Quigley
Raskin
Rice (NY)
Ross
Roybal-Allard
Ruiz
Ruppersberger
Rush
Ryan
Salazar
Sánchez
Sarbanes
Scanlon
Scott (VA)
Scott, David
Sewell
Sherman
Sherrill
Simpson
Sires
Slotkin
Smith (WA)
Soto
Spanberger
Speier
Stansbury
Stanton
Stevens
Strickland
Suozzi
Swalwell
Takano
Thompson (CA)
Thompson (MS)
Titus
Tlaib
Tonko
Torres (CA)
Torres (NY)
Trahan
Trone
Turner
Underwood
Upton
Vargas
Veasey
Velázquez
Wasserman Schultz
Waters
Watson Coleman
Welch
Wexton
Wild
Williams (GA)
Wilson (FL)
Yarmuth

NAYS—190

Aderholt
Allen
Amodei
Armstrong
Arrington
Babin
Bacon
Baird
Balderson
Banks
Barr
Bentz
Bergman
Bice (OK)
Biggs
Bilirakis
Bishop (NC)
Boebert
Bost
Brady
Brooks
Buchanan
Buck
Bucshon
Budd
Burchett
Burgess
Calvert
Cammack
Carey
Carl
Carter (GA)
Carter (TX)
Cawthorn
Chabot
Cheney
Cline
Cloud
Clyde
Comer
Crawford
Crenshaw
Curtis
Davidson
Davis, Rodney
DeLauro
DesJarlais
Diaz-Balart
Donalds
Duncan
Dunn
Ellzey
Emmer
Fallon
Feenstra
Ferguson
Fischbach
Fitzgerald
Fleischmann
Foxx
Franklin, C. Scott
Fulcher
Gaetz
Gallagher
Garcia (CA)
Gibbs
Gimenez
Gohmert
Gonzales, Tony
Gonzalez (OH)
Good (VA)
Gooden (TX)
Gosar
Granger
Graves (LA)
Graves (MO)
Green (TN)
Greene (GA)
Griffith
Grothman
Guthrie
Harris
Harshbarger
Hartzler
Hern
Herrell
Herrera Beutler
Hice (GA)
Higgins (LA)
Hinson
Hollingsworth
Hudson
Huizenga
Issa
Jackson
Johnson (LA)
Johnson (OH)
Johnson (SD)
Jordan
Joyce (PA)
Keller
Kelly (MS)
Kelly (PA)
Kustoff
LaHood
LaMalfa
Lamborn
Larson (CT)
Latta
LaTurner
Lesko
Letlow
Long
Loudermilk
Lucas
Luetkemeyer
Mace
Malliotakis
Mann
Massie
Mast
McCarthy
McClain
McClintock
McHenry
Meuser
Miller (WV)
Miller-Meeks
Moolenaar
Mooney
Moore (AL)
Moore (UT)
Mullin
Murphy (NC)
Nehls
Newhouse
Norman
Obernolte
Owens
Palazzo
Palmer
Pence
Perry
Pfluger
Posey
Reschenthaler
Rice (SC)
Rodgers (WA)
Rogers (AL)
Rogers (KY)
Rose
Rosendale
Rouzer
Roy
Scalise
Schweikert
Scott, Austin
Sessions
Smith (MO)
Smith (NE)
Smith (NJ)
Smucker
Spartz
Stauber
Steel
Stefanik
Steil
Steube
Stewart
Taylor
Tenney
Thompson (PA)
Tiffany
Timmons
Valadao
Van Drew
Van Duyne
Wagner
Walberg
Walorski
Waltz
Weber (TX)
Webster (FL)
Wenstrup
Westerman
Williams (TX)
Wilson (SC)
Wittman
Womack
Zeldin

NOT VOTING—6

Casten
Estes
Guest
Jacobs (CA)
Miller (IL)
Rutherford

□ 1806

So the bill was passed.

The result of the vote was announced as above recorded.

A motion to reconsider was laid on the table.

Stated for:

Mr. LAHOOD. Mr. Speaker, I was recorded as "nay," but I intended to vote "yea" on rollcall No. 267.

MEMBERS RECORDED PURSUANT TO HOUSE RESOLUTION 8, 117TH CONGRESS

Amodei (Balderson)
Bustos (Mrvan)
Carter (TX) (Weber (TX))
Correa (Huffman)
Crist (Wasserman Schultz)
Davids (KS) (Neguse)
Davis, Danny K. (Beyer)
Deutch (Rice (NY))
Evans (Beyer)
Gonzalez (OH) (Meijer)
Granger (Weber (TX))
Johnson (GA) (Manning)
Johnson (TX) (Jeffries)
Kahele (Mrvan)
Kelly (IL) (Neguse)
Khanna (Watson Coleman)
Lamb (Blunt Rochester)
Lawrence (Stevens)
Lawson (FL) (Wasserman Schultz)
Lynch (Langevin)
Mace (Carter (GA))
McEachin (Beyer)
Meeks (Jeffries)
Moore (WI) (Beyer)
Nadler (Pallone)
Newman (Beyer)
O'Halleran (Schrader)
Palazzo (Fleischmann)
Payne (Pallone)
Peters (Jeffries)
Pingree (Wasserman Schultz)
Price (NC) (Manning)
Rice (SC) (Meijer)
Schneider (Stevens)
Stanton (Huffman)
Suozzi (Beyer)
Taylor (Van Duyne)
Tenney (Jackson)
Titus (Pallone)
Walorski (Bucshon)
Waters (Takano)
Wilson (FL) (Neguse)

ADVANCED AIR MOBILITY COORDINATION AND LEADERSHIP ACT

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Pursuant to clause 8 of rule XX, the unfinished business is the vote on the motion to suspend the rules and pass the bill (S. 516) to plan for and coordinate efforts to integrate advanced air mobility aircraft into the national airspace system, and for other purposes, as amended, on which the yeas and nays were ordered.

The Clerk read the title of the bill.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The question is on the motion offered by the gentleman from Oregon (Mr. DEFAZIO) that the House suspend the rules and pass the bill, as amended.

This is a 5-minute vote.

The vote was taken by electronic device, and there were—yeas 380, nays 30, not voting 17, as follows:

[Roll No. 268]

YEAS—380

Adams
Aderholt
Aguilar
Allen
Allred
Amodei
Armstrong
Arrington
Auchincloss
Axne
Babin
Bacon
Baird
Balderson
Barr
Barragán
Bass
Beatty
Bentz
Bera
Bergman
Beyer
Bice (OK)
Bilirakis
Bishop (GA)
Blumenauer
Blunt Rochester
Bonamici
Bost
Bourdeaux
Bowman
Boyle, Brendan F.
Brady
Brown (MD)
Brown (OH)
Brownley
Buchanan
Bucshon
Burchett
Bush
Bustos
Butterfield
Calvert
Cammack
Carbajal
Cárdenas
Carey
Carl
Carson
Carter (GA)
Carter (LA)
Carter (TX)
Cartwright
Case
Castor (FL)
Castro (TX)
Chabot
Cheney
Cherfilus-McCormick
Chu
Cicilline
Clark (MA)
Clarke (NY)
Cleaver
Cline
Cloud
Clyburn
Cohen
Cole
Connolly
Cooper
Correa
Costa
Courtney
Craig
Crawford
Crenshaw
Crist
Crow
Cuellar
Curtis
Davids (KS)
Davidson
Davis, Danny K.
Davis, Rodney
Dean
DeFazio
DeGette
DeLauro
DelBene
Demings
DeSaulnier
DesJarlais
Deutch
Diaz-Balart
Dingell
Doggett
Duncan
Dunn
Ellzey
Emmer
Escobar
Eshoo
Espaillat
Evans
Fallon
Feenstra
Ferguson
Fischbach
Fitzgerald
Fitzpatrick
Fleischmann
Fletcher
Foster
Foxx
Frankel, Lois
Franklin, C. Scott
Gallagher
Gallego
Garamendi
Garbarino
Garcia (CA)
Garcia (IL)
Garcia (TX)
Gibbs
Golden
Gomez
Gonzales, Tony
Gonzalez (OH)
Gonzalez, Vicente
Gottheimer
Granger
Graves (LA)
Graves (MO)
Green (TN)
Green, Al (TX)
Griffith
Grijalva
Guthrie
Harder (CA)
Hartzler
Hayes
Herrell
Herrera Beutler
Higgins (LA)
Higgins (NY)
Hill
Himes
Hinson
Hollingsworth
Horsford
Houlahan
Hoyer
Hudson
Huffman
Huizenga
Issa
Jackson
Jackson Lee
Jacobs (NY)
Jayapal
Jeffries
Johnson (GA)
Johnson (LA)
Johnson (OH)
Johnson (SD)
Johnson (TX)
Jones
Jordan
Joyce (OH)
Joyce (PA)
Kahele
Kaptur
Katko
Keating
Keller
Kelly (IL)
Kelly (MS)
Kelly (PA)
Khanna
Kildee
Kilmer
Kim (CA)
Kim (NJ)
Kind
Kirkpatrick
Krishnamoorthi
Kuster
Kustoff
LaHood
LaMalfa
Lamb
Lamborn
Langevin
Larsen (WA)
Larson (CT)
Latta
LaTurner
Lawrence
Lawson (FL)
Lee (CA)
Lee (NV)
Leger Fernandez
Lesko
Letlow
Levin (CA)
Levin (MI)
Lieu
Lofgren
Long
Loudermilk
Lowenthal
Lucas
Luetkemeyer
Luria
Lynch
Mace
Malliotakis
Maloney, Carolyn B.
Maloney, Sean
Mann
Manning
Mast
Matsui
McBath
McCarthy
McCaul
McClain
McCollum
McEachin
McGovern
McHenry
McKinley
McNerney
Meeks
Meijer
Meng
Meuser
Mfume
Miller (WV)
Miller-Meeks
Moolenaar
Mooney
Moore (AL)
Moore (UT)
Moore (WI)
Morelle
Moulton
Mrvan
Mullin
Murphy (FL)
Murphy (NC)
Nadler
Napolitano
Neal
Neguse
Newhouse
Newman
Norcross
O'Halleran
Obernolte
Ocasio-Cortez
Omar
Owens
Palazzo
Pallone
Palmer
Panetta
Pappas
Payne
Pence
Perlmutter
Peters
Pfluger
Phillips
Pingree
Pocan
Porter
Posey
Pressley
Price (NC)
Quigley
Raskin
Reschenthaler
Rice (NY)
Rice (SC)
Rodgers (WA)
Rogers (AL)
Rogers (KY)
Rose
Ross
Rouzer
Roybal-Allard
Ruiz
Ruppersberger
Rush
Rutherford
Ryan
Salazar
Sánchez
Sarbanes
Scalise
Scanlon
Schakowsky
Schiff
Schneider
Schrader
Schrier
Schweikert
Scott (VA)
Scott, Austin
Scott, David
Sessions
Sewell
Sherman
Sherrill
Simpson
Smith (MO)
Smith (NE)
Smith (NJ)
Smith (WA)
Smucker
Soto
Spanberger
Spartz
Speier
Stansbury
Stanton
Stauber
Steel
Stefanik

Steil
Stevens
Stewart
Strickland
Suozzi
Swalwell
Takano
Tenney
Thompson (CA)
Thompson (MS)
Thompson (PA)
Timmons
Titus
Tlaib
Tonko
Torres (CA)
Torres (NY)
Trahan
Trone
Turner
Underwood
Upton
Valadao
Van Drew
Van Duyne
Vargas
Veasey
Velázquez
Wagner
Walberg
Walorski
Waltz
Wasserman Schultz
Waters
Watson Coleman
Weber (TX)
Webster (FL)
Welch
Wenstrup
Westerman
Wexton
Wild
Williams (GA)
Williams (TX)
Wilson (FL)
Wilson (SC)
Wittman
Womack
Zeldin

NAYS—30

Banks
Biggs
Boebert
Brooks
Buck
Burgess
Cawthorn
Clyde
Comer
Gaetz
Gohmert
Good (VA)
Gooden (TX)
Gosar
Greene (GA)
Grothman
Harris
Harshbarger
Hern
Hice (GA)
Massie
McClintock
Nehls
Norman
Perry
Rosendale
Roy
Slotkin
Steube
Taylor

NOT VOTING—17

Bishop (NC)
Budd
Casten
Donalds
Doyle, Michael F.
Estes
Fulcher
Gimenez
Guest
Jacobs (CA)
Kinzinger
Malinowski
Miller (IL)
Pascrell
Sires
Tiffany
Yarmuth

□ 1814

So (two-thirds being in the affirmative) the rules were suspended and the bill, as amended, was passed.

The result of the vote was announced as above recorded.

A motion to reconsider was laid on the table.

MEMBERS RECORDED PURSUANT TO HOUSE RESOLUTION 8, 117TH CONGRESS

Amodei (Balderson)
Bustos (Mrvan)
Carter (TX) (Weber (TX))
Correa (Huffman)
Crist (Wasserman Schultz)
Davids (KS) (Neguse)
Davis, Danny K. (Beyer)
Deutch (Rice (NY))
Evans (Beyer)
Gonzalez (OH) (Meijer)
Granger (Weber (TX))
Johnson (GA) (Manning)
Johnson (TX) (Jeffries)
Kahele (Mrvan)
Kelly (IL) (Neguse)
Khanna (Watson Coleman)
Lamb (Blunt Rochester)
Lawrence (Stevens)
Lawson (FL) (Wasserman Schultz)
Lynch (Langevin)
Mace (Carter (GA))
McEachin (Beyer)
Meeks (Jeffries)
Moore (WI) (Beyer)
Nadler (Pallone)
Newman (Beyer)
O'Halleran (Schrader)
Palazzo (Fleischmann)
Payne (Pallone)
Peters (Jeffries)
Pingree (Wasserman Schultz)
Price (NC) (Manning)
Rice (SC) (Meijer)
Schneider (Stevens)
Stanton (Huffman)
Suozzi (Beyer)
Taylor (Van Duyne)
Tenney (Jackson)
Titus (Pallone)
Walorski (Bucshon)
Waters (Takano)
Wilson (FL) (Neguse)

SMALL STATE AND RURAL RESCUE ACT

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Pursuant to clause 8 of rule XX, the unfinished business is the vote on the motion to suspend the rules and pass the bill (H.R. 7211) to amend the Robert T. Stafford Disaster Relief and Emergency Assistance Act, review a final rule of the Federal Emergency Management Agency, and for other purposes, on which the yeas and nays were ordered.

The Clerk read the title of the bill.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The question is on the motion offered by the gentleman from Oregon (Mr. DEFAZIO) that the House suspend the rules and pass the bill.

This will be a 5-minute vote.

The vote was taken by electronic device, and there were—yeas 396, nays 14, not voting 17, as follows:

[Roll No. 269]

YEAS—396

Adams
Aderholt
Aguilar
Allen
Allred
Amodei
Armstrong
Arrington
Auchincloss
Axne
Babin
Bacon
Baird
Balderson
Banks
Barr
Barragán
Bass
Beatty
Bentz
Bera
Bergman
Beyer
Bice (OK)
Bilirakis
Bishop (GA)
Blumenauer
Blunt Rochester
Bonamici
Bost
Bourdeaux
Bowman
Boyle, Brendan F.
Brady
Brown (MD)
Brown (OH)
Brownley
Buchanan
Buck
Bucshon
Burchett
Burgess
Bush
Bustos
Butterfield
Calvert
Cammack
Carbajal
Cárdenas
Carey
Carl
Carson
Carter (GA)
Carter (LA)
Carter (TX)
Cartwright
Case
Castor (FL)
Castro (TX)
Cawthorn
Chabot
Cheney
Cherfilus-McCormick
Chu
Cicilline
Clark (MA)
Clarke (NY)
Cleaver
Cline
Cloud
Clyburn
Cohen
Cole
Comer
Connolly
Cooper
Correa
Costa
Courtney
Craig
Crawford
Crenshaw
Crist
Crow
Cuellar
Curtis
Davids (KS)
Davidson
Davis, Danny K.
Davis, Rodney
Dean
DeFazio
DeGette
DeLauro
DelBene
Demings
DeSaulnier
DesJarlais
Deutch
Diaz-Balart
Dingell
Doggett
Donalds
Duncan
Dunn
Ellzey
Emmer
Escobar
Eshoo
Espaillat
Evans
Fallon
Feenstra
Ferguson
Fischbach
Fitzgerald
Fitzpatrick
Fleischmann
Fletcher
Foster
Foxx
Frankel, Lois
Franklin, C. Scott
Fulcher
Gaetz
Gallagher
Gallego
Garamendi
Garbarino
Garcia (CA)
García (IL)
Garcia (TX)
Gibbs
Gimenez
Gohmert
Golden
Gomez
Gonzales, Tony
Gonzalez (OH)
Gonzalez, Vicente
Gooden (TX)
Gottheimer
Granger
Graves (MO)
Green (TN)
Green, Al (TX)
Griffith
Grijalva
Grothman
Guthrie
Harder (CA)
Harris
Harshbarger
Hartzler
Hayes
Hern
Herrell
Herrera Beutler
Higgins (LA)
Higgins (NY)
Hill
Hinson
Hollingsworth
Horsford
Houlahan
Hoyer
Hudson
Huffman
Huizenga
Issa
Jackson
Jackson Lee
Jacobs (NY)
Jayapal
Jeffries
Johnson (GA)
Johnson (LA)
Johnson (OH)
Johnson (SD)
Johnson (TX)
Jones
Joyce (OH)
Joyce (PA)
Kahele
Kaptur
Katko
Keating
Keller
Kelly (IL)
Kelly (MS)
Kelly (PA)
Khanna
Kildee
Kilmer
Kim (CA)
Kim (NJ)
Kind
Kirkpatrick
Krishnamoorthi
Kuster
Kustoff
LaHood
LaMalfa
Lamb
Lamborn
Langevin
Larsen (WA)
Larson (CT)
Latta
LaTurner
Lawrence
Lawson (FL)
Lee (CA)
Lee (NV)
Leger Fernandez
Lesko
Letlow
Levin (CA)
Levin (MI)
Lieu
Lofgren
Long
Loudermilk
Lowenthal
Lucas
Luetkemeyer
Luria
Lynch
Mace
Malinowski
Malliotakis
Maloney, Carolyn B.
Maloney, Sean
Mann
Manning
Mast
Matsui
McBath
McCarthy
McCaul
McClain
McClintock
McCollum
McEachin
McGovern
McHenry
McKinley
McNerney
Meeks
Meijer
Meng
Meuser
Mfume
Miller (WV)
Miller-Meeks
Moolenaar
Mooney
Moore (AL)
Moore (UT)
Moore (WI)
Morelle
Moulton
Mrvan
Mullin
Murphy (FL)
Murphy (NC)
Nadler
Napolitano
Neal
Neguse
Nehls
Newhouse
Newman
Norcross
O'Halleran
Obernolte
Ocasio-Cortez
Omar
Owens
Palazzo
Pallone
Palmer
Panetta
Pappas
Payne
Pence
Perlmutter
Peters
Pfluger
Phillips
Pingree
Pocan
Porter
Pressley
Price (NC)
Quigley
Raskin
Reschenthaler
Rice (NY)
Rice (SC)
Rodgers (WA)
Rogers (AL)
Rogers (KY)
Rose
Ross
Rouzer
Roybal-Allard
Ruiz
Ruppersberger
Rush
Rutherford
Ryan
Salazar
Sánchez
Sarbanes
Scalise
Scanlon
Schakowsky
Schiff
Schneider
Schrader
Schrier
Scott (VA)
Scott, Austin
Scott, David
Sessions
Sewell
Sherman
Sherrill
Simpson
Slotkin
Smith (MO)
Smith (NE)
Smith (NJ)
Smith (WA)
Smucker
Soto
Spanberger
Spartz
Speier
Stansbury
Stanton
Stauber
Steel
Stefanik
Steil
Steube
Stevens
Stewart
Strickland
Suozzi
Swalwell
Takano
Taylor
Tenney
Thompson (CA)
Thompson (MS)
Thompson (PA)
Timmons
Titus
Tlaib
Tonko
Torres (CA)
Torres (NY)
Trahan
Trone
Turner
Underwood
Upton
Valadao
Van Drew
Van Duyne
Vargas
Veasey
Velázquez
Wagner
Walberg
Walorski
Waltz
Wasserman Schultz
Waters
Watson Coleman
Weber (TX)
Webster (FL)
Welch
Wenstrup
Westerman
Wexton
Wild
Williams (GA)
Williams (TX)
Wilson (FL)
Wilson (SC)
Wittman
Womack
Zeldin

NAYS—14

Biggs
Boebert
Clyde
Good (VA)
Gosar
Hice (GA)
Jordan
Massie
Norman
Perry
Posey
Rosendale
Roy
Schweikert

NOT VOTING—17

Bishop (NC)
Brooks
Budd
Casten
Doyle, Michael F.
Estes
Graves (LA)
Greene (GA)
Guest
Himes
Jacobs (CA)
Kinzinger
Miller (IL)
Pascrell
Sires
Tiffany
Yarmuth

□ 1822

So (two-thirds being in the affirmative) the rules were suspended and the bill was passed.

The result of the vote was announced as above recorded.

A motion to reconsider was laid on the table.

PERSONAL EXPLANATION

Mrs. MILLER of Illinois. Mr. Speaker, had I been present, I would have voted "NAY" on rollcall No. 262, "YEA" on rollcall No. 263, "NAY" on rollcall No. 264, "NAY" on rollcall No. 265, "YEA" on rollcall No. 266, "NAY" on rollcall No. 267, "YEA" on rollcall No. 268, and "YEA" on rollcall No. 269.

MEMBERS RECORDED PURSUANT TO HOUSE RESOLUTION 8, 117TH CONGRESS

Amodei (Balderson)
Bustos (Mrvan)
Carter (TX) (Weber (TX))
Correa (Huffman)
Crist (Wasserman Schultz)
Davids (KS) (Neguse)
Davis, Danny K. (Beyer)
Deutch (Rice (NY))
Evans (Beyer)
Gonzalez (OH) (Meijer)
Granger (Weber (TX))
Johnson (GA) (Manning)
Johnson (TX) (Jeffries)
Kahele (Mrvan)
Kelly (IL) (Neguse)
Khanna (Watson Coleman)
Lamb (Blunt Rochester)
Lawrence (Stevens)

Lawson (FL) (Wasserman Schultz)
Lynch (Langevin)
Mace (Carter (GA))
McEachin (Beyer)
Meeks (Jeffries)
Moore (WI) (Beyer)
Nadler (Pallone)
Newman (Beyer)
O'Halleran (Schrader)
Palazzo (Fleischmann)
Payne (Pallone)
Peters (Jeffries)
Pingree (Wasserman Schultz)
Price (NC) (Manning)
Rice (SC) (Meijer)
Schneider (Stevens)
Stanton (Huffman)
Suozzi (Beyer)
Taylor (Van Duyne)
Tenney (Jackson)
Titus (Pallone)
Walorski (Bucshon)
Waters (Takano)
Wilson (FL) (Neguse)

COMMUNICATION FROM THE CLERK OF THE HOUSE

The SPEAKER laid before the House the following communication from the Clerk of the House of Representatives:

OFFICE OF THE CLERK,
HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES,
Washington, DC, June 14, 2022.

Hon. NANCY PELOSI,
The Speaker, House of Representatives, Washington, DC.

DEAR MADAM SPEAKER: I have the honor to transmit herewith a scanned copy of a letter received from Ms. Jana M. Lean, Chief, Elections Division, California Secretary of State, indicating that, according to the preliminary results for the Special General Election held June 7, 2022, the Honorable Connie Conway was elected for Representative to Congress for the Twenty-Second Congressional District, State of California.

With best wishes, I am,

Sincerely,

CHERYL L. JOHNSON,
Clerk.

CALIFORNIA SECRETARY OF STATE,
Sacramento, CA, June 14, 2022.

Hon. CHERYL L. JOHNSON,
Clerk, House of Representatives, Washington, DC.

DEAR MS. JOHNSON: This is to advise you that as of June 13, 2022, at 4:59 p.m., the State of California has an estimated 2,240,611 unprocessed ballots and together the counties of Fresno and Tulare have an estimated 53,610 unprocessed ballots. The U.S. House of Representative 22nd District encompasses the counties of Fresno and Tulare.

As of June 13, 2022, at 4:59 p.m. the unofficial results of the Special General Election held on Tuesday, June 7, 2022, for U.S. House of Representative 22nd District show that Connie Conway received 55,169 votes or 61.5% of the total number of votes cast for that office.

According to the unofficial results, it appears that Connie Conway has received the majority of votes cast for the U.S. House of Representative 22nd District of California.

To the best of the Secretary of State's knowledge and belief at this time, there is no contest to this election.

As soon as the official results are certified to this office by the registrar of voters for the counties of Fresno and Tulare, an official Certificate of Election will be prepared for transmittal as required by law.

Sincerely,

JANA M. LEAN,
CHIEF, ELECTIONS DIVISION,
California Secretary of State.

SWEARING IN OF THE HONORABLE CONNIE CONWAY, OF CALIFORNIA, AS A MEMBER OF THE HOUSE

Ms. LOFGREN. Madam Speaker, I ask unanimous consent that the gentlewoman from California, the Honorable CONNIE CONWAY, be permitted to take the oath of office today.

Her certificate of election has not arrived, but there is no contest, and no question has been raised with regard to her election.

The SPEAKER. Is there objection to the request of the gentlewoman from California?

There was no objection.

The SPEAKER. Will the Representative-elect and the members of the California delegation present themselves in the well.

All Members will rise and the Representative-elect will please raise her right hand.

Ms. CONWAY appeared at the bar of the House and took the oath of office, as follows:

Do you solemnly swear that you will support and defend the Constitution of the United States against all enemies, foreign and domestic; that you will bear true faith and allegiance to the same; that you take this obligation freely, without any mental reservation or purpose of evasion; and that you will well and faithfully discharge the duties of the office on which you are about to enter, so help you God.

The SPEAKER. Congratulations, you are now a Member of the 117th Congress.

WELCOMING THE HONORABLE CONNIE CONWAY TO THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

The SPEAKER. Without objection, the gentlewoman from California (Ms. LOFGREN) is recognized for 1 minute.

There was no objection.

Ms. LOFGREN. Madam Speaker, on behalf of my California colleagues and the House of Representatives, I welcome Representative CONNIE CONWAY to Congress.

A lifelong San Joaquin Valley resident, Representative CONWAY has served as a businesswoman, healthcare worker, Tulare County supervisor, president of the California State Association of Counties, and director of the National Association of Counties.

From 2008 to 2014, she served in the California State Assembly. During her tenure she also served as the Assembly minority leader.

In 2019, Representative CONWAY was appointed to the USDA Farm Service Agency as the California executive director.

In that role, she administered more than $100 million in safety net and disaster relief programs serving California farmers, ranchers, foresters, and agricultural producers.

Representative CONWAY previously operated her own consulting business and comes with experience in the healthcare sector—previously working for the Women's Health Department at Tulare District Hospital and coordinating a wellness program for Visalia's Kaweah Health Medical Center.

We look forward to working with Representative CONWAY.

Madam Speaker, I yield to the gentleman from California (Mr. CALVERT).

□ 1830

WELCOMING THE HONORABLE CONNIE CONWAY

The SPEAKER. Without objection, the gentleman from California (Mr. CALVERT) is recognized for 1 minute.

There was no objection.

Mr. CALVERT. Madam Speaker, it is my privilege and honor to welcome now-Representative CONNIE CONWAY as the newest Member of the U.S. House of Representatives.

Congresswoman CONWAY is a proud, lifelong resident of California's San Joaquin Valley. She has dedicated the better part of her life to public service as a county supervisor, a legislator in the California State Assembly, and as the California Executive Director of the USDA's Farm Service Agency. The constituents in California's 22nd District stand to benefit from Congresswoman CONWAY's vast experience and dedication.

I congratulate the entire CONWAY family on this exciting occasion, including CONNIE's husband, Craig; her children; and, of course, we can't leave out her black lab, Jake.

Madam Speaker, I yield to the dean of the California delegation, Ms. LOFGREN, to introduce our new colleague.

Ms. LOFGREN. Madam Speaker, I would like to now welcome our newest Representative to the podium.

Madam Speaker, I yield to Representative CONWAY.

Ms. CONWAY. Actually, Jake wanted to come, so did my husband, and he wasn't able to make it.

I want to thank him; my sons, Anthony and Tim; and my grandchildren, Caine and Autrey, for their constant, loving support. I hope to make them all proud. As an aside, my grandson, Caine, tomorrow will be 16.

He told me: Nonnie, I can't go watch because I have had an appointment at the DMV for 6 months. I am getting my license, and I am not giving it up.

So all I have to say to that is: Watch out Tillamook, he is off the tractor and onto the roads.

I stand before you today and vow to give everything I have to be the capable and zealous Representative that my constituents deserve. I often look to the words of Luke and paraphrase: To whom much is given, much is expected. I take these words to heart in the role that has been entrusted to me: to honestly, loyally, and passionately represent my constituents in the United States House of Representatives.

I accept this charge with deep humility. My constituents, the great people of California's 22nd District, are facing water shortages, rising inflation, and many other trials not of their own making. Their pain is my pain. Their concerns are my concerns. I stand shoulder to shoulder with them.

As a daughter of the Central Valley and a lifelong fighter for our values, it

is my duty to ensure that our voices are heard in Congress. As your Representative, you have my commitment that my door will always be open to those seeking to make the Central Valley a better place. I look forward to serving with you.

Madam Speaker, I close my remarks with a local colloquial saying: Go Dogs, Win the Mountain West.

ANNOUNCEMENT BY THE SPEAKER

The SPEAKER. In light of the administration of the oath to the gentlewoman from California (Ms. CONWAY), the whole number of the House is now 429.

AMERICAN SOLAR

(Ms. KAPTUR asked and was given permission to address the House for 1 minute and to revise and extend her remarks.)

Ms. KAPTUR. Mr. Speaker, the Biden administration abandoning tariffs on imported solar companies is terrible.

What is the administration's strategy to protect American companies and American workers who are going to be harmed?

First Solar and Solar Toledo, Ohio, two companies whose products are unrivaled anywhere on Earth, are at risk with thousands of workers' jobs on the line.

These firms employ hardworking Ohioans earning living wages that support themselves and their families, and it is unacceptable to allow China to lay waste to American industries. China has violated the rules and tilted the playing field in its favor. Our workers are sick of it.

I have introduced a bill to create an office of manufacturing within the White House to champion good jobs in the USA. This bipartisan bill would ensure there is an explicit, long-term plan to grow American manufacturing industries and unleash our full manufacturing potential.

Domestic manufacturing is the backbone of our region's middle class, and it is time the Federal Government recognizes it.

Enough is enough. Let America's workers succeed.

HONORING DR. JAMES EMMETT ''JIMMY'' DUCEY, SR., D.V.M.

(Mr. CARTER of Georgia asked and was given permission to address the House for 1 minute and to revise and extend his remarks.)

Mr. CARTER of Georgia. Mr. Speaker, I rise today in memory of Dr. James Emmett ''Jimmy'' Ducey, Sr., a veteran, a veterinarian, and an exceptional Georgian.

Jimmy was born in Savannah in 1934, the youngest of four children, and spent his entire youth in the State of Georgia. He then went on to graduate from Savannah High School and attended the University of Georgia where he earned his doctorate in veterinarian medicine.

In 1959 Jimmy and his wife moved to Fort Hood, Texas, where Jimmy served in the U.S. Army as a veterinarian. In 1960, Jimmy returned to Savannah and took over his father's veterinarian practice where he continued to serve his community for 60 years.

Jimmy eventually retired from the Army, achieving the rank of major. Jimmy founded and coached the Wilmington Island Cardinals baseball, soccer, and football teams, winning multiple city championships in soccer.

Thankfully, Jimmy was able to see the University of Georgia win their third national championship before his passing.

A loving father and husband, a veterinarian, a veteran, and fellow Georgia sports fan, Jimmy is sure to be missed.

BOOSTING SCIENCE-BASED CONSERVATION EFFORTS

(Ms. PORTER asked and was given permission to address the House for 1 minute and to revise and extend her remarks.)

Ms. PORTER. Mr. Speaker, our Nation's populations of fish and wildlife are dwindling. To save threatened and endangered species, we need the bipartisan Recovering America's Wildlife Act which will boost science-based conservation efforts.

The United Nations has warned the world that human actions will continue to drive plant and animal species to extinction if we do not act. In my home State of California, native species have declined by 20 percent, and over 600 species risk extinction.

As a member of the House of Representatives Natural Resources Committee, I have learned from scientists and advocacy groups that we need dedicated funding to recover and sustain healthy populations of threatened and endangered species.

Importantly, protecting these species is good for our economy. Wildlife-focused recreation generates $140 billion annually. The Recovering America's Wildlife Act will sustain biodiversity, create jobs, and protect our planet.

FLAG DAY AND THE U.S. ARMY'S 247TH BIRTHDAY

(Mr. THOMPSON of Pennsylvania asked and was given permission to address the House for 1 minute and to revise and extend his remarks.)

Mr. THOMPSON of Pennsylvania. Mr. Speaker, today is Flag Day and the U.S. Army's 247th birthday.

Every year on June 14 we celebrate our Stars and Stripes. We celebrate on June 14 because on this day in 1777 the Continental Congress approved the design for our first flag.

Over the years our flag has been changed to reflect the growth of our Nation, but one thing remains the same: It will always stand for freedom.

Our flag is a glorious symbol of hope for our brave servicemen and -women who salute it, defend it, serve it, and, in some cases, die to protect our freedom and liberty.

Today is also the U.S. Army's birthday. For the last 247 years, our servicemembers have been defending freedom at home and abroad.

Today, our Nation celebrates our Army and our flag, which symbolize both America being the land of the free and the home of the brave.

HONORING THE LIFE AND SERVICE OF SYLVIA SASS, THE FIRST LADY OF SISTER CITIES INTERNATIONAL

(Ms. STRICKLAND asked and was given permission to address the House for 1 minute and to revise and extend her remarks.)

Ms. STRICKLAND. Mr. Speaker, I rise today to honor the life and service of Sylvia Sass, an extraordinary public servant and community leader in the State of Washington.

Sylvia was a vital player in the early development of the Sister Cities International organization. She was even appointed Washington State coordinator due to her work in helping President Dwight Eisenhower rebuild international ties, and she was selected as a delegate to have lunch with him.

In 2017, Sylvia received the Sister Cities International Lifetime Achievement Award, and to this day she remains an active and honorary board member of the organization. Sylvia Sass is known as the first lady of Sister Cities International.

Mr. Speaker, Sylvia exemplifies hard work, perseverance, and selfless service to others. I am proud to call her my friend, and I offer these remarks in her honor.

SUPREME COURT JUSTICE SECURITY

(Mr. ROSE asked and was given permission to address the House for 1 minute and to revise and extend his remarks.)

Mr. ROSE. Mr. Speaker, the United States is a nation of laws, not mob rule. Whoever leaked a draft opinion of Dobbs v. Jackson broke the law and did great damage to the integrity of our judicial institutions.

In the 5 weeks following the leak, protesters have taken to the streets of Justices' homes to intimidate and harass them for fulfilling their constitutional duty to interpret the law, and even one deranged individual plotted to assassinate Justice Kavanaugh.

Because of this, I am dumbfounded by the Speaker's refusal on three separate occasions to allow a vote to provide protections for the Justices and their families.

Finally, more than 1 month after the Senate passed the bill by unanimous consent, we were able to hold a vote today. It took way too long, but, thankfully, it wasn't too late.

OUR SLUMBERING PRESS CORPS

(Mr. GROTHMAN asked and was given permission to address the House for 1 minute.)

Mr. GROTHMAN. Mr. Speaker, the talk of everyone back home is over inflation. I want to give the press corps something to do. We are told the current inflation rate is 8.2 percent, the highest it has been in 40 years. I believe the number is higher than that.

They claim that the cost of rent or the cost to buy a house has gone up 5.2 percent. I have talked to builders in which the cost of identical homes has gone up 30 percent.

Interest rates have gone up from 2.5 to 4.5 percent. I know somebody who is looking to perhaps flip a house that has gone up 20 percent.

I would like the press corps in this country to look for examples of housing that has only gone up 5.2 percent.

The other thing I would like them to look up is used cars have gone up 16 percent. I have talked to car dealers, and they tell me the price of used cars has gone up 25 to 35 percent.

So I beg the somewhat slumbering press corps to look into this and see whether our leg is being pulled by the claim that the CPI is only up 8.2 percent.

□ 1845

EFFECTS OF INFLATION

The SPEAKER pro tempore (Mr. JONES). Under the Speaker's announced policy of January 4, 2021, the gentleman from Arizona (Mr. SCHWEIKERT) is recognized for 60 minutes as the designee of the minority leader.

Mr. SCHWEIKERT. Mr. Speaker, we are going to try to do a continuation on a theme. Last week, I came to the floor and sort of walked through what inflation was doing to seniors. Today, I am going to try to walk through what it is doing to the poor, the working poor, the middle class, all of society.

One of the difficult things I am going to do, and I know it is somewhat rhetorical, is ask my brothers and sisters on the left: Are you happy with what you have accomplished?

Democrats took, functionally, power here 15 months ago. They had the House, the Senate, and they took the White House. And we got to see the playbook.

This is important because we often are so busy chasing shiny objects here, we never sort of talk about some of the economic differences and the way the left and those of us on the right view the world.

The left sort of believes in this model of consumption. Send people checks, and they will go buy stuff and, somehow, that will make society utopian. Of course, it also sets off really bad societal problems like: ''Hey, I have money. I don't have to participate in society and the economy.'' ''Hey, I have money. Let's just go buy stuff today,'' and it sets off inflation.

Those of us who actually showed up to our economics classes, we believe in this concept—it is often referred to as supply side. It is much more complicated. That is productivity in a society, when you are going to pay someone more money, when a worker is paid more money, it is, functionally, from two things: inflation, which doesn't mean they got anywhere. As a matter of fact, when you raise someone's salary because of inflation, they are often always behind the curve.

The second part is productivity. There was investment in plants and equipment to be more productive, to have that newest, best, functional product. That is a supply-side model. That is, functionally, what we accomplished in tax reform.

The other challenge I will give to our friends on the Democrat side is, take a look at our couple of years when we did regulatory reform, when we did tax reform, 2018, 2019. The middle class got much wealthier. Income inequality shrank. Food insecurity shrank. Minority populations had their best economic period in the modern economic time.

I would visit the homeless shelter in downtown Phoenix, and St. Joseph the Worker had a list of businesses that were desperate for anyone who would just show up.

Now, the contrast: The Democrats took over, and, functionally, 15 months ago, they moved $1.9 trillion of spending. I have been to the floor multiple times. I have shown you all the charts saying, isn't it fascinating that almost on the day you did this, you can actually see actual, functional, price changes in the wholesale markets? You can actually see the curve going: Hey, they passed a bill; there is inflation.

Now, some of that is not completely fair because some of it was actually already built into the policy sets the Democrats had adopted.

When they blew up the capital stack, meaning when the Biden administration took over, and they had a compliant Democrat Congress and a Democrat Senate and, particularly, the left controlling the House of Representatives, when they threatened capital markets for investing in hydrocarbons, when they threatened capital markets for investing in the transportation of hydrocarbons, moving natural gas—oh, you are going to build a pipeline. We are going to do everything so that you have to report to the SEC. We are going to basically make it so the companies, the investors in this, have to do documentation of their environmental scores.

You wonder why September a year ago you actually looked at the futures markets and saw it was already beginning—natural gas, crude prices. So, the horrible prices you are paying today at the pump, it is not because of the Russian invasion of Ukraine. That just moved it forward. This was already built into the Democrats' policy set.

Let's actually focus on something that is the derivative, that is the next level over from last week's. Last week, we focused substantially on what the left's policies were going to do to seniors, how many of them will be in poverty a decade from now because of inflation today.

But let's actually sort of talk through inflation through the economy because my fear is we do the headline discussion. Hey, did you see the number last week? It was 8.6. My community, it is 11 something. I happen to live in number one or number two, the Scottsdale-Phoenix area, inflation in the Nation.

But what does it actually mean? It is much more than the little number you saw saying, ''Hey, last month it was this.'' It is: What did it do to your retirement a decade from now? What did it do to your kids' and your grandkids' ability to ever purchase a house, to ever build up savings, when every single day their savings become worth less?

There is a reason inflation is the bogeyman. It is because it functionally is government. You have a government with debt the size of our economy, and we are out there taxing all of you. Whether you understand it or not, that is the scam of inflation. This is what the Democrats have set up.

Every single day, your savings becomes less, but also, the value of that massive debt the United States has becomes less because we are transferring your wealth. We are, functionally, devaluing your savings and then devaluing our debt because it is being paid for by inflated dollars.

I don't believe it is purposeful, but now that they have set it off, I promise you, there are economists in this government who basically look the other way and say let it run this way for a couple of years.

Think about it. The actual value of the debt, in constant dollars, stays the same, but—well, excuse me. It decreases because the dollar value has changed dramatically.

It is cruel. It is crushing. And the economic violence that the Democrats' failure to understand basic economics has done to the poor, the working poor, the middle class—please, just stop hurting people. It is math.

Let's take a look at this. We all got the May number, and we saw the price increases, the PCE. But when you started to look at the Consumer Price Index, 8.6—now, do you happen to remember before May, April, March, ''Oh, we have hit peak inflation.'' That is absolute crap.

Structurally, how many of you have actually looked at the gas pump this month? Have you seen where gas prices are? Put that as a factor in the inflation and tell me that prices are going down, that prices have stabilized.

There is an argument out there that we have hit a plateau. It just happens to be an outrageously high plateau. I don't see it yet.

We are in, functionally, what you call a wage-price spiral right now. I

was made fun of about 3, 4 months ago when I came here and said that I think we are on the cusp of a wage-price spiral. Well, guess what? I was right.

What is a wage-price spiral? A business raises its prices. Well, for my workers to be able to afford things, we need to raise their wages. But if we raise their wages, well, we have to raise our prices. Well, if we raise our prices, you raise your wages. It is the puppy chasing its tail.

Right now, the only solution the left is offering, the only solution the Biden administration is offering, is to let the Federal Reserve break people's backs. Raise interest rates enough. Pull liquidity out of the market. Break their backs. Put people in the unemployment lines. That will slow it down.

The cruelty of what has gone on here—and there are other solutions. I have been here to the floor multiple times saying there are things we can do tax policy-wise, incentives to save, other things that would be great for retirement security, great for growing the economy, and would help. It doesn't solve the Federal Reserve's problems, but it would help.

The problem is, I would need my brothers and sisters on the Democrat side to basically open up an economics book and say: Yes, maybe making more stuff, maybe becoming more productive, would be good for society, and it would be good for pushing down inflation.

But God knows, the way the Democrats run this place, I can't even get an amendment in the Ways and Means Committee anymore, assuming they would actually hold a real hearing.

This place is nothing but virtue signaling anymore, but it is a virtue signaling that—if they would actually talk about what they have done to people.

The hits keep coming. You start to look—and I know some of these charts are noisy. One of the tough things about talking about this right now is, these numbers have been moving so fast, trying to make sure you are using credible, third-party sources so you are just not making up numbers out of your own office and building a pretty chart, but you go out and find the experts. The experts can't keep up with the movement of the prices, the economic distortion that is going on.

Part of my challenge is: Go look at your 401(k) right now. Are you happy?

Now, you need to add in also that the fact of the matter is the money you have in there is substantially worth less than a year ago. So it is not that your savings, your investments, have crashed. Also, it is buying about 10 percent less stuff anyway, so you needed to discount rate that.

You understand that we have real negative interest rates right now. That is one of the reasons the Federal Reserve is probably going to have to jack up rates dramatically more than the talking heads are telling you on cable finance news.

Think about it. If you are living in a country where the interest rate—let's just use 10. It is an easy number. I know the number was 8.6. In my community, it is probably 11.

Federal funds rates, let's do a 10-year. Let's use 3½. Do you see that gap there? That is actually negative. You invest in a 10-year T bill, a 10-year U.S. sovereign instrument. You just lost all that.

The model basically says the Federal Reserve is going to have to jack up interest rates to close that gap. And be scared. Be scared.

I have been here on the floor with charts before that basically said if the mean interest rate is 2 points higher on U.S. sovereign debt for, like, 25 years, at the end of that 25 years, every dime of tax receipts, every dime of tax revenue, goes to just interest.

Do you understand the scale of the dystopian misery that the Democrats' economic policy has set off?

Yes, it had great virtue signaling. We are going to give money to all these people. Great job. They are all poorer today than a year ago when you handed out $1.9 trillion.

You start to look at who you are hurting. You start to look at folks in Social Security. Well, they are already upside down another percent.

You start to look at major healthcare programs. Well, the inflation there, packing into that.

You start to take a look at other mandatory spending. Well, at least that has actually been deflated upside down because they don't have the same COLA kickers.

But you start to add up what is going on, major changes and projected outlays. The budget process here is going to be really interesting coming next year when we take the majority because the mess that has to be cleaned up economically is not going to happen in a year.

For everyone who may be participating and crazy enough to listen to me, it is going to take years and years, maybe a decade, to just clean up this, functionally, 24-month cycle of what bad decisions did. For everyone listening, please, rethink your retirement.

□ 1900

Please rethink your savings. Please rethink your investments. You are poorer today than you understand because it multiplies out into the future, and I am scared.

I mean, we did one model in our office, and I have some boards here that are going to sort of touch on this, but let's see if I can try to describe it.

Let's go back to my retiree. You are on Medicare, okay. So there is a hold harmless on the cost of Medicare, but not your co-pay.

So if medical inflation is going up at almost double the inflation rate, so we had what, 8.6, but we have some charts that show medical inflation in the previous month may have been as high as 16, 16.8.

So if you have almost double, that 20 percent of cash that comes out of your pocket also just doubled. So you are going to get an 8 percent COLA on your Social Security, okay, and your Medicare premium will adjust some, but your co-pay is skyrocketing.

If you carry that out through the decade, the number of our brothers and sisters who will be in their retirement who will be in poverty—it is math. But, damn it, doesn't this place care about people, or is it just too painful to step up and say we screwed up? Well, they screwed up.

We are going to reach across the aisle. We are going to actually work with people who actually showed up to their economics classes. There are some ideas that would be good—and they should be bipartisan—that actually would help productivity, help people save for retirement, and would be great for bending the inflation curve.

Do you think any of us could get an amendment, actually even listened to? Because they don't care. It doesn't fit. Remember, we do public policy now by virtue signaling. The incredible difference—I am realizing the difference between my brothers and sisters on the left and those of us on the right is my constituents judge us on what did our policies accomplish?

I swear to you. The media and the left judge their folks on what was their intention? What were their feelings? Because if they were judged on what they have accomplished, they have accomplished misery.

As of May 2020, inflation is plateauing, really, rather than peaking. Understand what these economists were basically saying is this isn't transitory. We were promised that over and over and over from the Treasury Secretary, from the President, from Democratic leadership, even my brothers and sisters on the Democrat side on Ways and Means. Oh, it is temporary. It is a supply chain spike. No, it isn't. Such horrible policies.

They built a structural inflation problem. Now you are in a wage price spiral, and many of the economists are now saying it is not a peak and a fall—it is a plateau.

One of the things that scares the crap out of me—and I am sorry, but I don't know a better way to try without crossing the line and cursing and getting my words taken down—is you hit the inflationary cycle with stagflation, meaning you functionally have some economic growth. You have employment. The Federal Reserve is jacking up interest rates, so you are trying to push up some of the employment. You are going to see some unusual charts and data we have here.

But the inflation is sticky, and you basically have a plateau of inflation, you have a plateau of misery, and you are not able to raise it and crash it.

One of the reasons I come to you with that as a personal theory—and it drives some of my economists nuts on the Joint Economic Committee when I

say this—is I think we have a much more difficult demographic problem.

Inflation in the late 1970s, very, very early 1980s, you had this huge baby boom population that was available for labor, available with new technologies, investments to spike productivity.

We have got a demographic problem. Functionally, in 7 years, 22 percent of America is 65 and older. We have gotten old. We have huge, massive social entitlement promises that we have a moral obligation to keep—the financing of Social Security, the financing of Medicare.

Remember: Every new dime of debt over the next 30 years is just Social Security and Medicare. I know a lot of folks don't like to hear that, but it is. It is our demographic. We got old. The rest of the budget is functionally in balance.

Really hard to break a stagflation cycle without that available population spike to have that productivity to start to say, hey, we are going to make more stuff. We are cracking inflation.

When you start to see some of the smart economists saying hey, we have got a problem. We are plateauing. It is not a spike. This may be the mean for a while. What is amusing, in a very dark way, is I have used this chart once before, so it is the projection of where inflation was going to go.

The number of talking heads who would repeat the White House's line that oh, it is transitory, or it is just temporary, or it is Putin inflation. Come on. At some point, treat the American people like adults.

They may not have spent their life bathing in the numbers. They don't go home every night and read The Economist magazine and these things, trying to dig. That is our job. That is what we are paid to do. Other people need to take care of their families and have a life and try to survive these prices.

But the trend line on inflation is heading toward almost a 10 percent plateau. God, I don't think we are going to get there, I really don't, but that is my charting.

You know, this was our target. We are nowhere near our target. We blew through our target by 2.8 percent. I am trying to show the happy talk that was going on in the previous three or four months. Oh, inflation is transitory. They have been wrong.

I am going to do something slightly jerky. I have been here on the floor, and I got it right because we actually looked at the real numbers.

You know, when you looked at the April inflation and realize, well, damn it, April inflation, they were calculating—they had fuel prices, they had base energy going down .6, .4, based on the numbers. That isn't what happened in May.

I mean, all you had to do was break it apart and look at the numbers and own a calculator. But remember: We work in a math-free zone. You start to understand.

I know I am a Republican. I come behind the microphone, I sound like an accountant on steroids. That is not my point. These numbers are people. These numbers are hurting people. There are millions—matter of fact, almost all of America is poorer today than they were 15 months ago when the left took power. Judge us by that. It didn't need to be this way.

I mean, you know, what is it, Larry Summers—I mean, a leftist economist is begging the Democrats, saying, don't do this. Don't do it. Don't do it. You are going to hurt people. Oh, no. I am a Member of Congress. I understand better than a guy with a Ph.D. from Harvard.

Turns out the Ph.D. leftist from Harvard who was begging you not to do what you did; you went ahead and did it. Now you have a Republican quoting him on the floor.

Only large businesses—now, this one is important—are adding sufficient numbers of workers. So you remember how President Biden, I think it was yesterday, got behind the microphone and said, but we have such great employment.

The pessimism on small- and medium-size businesses has skyrocketed, and that is actually where much of our job creation and disruption in the economy and new spikes of productivity come from. They are the risk takers who will try new methods and systems.

So, right now, big business has still been doing the hiring. What happens is that function where the Federal Reserve goes about jacking up interest rates, they are going to crush mid-market and small businesses. I hope it doesn't come, but every number I look at says it is going to come: the recession the Democrats have brought us.

Is it going to continue the movement of the United States being a country of oligopolies, because we are going to wipe out a bunch of our small businesses? Our regional, smaller, mid-size businesses get wiped out, but the big boys stay because they can afford the regulatory—they can actually participate in capital markets.

Is that going to be the outcome once again, that this, once again, becomes more and more a monopolistic economy? You also know the problem with that is you don't get a productive society when you have massive players that control so much of the society, the economics.

Some of these numbers—you have got to understand, this number was the worst reading in 49 years for the smaller- and mid-size businesses doing hiring.

So you functionally have almost two economies running at the same time. But this economy here, the small and mid-size, are most of our employment. Be worried. These numbers are not warm and fuzzy.

Now we start to go to some of the cruelty that the Democrats' economics have done. You see that bottom line? Those are functionally real wages. So, hey, here are inflation wages. Hey, I got a raise. Look, wages are going up. Real purchasing power. I am poorer today than I was the day before.

So when you hear leftists come behind these microphones and talk about income equality, they did it. It is driven by crap policy like this. This is what is going on right now. Real wages. People are getting poorer every single day.

Yet, there are folks here who are willing to just completely mislead on facts. Oh, but wages are up. Yeah, they are up. But they are not up nearly at the pace of inflation. This is really dangerous.

You have got to understand, if numbers like this continue, this is what tears apart societies. This is not a game. This is beyond me being a Republican, and I am beating up on Democrats.

Please. I know we are heading into election season. I know everything is about knifing each other, but this chart is actually—this line here is people. These are people getting poorer every single day.

We keep offering suggestions, and we can't even get an amendment considered. I understand the partisan cruelty to our side. We are not in charge. You are in charge. But why the cruelty to your own constituents?

Because this did not need to happen, and it doesn't need to continue. There are solutions, but maybe those solutions also require something very difficult.

You know, if you are in a 12-step program—and God knows I have had enough family in 12-step programs—what is the very first step? Admit you have a problem. Democrats, I challenge you. Take the first step. Admit you screwed up, you screwed the American people, and you are willing to make it right. You are willing to work with us who own calculators to make it right, to help our brothers and sisters not continue to be poorer every day.

These numbers should start to scare you. There are a number of economists out there I believe who have gotten this wrong. They say, well, we handed out so much free money in 2021, everyone had so much cash in their bank accounts, they set off inflation because everyone went out and bought a new television. Fine.

Okay. What happens by the end of 2021? By the end. So several months ago, credit card debt was climbing and had climbed rather substantially. That basically lets you know the way people were maintaining their consumption, their lifestyle.

It wasn't that they were building it in their earning power. They chewed up their savings. They were using debt to maintain their lifestyle. This is dangerous because at a certain point you hit that debt wall and you have how many of your brothers and sisters who, all of a sudden, now are in real financial stress.

□ 1915

When you start to see 28 percent annualized increase in the fourth quarter was the fastest on record, basically saying, hey, fourth quarter last year was the fastest on record of credit card accumulation of debt.

So when the White House, when my Democratic colleagues say, well, things aren't that bad. Yes, we have inflation, but look how good the economy is. You built an economy on fake money, and now people are borrowing it through their credit cards.

At the end of the fourth quarter, there was a sizable but shrinking pool of excess liquidity. So what they are basically saying is, do you remember how a number of us were coming to the mike and said, hey, Democrats, your $1.9 trillion that you did, what was it, end of March 2021, you pumped all this liquidity into the marketplace, as you set off inflation. People shored up—they paid off some debt. They had lots of cash in their bank accounts, and it was substantially gone by the end of last year.

So how have people been financing the consumption of these incredible price hikes over the last few months? We are hunting for the latest borrowing data, but we are seeing some preliminary numbers. A lot of Americans now are in substantially more debt, so they are poorer than when the Democrats handed out $1.9 trillion.

So within a year, they set off inflation, and they made people poor, and now they are upside-down in debt, and they have got to figure out a way to pay for it. It is like every economic nightmare. Everything you could do wrong has functionally been done in the 15 months of Democrat power.

Mr. Speaker Pro Tempore, may I inquire how much time I have remaining?

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The gentleman has 28½ minutes remaining.

Mr. SCHWEIKERT. Look, this is functionally the same chart as the last one, except the point I am making on this one is we functionally moved from 1 trillion 726 billion up. Before that, we were at $1.3 trillion of household savings. The savings basically has collapsed.

Is anyone talking about this? Remember, that was supposed to be the big Democrat talking point is, yes, we gave away a lot of money, but, look, we shored up people's bank accounts. It is gone. It is gone. And it wasn't done through productivity. It wasn't done through investments that lead us into a greater future.

The left keeps on saying, well, you invest in green energy. Fine. But that is not what you did. You basically adopted almost every policy—you do realize in the 15 months the Democrats have been in charge, we are burning a hell of a lot more coal today.

The 2021 number is 23 percent more coal was burnt to produce U.S. electrical energy because they blew up the natural gas markets. They made the United States dirtier, according to the greenhouse gas calculations. So even on that they screwed it up.

And then here is sort of the punch line of why I am here tonight. You see the chart, you see the red, the red line? Is that red or maroon? Let's go with red. Do you see this chart right here? That is for folks under $40,000 a year. And red basically means severe hardship. They are in economic stress.

This number here has exploded under the 15 months of Democrat control. This is what functionally they have caused by inflation, by everything around them. They have taken almost modest quartile of incomes, and they are brutalizing the poor. They are just brutalizing the working poor.

Now, those folks over $100,000, yeah, but most of it is no real hardship. Their income category, they are doing not fine, but better. But you get down to $40,000 and less. So if you ever let someone on the left tell you they are the ones who care about the poor and the working poor and the working middle class, they may care. They may care, but they brutalize them by their policies.

Look, it is in the math. Once again, the math doesn't lie. The math will set you free. But we seem to do policy by virtue signaling here, not by some of the most compassionate, which is do the right thing.

You have a model. Take a look what we accomplished in 2018, 2019, first quarter of 2020. The number of our brothers and sisters that were less poor, it was one of the most amazing economic revivals in U.S. history. Yes, we had the pandemic. Yes, it was miserable.

But think about this. Almost every bit of those gains are gone, and not gone because of the pandemic. They are gone because of the last 15 months of horrible economic policy that set off inflation, has set off optionality, has flatlined productivity, and actually really screwed up the next decade of our economic future.

These get a little more difficult to show, but basically you are trying to sort of demonstrate when we hit the Biden inauguration, so this is the moment where Democrats had absolute power here, and how quickly the financial cushion disappeared. Now, a lot of this disappeared because you have the occasion where we are going to hand you a bunch of cash, but we are also going to set off inflation. It turns out the inflation chews up the cash a lot faster than we are handing out free money.

As of April 2022, the average retirement benefits—now, this is going to make complete sense, and in the scale, the reality is much, much worse, but we are trying to do a calculation of if you are getting retirement benefits, how much are you losing? How much is it changing? Our first calculation was about $162.

Now I need you to add a couple more months to that. What we are starting to try to model is every month people on a fixed income, how much poorer are they getting. And that is also adjusting, say, they have COLAs, so they are going up, but the actual purchasing power, even adjusted with the COLA, they are falling, they are getting poorer every day.

Now we are finally starting to get some of the data. The problem is we are about 3 months behind on trying to do hard calculations.

Now you start to look, and this one is really important. I don't have a brilliant way to try to lay this out. When we look at different demographics and what they consume, a young family is going to have different consumption than a couple in their seventies. This one is going to be much more medical costs, and this one might be education and a new bicycle. So what happens when you start to realize that food energy, when you start to see it moving in the charts, but then you come down here and start to see medical services, where they are in the inflation graph, and then you try to adjust them to populations. Then you realize you are ending up with this crazy sort of bell curve of misery, where older Americans are getting crushed, and younger families are getting crushed because they don't have assets that are inflating. And this is what is going on.

I don't know why there is not a fire drill around here. I mean, what would it take for those of us as Republicans to basically turn to the Democrat majority and the White House and Speaker PELOSI and the left who is in charge here and say, we actually care about Americans. We are willing to work with you. Let's actually do the fire drill. Let's actually do the things that set off productivity. Let's fix expensing on the Tax Code. Let's do this, let's do that. What can we do instead of just letting the Federal Reserve jack up interest rates and put people out of work? And that way Democrats can blame the Federal Reserve and not their own policies because they need deniability.

Our job is to make people's lives freer, economically more stable, better, but also someone like myself—and, yes, I have a 6-year-old daughter, and my wife and I are the same age. It is the greatest thing that ever happened. Yes, I am an old dad. Greatest thing that has ever happened. What is my moral obligation to her future? Seriously.

For every person who on occasion actually shows up and works here, what is your moral obligation? What is your moral obligation to your parents and your grandparents but also to these kids? We already have this demographic curve that is going to make fixing inflation much more difficult, and we are basically shifting.

If you are functionally under 40 years old, and you are still voting for the left, please, please go to an economics class. Go buy a calculator. Understand the amount of misery that has been

shifted onto your future. My back-of-the-napkin math basically says for someone who basically is getting ready to graduate college today, when they hit their peak earning years, their tax rate will have to be double what today's is just to maintain today's benefits. Congratulations.

Look, Mr. Speaker Pro Tempore, I still have a number of charts, but basically they are all saying the same thing. You get to when the Democrats took power, and just what they did in blowing up affordability in our communities, blowing up affordability, productivity in the country, and it was Democrat policies because it is more than just what we voted on here.

It was basically threatening investors. It was threatening: The SEC is going to come and start to look at your investments. It is threatening. They used the regulatory state, they used the up and down, even the virtue signaling within businesses. I mean, how many businesses basically sold their souls so Democrats wouldn't say mean things about them?

You start to look at family economic insecurity, and it just has exploded again since the Democrats took power.

Mr. Speaker, and to whoever is interested, I am blessed to be the senior Republican for the Joint Economic Committee, so I have access to some very smart people, and we are just doing our best to try to understand the numbers but also what we can do with the numbers.

Last week I became the senior Republican for Social Security, and, you know, you are reading the actuary report, and then you are teaming it up with the actuary report for Medicare, and you start to realize the scale. The numbers here are stunning. The numbers of zeros.

And we will get the clown show around this place that says, well, if you fix waste and fraud; well, if you get rid of foreign aid; hey, if you just tax rich people some more, everything will be fine. None of those things are close to being true.

The scale of the problem that was already built into just our demographics and our promises, remember, the shortfall for Social Security and Medicare when you pile on our current debt is $120 trillion, and that functionally hits in 29 years, and that is adjusted to today's dollars. Add in inflation, and the distortion.

So my last comment I really want to try to share is one of our projects we are working very hard in our office is if the Democrats' inflation continues for 24 months, how much of our society will be in poverty? How many seniors, how many younger people because of the distortion? They functionally have wiped out all the amazing economic progress we made in 2018 and 2019 and the first quarter of 2020.

Congratulations, you hated the last President, you hated the Republicans and what we did for the economy. Fine, you got rid of it. You wiped it all out.

□ 1930

But understand, in just 15 months, we have whole regions, whole populations, whole segments of our society that are several percent—sorry to put it in a percent—poorer today. It just doesn't go away, and you can't just do another transfer payment to make it up.

Turns out who you vote for does make a difference. Now, America gets to pay a price for what they did in the last couple of elections. But they were lied to. They basically thought virtue signaling was policy, and it wasn't. It was about winning elections.

At some point, Mr. Speaker pro tempore, the calculator tells the truth. Mr. Speaker pro tempore, at some point, we should be judged by our accomplishments for the American people. If that accomplishment is misery, be held to it. If it is prosperity, take joy in it. But we need to step up and demonstrate that we actually understand what is going on in our communities and that we are willing to step up and try to fix it instead of talk away from it.

Mr. Speaker, I yield back the balance of my time.

CONSTITUTIONAL RIGHT TO KEEP AND BEAR ARMS

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Under the Speaker's announced policy of January 4, 2021, the Chair recognizes the gentleman from Montana (Mr. ROSENDALE) for 30 minutes.

Mr. ROSENDALE. Mr. Speaker, for tonight's Special Order, the House Freedom Caucus would like to discuss our constitutional right to keep and bear arms.

I think it is really important that we make exceedingly clear that every one of the Members who is going to be here speaking this evening is as upset and disturbed by the tragic events in Uvalde as everyone else.

But what we will not do is allow the folks on the left side of the aisle to use that as a tool instead of addressing our school safety issues, instead of using it as a tool to address the mental health issues that are rampant across our Nation, instead to use it as a tool to diminish the constitutional rights of law-abiding citizens across our country, not only reducing the rights but, additionally, putting them in jeopardy as well, at the same time that they continue to try to undermine law enforcement and compromise the law enforcement community to protect these very same individuals so that they are forced to go out and make sure that they can defend themselves and their families and their property.

This is a problem that we see taking place time and time again across our Nation. This isn't just happening in Seattle, in Portland, and in Minneapolis-St. Paul. Unfortunately, we are seeing some of these exact same leftist radicals who try to strip the power of law enforcement from cities even in the State of Montana.

No one would ever believe it, but we had ordinances that were proposed in Helena, Montana, in Bozeman, Montana, and in Missoula, Montana, to try to defund our law enforcement at the same time we see crime levels rising everywhere. They are violent crimes. I have talked to the attorney general, and he has verified that very information.

The Members who are going to be here tonight are going to talk about the Second Amendment, and they are going to talk about it in great detail because they understand, as the million Montanans do, that the Second Amendment is about much more than just hunting. As a matter of fact, yes, there are people who enjoy hunting with firearms, and they also enjoy just target shooting with firearms. They also have weapons that are antiques or family heirlooms that have been in their homes and families since the 1800s. The most important thing that the Second Amendment is about is home security, defending your home and your household, and that is what we are going to hear a lot about tonight.

I am proud to say that Montana ranks as the number one State with the most guns per household. That, my friends, is how we can keep those crime levels down. Sixty-four percent of Montanans' homes have a gun within them. Guess what? Criminals know that. When you put a sign out that says we defend our homes, people tend to stay away from those areas.

We have a lot of information to go over this evening, and I have several of my colleagues who are going to be here to help me.

Mr. Speaker, I yield to the gentleman from Arizona (Mr. BIGGS), my dear friend.

Mr. BIGGS. Mr. Speaker, I thank the gentleman from Montana for yielding to me.

It is important for us to be here tonight. It is important for us to address the attack on the Second Amendment.

The reason I say that is that some people don't care about that Second Amendment. Some people would pack the Court to do away with that Second Amendment. That is an important right. It is so important that, in the Heller decision, Justice Scalia said: ''The very text of the Second Amendment implicitly recognizes the preexistence of the right and declares only that it 'shall not be infringed.' ''

What does it mean when you say that right is preexisting? It means that it is not given by the government, and thus it cannot be taken away by the government. Instead, it is inherent in every individual, every person.

In fact, the reason I use the word ''individual'' is because Justice Scalia made very clear, after a very lengthy discussion regarding militia versus individuals, that this is an individual right. It isn't some kind of collective. It isn't some kind of government-organized right. It is a God-given right, and

thus it is prohibited for government to infringe upon that right.

Justice Scalia went on to say exactly what I just said. He said: ''This is not a right granted by the Constitution. Neither is it in any manner dependent upon that instrument for its existence. The Second Amendment declares that it shall not be infringed.''

Anyone who has taken an oath of office to honor and defend the Constitution against all enemies, foreign and domestic, how can they then vote for legislation that would surrender that right to the government?

My friends across the aisle have failed to remember how important it is. I am going to make three quick points.

Number one: Why is an AR–15 important? It is a gun that is light and easy to handle for people who are being attacked. It is a perfect defensive weapon. It is important that we remember that.

Second thing: Good guys with guns actually do save lives. Democrats ignored the recent incident in West Virginia where a woman used her 9-millimeter pistol to stop a shooter who was shooting toward a crowd of people, with an AR–15, by the way. They ignored the actions of Stephen Willeford, who stopped a shooting in Sutherland Springs, Texas.

If you are relying solely on the police to come—I love my friends of the blue. We rely on them. We depend upon them. But when someone is attacking you, you don't always have time to wait for those first responders to get there.

My last point is this: If you are 18, 19, or 20 years old, you still have that God-given right to defend yourself and to the Second Amendment.

The proposals of this body ignore the fact that the Ninth Circuit recently recognized and realized that they have those rights, and they struck down a California law that imposed a restriction on 18-, 19-, and 20-year-olds.

Ladies and gentlemen, those who are listening, don't give up your right. If you are a Member of Congress, don't take away this important God-given right.

Mr. Speaker, I thank Mr. ROSENDALE for letting me speak.

Mr. ROSENDALE. Mr. Speaker, I thank very much Representative BIGGS, one of our strongest defenders of the Second Amendment here in the body.

If the left wants to address this issue, let's be up-front about it. Let's be honest about it. Let's stop trying to undermine the Second Amendment through changes in statute. Let's stop trying to strip away people's rights by inserting something into a law that later would be struck down by the Supreme Court.

If you want to be honest and up-front about stripping away people's rights, then come to this floor, propose an amendment to the Constitution, debate it here on the floor, send it to the United States Senate, see if you can get that done. Then send it back to the people of the United States and see how they feel about it.

That is how this is supposed to take place. You cannot violate the Constitution and strip away people's rights.

Mr. Speaker, I yield to the gentlewoman from Colorado (Mrs. BOEBERT), my good friend.

Mrs. BOEBERT. Mr. Speaker, I thank Mr. ROSENDALE for yielding.

Mr. Speaker, I love what Mr. BIGGS was saying, how these are our God-given rights. That right there is fundamental, and that is why we have a government, to secure our God-given rights.

None of our rights come from politicians. Our rights are not granted to us by the executive, by the legislative, or by the judicial branch. They are granted to us by God. These are our natural rights. They are unalienable. For anyone to say: ''I am from the Federal Government, and I am here to help,'' well, those are very dangerous words.

Another thing that is dangerous is gun-free zones. I am a cosponsor of Congressman MASSIE's bill that would remove the law that makes our schools gun-free zones. That makes them soft targets. Our children are our Nation's most valuable assets. The more value an asset has, the more protection it should have.

We secure our banks. We secure our airports. We secure the White House. We have even seen the Capitol surrounded by fences, miles of razor wire on top of that fence, 26,000 armed National Guardsmen, because even my colleagues on the other side of the aisle understand that borders that are secure and armed security work.

We need to harden our schools. We need to secure our schools. I believe this starts at a very local level. Maybe there is something there that can be boosted by the Federal Government, some of this unspent COVID money to go toward boosting security in our schools.

We don't need to be inching away the rights and liberties of American citizens. Liberty lost never comes back. We don't get that liberty back that we give away. We certainly were not elected to legislate away liberty from our constituents. We are here to keep the American people free. That is the proper role of government.

A lot of people would like to say that the Second Amendment, well, it is great because we know you want to hunt. The Second Amendment has nothing to do with hunting. Our Founding Fathers did not just return from a hunting expedition when they created the Bill of Rights, when they drafted that. No, they had just got done liberating a nation from a tyrannical, oppressive King, and they wanted a government that was so strong and powerful that it would be able to fight off that tyranny and oppression that anyone from around the world might seek to reimpose on this people. But they also wanted a government so limited that it would never impose that same tyranny and oppression on its own people.

Isn't it interesting that we heard for weeks how American taxpayers need to send money to Ukraine to make sure that those citizens are armed?

□ 1945

Now the same people who are saying that we were bought by Putin because we didn't want to send billions and billions of dollars to Ukraine while our southern border is unsecure, while we have an invasion taking place at our southern border, when we have our own supply chain crisis, we have inflation that is skyrocketing, and we said maybe let's just put America first for a minute. But the same people who made these accusations against those of us who would vote against that spending are now seeking to take the rights away from American citizens.

And these same people who had no problem arming Ukraine and wanting to disarm American citizens also call to defund the police. We even saw 24 of our colleagues from the other side of the aisle just today vote to not provide added security to our Supreme Court Justices who have had mob violence at their homes, murder attempts against a Supreme Court Justice. And 24 of these radical leftists said: No, they are fine. We are not going to send police to protect you. You won't be able to protect yourself. It is all rogue.

This is a lawless administration that we are serving under, and I would implore the Senate to not compromise on the American citizens' rights.

And I would like to just note that the 10 that we have heard of who are considering siding with these people who would limit the liberties and freedoms of American citizens are either not coming back to the Senate, they are retiring, or they are not up for reelection. I think that that is very telling, and I will not give an inch on the Second Amendment, of the rights of the people to keep and bear arms to protect themselves, especially when cries from this Chamber are calling to defund law enforcement and our southern border is wide open, allowing the cartel to send whatever they want through those borders without any added security.

Mr. Speaker, I thank Mr. ROSENDALE for leading this special order tonight, and I make reference that it is the House Freedom Caucus that is really setting the standard and protecting American liberties.

Mr. ROSENDALE. Mr. Speaker, we continue to hear the Democrats talk about the flawed arguments that we make that the Founding Fathers didn't know weaponry would advance the way that it has, that the Founding Fathers could not conceive of a government that would never force us to do something against our will or deny us of due process. Please consider some of the activities that have taken place and the mandates that have been placed

upon us over the last 2 years, and don't tell me that we have a government that has reached well beyond its boundaries.

Mr. Speaker, I yield to the gentleman from Ohio (Mr. DAVIDSON), who knows what it means to fight for our country.

Mr. DAVIDSON. Mr. Speaker, I don't think there could be a more serious matter before this body. Everyone in the country, frankly, everyone in the world knows we can't continue to see what is happening in our cities, in our schools, in vulnerable communities, we can't continue to see those things happening.

Sadly, Democrats have a preconceived play for every tragedy. A famous Democrat even coined the phrase, never let an emergency go to waste, never let a crisis go to waste.

It is a crisis for sure. But the crisis isn't the fact that America has guns or that individual American citizens have guns. We have always had guns.

What is different is the level of despair in our communities. We see it surging not just in mass shootings but in the rise of violent crimes, in the surge in suicides, in fatal overdoses. The leading cause of death for 18- to 45-year-olds is now fatal drug overdoses.

A lot of people will point to the mass shooters as they are ready to lose their lives. They have even coined a phrase, suicide by cop. They know how it is going to end when they go in doing it.

So what is driving this? Is it the gun? It is an inanimate object.

The solution, the Democrats say—it is a longstanding wish list. They have had a dream for a long time to repeal the Second Amendment. Frankly, they don't want to campaign on that.

Our colleague, Mr. MONDAIRE JONES from New York, when we were moving some of these bills through Judiciary Committee said, ''You will not stop us from passing gun control. If the filibuster obstructs us, we will abolish it. If the Supreme Court objects, we will expand. We will not rest until we have taken weapons of war out of our communities.'' Frankly, Justin Trudeau agrees, but he is the Prime Minister of Canada. Canada doesn't have a Second Amendment.

Just today, I was walking through the Capitol from the Senate side to the House side, and a reporter stopped me, and she pointed out inaccurately that the Second Amendment grants us the right to keep and bear arms.

No, ma'am, the Second Amendment does not grant us anything. In fact, the Bill of Rights grants us nothing. The Second Amendment is a limitation on the ability of government to infringe on our preexisting rights. Just as the Declaration recognized we were endowed by our creator with certain inalienable rights that among them are life, liberty, and the pursuit of happiness.

This is an extension of the right to life. And, hopefully, tomorrow we will see the Supreme Court defend life. You can't defend freedom without defending life. In the modern era one of the key instruments to defending life for adults is the right to keep and bear arms.

People have referred to some weapons as weapons of war. No, they are not the same weapons as weapons of war. Those were outlawed in the 1930s under the National Firearms Act. They have been outlawed for a long time. A semiautomatic rifle or a semiautomatic pistol is not a weapon of war, though sometimes they are used in that mode in combat. They are very effective in war, but our Founding Fathers didn't vest the defense of this Nation originally in a standing Army. In fact, they said we don't want a standing Army.

One of the limitations on this body is we have to fund the defense budget every cycle. We can't have it operate in perpetuity without reauthorizing it every time. We had a standing Navy, but we didn't have a standing Army.

Let's read the text of the Second Amendment. The Second Amendment says: ''A well regulated militia, being necessary to the security of a free State, the right of the people to keep and bear arms, shall not be infringed.'' Famous words.

People want to pretend that somehow the Second Amendment granted the State the ability to keep and bear arms. Only if you are in the military. Only if you are in the militia. That is the same right to keep and bear arms the North Korean Army has. What a fallacy. I can't believe some of our countrymen fall for that, but some of them do. And that is why my colleagues repeat it. They know, though, but they say the lie anyway.

Well, what are we going to do about it? Well, we are certainly not going to surrender our freedoms because we know freedom surrendered is rarely reclaimed. We aim to keep our Second Amendment.

Just as Ben Franklin—recognized walking out of the Constitutional Convention—was asked: What have you wrought, sir? A Republic if you can keep it. The people, and we aim to keep it as the people's Representatives.

Who defends freedom in Congress? The Freedom Caucus. I am proud to be here with my colleagues taking this time tonight to defend this important freedom.

But I think people are right to say, So what are we going to actually do about it?

If you listen to the debate you might know that there are a lot of shooters that turn into active shooters, mass murderers, doers of evil deeds that people will say after the fact, well, you know, everybody kind of knew Johnny or whoever was crazy. You know, we kind of saw this coming. Maybe we could have stopped him. If only there was a red flag law.

So people in America might not realize that in every single State and in the District of Columbia it is already possible to stop such a person. The law is known as the Baker Act. It is possible to have a person, even involuntarily, against their will, adjudicated mentally incompetent. That law preserves due process. The person has a right to confront his or her accusers. That law locks up the right thing. You can't deprive a person—under the Fifth Amendment and the 14th, you cannot deprive a person of life, liberty, or property without due process.

Red flag laws reverse that. Not only do they get rid of the due process, it is essentially civil asset forfeiture. First, you seize the guns and you get to due process later. It seizes the wrong things. It locks up the guns.

The person is the dangerous thing. So you take the guns away from the person. The person, if they really are mentally dangerous, they can get access to guns in other ways, perhaps illegally, as a substantial portion of shooters do. Perhaps they could drive a car through a parade route. They could use a blade. They could use all kinds of ways to harm others, and frankly, they could also harm themselves, turning into one of the tragic suicides that occur every day in our country.

So, no, I think the Baker Act ought to be the thing that people focus on. Those are overwhelmingly State laws. And we have to focus on understanding why those laws aren't used.

My colleagues know of these laws, particularly the ones on the Judiciary Committee, but they don't bring them up. They pretend as if the only way to stop this is with the red flag laws. And you know, while I know the Democrats have had a longstanding desire to go after the Second Amendment, I will admit it is especially discouraging when Republicans break ranks on this core issue.

I was disappointed to see 10 of our House colleagues vote for some measure of gun control in the House. Five of them aren't running again, and five of them may find that they are not running again at some point. In the Senate there are already 10 that are openly supportive of this outline, framework of a deal. We haven't seen text, but we do know it encourages red flag laws, which ought to be ruled unconstitutional, as all civil asset forfeiture ought to be ruled unconstitutional.

When you look at civil asset forfeiture, it is disproportionately used in minority and disadvantaged communities.

Why? How? Because they don't have the money to get the assets back. The government seizes it. It spins due process on its head, and you have to go to court to prove the property is yours or that you are able to own it safely.

And when you talk about a gun, while guns aren't always cheap, lawyers are more expensive. So most people will simply buy another gun, rather than go back and fight the unjust action in courts. It is so ripe for abuse. It is horrible to see anyone who has sworn an oath to support and defend our Constitution support such measures. I hope people will pull back and rethink it; not rethink solving the problem.

Let's look at the Baker Act, and let's look at mental health. Let's look at these acts of despair that are wrecking our communities and individual lives, and let's stop falling for the fallacies that somehow gun control is going to end the actions of these doers of evil deeds.

Mr. Speaker, I thank the gentleman for hosting this special order.

Mr. ROSENDALE. Mr. Speaker, I am proud to stand here with the members of the Freedom Caucus tonight because they are the ones that understand we are standing here with a simple task, and that is to defend the rights of the people across this Nation. That is what our job is.

Mr. Speaker, I yield to the gentleman from Georgia (Mr. HICE), my good friend.

Mr. HICE of Georgia. Mr. Speaker, I thank the gentleman from Montana for your leadership on this issue and for all the members of the House Freedom Caucus who stand for the issues that are both constitutional and extremely important to the American citizens.

All of us, all of us, all of us have been shocked over and over to see the unspeakable acts of violence, mass shootings and the like that have taken place in recent years and are rising in intensity and frequency. We see the heartwrenching situations that these tragedies create in families and communities, and we see the rippling effect that they have in our Nation as a whole.

But far too often when these types of things happen, the reaction has become predictable from our colleagues on the other side of the aisle, from the media, from others who immediately jump to conclusions, politicize the tragedies, and transfer to an agenda that includes disarming law-abiding citizens and stripping away our constitutionally protected Second Amendment.

□ 2000

Stricter regulation is not the issue—it is not the answer. Stripping away constitutional rights of American citizens is not the answer to these problems.

When considering how to deal with issues like mass shootings, we need to dig down to the root cause. This is just common sense. We have a major problem, let's get to the cause of the problem.

Firearms are just a tool, and like with any tool, the tool is only as effective or ineffective as the one operating the tool. I am not a violent person, that is why I don't have violent guns. The guns are not the problem. The person is the problem.

If you have a violent person—as has already been stated tonight—a violent person is going to commit violent acts. What is our response here—let's not go after the person, let's not deal with the cause, let's go after the tool, the instrument that was used. That does not solve the problem.

If we are ever going to deal with issues like mass shootings, and a host of other issues of that nature, then we have got to look at the problem, which is the shooter. We, in this country right now, we are a Nation in deep moral and spiritual crisis.

Among other things, we are watching our values in the family unit deteriorate right under our nose. Just today in a hearing in the Oversight Committee where the Democrats were yet again offering one piece of legislation after another that continues to deteriorate and dismantle the most critical unit in this country—that is the family unit.

Mr. Speaker, I would challenge anyone to take a deeper look at those who have committed such violent, heinous crimes that we have watched and see what their family life was like, what their spiritual life was like, and we will start finding some of the issues here that must be addressed.

Yet, we have so many attempts right now to address all the wrong things.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The time of the gentleman has expired.

BIDEN'S ECONOMICS

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Under the Speaker's announced policy of January 4, 2021, the Chair recognizes the gentleman from Pennsylvania (Mr. SMUCKER) for 30 minutes.

Mr. SMUCKER. Mr. Speaker, I rise today to discuss something that has been on my mind—discuss an issue that we have been talking about and we have been holding hearings in both the Budget Committee and the Ways and Means Committee, and that is the state of our economy, which I would characterize as the dire state of our economy, which I believe—I will demonstrate with some charts this evening—is due to the reckless budgetary policies of this administration.

What I am talking about is today we have inflation at 8.6 percent, which is the highest level in over 40 years. We also have a GDP, or gross domestic product, the total output of our economy that is shrinking in the first quarter. It shrank 1.4 percent. We may well be on the way to a recession if the second quarter shows that it is shrinking as well.

So there is no better time than right now to renew our Nation's commitment to fiscal responsibility, and to make a difference in the lives of the people that we represent.

Let's talk a little bit about inflation. Food prices are up 10.1 percent. Real wages—that is the difference between inflation and the rise of wages—are down 3.4 percent as of today, meaning that the average family is facing an effective pay cut of $1,500 just this year.

Everyone knows gas prices are at their highest ever with average prices in my hometown of Lancaster, Pennsylvania, now exceeding $5 a gallon. Overall energy costs, home fuel oil, and others included, is up 34.6 percent.

Unfortunately, as I will point out tonight, the spending policies enacted and pushed by the Biden administration and by Democrats in Congress are really responsible for driving inflation and are certainly—even if you don't agree with that—they are certainly saddling future generations with debt. Someone will pay the price for the massive debt we have now, and unfortunately, that will be our kids and grandkids and future generations.

It has been said that Congress has a habit of only addressing problems when we reach a crisis—only addressing issues when we reach a crisis. That crisis may have already begun right now. We are in a pretty tough spot in our economy at the moment and people are feeling it every single day. We must step up to begin to address this.

Every Member of Congress, I am sure, has talked to their constituents and can share stories about how their constituents are impacted by rising prices. I can tell you myself, growing up as a child, I experienced what it was like to have it be difficult for my family to afford food.

I was one of 12 kids. My father was first a farmer and a roofer, my mom was a stay-at-home mom. I can tell you about a stressful time for my mother was going to the grocery store. The reason for that is because she knew she would not have quite enough money to buy everything that she thought she needed.

I remember walking with her up and down the aisles and she was calculating in her head how much she was putting in the cart. She was very concerned that she would get to the register and be embarrassed that she would have to put some things back. Today, people are feeling that.

I hear in my district, for instance, my constituent, Lamar, he put the impact of inflation in clear terms. He tells me that he spends more now but has less. He is doing with less. Paul says he is sadly giving up on his hopes of retirement at this time. Tim said he has to choose between gas and groceries every week. Lavern is 66 years old and had to go back to work to help out his children and his grandchildren now, though the impact of inflation on future debt will mean, as I mentioned earlier, that his grandchildren will be paying the cost of the reckless spending that we are seeing now. They will be paying for that for decades.

We have all heard from our constituents. We have heard their outcries. We have heard them talk to us about needing to rein in inflation. I think it is time that we take it as a wakeup call. Let's identify the causes of inflation and work to mitigate them.

That is one of the reasons that I wanted to get up and speak tonight because we have had debates in both of the committees that I mentioned about the causes of inflation—and that is not just a political debate—it is not just because. It is because the only way that we can begin to solve it is to understand the root cause of inflation, what led to where we are now, and then what we can do to change it.

It is going to take leadership at all levels of government to address not only inflation, but the $30 trillion now in debt, and trillions of dollars in deficits as far as we can see and as far as the Biden budget projects.

I am a businessowner, not an economist, so I can't even say that I have all the answers. What I can tell you is that I believe that capitalism, freedom, and free enterprise have made the United States the most powerful Nation in the history of the world and has provided more opportunity than ever before in the history of humankind. I think returning to those core values can help lead us—will help lead us—out of this mess.

First of all, there is a chart I will show you. Inflation does not arrive randomly. There are forces that cause inflation. Every time we have seen inflation in our history there are forces that cause it.

In this case, we have had things that are outside of our control, Democrats will argue, and the President blames inflation on COVID–19, supply chain disruptions, Russia's invasion of Ukraine, the big bad oil and gas companies, and other things. I don't know what the next thing is that he will be blaming inflation on. I agree, they have certainly played a role in causing inflation.

However, those challenges are the same challenges that every other country across the world has faced and they do not explain why inflation in the United States spiked earlier and is much worse than what we are seeing in other countries.

This chart shows the annual core CPI inflation compared to OECD, which is sort of peer countries, the Organization for Economic Cooperation in Development Countries. It shows how inflation spiked starting roughly the beginning of 2021 and far exceeded that of a comparable country. What caused that?

I have another chart that puts a little finer point on this. This shows that inflation started about the time that Biden took office and really accelerated after the passing of the American Rescue Plan, which put trillions of dollars in spending into our economy.

Now, I showed that chart today in a hearing in the Budget Committee to Mr. Stephen Moore of the Save America Coalition, and he agreed that the clear difference between what we saw in the past chart, the blue line, and the other countries, the clear difference was the stimulus that was provided, the increase in demand that was provided by inserting trillions of dollars into the U.S. economy through the American Rescue Plan Act.

Mr. Speaker, I include in the RECORD an article I wrote, an op-ed that was published in The Hill on how President Biden's policies have caused and will further fuel inflation.

[From The Hill, Mar. 31, 2022]

BIDEN'S SPENDING PLAN WILL FURTHER FUEL INFLATION

(By Rep. Lloyd Smucker)

Americans are concerned about the economy. A recent NBC poll indicated that only 33 percent of Americans approve of President Joe Biden's handling of the economy. Inflation is now at a 40-year high and has families concerned about their financial well-being as they gather to review their budgets around the kitchen table.

Democrats try to dismiss inflation as a mere nuisance for Americans who have to cut back on so-called ''luxuries.'' When my constituents point out that gas is too expensive, Democrats shrug and tell them to buy a Tesla. The Penn Wharton Budget Model concluded that inflation disproportionately impacts lower income Americans who have to pay an even higher percentage of their income on necessities like food and transportation. The latest consumer price index report shows prices for food are up 7.9 percent, gasoline prices recently reached record highs. We need to help the Americans who can't afford to put gas in their car, let alone buy an expensive new electric car.

Inflation isn't just an economic term; it has real world consequences for the constituents that I represent. In my district, I think of Connie who at 70 years old is looking for a part-time job to help make ends meet because of the higher cost of everyday necessities. I think of Tim who told me he must decide between buying gas or groceries. I think of Lynne who told me that she and her husband are planning to put off retiring because of higher prices.

These kinds of stories are commonplace as inflation strains family budgets across the nation. The Biden administration claimed inflation was ''temporary'' and now places blame on everything except his reckless spending. We know that the left's irresponsible spending has accelerated inflation past harmful levels. A study from the Federal Reserve Bank of San Francisco concludes that Biden's spending led to higher levels of inflation.

As the saying goes, an organization's budget is a statement of its values. Now that President Biden released his Fiscal Year 2023 budget, albeit seven weeks past the statutory deadline, we can see clearly that this administration puts wasteful, inflationary spending before all else. While the president preaches fiscal restraint, this budget puts forth policies reaffirming the president's tax-and-spend march towards socialism.

Biden's proposed budget would spend $5.8 trillion next fiscal year. His proposal would continue to pile on to the national debt, which eclipsed $30 trillion earlier this year. By their own estimates, his spending plan will add nearly $15 trillion in new debt over the next decade, with annual budget deficits of at least $1 trillion per year.

The Biden administration continues to live in an alternate reality when it comes to their inflation predictions. Their budget report estimated the consumer price index (CPI) would increase 4.7 percent for 2022. The most recent reading from the Bureau of Labor Statistics reports that CPI is up 7.9 percent over the last year. In last year's budget, they predicted only a 2.1 percent change in CPI for 2022, far off the mark from the high levels of inflation that we're experiencing.

Buried deep within the administration's remarks in the ''analytical perspectives'' the Biden administration believes that inflation will return to its long-term trend in 2023 despite ''considerable uncertainty'' and their efforts to continue the White House's messaging blaming Russia for increased inflation. They have spent nearly a year deflecting that their policies contribute to inflation, but at least the administration is no longer parroting that inflation is temporary.

From what we've read in Biden's first two budget proposals, Americans should remain concerned about his dangerous levels of spending, what it means for the future financial health of our nation, and what it means for the future of inflation levels. Our $30 trillion national debt significantly impacts the next generation of Americans. Continuing to run trillion-dollar deficits and adding more to our mountainous debt further endangers our future.

While President Biden and congressional Democrats have tried to move on from their months-long public feud on spending, House Republicans are united in our fundamental principles of working to renew fiscal sanity in Washington through a limited government, pro-growth tax policy, and strengthening our free enterprise system to create opportunities for Americans to live the American Dream. We will exercise robust oversight of President Biden's spending spree to hold this administration accountable. We will continue to fight against wasteful spending ballooning our debt and deficit. House Republicans will work to put America's fiscal house in order.

Mr. SMUCKER. Mr. Speaker, March 2021, the Biden administration and congressional Democrats rammed through $1.9 trillion in deficit spending, and only a small portion of that really went to solving problems and helping people that needed help through the pandemic—that helped to defeat the pandemic. Much of this was not needed and only served to fuel inflation.

By the way, they were warned by many economic experts. We warned them. Republicans on the Budget Committee and the Ways and Means Committee warned Democrats at the time this was passed in early 2021 that we would see exactly this result. We were relying on the forecasts of many economists who were saying exactly that, who were warning the administration of that at the time. Not just Republican economists, by the way.

There is a name that many of you will know, he is a former Obama and Clinton economist, Treasury Secretary Larry Summers, warned that the American Rescue Plan would be the biggest macroeconomic mistake in 40 years, and it would cause inflationary pressures of a kind that we have not seen in a generation.

Again, Larry Summers, a very well-respected Democrat administration economist warning that we would be seeing the inflation that we are seeing now, over a year ago, when the American Rescue Plan was passed.

Just recently a study by the San Francisco Federal Reserve confirms that prediction, attributing the American Rescue Plan for at least three points of the current 8.6 percent. Mark Goldwein of the Committee for a Responsible Federal Budget, CRFB, described the American Rescue Plan as ''pouring gasoline on the fire,'' in terms of an already stimulated economy.

In my discussion with CBO director, Phillip Swagel, during a House Budget

Committee hearing last month, he also agreed—head of CBO—that the American Rescue Plan Act pumped trillions of dollars into the economy that artificially fueled demand and ultimately drove today's inflation crisis.

□ 2015

So what happened?

We had far too much cash in the economy and far too much demand.

I will show you, Mr. Speaker, something that my Governor in Pennsylvania said. Governor Wolf tweeted that he wanted to send more money to people all across Pennsylvania after jobs were open and people were back to work because he said, ''States are swimming with cash.''

They have an unusual problem in Pennsylvania right now today. This is the week they are finishing the Pennsylvania budget, and they have more money than they know what to do with. Much of that came as a result of the American Rescue Plan, and it was excess money that wasn't needed in the economy.

So those funds would have been far better used paying down the deficit, paying down the debt, and not fueling inflation by artificially boosting demand. So it really is unfortunate because this hurts my constituents, and it hurts people all across the country that the White House did not heed the call of experts sooner and did not take steps to reduce the impact of inflation.

For a while the White House instead said that inflation would be transitory, and now just recently Secretary of the Treasury Yellen and Fed Chairman Jerome Powell backed off that argument and agreed that they were wrong, and that inflation was not transitory. We have a real problem dealing with inflation at this point.

Secretary Yellen said in a Ways and Means hearing just last week: ''I think I was wrong then about the path that inflation could take.''

One of the sad things about inflation is that it impacts different people differently. The White House has claimed that inflation and the economy's challenges that we are seeing today are high-class woes reserved for the rich. But instead, it is the people on the lower end of the economic scale who are making less money who are impacted more than any others by inflation.

The Penn Wharton Budget Model concluded that inflation disproportionately impacts lower-income Americans who have to pay an even higher percentage of their income on necessities like food and transportation, the price increases for which outpace the general inflation rate.

As I mentioned earlier, the White House tries to blame multiple sources: corporate greed, gas companies, Russia, and whatever else may be as a source of inflation. But I think that only serves to deflect blame, obscure the truth, and prevent us from coming to an agreement where we can then begin to solve this.

I think the President became more interested in inflation after seeing his plummeting approval rate. He is now talking about inflation being a top priority of the administration. In fact, just recently he wrote an op-ed in The Wall Street Journal titled: ''My Plan for Fighting Inflation.''

I will talk just briefly about that. He begins the op-ed by arguing that our economy is actually in great shape, which strikes me as being about as out of touch as you can get. He apparently isn't talking to the constituents whom I talk to on a regular basis.

He lays out three points for combating inflation.

One, well, it is the Fed's job; two, his energy policies and build back better agenda will fix it; and three, a supposed newfound commitment to fiscal discipline.

In the op-ed he said that he welcomes debate on his plan. And maybe tonight that is what we are doing. We are debating what really are the ways that we can combat inflation and whether his plan really will work.

So let's talk about the Fed because the President's first point was arguing that it is the Fed's responsibility to control inflation. And the President, again, has spent 1½ years pushing policies that fuel inflation and then points to the Fed to fix the problem.

Now, I do agree that the Fed has a role in controlling inflation, and essentially the tool they have will be to raise interest rates to try to slow down the economy. But we all know that raising rates will be required, which they are doing now. Tomorrow they are talking about a 0.75 percent increase in the Federal rate, which is a significant increase, and they are talking about doing that multiple times. So it has significant consequences on our economy both in the short and long term.

What do I mean by that?

It makes it more expensive for businesses to borrow money. It makes it more expensive for individuals to borrow money. We are seeing home mortgage rates go up significantly already that will continue to do that, and hundreds of thousands fewer people today are able to afford to buy a home when they could have done so when they were lower. So there will be a decrease for demand of goods and services which, again, is an attempt to tamp down the economy to decrease demand and decrease spending.

The other entity that is affected by rising interest rates is the Federal Government. We are $30 trillion in debt. This chart shows what will happen as interest rates are being raised. By just raising one-half of a percent—you see the first line—will increase interest costs over the next 10 years by $1.3 trillion. Going up 2 percent will increase interest costs by $5.3 trillion over the next 10 years.

Now, let's put that in perspective. That would be, under the President's plan, 1.5 times our current Medicare spending, 1.4 times our current defense spending, and 11 times our current veterans' healthcare spending. So every single dollar that we have to pay in additional interest costs will be taking dollars from programs that help people across the country and will be taking dollars out of our economy.

Increasing national debt is also a threat to our national security. Mr. Speaker, I also wrote an op-ed in May that was published in The Washington Times.

I include in the RECORD the article.

[From the Washington Times, May 17, 2022]

WHEN THE BALLOON POPS: INFLATING OUR DEBT AND UNDERMINING OUR SECURITY

(By Rep. Lloyd Smucker)

OPINION:

Twelve years ago, Joint Chiefs of Staff Chair Adm. Michael Mullen famously warned, ''the most significant threat to our national security is our debt.'' At the time, the nation's federal debt was roughly $13.5 trillion. Congress and our government have completely ignored Mr. Mullen's warning; our national debt has now surpassed $30 trillion and is growing exponentially.

China now owns $1.1 trillion of that debt, the second-highest total among foreign sovereign governments, a clear threat to our national security. If current trends continue, that number will increase to $1.7 trillion over the next decade.

Mr. Mullen recognized the tangible risks rising deficits have on our nation. Every dollar spent servicing our debt, meaning dollars spent paying the interest on the debt already accrued, are dollars not spent on funding national priorities. Currently, the Congressional Budget Office estimates that we will pay an average of $543 billion per year on just the interest for our nation's $30 trillion-plus in national debt.

President Biden's Fiscal Year 2023 Budget only worsens the problem. Under the president's proposed spending plan, interest payments would jump to an average of $756 billion per year, meaning $2 trillion more in total interest payments over the next 10 years than currently projected.

Our country would be paying over $1 trillion in interest payments to service the debt by 2031. To put that in perspective, by 2031, we would pay 1.5 times our current Medicare outlays and 1.4 times our current defense budget on interest payments. As Undersecretary of Defense Comptroller Michael McCord agreed during our discussion at the House Budget Committee, the increasing burden of mandatory interest payments threatens to crowd out discretionary spending priorities, such as our defense budget.

Mr. Mullen warned us that our debt would soon reach a point where we spent more paying off interest than funding our military, risking our national security. Under the president's budget, that warning will be proved true in 2029. Given that China owns an increasing amount of our debt, those interest payments will directly fund the interests of an economic, and perhaps military, adversary.

Unfortunately, rampant, irresponsible federal spending has compounding consequences on our economy.

Mr. Biden and House Democrats are wreaking havoc on our economy and fueling inflation. Spurred by the $1.9 trillion American Rescue Plan Act, the inflationary impacts of which were forecasted and have been confirmed, our government ran a $2.8 trillion deficit in 2021. The results of this massive spending influx by the federal government have been immediate and drastic: The Bureau of Labor Statistics reports that the

consumer price index for all items rose 8.3 percent over the past year, near the highest level in over 40 years.

Inflation not only harms our economy in the immediate future but also has long-term impacts on the cost of servicing our debt. In March, in an attempt to tamp down Mr. Biden's inflation, the Federal Reserve Board raised benchmark interest rates by 0.25 percentage points. On May 4, the Fed raised interest rates an additional 0.50 percentage points, the largest single increase since 2000. These rate hikes will have a ripple effect across our economy, including on servicing our national debt. As inflation persists this year, the Fed is expected to continue to raise rates at least 5 more times this year, with rates expected to surpass 1.9 percent.

The Committee for a Responsible Federal Budget, a nonpartisan nonprofit research organization, reports, ''If interest rates are 50 basis points (0.50 percentage points) higher than projected, average annual interest costs would increase by $94 billion per year.'' Even higher interest rate hikes will have even more devastating impacts. If interest rates were to exceed CBO's projections by 2 percentage points each year, similar to the Fed's expected actions for this year, our nation could spend an additional $3.7 trillion servicing our debt over the next decade.

This does not even factor in expected spending increases under Mr. Biden's budget—this is just the impact of what has already been spent. My Republican colleagues on the House Budget Committee have prepared an analysis titled ''The Consequences of Higher Interest Rates to the Federal Budget,'' which provides an even grimmer outlook on the long-term impacts of rate hikes on our nation's fiscal strength.

The Biden administration's spending increases the debt from the outset, and the Fed's response to control inflation by raising rates balloons the cost of our debt even more. Our national security will falter. America will be forced to fund China's rise. Generations yet to be born will be paying the price for Mr. Biden's inflation. It is long past time for Congress to step up and rein in this out-of-control spending and inflation.

Mr. SMUCKER. The article lays out how increased inflation ultimately undermines our national security.

China, perhaps our greatest adversary of the next decade, now owns $1.1 trillion of the national debt. That is the second highest total among foreign sovereign governments, and increased dependence on China is a clear threat to our national security.

If the current trends continue, China's portion of our national debt will increase to $1.7 trillion over the next decade. Interest payments as they rise will mean more income for China and will directly fuel China's growth making them a stronger economic and military adversary.

Twelve years ago, Joint Chiefs of Staff Chairman Admiral Michael Mullen famously warned: ''The most significant threat to our national security is our debt.'' That was 12 years ago. The most significant threat to our national security is our national debt.

At that time, by the way, the Nation's Federal debt was roughly $13.5 trillion. Now it is at $30 trillion and growing.

What could be even worse is if our lenders lose faith in the ability of the United States to pay back and make good on those loans. If they essentially lose faith in the credit of the United States, that would be what we call a sovereign debt crisis which would have a major economic impact in the United States affecting every single American.

By the way, that is not merely a hypothetical. We have seen major nations face sovereign debt crises. In 2009 Greece's budget deficits totaled 12.7 percent of its GDP. By 2012, Greece's debt-to-GDP ratio was 160 percent. Under CRFB's analysis our debt held by the public will reach 126 percent of GDP by 2032 with the anticipated increased interest rates. If we don't change this trajectory, this will put us well on the way to a fiscal calamity like Greece has experienced not long ago, just a few years ago.

So it is long past time for the U.S. to get our fiscal house in order and abandon the reckless budgetary policies that sank the Greek economy at that time.

Let's talk just briefly about energy, Mr. Speaker, another big factor in the rising prices that we are seeing. This chart sort of blows me away. Average prices of gas in my hometown right now exceed $5 a gallon. Think about that, Mr. Speaker. Just a year and a half ago, 2 years ago, no one would have imagined that we would be spending $5 per gallon. You see the same kind of increases in home fuel, Mr. Speaker, heating costs, and so on. And the President blames oil and gas markets for that high inflation rate, and he focuses on the role of Russia in driving those.

But do you know what is amazing, Mr. Speaker?

Under President Trump when President Biden took office, our Nation was energy independent and becoming a net exporter of oil in 2019. Some of the very first actions that President Biden took were to halt drilling on Federal lands and to stop the Keystone pipeline. Even as prices went up, the administration doubled down on limiting the supply of our drilling. No new permits were approved. So it is a classic economic formula. They dramatically increased demand and reduced supply which led to the prices that we are seeing now.

The President just put out his new budget. He says that now—really the first time I think since he has been in office—it is important to reduce deficits. I welcome that. I think it is important that we reduce deficits. We have to reduce the debt long term. He claims credit for reducing the Federal deficit by $1.7 trillion this year due to the expiration of spending in the American Rescue Plan which, by the way, is all deficit spending. He says that this reduction demonstrates a newfound commitment to fiscal discipline.

Now, let's just look at that for a little bit.

If I eat 10,000 calories today—which is way more than I need—and tomorrow I eat 5,000, well, that won't make me a model. It doesn't mean that I am on any kind of a diet.

Look at this plan. This is the President's budget straight from his budget documents. I get it. There was an anomaly during COVID. It was a challenge for all of us, and the deficit went way up during COVID. But look at the deficit before COVID which is the second bar on the left side.

And then coming out of COVID what happens?

Do you see—if you take out the two COVID years which was an exception, an anomaly, do you see deficits declining at all?

No. In fact, they are going up every single year.

That is not fiscal responsibility. In fact, I call it swamp math, to say that we are reducing deficits when this is exactly what it looks like in their budget plan. It is swamp math.

Mr. Speaker, if you set one foot outside the beltway, I can tell you that every single American who looks at this does not believe that we are reducing deficits in any way.

□ 2030

I don't mean that as a knock on the administration. Well, I guess I do mean it as a knock on the administration.

But what I really mean to say is that we have to get serious about implementing policies that will drive growth and that will result in lower deficits over time, or we will be going down that path of fiscal calamity.

Besides this, the other thing that the President is calling for, still calling for, is what he calls the Build Back Better plan. This is outlined in his budget.

Now, I call it build back bankrupt because it continues to put us on a path of a potential sovereign debt crisis. It certainly continues to build debt for our kids, our grandkids, and future generations.

The build back bankrupt plan imposes new taxes, 36 new taxes, on Americans and dramatically increases spending beyond what you see here. This is what they want to do, while they are claiming to do this, which they are saying is reducing deficits. It makes no sense whatsoever.

One of the other things I want to mention—I am running out of time here.

It has just been recently that we have had this economy working on all cylinders, and we could be doing that again. This economy could be in a far different position if we implemented policies similar to what were done under the Tax Cuts and Jobs Act under the previous administration.

Just before COVID hit, we were seeing the impact. Almost every measure you could possibly take showed that the economy was working for the American people. By the way, middle-income American, the average household income increased by $6,000 per year. That is a real impact. People were feeling it, compared to a $3,500 drop in real wages during this administration.

The TCJA boosted workers' paychecks. Income and wealth inequality fell. Real wages for the bottom 10 percent, by the way, grew nearly twice as fast as the top 10 percent. Real wealth of the bottom 50 percent of households rose three times faster than that of the top 1 percent.

Despite the challenges that we face now, I think hope is not lost. I am optimistic that if we implement the right policies, America can once again work for the American people. We need to be committed to that. We need to have a discussion about what policies will work.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The time of the gentleman has expired.

SENATE ENROLLED BILL SIGNED

The Speaker announced her signature to an enrolled bill of the Senate of the following title:

S. 3580—An act to amend title 46, United States Code, with respect to prohibited acts by ocean common carriers or marine terminal operators, and for other purposes.

ADJOURNMENT

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Pursuant to section 11(b) of House Resolution 188, the House stands adjourned until 10 a.m. tomorrow for morning-hour debate and noon for legislative business.

Thereupon (at 8 o'clock and 33 minutes p.m.), under its previous order, the House adjourned until tomorrow, Wednesday, June 15, 2022, at 10 a.m. for morning-hour debate.

OATH OF OFFICE MEMBERS, RESIDENT COMMISSONER, AND DELEGATES

The oath of office required by the sixth article of the Constitution of the United States, and as provided by section 2 of the act of May 13, 1884 (23 Stat. 22), to be administered to Members, Resident Commissioner, and Delegates of the House of Representatives, the text of which is carried in 5 U.S.C. 3331:

> ''I, AB, do solemnly swear (or affirm) that I will support and defend the Constitution of the United States against all enemies, foreign and domestic; that I will bear true faith and allegiance to the same; that I take this obligation freely, without any mental reservation or purpose of evasion; and that I will well and faithfully discharge the duties of the office on which I am about to enter. So help me God.''

has been subscribed to in person and filed in duplicate with the Clerk of the House of Representatives by the following Member of the 117th Congress, pursuant to the provisions of 2 U.S.C. 25:

CONNIE CONWAY, Twenty-Second District of California.

EXECUTIVE COMMUNICATIONS, ETC.

Under clause 2 of rule XIV, executive communications were taken from the Speaker's table and referred as follows:

EC–4334. A letter from the Assistant Administrator, Office of Policy and Program Development, Department of Agriculture, transmitting the Department's final rule — Removal of 9 CFR 355--Certified Products for Dogs, Cats, and Other Carnivora; Inspection, Certification, and Identification as to Class, Quality, Quantity, and Condition [Docket No.: FSIS-2020-0013] (RIN: 0583-AD83) received June 7, 2022, pursuant to 5 U.S.C. 801(a)(1)(A); Public Law 104-121, Sec. 251; (110 Stat. 868); to the Committee on Agriculture.

EC–4335. A letter from the Assistant Administrator, Office of Policy and Program Development, Department of Agriculture, transmitting the Department's final rule — Elimination of the Requirement To Defibrinate Livestock Blood Saved as an Edible Product [Docket No.: FSIS-2020-0005] (RIN: 0583-AD81) received June 7, 2022, pursuant to 5 U.S.C. 801(a)(1)(A); Public Law 104-121, Sec. 251; (110 Stat. 868); to the Committee on Agriculture.

EC–4336. A letter from the Senior Congressional Liaison, Bureau of Consumer Financial Protection, transmitting the Bureau's advisory opinion — Equal Credit Opportunity (Regulation B); Revocations or Unfavorable Changes to the Terms of Existing Credit Arrangements received June 9, 2022, pursuant to 5 U.S.C. 801(a)(1)(A); Public Law 104-121, Sec. 251; (110 Stat. 868); to the Committee on Financial Services.

EC–4337. A letter from the President and Chair, Board of Directors, Export-Import Bank of the United States, transmitting a transaction pursuant to section 2(b)(3) of the Export-Import Bank Act of 1945, pursuant to 12 U.S.C. 635(b)(3); July 31, 1945, ch. 341, Sec. 2 (as added by Public Law 102-266, Sec. 102); (106 Stat. 95); to the Committee on Financial Services.

EC–4338. A letter from the Acting Assistant Secretary, Employee Benefits Security Administration, Department of Labor, transmitting the Department's final rule — Annual Information Return/Reports (RIN: 1210-AB97) received June 8, 2022, pursuant to 5 U.S.C. 801(a)(1)(A); Public Law 104-121, Sec. 251; (110 Stat. 868); to the Committee on Education and Labor.

EC–4339. A letter from the Division Chief, Competition Policy Division, Wireline Competition Bureau, Federal Communications Commission, transmitting the Commission's Major final rule — In the Matter of Advanced Methods to Target and Eliminate Unlawful Robocalls [CG Docket No.: 17-59]; Call Authentication Trust Anchor [WC Docket No.: 17-97] received June 3, 2022, pursuant to 5 U.S.C. 801(a)(1)(A); Public Law 104-121, Sec. 251; (110 Stat. 868); to the Committee on Energy and Commerce.

EC–4340. A letter from the Director, Office of Congressional Affairs, Office of Nuclear Reactor Regulation, Nuclear Regulatory Commission, transmitting the Commission's NUREG — Fuel Qualification for Advanced Reactors [NRC-2021-0112] received June 9, 2022, pursuant to 5 U.S.C. 801(a)(1)(A); Public Law 104-121, Sec. 251; (110 Stat. 868); to the Committee on Energy and Commerce.

EC–4341. A letter from the Senior Bureau Official, Bureau of Legislative Affairs, Department of State, transmitting Department Report Number: 004769, pursuant to Public Law 116-260, div. K, title VII, Sec. 7070; (134 Stat. 1813) and Public Law 116-260, div. K, title VII, Sec. 7070; (134 Stat. 1813); to the Committee on Foreign Affairs.

EC–4342. A letter from the Senior Bureau Official, Bureau of Legislative Affairs, Department of State, transmitting Department Notification Number: DDTC 21-068; to the Committee on Foreign Affairs.

EC–4343. A letter from the Regulations Officer, Senior Attorney Advisor, Federal Highway Administration, Department of Transportation, transmitting the Department's final rule — Diversion of Highway Revenues; Removal of Obsolete Regulation (RIN: 2125-AG04) received June 7, 2022, pursuant to 5 U.S.C. 801(a)(1)(A); Public Law 104-121, Sec. 251; (110 Stat. 868); to the Committee on Transportation and Infrastructure.

EC–4344. A letter from the Regulations Officer, Senior Attorney, Federal Highway Administration, Department of Transportation, transmitting the Department's final rule — National Bridge Inspection Standards [FHWA Docket No.: FHWA-2017-0047] (RIN: 2125-AF55) received June 7, 2022, pursuant to 5 U.S.C. 801(a)(1)(A); Public Law 104-121, Sec. 251; (110 Stat. 868); to the Committee on Transportation and Infrastructure.

REPORTS OF COMMITTEES ON PUBLIC BILLS AND RESOLUTIONS

Under clause 2 of rule XIII, reports of committees were delivered to the Clerk for printing and reference to the proper calendar, as follows:

Ms. JOHNSON of Texas: Committee on Science, Space, and Technology. H.R. 6933. A bill to amend the Energy Policy Act of 2005 to require reporting relating to certain cost-share requirements (Rept. 177–367). Referred to the Committee of the Whole House on the state of the Union.

Mr. DAVID SCOTT of Georgia: Committee on Agriculture. H.R. 4140. A bill to make improvements with respect to the pricing of cattle in the United States, and for other purposes; with an amendment (Rept. 117–368). Referred to the Committee of the Whole House on the state of the Union.

Ms. JOHNSON of Texas: Committee on Science, Space, and Technology. H.R. 3588. A bill to coordinate Federal research and development efforts focused on modernizing mathematics in STEM education through mathematical and statistical modeling, including data-driven and computational thinking, problem, project, and performance-based learning and assessment, interdisciplinary exploration, and career connections, and for other purposes (Rept. 177–369). Referred to the Committee of the Whole House on the state of the Union.

PUBLIC BILLS AND RESOLUTIONS

Under clause 2 of rule XII, public bills and resolutions of the following titles were introduced and severally referred, as follows:

By Mr. GRAVES of Louisiana (for himself, Mr. LARSEN of Washington, Mr. GRAVES of Missouri, and Mr. DEFAZIO):

H.R. 8049. A bill to require the Secretary of Transportation to establish the Aerospace Supply Chain Resiliency Task Force, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Transportation and Infrastructure.

By Mr. PAPPAS (for himself, Ms. MALLIOTAKIS, Mr. O'HALLERAN, Mr. BEYER, Mr. KHANNA, Mr. CARSON, Ms. KAPTUR, Mr. NEGUSE, Mrs. WATSON COLEMAN, Ms. KUSTER, Mrs. NAPOLITANO, Mr. MALINOWSKI, Mr. CONNOLLY, Mr. SUOZZI, Ms. MCCOLLUM, Mr. CARBAJAL, Ms. MACE, Mr. FITZPATRICK, Mr. CLYDE, Mr. ROSE, Mr. KELLY of Pennsylvania, Mr. CARTER of Georgia, Mr. GARBARINO, Mr.

VAN DREW, Mr. BOST, Mr. MOOLENAAR, Ms. LETLOW, Mr. BUDD, Mr. RICE of South Carolina, Ms. TENNEY, Ms. SALAZAR, Mr. CRAWFORD, Mr. TIFFANY, Ms. VAN DUYNE, Mr. VALADAO, Mr. DUNN, and Mr. MCCAUL):

H.R. 8050. A bill to reauthorize the Fallen Heroes Flag Act of 2016; to the Committee on House Administration.

By Mr. BEYER (for himself, Mr. BROWN of Maryland, Mr. RUPPERSBERGER, Mr. LOWENTHAL, Mr. EVANS, Ms. TLAIB, Mrs. CAROLYN B. MALONEY of New York, Ms. MCCOLLUM, Mr. DAVID SCOTT of Georgia, Mrs. WATSON COLEMAN, Mr. CONNOLLY, Mr. CASTEN, Ms. JACOBS of California, Mr. MALINOWSKI, Mr. JOHNSON of Georgia, Mr. CLEAVER, Mr. RASKIN, Ms. TITUS, Mr. COHEN, Mr. LANGEVIN, Mr. MFUME, Ms. SCHAKOWSKY, Mr. LYNCH, Ms. BARRAGÁN, Mr. BLUMENAUER, Mr. GRIJALVA, Ms. NORTON, Ms. LEE of California, Mr. LIEU, Ms. JAYAPAL, Ms. PORTER, Ms. ADAMS, Ms. WILSON of Florida, Mr. CARSON, Mrs. TRAHAN, Ms. BROWNLEY, and Mr. PRICE of North Carolina):

H.R. 8051. A bill to amend the Internal Revenue Code of 1986 to impose an additional 1000 percent excise tax on the sale of large capacity ammunition feeding devices and semiautomatic assault weapons, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Ways and Means.

By Mr. CARTER of Georgia (for himself and Mr. PETERS):

H.R. 8052. A bill to direct the Secretary of Energy to conduct a study on the global status of the civilian nuclear energy industry, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Energy and Commerce, and in addition to the Committee on Foreign Affairs, for a period to be subsequently determined by the Speaker, in each case for consideration of such provisions as fall within the jurisdiction of the committee concerned.

By Mr. CROW (for himself, Mr. PETERS, and Mr. BACON):

H.R. 8053. A bill to provide the Secretary of Energy with the authority to enter into contracts and cooperative agreements to improve the resilience of defense critical electric infrastructure and reduce the vulnerability of critical defense facilities to the disruption of the supply of electric energy to those facilities; to the Committee on Energy and Commerce.

By Mr. DIAZ-BALART (for himself, Ms. WASSERMAN SCHULTZ, Mrs. MURPHY of Florida, Mrs. CAMMACK, Mr. WEBSTER of Florida, Ms. SALAZAR, Mr. SOTO, Mr. LAWSON of Florida, Mr. POSEY, Mr. RUTHERFORD, Mr. STEUBE, Mr. C. SCOTT FRANKLIN of Florida, Mr. GIMENEZ, Mr. CRIST, and Mr. BUCHANAN):

H.R. 8054. A bill to modify minimum required weight of orange juice soluble solids; to the Committee on Energy and Commerce.

By Mr. GARCIA of California:

H.R. 8055. A bill to require State educational agencies to hire and train school resource officers, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Education and Labor, and in addition to the Committees on Oversight and Reform, Financial Services, Transportation and Infrastructure, and Foreign Affairs, for a period to be subsequently determined by the Speaker, in each case for consideration of such provisions as fall within the jurisdiction of the committee concerned.

By Miss GONZÁLEZ-COLÓN (for herself, Mrs. MURPHY of Florida, Mr. PALAZZO, and Mr. WALTZ):

H.R. 8056. A bill to require the Secretary of Homeland Security to assess technology needs along the maritime border and develop a strategy for bridging such gaps, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Homeland Security.

By Ms. JACOBS of California (for herself, Mr. FITZPATRICK, Ms. BASS, Mrs. KIM of California, Ms. SALAZAR, and Ms. MCCOLLUM):

H.R. 8057. A bill to amend the Foreign Assistance Act of 1961 to implement policies to end preventable maternal, newborn, and child deaths globally; to the Committee on Foreign Affairs.

By Mr. JOYCE of Ohio (for himself, Mr. TURNER, Ms. BROWN of Ohio, and Ms. ROSS):

H.R. 8058. A bill to require the Attorney General to propose a program for making treatment for post-traumatic stress disorder and acute stress disorder available to public safety officers, and for other purposes; to the Committee on the Judiciary.

By Mr. NEGUSE (for himself, Mr. BURCHETT, and Mr. FOSTER):

H.R. 8059. A bill to require the Administrator of the Environmental Protection Agency to carry out certain activities to improve recycling and composting programs in the United States, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Energy and Commerce.

By Mrs. RODGERS of Washington (for herself and Mr. HIMES):

H.R. 8060. A bill to promote the creation of State anonymous school threat reporting programs, and for other purposes; to the Committee on the Judiciary.

By Ms. ROSS (for herself, Mr. SWALWELL, Mr. RESCHENTHALER, and Ms. SALAZAR):

H.R. 8061. A bill to amend title 18, United States Code, to eliminate the statute of limitations for the filing of a civil claim for any person who, while a minor, was a victim of a violation of section 1589, 1590, 1591, 2241(c), 2242, 2243, 2251, 2251A, 2252, 2252A, 2260, 2421, 2422, or 2423 of such title; to the Committee on the Judiciary.

By Mr. ROUZER:

H.R. 8062. A bill to amend title 18, United States Code to prohibit picketing or parading certain buildings or residences; to the Committee on the Judiciary.

By Mr. SCHNEIDER (for himself and Mr. BILIRAKIS):

H.R. 8063. A bill to amend title XVIII of the Social Security Act to repeal the private cause of action for damages in the case of a primary plan which fails to provide for primary payment or appropriate reimbursement; to the Committee on Ways and Means, and in addition to the Committee on Energy and Commerce, for a period to be subsequently determined by the Speaker, in each case for consideration of such provisions as fall within the jurisdiction of the committee concerned.

By Mrs. TORRES of California (for herself and Mr. FLEISCHMANN):

H.R. 8064. A bill to amend the Workforce Innovation and Opportunity Act to establish demonstration and pilot projects to facilitate education and training programs in the field of advanced manufacturing; to the Committee on Education and Labor.

By Mr. WALTZ (for himself, Mr. SOTO, Mr. DONALDS, Mr. SWALWELL, and Mr. GOTTHEIMER):

H.R. 8065. A bill to authorize the development of a national strategy for the research and development of distributed ledger technologies and their applications, to authorize awards to support research on distributed ledger technologies and their applications, and to authorize an applied research project on distributed ledger technologies in commerce; to the Committee on Science, Space, and Technology.

By Mr. YARMUTH:

H.R. 8066. A bill to make technical changes clarifying section 502 of the Federal Credit Reform Act of 1990; to the Committee on the Budget.

By Mr. YARMUTH:

H.R. 8067. A bill to make technical changes clarifying section 503 of the Federal Credit Reform Act of 1990; to the Committee on the Budget.

By Mr. JEFFRIES:

H. Res. 1173. A resolution electing Members to certain standing committees of the House of Representatives; considered and agreed to.

By Mr. BURGESS (for himself and Mrs. AXNE):

H. Res. 1174. A resolution supporting the goals and ideals of ''Deep Vein Thrombosis and Pulmonary Embolism Awareness Month''; to the Committee on Energy and Commerce.

By Miss RICE of New York (for herself, Mr. KATKO, Mr. FITZPATRICK, Ms. JACKSON LEE, Mr. PAPPAS, Mr. GUEST, Mrs. LEE of Nevada, and Mr. RUTHERFORD):

H. Res. 1175. A resolution supporting the designation of June 26, 2022 as the ''International Day against Drug Abuse and Illicit Trafficking''; to the Committee on Energy and Commerce, and in addition to the Committees on Foreign Affairs, the Judiciary, and Financial Services, for a period to be subsequently determined by the Speaker, in each case for consideration of such provisions as fall within the jurisdiction of the committee concerned.

CONSTITUTIONAL AUTHORITY STATEMENT

Pursuant to clause 7 of rule XII of the Rules of the House of Representatives, the following statements are submitted regarding the specific powers granted to Congress in the Constitution to enact the accompanying bill or joint resolution.

By Mr. GRAVES of Louisiana:

H.R. 8049.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article I, Section 8, Clause 3 and Clause 18 of the United States Constitution.

By Mr. PAPPAS:

H.R. 8050.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article 1, Section 8, Clause 18 of the United States Constitution states that ''Congress shall have the authority to make all Laws which shall be necessary and proper for carrying into Execution the foregoing Powers, and all other Powers vested by the Constitution in the Government of the United States, or in any Department or Officer thereof.''

By Mr. BEYER:

H.R. 8051.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article 1, Section 8

By Mr. CARTER of Georgia:

H.R. 8052.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Clause 3 of Section 8 of article I of the U.S. Constitution provides Congress with the power to regulate commerce.

By Mr. CROW:

H.R. 8053.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article I, Section 8, U.S. Constitution.

By Mr. DIAZ-BALART:

H.R. 8054.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article I, Section 8 of the United States Constitution

By Mr. GARCIA of California:

H.R. 8055.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article I Section VIII

By Miss GONZÁLEZ-COLÓN:

H.R. 8056.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article I, Section 1 of the U.S. Constitution

''All legislative Powers herein granted shall be vested in a Congress of the United States, which shall consist of a Senate and House of Representatives.''

Article I, Section 8, Clause 18 of the U.S. Constitution

Congress shall have the power . . . ''To make all Laws which shall be necessary and proper for carrying into Execution the foregoing Powers, and all other Powers vested by this Constitution in the Government of the United States, or in any Department or Officer thereof.''

By Ms. JACOBS of California:

H.R. 8057.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Section 8 of Article I of the Constitution.

By Mr. JOYCE of Ohio:

H.R. 8058.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article I, Section 8, Clause 18

By Mr. NEGUSE:

H.R. 8059.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article 1, Section 8

By Mrs. RODGERS of Washington:

H.R. 8060.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article 1, Section 8, Clause 3 of the United States Constitution.

By Ms. ROSS:

H.R. 8061.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article I, Section 8 of the U.S. Constitution.

By Mr. ROUZER:

H.R. 8062.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article I, VII

By Mr. SCHNEIDER:

H.R. 8063.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article I, Section 8

By Mrs. TORRES of California:

H.R. 8064.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

According to Article 1: Section 8: Clause 18: of the United States Constitution, seen below, this bill falls within the Constitutional Authority of the United States Congress.

Article 1: Section 8: Clause 18: To make all Laws which shall be necessary and proper for carrying into Execution the. foregoing Powers, and all other Powers vested by this Constitution in the Government of the United States, or in any Department or Officer thereof.

By Mr. WALTZ:

H.R. 8065.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article I, Section 8

By Mr. YARMUTH:

H.R. 8066.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article I, Section 8, clause l; Article I, Section 8, clause 18; and Article I, Section 9, clause 7 of the United States Constitution.

By Mr. YARMUTH:

H.R. 8067.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article I, Section 8, clause l; Article I, Section 8, clause 18; and Article I, Section 9, clause 7 of the United States Constitution.

ADDITIONAL SPONSORS

Under clause 7 of rule XII, sponsors were added to public bills and resolutions, as follows:

H.R. 72: Mr. OWENS.

H.R. 251: Mr. PETERS.

H.R. 336: Ms. SHERRILL.

H.R. 541: Mr. FALLON.

H.R. 608: Mr. VAN DREW and Mr. MEUSER.

H.R. 622: Ms. DAVIDS of Kansas.

H.R. 623: Ms. BROWNLEY and Ms. UNDERWOOD.

H.R. 645: Mr. FALLON.

H.R. 911: Mr. SOTO.

H.R. 1007: Mrs. WATSON COLEMAN.

H.R. 1026: Ms. JAYAPAL.

H.R. 1164: Mr. GREEN of Texas.

H.R. 1207: Ms. TITUS.

H.R. 1297: Mr. NADLER.

H.R. 1330: Mr. STEUBE.

H.R. 1417: Mr. JACOBS of New York.

H.R. 1560: Ms. MATSUI and Mrs. CAROLYN B. MALONEY of New York.

H.R. 1567: Mr. SMITH of Nebraska, Mr. TIMMONS, and Mr. VAN DREW.

H.R. 1607: Mr. FALLON.

H.R. 1627: Mr. BRENDAN F. BOYLE of Pennsylvania, Mr. BUTTERFIELD, Mr. LIEU, Ms. BROWN of Ohio, and Mr. GREEN of Texas.

H.R. 1646: Mr. DONALDS.

H.R. 1729: Mr. FALLON.

H.R. 1946: Mr. GARCIA of California and Mr. KATKO.

H.R. 1948: Mr. PASCRELL, Mr. RUIZ, Mr. THOMPSON of Mississippi, and Mr. CICILLINE.

H.R. 2037: Mr. KILMER and Mr. FALLON.

H.R. 2196: Mr. FITZPATRICK.

H.R. 2252: Mrs. HAYES.

H.R. 2255: Mr. CORREA.

H.R. 2294: Mr. JOHNSON of Georgia.

H.R. 2337: Mr. MCEACHIN.

H.R. 2451: Ms. SALAZAR.

H.R. 2489: Mr. MCEACHIN.

H.R. 2706: Mr. JONES.

H.R. 2717: Mr. VAN DREW.

H.R. 2820: Ms. TITUS.

H.R. 2907: Mr. BUTTERFIELD.

H.R. 2974: Ms. ADAMS, Mrs. BICE of Oklahoma, Ms. BONAMICI, Mr. BUDD, Mr. DESAULNIER, Mr. DUNN, Mr. GOMEZ, Mr. KHANNA, Mr. LANGEVIN, Ms. MANNING, Mr. NADLER, Mr. NORCROSS, Mr. OWENS, Ms. PLASKETT, Mr. TONKO, Mrs. WAGNER, and Mr. VEASEY.

H.R. 3159: Mrs. LAWRENCE and Mr. BLUMENAUER.

H.R. 3183: Mr. WITTMAN, Ms. WILSON of Florida, and Mr. LEVIN of California.

H.R. 3294: Ms. WEXTON.

H.R. 3425: Mrs. RODGERS of Washington, Mrs. WAGNER, Mr. GOSAR, and Mr. BUDD.

H.R. 3483: Mr. MCGOVERN.

H.R. 3498: Mr. TRONE.

H.R. 3558: Ms. ROSS and Ms. WEXTON.

H.R. 3895: Mr. CLEAVER.

H.R. 4118: Ms. TLAIB and Ms. BARRAGÁN.

H.R. 4151: Ms. JACOBS of California.

H.R. 4176: Mrs. LAWRENCE.

H.R. 4239: Mrs. FISCHBACH.

H.R. 4268: Ms. HOULAHAN.

H.R. 4287: Mrs. WALORSKI.

H.R. 4311: Ms. SPEIER.

H.R. 4366: Mr. MALINOWSKI.

H.R. 4390: Ms. DAVIDS of Kansas.

H.R. 4436: Ms. ROYBAL-ALLARD, Mr. SOTO, Mr. MCEACHIN, and Ms. PORTER.

H.R. 4457: Ms. PLASKETT, Mr. SOTO, and Mrs. TRAHAN.

H.R. 4603: Ms. PORTER, Mr. COURTNEY, and Ms. JAYAPAL.

H.R. 4607: Mr. BILIRAKIS.

H.R. 4636: Mr. CLEAVER and Ms. NORTON.

H.R. 4780: Ms. STANSBURY and Ms. VELÁZQUEZ.

H.R. 4826: Ms. ROSS.

H.R. 4841: Mr. MRVAN.

H.R. 4865: Mr. MOONEY.

H.R. 4919: Mr. FLEISCHMANN, Mr. GROTHMAN, and Mr. WENSTRUP.

H.R. 5041: Ms. SALAZAR, Ms. CASTOR of Florida, and Mr. EVANS.

H.R. 5218: Mrs. TRAHAN.

H.R. 5370: Ms. SEWELL and Ms. BOURDEAUX.

H.R. 5605: Ms. TITUS.

H.R. 5632: Mr. GRIFFITH and Mr. GUTHRIE.

H.R. 5893: Mr. MALINOWSKI.

H.R. 5987: Ms. STANSBURY.

H.R. 6037: Mr. WEBER of Texas.

H.R. 6134: Mr. POCAN.

H.R. 6190: Mr. BLUMENAUER.

H.R. 6192: Ms. BONAMICI.

H.R. 6202: Ms. PORTER, Ms. NORTON, Mr. CAWTHORN, Mr. FERGUSON, Ms. DEAN, and Mr. LYNCH.

H.R. 6251: Mr. QUIGLEY, Mr. CASE, and Mr. MALINOWSKI.

H.R. 6319: Mr. BILIRAKIS.

H.R. 6336: Ms. MATSUI.

H.R. 6398: Ms. PINGREE.

H.R. 6411: Mrs. CHERFILUS-MCCORMICK, Mr. RUIZ, and Mr. ROUZER.

H.R. 6538: Mr. LIEU and Ms. LETLOW.

H.R. 6567: Mr. FALLON.

H.R. 6571: Ms. VAN DUYNE.

H.R. 6583: Mrs. TRAHAN.

H.R. 6613: Mr. MCNERNEY and Mr. RUIZ.

H.R. 6629: Mr. CASE and Mr. CRENSHAW.

H.R. 6635: Mr. COHEN.

H.R. 6658: Mrs. LESKO.

H.R. 6702: Mr. MOORE of Utah.

H.R. 6712: Mrs. MILLER-MEEKS.

H.R. 6716: Mr. JOHNSON of South Dakota.

H.R. 6768: Mr. BOST.

H.R. 6785: Ms. BARRAGÁN and Mr. KEATING.

H.R. 6937: Mr. SCHWEIKERT.

H.R. 6940: Mr. ROGERS of Alabama and Mr. KATKO.

H.R. 6991: Ms. STRICKLAND.

H.R. 7033: Mr. DONALDS.

H.R. 7048: Mr. WITTMAN, Mr. BACON, Mr. VAN DREW, and Mr. HARRIS.

H.R. 7122: Ms. BARRAGÁN.

H.R. 7151: Mr. GREEN of Tennessee.

H.R. 7167: Ms. NORTON.

H.R. 7249: Mr. RUTHERFORD.

H.R. 7294: Mr. FALLON.

H.R. 7395: Ms. PINGREE.

H.R. 7438: Mr. ROUZER.

H.R. 7439: Mr. SUOZZI, Mr. PAYNE, Mr. WELCH, Mr. RASKIN, Mr. TORRES of New York, Ms. STANSBURY, and Mr. QUIGLEY.

H.R. 7451: Ms. DAVIDS of Kansas.

H.R. 7462: Mr. HUDSON.

H.R. 7477: Mr. LARSON of Connecticut and Mr. FITZGERALD.

H.R. 7534: Mr. BLUMENAUER.

H.R. 7559: Ms. DEAN, Ms. CASTOR of Florida, Mr. WOMACK, and Mr. MICHAEL F. DOYLE of Pennsylvania.

H.R. 7624: Mr. RUSH and Mr. VEASEY.

H.R. 7642: Mr. CARBAJAL.

H.R. 7644: Mr. SOTO and Mr. BOWMAN.

H.R. 7647: Mr. POCAN, Ms. TLAIB, and Mr. BLUMENAUER.

H.R. 7651: Mr. BURCHETT.

H.R. 7693: Mr. OBERNOLTE.

H.R. 7705: Mr. STEUBE, Mr. RODNEY DAVIS of Illinois, Mrs. MILLER-MEEKS, Ms. HERRELL, Mr. BENTZ, and Mrs. FISCHBACH.

H.R. 7729: Mr. TAKANO.

H.R. 7731: Mr. GARAMENDI.

H.R. 7768: Mrs. HARTZLER.

H.R. 7814: Mr. DANNY K. DAVIS of Illinois, Ms. STEVENS, Ms. PINGREE, and Mr. NEGUSE.

H.R. 7824: Mr. BABIN.

H.R. 7837: Mr. MULLIN, Mr. JACOBS of New York, and Mr. FALLON.

H.R. 7847: Ms. SPEIER and Mr. PERLMUTTER.

H.R. 7851: Mr. RUTHERFORD.

H.R. 7884: Mr. ROSE.

H.R. 7892: Mr. ROUZER.

H.R. 7896: Mr. DONALDS, Mrs. LESKO, Mr. CRENSHAW, and Mr. PERRY.

H.R. 7902: Mr. CARL.

H.R. 7912: Mr. DAVID SCOTT of Georgia.

H.R. 7935: Ms. BARRAGÁN.

H.R. 7942: Ms. LETLOW, Mr. GROTHMAN, Mr. GIMENEZ, Mr. LATTA, Mr. THOMPSON of Pennsylvania, Mr. BENTZ, Ms. SALAZAR, and Mr. DUNN.

H.R. 7946: Mr. ESPAILLAT, Mr. THOMPSON of California, Mr. MCGOVERN, Mr. LOWENTHAL, Mr. RUSH, and Ms. NORTON.

H.R. 7949: Mr. SOTO, Ms. BUSH, and Ms. DEGETTE.

H.R. 7951: Mr. RASKIN.

H.R. 7966: Mr. TIMMONS.

H.R. 7987: Ms. STEFANIK, Mr. VAN DREW, Mrs. MILLER-MEEKS, Mr. TORRES of New York, Mrs. MURPHY of Florida, Mr. FITZPATRICK, and Mr. GOTTHEIMER.

H.R. 8004: Mr. LOUDERMILK, Mr. CRENSHAW, and Mr. PENCE.

H.R. 8048: Ms. MACE.

H.J. Res. 53: Mr. RUIZ, Ms. MCCOLLUM, and Mr. KILDEE.

H.J. Res. 80: Mr. COHEN.

H. Res. 734: Mr. SOTO.

H. Res. 913: Mr. MOONEY.

H. Res. 946: Mr. MOONEY and Mr. GUTHRIE.

H. Res. 975: Mr. CÁRDENAS, Ms. STANSBURY, and Mr. MCGOVERN.

H. Res. 1076: Mr. DESAULNIER.

H. Res. 1083: Mr. CROW, Mr. PANETTA, Mr. LEVIN of California, Mr. SCOTT of Virginia, and Mr. VARGAS.

H. Res. 1091: Mr. GOOD of Virginia.

H. Res. 1102: Mr. MOONEY.

H. Res. 1155: Ms. JAYAPAL, Ms. DELBENE, Mr. SIRES, Mr. BOWMAN, Mr. CARTER of Louisiana, Mrs. HAYES, Ms. TLAIB, and Ms. CLARKE of New York.

H. Res. 1166: Mr. WEBER of Texas.

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PROCEEDINGS AND DEBATES OF THE 117th CONGRESS, SECOND SESSION

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Senate

The Senate met at 11 a.m. and was called to order by the Honorable ALEX PADILLA, a Senator from the State of California.

PRAYER

The Chaplain, Dr. Barry C. Black, offered the following prayer:

Let us pray.

Eternal God, help us to so live that the generations to come will know of Your mighty acts.

Today, give our lawmakers the singularity of heart to seek, find, and follow Your will so that their legacy will be exemplary.

Lord, guide them in the path You have created, inspiring them with the potency of your powerful presence.

May they trust You in times of adversity and prosperity, knowing that they will reap a productive harvest if they persevere. Keep them from underestimating the power of Your great Name.

We pray in the Name of our redeemer. Amen.

PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE

The Presiding Officer led the Pledge of Allegiance, as follows:

I pledge allegiance to the Flag of the United States of America, and to the Republic for which it stands, one nation under God, indivisible, with liberty and justice for all.

APPOINTMENT OF ACTING PRESIDENT PRO TEMPORE

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The clerk will please read a communication to the Senate from the President pro tempore (Mr. LEAHY).

The legislative clerk read the following letter:

U.S. SENATE,
PRESIDENT PRO TEMPORE,
Washington, DC, June 14, 2022.

To the Senate:

Under the provisions of rule I, paragraph 3, of the Standing Rules of the Senate, I hereby appoint the Honorable ALEX PADILLA, a Senator from the State of California, to perform the duties of the Chair.

PATRICK J. LEAHY,
President pro tempore.

Mr. PADILLA thereupon assumed the Chair as Acting President pro tempore.

RESERVATION OF LEADER TIME

The ACTING PRESIDENT pro tempore. Under the previous order, the leadership time is reserved.

CONCLUSION OF MORNING BUSINESS

The ACTING PRESIDENT pro tempore. Morning business is closed.

LEGISLATIVE SESSION

HONORING OUR PROMISE TO ADDRESS COMPREHENSIVE TOXICS ACT OF 2021—Resumed

The ACTING PRESIDENT pro tempore. Also, under the previous order, the Senate will resume consideration of H.R. 3967, which the clerk will report.

The legislative clerk read as follows:

A bill (H.R. 3967) to improve health care and benefits for veterans exposed to toxic substances, and for other purposes.

Pending:

Tester-Moran amendment No. 5051, in the nature of a substitute.

Schumer amendment No. 5065 (to amendment No. 5051), to add an effective date.

Schumer amendment No. 5076 (to the text proposed to be stricken by amendment No. 5051), to add an effective date.

RECOGNITION OF THE MAJORITY LEADER

The ACTING PRESIDENT pro tempore. The Democratic leader is recognized.

GUN VIOLENCE

Mr. SCHUMER. Mr. President, as we speak, the U.S. Senate is working on something not seen since the time we passed the Brady bill I authored nearly three decades ago: a bipartisan effort to draft meaningful gun safety legislation.

For decades, the rhythms of the gun debate in Congress have followed a dispiriting pattern: a mass shooting takes place somewhere in America, innocent people are slaughtered, families grieve and demand action, but gridlock takes over, and nothing—nothing—gets done. This was the cycle of inaction after Sandy Hook, Las Vegas, Orlando, Charleston, Parkland, El Paso, Atlanta, Pittsburgh, and so many others. But after Uvalde and Buffalo, perhaps—perhaps—this time could be different.

To many Senators on both sides, this debate certainly feels different. With Sunday's announcement of a bipartisan framework for gun legislation, we are further down the road to gun safety reform than we have been in a long time.

I spoke with Senators CORNYN and MURPHY this morning, and they updated me on their progress. They are working with the urgency the situation demands, and they are hopeful the legislative text can be finalized in the coming days.

I have assured my colleagues that once we get legislative text to a gun safety bill, I will move to hold a vote on the Senate floor as soon as possible.

I hope that in the very near future, Democrats and Republicans can take the real momentum of the past few weeks and translate it into something that has escaped this Chamber for decades: voting on and passing long-sought gun safety reform.

It is a rare opportunity for the Senate. So in order to reach our goal, we have to keep working with the same urgency and good faith that has carried us this far.

For sure, the bipartisan framework is far from perfect, but if passed, it will unquestionably save lives and would be the most significant action on guns that the Senate has taken in nearly

● This "bullet" symbol identifies statements or insertions which are not spoken by a Member of the Senate on the floor.

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three decades. If passed, it would enhance background checks for those under 21. It will help States with their red flag laws, preventing shootings before they happen. It will make it harder for domestic abusers to acquire a weapon by closing the boyfriend loophole.

Significantly, this framework also calls for new punishment for gun traffickers. We all know one of the biggest weaknesses in our country's gun laws as they are today is that anyone can buy a gun in one State and then simply smuggle it into another. We could begin to fight against that with stiffer penalties on gun trafficking.

Of course, this framework will help lower crime and reduce gun violence in our neighborhoods by increasing funding for mental health as well. And even on its own, funding for mental health with great increases in mental health problems that we see after COVID is very much needed.

Taken together, the policies outlined by the bipartisan framework would be an important first step to saving lives. It would lay the foundation for a more sensible approach to gun safety in the future. It certainly is not everything Democrats want, but if we can save even one life—one life—our efforts will have been worth it.

I hope that very soon the Senate can break the cycle of violence, grieving, and gridlock that has held firm for far too long. This is the best chance we have had in years to finally tell the American people that, yes, after the horrifying tragedies of Uvalde and Buffalo, this time—this time—will be different.

We have more work to do so I urge my colleagues not to let this precious opportunity slip away.

H.R. 3967

Mr. President, now on the PACT Act, today, the Senate will continue consideration of the Honoring Our PACT Act—the most ambitious and important expansion of veteran healthcare benefits that we have seen in decades.

Yesterday, we invoked cloture on the substitute amendment to the PACT Act with a very strong bipartisan vote, 78 to 17. Seventy-eight votes, a clear indication that both sides want this bill passed through the Senate. There is no reason to delay that outcome.

Today, we will continue working with our Republican colleagues to see if we can speed up consideration of this legislation. With Republican cooperation, we could be done with the PACT Act as soon as tomorrow.

We need to pass the PACT Act ASAP because our veterans have waited long enough for their healthcare benefits to treat complications from toxic exposure. Over the last two decades, an estimated 3.5 million servicemembers were exposed to dangerous chemicals while in the line of duty while risking their lives for us.

Burn pits were a common method of eliminating all sorts of waste throughout Iraq and Afghanistan, from everyday trash to hazardous and poisonous materials. After returning home, many veterans developed terrible diseases because of their exposure to these toxic waste dumps. But even so, nearly 80 percent of all disability claims related to burn pits have been denied by the Veterans' Administration. What an indignity. What an injustice. No veteran should ever have to carry the burden of treating complications from toxic exposure alone, and we can change that with this bill.

There is every reason in the world to get the PACT Act done quickly. Both parties want it, our veterans deserve it, and the time is long past for us to make a change at the VA.

OCEAN SHIPPING REFORM ACT

Mr. President, on shipping, last night, finally, the House overwhelmingly approved the Senate's Ocean Shipping Reform Act—the most significant maritime reform law passed by Congress in years.

The inflation-fighting shipping bill now goes to the President's desk for signature, finally providing relief to American exporters and consumers alike.

Shipping reform is exactly the kind of bill that can make a difference to the American people: It fights inflation. It relieves our supply chains. It helps small businesses and consumers alike. Not too much has been written about this bill because, sadly, the way our world and media work, if there is not a big conflict, they don't write much about it. But this is very important.

If high prices are our No. 1 nemesis, one of the main reasons is the ships piled up at our ports. We have all seen the pictures outside the ports of L.A. and Seattle and Savannah and Norfolk and New York, New Jersey. This is causing people to pay more. It is no one's fault. It is COVID-related, and now there is a big rush to make up for the delays that COVID caused.

We have to do something about it, and we have. There are many frustrating reasons why prices are going up right now, but one of the main ones is abuses from ocean carriers.

Over the course of the pandemic—listen to this, folks. Over the course of the pandemic, unfair shipping practices led carriers to increase prices by as much as 1,000 percent—1,000-percent increase in prices in shipping. And who is paying that? The average family in America and the average exporting business.

Even worse, foreign carriers oftentimes refuse to even transport U.S. goods overseas. And by now we are seeing the results: backlogs at the ports of L.A. and Seattle and Georgia and New York and New Jersey and other major hubs.

This is not just a problem for the coasts. When backlog occurs at the ports in Los Angeles, it hurts farmers in Minnesota or Wisconsin. It hurts truckers and tech companies and manufacturers in mom-and-pop shops all over the country. And most of all, it hurts American consumers.

Our shipping reform bill will fix this by making it harder for ocean carriers to unreasonably refuse American goods at our ports, while strengthening the Federal Maritime Commission's powers to stop abusive practices by foreign carriers.

I want to thank Speaker PELOSI and my House colleagues who worked to pass this bill. And special thanks goes to Senators KLOBUCHAR and THUNE for authoring the legislation, as well Chairman CANTWELL who used her legislative skills, which are indeed very, very fine. She shepherded the bill through this Chamber. Because of the hard work of these folks, shipping reform will now become law. American consumers will soon feel the benefit.

I yield the floor.

I suggest the absence of a quorum.

The ACTING PRESIDENT pro tempore. The clerk will call the roll.

The legislative clerk proceeded to call the roll.

Mr. MCCONNELL. Mr. President, I ask unanimous consent that the order for the quorum call be rescinded.

The ACTING PRESIDENT pro tempore. Without objection, it is so ordered.

RECOGNITION OF THE MINORITY LEADER

The Republican leader is recognized.

CRIME

Mr. MCCONNELL. A few months ago, from this desk, I talked about the results of a recall election in San Francisco. In February, a multilingual, multiethnic coalition in San Francisco stood up for common sense and rejected three members of the far-left school board who had prioritized woke lunacy over the basics of education.

Well, last week, these same fed-up citizens provided a sequel. Even the deep-blue Bay area decided they had had enough—enough—with their radical-left district attorney—a prosecutor in name only—who had become nationally famous for running a soft-on-crime experiment.

As deaths from drug overdoses skyrocketed, his office chose to almost entirely stop prosecuting drug dealing. Burglaries shot up 50 percent. Chain stores had to close locations because of rampant shoplifting. One person who had been arrested five times in 6 months in 2020 was let out every time—every single time—until he killed two women with a stolen car. Liberals actually bragged about how they had cut down incarceration rates, even as disorder swallowed up more and more of the city.

The citizens were fed up—fed up—with being the far-left's guinea pigs. They flocked to the ballot box, and they voted for change.

This phenomenon is not only playing out in San Francisco, it is nationwide—nationwide. For years, the far left has zeroed in on local prosecutors and district attorneys as juicy opportunities to make America radically softer on crime.

According to recent news reports, for example, one far-left billionaire donated more than $1 million each to the political campaigns of soft-on-crime prosecutors in Chicago, New York, Los Angeles, and Philadelphia. According to one group's analysis, the army of soft-on-crime prosecutors supported by this one donor—this one donor—and his networks oversees as much as 20 percent of the Nation's entire population.

Once in office, many of these prosecutors set about abusing their authority by basically unilaterally decriminalizing various crimes that neither voters nor legislators have actually decriminalized in reality. As the attorney general of Virginia put it recently, ''Instead of trying to change the law . . . these groups are electing prosecutors who simply ignore it.''

As this liberal campaign has been playing out at the State and local level, we have seen violent crime surge all across the country. Here are just a few recent news reports.

From Minnesota: ''Robberies, assaults, and gun crimes are causing waves of anxiety and fear among suburban residents across the Twin Cities.''

From Colorado: ''Since the beginning of the pandemic . . . murders had gone up 47 percent, some types of property crime had nearly doubled, and [the] seizures of fentanyl and methamphetamine had quadrupled'' in just the last year.

Atlanta ''saw a 30-year record in homicides last year [in 2021],'' and 2022 has been looking actually even worse. At least as of a few months ago, both murders and rapes were way ahead of even that 2021 pace.

Residents of Phoenix who try to use public transit to escape soaring gas prices have found out that ''assaults and drug crime in and around public transportation have risen over the last five years.''

Philadelphia is reporting an 80-percent increase in assaults aboard buses.

In my hometown of Louisville, we are struggling as well. ''Over the past several years, violent crime has sharply risen across the city, breaking gruesome records including record homicides and assaults.'' And we have seen carjacking ''more than triple in the [last] five years.'' Last weekend alone—last weekend alone—Louisville saw 3 homicides and 10 nonfatal shootings. Five teenagers and a 9-year-old were shot during a single altercation at my hometown's Big Four Bridge. Violent criminals turned a popular attraction for families and tourists into a literal war zone.

Stable prices, border security, and public safety are three of the most basic deliverables that any government owes to its citizens—strike one, strike two, and strike three for Democrats at the Federal, State, and local level.

That explains one last headline I will mention this morning: ''Americans are more worried about crime than at any other time this century.''

UKRAINE

Mr. President, now on a different matter, the latest news from Ukraine confirms that our friends need more robust weaponry, and they need it fast.

''Outgunned Ukraine Needs More Weapons Fast as Russia Advances, Officials Say.''

''Ukraine Pleads for Weapons, Saying Russia Has Much More Artillery.''

The people of Ukraine have inspired the world with their resilience, but resisting Russian aggression takes reliable supplies of lethal force.

As the Biden administration continues to provide shipments and prod our allies, they must adopt the kind of strong and positive posture that has eluded them at earlier points in the conflict.

As early as last November, I was urging sanctions for deterrence and pushing for NDAA provisions to send enhanced lethal aid last November. Throughout December and January, I urged the President to bolster NATO's eastern flank with more U.S. forces and get more weapons to Ukrainian forces before—before—Russia attacked. In February, I called on President Biden to anticipate Russian manipulation of the energy markets and back off his own holy war against domestic American production. But for months, the Biden administration seemed mute, seemed actually more focused on deterring itself than deterring Putin—too much hesitation, too much hemming and hawing, too little preventive action in advance.

The United States cannot make the same mistakes again with prolonged dithering over whether to provide longer range or more powerful weapons. That is where we are now. It is time to get Ukraine what it needs to finish this fight, including artillery and long-range rockets, and strongly and firmly push our European allies to do the same. The wealthiest European countries need to move fast to do their part—no more hesitation, and quit making excuses.

This war has carried terrible human costs for the Ukrainian people. We cannot bring back the thousands who have been lost, but with strong assistance, we can help Ukraine limit future losses, reduce the risk of greater conflict, and create a deterring precedent for other would-be aggressors, like China.

There is another area where the Ukraine crisis has showcased the need to take decisive action quickly while there is still time. That is with respect to our own defense industrial base and our supplies of critical arms.

Equipping Ukraine has seriously depleted our own stockpiles of Javelins and Stingers. According to the Secretary of the Army, the U.S. military has ''taken some risk to our own readiness.'' This sounds exactly like the sort of situation that prompted the creation of the Defense Production Act, but thus far, we have heard far more from Washington Democrats about using the DPA to fast-track green energy boondoggles than to expand production capacity for critical weapons and munitions.

Our allies and our partners are interested in buying American military technology. This should be a win-win: allies spending their own money to strengthen themselves by buying American and making our militaries more interoperable in the process. But too often, our partners are hamstrung by American constraints on the process, like the heel-dragging bureaucracy that runs our military sales, and lagging production schedules.

We must adequately stockpile weapons and munitions for our own military and have sufficient supplies and production capacity to arm our friends, and we need to do this before it is too late.

Building up our own stores and upgrading our allies' is the best way we can avoid nightmare scenarios down the road where America could be forced into a terrible choice between committing U.S. troops to a conflict or doing nothing. The remedy is to help our allies upgrade their military capabilities in advance.

Of course, this takes money. All the serious preparations and military modernization that it will take to compete with Russia and China require resources. Tomorrow, the Armed Services Committee will mark up the National Defense Authorization Act. This is a key opportunity to show that both parties are serious about the real growth in defense spending that it will take to keep us on the cutting edge.

The Biden administration's defense budget request was woefully insufficient. The President has proposed a real-dollar cut for defense spending after President Biden's own inflation.

Our colleagues on the committee must help Congress to deliver an NDAA that provides for real, robust growth above inflation so that we can modernize our forces, ensure adequate inventories of critical weapons and munitions, and keep America safe.

I suggest the absence of a quorum.

The ACTING PRESIDENT pro tempore. The clerk will call the roll.

The legislative clerk proceeded to call the roll.

Mr. DURBIN. Mr. President, I ask unanimous consent that the order for the quorum call be rescinded.

The ACTING PRESIDENT pro tempore. Without objection, it is so ordered.

JANUARY 6

Mr. DURBIN. Mr. President, it is hard to believe it was 50 years ago this week—50 years ago—when five men were caught breaking into the offices of the Democratic National Committee here in Washington.

Two years after that, the so-called Watergate break-in and the coverup by the Nixon White House, it brought down the President.

For nearly half a century, the Watergate scandal really ranked as America's greatest constitutional test since

the Civil War—then came January 6, 2021.

An angry mob, summoned by a defeated President, attacked this Capitol building, attacked this Chamber, and those of us who were in it knew it was an attempt to overthrow an election, an election which Donald Trump lost but never admitted.

How did we respond?

Well, the proposal was made—the right proposal—to create a bipartisan commission to investigate what happened on January 6, 2021. Unfortunately, the Republicans, led by Senator MCCONNELL in the Senate, filibustered the creation of an independent commission to investigate January 6. Fortunately, the House went forward to proceed on its own on a bipartisan basis to get to the truth.

Now, after 11 months and 1,000 interviews—more than 1,000—the bipartisan Select Committee to Investigate the January 6 Attack on the U.S. Capitol is sharing its findings with America, and the revelations are so damning.

In its first two public hearings, the committee has shown that the attack on the Capitol was not a demonstration that changed spontaneously and became a riot. The attack on our Nation's Capitol, the attack on this Chamber, was the result of a plan: a violent effort to prevent the peaceful transfer of power from the Trump administration to the Biden administration, to stop the peaceful transition of power in America for the first time in our history.

To quote Congresswoman LIZ CHENEY, the former President Donald Trump ''summoned the mob, assembled the mob, and lit the flame of this attack.''

When the mob beat our police officers and ransacked the Capitol—going through our desks here on the floor, posing for pictures where the Presiding Officer is now sitting, all sorts of things to make them look famous with their friends at the expense of the integrity of this building and this Chamber.

They beat the police officers. Donald Trump did nothing to stop them—nothing. He wouldn't order the National Guard to defend the Capitol, the Senate, the House. He watched the mayhem on TV, rewinding it to watch it over and over again. He gloried in the moment.

When the crowd threatened to hang Vice President Pence, Donald Trump said, ''He deserves it.'' Deserves it. The Vice President of the United States deserves it.

His own advisers told him repeatedly that the voter fraud conspiracy theories that he was pedaling were false. They were called ''idiotic,'' ''amateurish,'' ''detached from reality.'' Who said that? The former Attorney General serving Donald Trump said it in describing the false claims that President Trump continued to pedal.

Donald Trump was told the truth over and over again, and yet he continued to push his deadly Big Lie.

He deliberately—the former President of the United States—deliberately undermined America's faith in our election process to overturn the election and to hold onto power no matter what.

He used the Big Lie to make big bucks. We learned that yesterday—quarter of a million dollars—quarter of a billion dollars in donations, including millions of dollars for an election defense fund that didn't exist.

In a coming hearing, the committee will show how Donald Trump pressured the Justice Department into helping him overturn the election. I know a little bit about that. Our Senate Judiciary Committee, which I chair, documented this attempt to subvert the Justice Department in an 8-month investigation and report that we produced last fall. We produced this report in a bipartisan fashion, inviting Republican and Democratic Members of the Senate Judiciary Committee to witness the testimony of key individuals and to ask questions themselves.

We interviewed former Justice officials like Jeffrey Rosen and Richard Donoghue, the then-acting Attorney General and Deputy Attorney General, who resisted Donald Trump's pressure to take over the Justice Department.

They told us how repeatedly they informed the former President that his bogus election claims were false. They told us how Trump, nevertheless, asked the Justice Department to ''Just say the election was corrupt—and leave the rest to me and Republican Congressmen.''

And they resisted Donald Trump's plan to replace Jeffrey Rosen with the Big Lie lawyer Jeffrey Clark, who wanted the Justice Department to help overturn the election.

The facts that the Senate Judiciary Committee uncovered are damning. The January 6 committee will unveil those—many of their own discovery and reporting and some that we sent to them from our testimony that we gathered in the Senate Judiciary Committee.

We came close to losing this democracy in America on January 6. I believe that by laying out the truth for us and for future generations, members of the committee are performing a public service of heroic proportions.

It is sad—sad—that given an opportunity of a bipartisan commission, just as we had with 9/11, that the Senate Republicans stopped it. Why? It is a question they are going to have to answer.

POLITICAL PRISONERS

Mr. President, on another topic, we speak often in the Senate about threats to peace and freedom around the world: Russia's unprovoked invasion of Ukraine, China's brutal repression of the Uighurs, the dismantling of democracy in Hong Kong, Nicaragua's repressive dictatorship, and more.

In each of these struggles, there are some brave men and women who are prepared to risk their liberty and their lives to defend democracy and dignity. Many of them languish in prison as political prisoners. Their captors often try to torment them by telling them: The world has forgotten you; no one knows you are here.

Well, I want to make sure that that doesn't happen by coming to floor of the Senate and sharing some of these stories. Today, let me tell you about a few of them.

Let me start with a Russian opposition leader of remarkable courage: Vladimir Kara-Murza. He was poisoned twice by the Russian spy agency FSB, in 2015 and 2017. He not only survived that, but he continued his work for a democratic Russia.

He was a close friend of Senator John McCain, who asked him personally to serve as a pallbearer at his funeral.

I met Mr. Kara-Murza in March, 3 weeks before Russia invaded Ukraine. He was living in Washington at the time with his wife and three children, and he told me he was going back to Russia. He had work to do.

On April 11, he was arrested in Moscow, 1 day after giving an interview in which he called Vladimir Putin's government a ''team of murderers.''

His wife, Evgenia Kara-Murza, also an advocate for democracy in Russia, who I expect to meet with later on this week, said: ''He's doing as well as you can do in a Russian prison that is notorious for torture, humiliation, and mistreatment.''

Earlier this month, the Senate unanimously passed a resolution I led with Senator MARCO RUBIO, calling on Russia to release Vladimir Kara-Murza immediately, along with Alexei Navalny, another Russian opposition leader, and thousands of others—Russians jailed for speaking up against repression, for even mentioning the possibility of the murderous war in Ukraine.

It is time for America to stand up for Mr. Kara-Murza and those like him who have shown extraordinary courage.

Senator Leila DeLima is a leading human rights advocate in the Philippines. She is a state senator who just passed her fifth year in jail.

Here she is in her cell.

Why is she in prison for 5 years? She criticized the repressive regime of President Rodrigo Duterte.

From time to time, she writes to me from her prison cell. Let me share a short excerpt of a recent letter:

> Warm greetings from my detention headquarters . . . I do not know for how long I will remain behind bars but there is one thing that I am sure of—my will to fight for what is right continues to be undeterred.

Recently, two key witnesses in the sham case against Senator DeLima recanted their testimony, proving what we already know: The case against her is contrived. It is a travesty of justice.

Many Filipino Americans in Illinois tell me they are deeply concerned about the accountability and democracy and its prospects in the Philippines.

The incoming Marcos regime can demonstrate its commitment to a democratic Philippines by ending the harassment of journalists and making Senator DeLima's release one of its first priorities.

Let me now turn to Saudi Arabia—timely.

I have been troubled by the human rights record of this Kingdom, including the murder of Jamal Khashoggi, for which there is no real accountability yet.

This year brought a bit of welcome news. Writer Raif Badawi was finally freed from prison after completing a 10-year prison sentence for dubious charges about his peaceful writings.

I hope that the Saudis will allow Raif the dignity of reuniting with his brave wife, Ensaf Haidar, who I met in Washington, and their three children, now living in Canada.

Badawi's lawyer, Waleed Abu al-Khair, a leading human rights defender, is still in prison. He was convicted in Saudi Arabia's Specialized Criminal Court, usually reserved for terrorists.

I appeal to the Saudi Government to free Waleed and to allow Raif to be reunited with his family.

These gestures would be particularly notable in light of President Biden's upcoming visit.

Finally, let me turn to the United Arab Emirates.

This is Ahmed Mansoor, one of the last major human rights voices in the Emirates.

He was arrested in 2017 for using blog posts to advocate for reform and human rights in his nation. He was convicted of charges of threatening the UAE's state security and social harmony, they sentenced him to 10 years in prison. He has been there for more than 5, at times, in solitary confinement, isolated from other prisoners, no contact with his family. He has reportedly been tortured.

Despite the dismal conditions of his incarceration, he remains steadfast in his commitment to human rights. He has conducted multiple hunger strikes to protest prison conditions.

I appeal to the United Arab Emirates' new President, Muhammad bin Zayed Al-Nahyan, to take this opportunity early in his Presidency to demonstrate compassion and courage by releasing Mr. Mansoor.

America's strength around the world comes not only from our military and economic might but from the power of our values. Over the years, I have heard from many political prisoners. They tell me the support this body, of Congress, of America, and so many others in our government sustained them through the lonely, desperate times they spent in jail for days and weeks and months and years.

I will close with the words of Vladimir Kara-Murza. This is from a recent op-ed he wrote for the Washington Post from his Russian prison. He wrote:

> The prisoner's worst nightmare is the thought of being forgotten . . . I always knew how true those words were—and how important were international campaigns of solidarity with prisoners of conscience. I now feel it with my own skin.

To Vladimir Kara-Murza, Raif Badawi, Waleed Abulkhair, Senator Leila de Lima, and Ahmed Mansoor, I say: You are not forgotten, and we will continue to advocate for your freedom.

Let me also close by acknowledging that a member of my staff, Chris Homan, has really inspired me to take on this cause, and he works at it diligently—our reward, an occasional political prisoner makes it here to my office here in Washington. One of them from Africa presented me with basically a baton that he had made while in prison with my name on it because he heard that I remembered him and spoke of him on the floor of the Senate.

I would say to my colleagues on both sides of the aisle: Make this part of your responsibility as a U.S. Senator. Find these people, these heroes who are sadly wasting away in prison and remember them on this floor. It can make a difference. Some will be released; all will remember the fact that you stood up for them at a time of great need.

I yield the floor.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The Senator from South Dakota.

INFLATION

Mr. THUNE. Mr. President, the latest inflation numbers came out on Friday, and it has become par for the course in the Biden economy that they weren't pretty.

Inflation hit 8.6 percent in May, the worst inflation since December of 1981. Grocery prices increased nearly 12 percent on average. Eggs were up 32 percent; chicken was up 17 percent; milk was up 15 percent; and the list goes on and on.

Gas prices were up 48 percent. Since President Biden took office, the price of gas has more than doubled. Gas is at $5 a gallon, and the price of diesel, so essential to our Nation's farmers and ranchers, is even worse. The problem is, there is no end in sight. JPMorgan estimates that gas prices could exceed $6 a gallon by August. Other energy costs have also increased with electricity up 12 percent and utility gas service up 30 percent.

By one estimate, inflation is costing American households $460 per month. That is right: $460 per month. It is no surprise that in a recent poll, 83 percent of respondents—83 percent—describe the state of the economy as ''poor'' or ''not so good'' or that just 27 percent said they have a good chance of improving their standard of living.

President Biden likes to talk about creating ''an economy that works for working families.'' Well, I have news for the President. This economy is not working for working families. Working families can't absorb an additional $460 a month. They have to cut back. They have to put off needed car repairs or eliminate a family vacation or cut down on milk for their kids. The President said the other day that ''[the economy] is strong as can be but for inflation, but for gas and food.''

But for gas and food? Well, I have to tell you, gas and food prices are two pretty essential economic measures for families.

Moms and dads wondering how they can afford to fill up their cars to get to work or get their kids to baseball practice don't care how good the President says the economy is when the price of a tank of gas has more than doubled since the President took office.

I guess we can at least be glad the Democrats and the President have finally started acknowledging our inflation crisis. For months last year, as inflation climbed, the administration dismissed those concerns. Even as it became more and more clear that we had a long-term problem on our hands, the President and congressional Democrats spent their time focusing not on solutions to our inflation crisis but on a massive spending spree almost guaranteed to make our inflation problem worse.

That is right. Let's remember how we got here. When President Biden took office, inflation was at 1.4 percent, well within the Fed's target inflation rate of 2 percent. And it might have stayed there had Democrats not decided to pass a massive and partisan $1.9 trillion spending spree under the guise of COVID relief mere weeks after the Congress had passed a fifth bipartisan COVID bill that met essentially all current pressing COVID needs.

The Democrats' so-called American Rescue Plan sent a lot of unnecessary government money into the economy, and the economy overheated as a result.

And you don't have to take my word for it.

Here is what one Democratic economist who worked in the Obama administration had to say on the subject:

> The $1.9 trillion American Rescue Plan passed in the early days of the Biden administration will go down in history as an extraordinary policy mistake.

Let me just repeat that.

> The $1.9 trillion American Rescue Plan passed in the early days of the Biden administration will go down in history as an extraordinary policy mistake.

That is a direct quote from a Democratic economist who worked in the Obama administration.

Democrats were warned that the American Rescue Plan ran the risk of overstimulating the economy, but they went ahead anyway. What is almost worse was their subsequent decision to pursue another massive spending spree, their so-called Build Back Better plan, even after it had become clear that their first spending spree had helped plunge our economy into a serious inflationary crisis.

Even now—even now—as Americans deal with the worst inflation in decades, it is looking like Democrats are trying to revive elements of their Build Back Better plan and use reconciliation rules to pass yet another partisan spending spree. It is the triumph

of Big Government ideology over economic reality. If Democrats succeed in passing another partisan spending spree using reconciliation rules, Americans' economic situation is going to get even worse.

Unfortunately, there is no easy solution to the Democrats' largely self-inflicted inflation crisis, but the first priority is to do no more harm. That means no more partisan spending sprees like the Democrats' Build Back Better plan.

Another big priority should be unleashing American energy production—in particular, the domestic production of oil and gas—to ease energy prices. High gas and energy prices fuel higher consumer prices across the board—no question about it. Unleashing American energy production would not only help reduce the price of gas, but it could also help rein in prices for other commodities. Unfortunately, the President has demonstrated a clear hostility to conventional energy production, which is discouraging investment in American energy and prolonging the current gas price situation.

Another thing we should be doing to help make life easier for consumers is trying to ease supply chain woes whether that involves removing burdensome trucking regulations or passing legislation like my Ocean Shipping Reform Act.

I am pleased that both Democrats and Republicans have come together to support my bipartisan bill, which I introduced, along with Senator KLOBUCHAR, earlier this year. I am particularly grateful to my fellow South Dakotan, Representative DUSTY JOHNSON, who helped usher this legislation through the House of Representatives.

The Ocean Shipping Reform Act would help ease supply chain pressures by addressing unfair ocean carrier practices, speeding up the resolution of detention and demurrage disputes, and improving the movement of goods at our Nation's ports. It won't solve our Nation's inflation crisis, but it should help make life easier for U.S. exporters, importers, and consumers alike.

I am very pleased that this legislation passed the House of Representatives yesterday and that it will soon be on its way to the President's desk, and I hope that we will be able to pursue more bipartisan propositions to help make life easier for American families.

Democrats' big-spending, Big Government agenda has resulted in a lot of pain for working families. If President Biden and Democrats really want to make life better for ordinary Americans, they will decisively reject any further spending sprees and work with Republicans to do what we can to alleviate the inflation crisis the Democrats have helped create.

I yield the floor.

The ACTING PRESIDENT pro tempore. The Senator from Iowa.

(The remarks of Mr. GRASSLEY pertaining to the introduction of S. 4393 are printed in today's RECORD under ''Statements on Introduced Bills and Joint Resolutions.'')

Mr. GRASSLEY. I yield the floor.

I suggest the absence of a quorum.

The PRESIDING OFFICER (Mr. LUJÁN). The clerk will call the roll.

The senior assistant legislative clerk proceeded to call the roll.

Mr. CORNYN. Mr. President, I ask unanimous consent that the order for the quorum call be rescinded.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. Without objection, it is so ordered.

Mr. CORNYN. Mr. President, I ask unanimous consent that I be allowed to complete my remarks before the Senate adjourns for the lunch hour.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. Without objection, it is so ordered.

GUN VIOLENCE

Mr. CORNYN. Mr. President, I want to report that we are making serious progress in our bipartisan effort to respond to the shooting in Uvalde, TX, and other places around the country. Over the last few weeks, I have been working, in particular, with Senator MURPHY, Senator SINEMA, and Senator TILLIS on mental health and school safety reforms, and we have narrowed the scope of our discussions to provisions that we believe can earn broad bipartisan support in the Senate, and a number of our colleagues on both sides have joined the discussion.

Over the weekend, we announced an agreement on principles for bipartisan legislation, 20 Senators—10 Republicans and 10 Democrats. This included a range of targeted reforms to keep our children and our communities safe, from mental health resources to funding to harden schools and make them more safe. No parent should have to send their child to school wondering whether they are going to be safe at school, and certainly no student should be afraid to go to school for fear of their safety.

We also included a number of targeted measures to prevent violence by people committing crimes and other dangerous individuals. I am proud of the work we have done so far, but, of course, we are not at the finish line. We are still at the beginning when it comes to drafting appropriate text.

Our agreement is based on principles alone. And translating this proposal into legislative language is no easy task, as Members of the Senate understand. Here is an example of the many details that need to be ironed out: One of the big pieces of this bill relates to State crisis intervention programs and initiatives.

The idea here is pretty simple: Support programs that reduce violence, protect the public, and help individuals in crisis get the help they need. But there are a number of different ways this provision could be drafted, and I am committed to ensuring that we get it done right.

But I want to be clear because there has been a lot of misinformation, misunderstanding on this point. None of what we are proposing would create a national red flag law—no national red flag law. Some have mischaracterized this provision as an incentive for States to pass a red flag law, but that is something I am aiming to avoid. I trust the States to make their own decisions, and 16 States have decided to pass red flag laws. But that is fewer than half of the States with red flag laws on the books. Congress should not only send Federal funding to those States but also other States that are doing things to deal with people in crisis. And as the agreement, in principle, said, what we are focused on is crisis intervention.

But there are a number of different ways that this could be approached. And I am fighting for this proposal to include a grant program that gives every State, regardless of whether it has a red flag law or not, funding to administer programs that they do have that will reduce violence, increase public safety, and make sure that individuals in crisis get the help that they need.

There should be no requirement for States that do not currently have a red flag law to pass one. The existence or lack of a red flag law should not impact on any States' ability to receive funds for crisis intervention. And if a State does want to use this money to implement a red flag law, they should not be able to do so unless their red flag law contains a full set of due process and Bill of Rights protections in the Constitution.

So how can States without red flag laws use this money? Well, there are a range of evidence-based programs that support our shared goal, which is, in fact, to keep communities safe and to save lives. One great example is the assisted outpatient treatment programs. These are sometimes just called AOTs. These programs allow courts to order people with serious mental illness to receive outpatient treatment as a condition of living in the community. AOTs can be life changing for people who struggle to maintain consistent mental health treatment.

Programs vary from State to State but typically include medication, along with a variety of other services including counseling. AOTs rely on evidence-based treatment plans to help individuals live healthier, safer lives, and they have a successful track record. Assisted outpatient treatment programs are effective in reducing arrests and incarceration, violent mental crises, and hospital stays and homelessness. I think this is another way that States without red flag laws might be able to use the funding that we would provide under the provisions of this bill. At least that is what I am hoping we ultimately will land on.

I think it would be kind of strange if we passed a national law that said only 16 States were going to be eligible for this money and you would only be eligible for it if you passed a red flag law.

I think that would almost be like trying to commandeer the States' legislature and government and force them to accept something they decided not to do but because maybe they tried to do something a little bit differently, like assisted outpatient treatment, mental health courts, which have been very successful in my State and veterans courts, in particular, to focus on our veterans community who has particular challenges.

While I am talking about assisted outpatient treatment, 47 States actually have those laws, and I would like the money that would be available under this fund for crisis intervention to be able to be used for that. Again, I don't support any prescriptive mandates or national mandates at all, including a national red flag. Each State should be able to make their own choices and use its share of funding in the best way it sees fit to protect the constitutional rights of somebody who is in mental health crisis or to provide other resources, like assisted outpatient treatment or mental health court adjudications or veterans courts hearings, in order to help them address their challenges.

The great thing about the design of our country is that we have a national government, but we have sovereign States. Louis Brandeis once called them the laboratories of democracy. And, actually, it makes plenty of sense to me that we learned from the experience of the States that have passed red flag laws and States that have passed other types of ways to address people requiring crisis intervention. This provides the ability to innovate and to try new ideas and to come up with best practices that the Federal Government simply cannot do when you are considering legislating for a country of 330 million people.

So I personally do not support an overly prescriptive grant program that favors only a few States over all 50 States. And, of course, I won't support any grant program that violates the Constitution or the requirement of due process of law when it comes to a constitutional right like the Second Amendment.

So I do believe there are a range of options to improve public safety, and the States should have the funding and flexibility to invest in programs that they think best delivers the result—to save lives, to help people in crisis. And that is really what we are trying to do with this legislation.

So the details are still being worked out. And we are drafting legislative text, and, of course, that is sometimes hard. Sometimes, I found that people use the same word, and they mean something different by it, or they come to it with a sort of context that maybe isn't apparent from a conversation about principles. And that is why going from the principles that 20 of us have agreed on into legislative text that we can then vote on and pass is a challenge.

We know that on a sensitive topic like this, a single word or the placement of a comma can make the difference between protecting and infringing on rights. So I am laser-focused on drafting text that reflects the commonsense, targeted proposal that we have agreed to in principle. Again, we are working through the details, and I hope we will have legislative text later this week. But I am not willing to rush it for the sake of speed.

I spoke with Senator SCHUMER, the majority leader, this morning, and he said he would like to have this bill ready to vote on next week. And I am certainly with him in terms of that aspirational goal. That means we are going to have to complete our work on the text by the end of this week so Senator SCHUMER will have that legislation available to take up next week.

I yield the floor.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The Senator from Minnesota.

Ms. KLOBUCHAR. Thank you, Senator CORNYN, for the work you are doing and working with Senator MURPHY and so many other Senators. You and I have done so many bills together, including the historic Save Our Stages bill, which made such a difference. And I am very pleased that we are finally advancing gun safety legislation. And a lot of these provisions are things that we have been working across the aisle on for many years, the boyfriend loophole—something that I introduced in 2013, 10 years ago—to close the boyfriend loophole. That is a part of this negotiation, part of the framework. We have so many women killed, 1 every 14 hours, from domestic partners—1 every 14 hours from domestic partners—with guns in this country. And, sadly, half of those involve dating partners, people who aren't married to someone, but they are in a romantic relationship with them in some way. And the way the law works in all but 19 States where it is fully closed, in many of these States, you get convicted of domestic abuse, and you can still go out and buy a gun the next day.

So I am really pleased that we are moving forward on this provision. This isn't the first time we have heard the call to action from America when it comes to guns. We heard it after 23 people were killed at a Walmart in El Paso; after 17 people were killed at Marjory Stoneman Douglas High School in Parkland; after 59 people were killed at a country music festival, just out there on a beautiful evening enjoying the music; after 59 people dead in Las Vegas; and after 49 people were killed at the Pulse nightclub in Orlando.

Today, we hear calls for action because of more tragedies: a White supremacist murdering 10 people who are simply shopping for groceries; one guy out buying a cake for his little boy, a birthday cake for his son, who never returned; 10 people killed.

The American people are demanding that we do something after the senseless murder of 19 children and 2 teachers who died putting their very lives up to protect those children in Uvalde, TX. We have seen the pictures of those kids in their confirmation-communion dresses, in their sports uniforms, the Converse green sneakers, the glasses, the smiles. In some photos, they were actually holding awards they had won just that morning.

But today, after too many of these tragedies to name, I rise with renewed hope that we are finally working together to help keep Americans safe from gun violence. While there is so much more work to be done, reforms outlined in the bipartisan framework, like encouraging States to enact risk protection orders, which are also known as red flag laws, expanding access to mental health services, and supporting school violence prevention—Senator GRASSLEY and I led that bill after Parkland that we passed with significant funding for schools. Clearly, more must be done.

As I noted, I am particularly pleased to see that the framework will include my bill to finally close the boyfriend loophole. Every year, more than 600 American women are shot to death by intimate partners. We understandably focus on the horror of these mass shootings, but think of those numbers: 600 women shot every year by intimate partners.

We know that preventing convicted domestic abusers from getting guns saves lives. We know that because we have seen the numbers in the States that have the laws in place.

Currently, Federal law only prohibits domestic abusers from buying a gun if they are currently or formerly married—think about that: currently or formerly married—or if they have ever lived together or if they have a child. That is despite the fact, as I noted, that half of these homicides—half of the women killed are killed by dating partners. That is why in 2013 I introduced this bill to close this dangerous loophole, and now, I am so pleased that there is growing bipartisan support for the bill.

By the way, we have shown that support in the past. It was part of the Violence Against Women Act that passed in the House, and it had 29 Republicans vote for it. That included an even more broad version of the bill, which also included stalking and was broader than what we are going to see in this bill.

Obviously, I support my original bill, but the fact that we are making progress to close the loophole in the States that so far have not gotten to where the other 19 are is incredibly positive. It did not pass last time when we passed the Violence Against Women Act in the Senate. Sadly, it didn't make it in there. But, again, it got 29 Republican votes in the House, and that just shows the kind of growing momentum we have for this.

I come from a State with a proud tradition of hunting and fishing, like yours. I always think about my Uncle

Dick and his deer stand, and I always ask, when I look at these proposals—from closing the boyfriend loophole to putting in better background checks, to doing something about better checking the records of 18- to 21 year olds—I think, does that hurt my Uncle Dick and his deer stand? Of course, the answer is, it does not.

This is our moment to act. It is not just one killing, and we all know that. It has happened in every single community. Every single Senator in this Chamber knows of a moment where they thought ''How could this happen in my community?'' when they meet with a family.

What I remember the most, actually, is a case involving a police officer out of Lake City, MN. He was a good cop doing his job. He was called to a domestic violence incident.

What people don't often know is that for police officers, these domestic violence calls can be some of the most dangerous because you have someone who is very angry, and you don't know what you are walking into. It is in the moment.

He gets there to the door. He has his bulletproof vest on, but the perpetrator—clearly mentally ill—who had been beating up his young, young, young girlfriend, meets him with a gun, shoots him in his head, and he dies.

I was there for that funeral. There was an outpouring of support from the community. The funeral was held in the very same church where the officer and his wife and their three little kids had gathered for the nativity play just a few weeks before for Christmas, those two little boys and a little girl. The father had sat in the front row to watch his boys in that nativity play only a few weeks before, and the next time the family is in that church, it is the widow, the two little boys, and this little tiny girl in a dress with blue stars on it walking down the aisle of that church at his funeral. That is a moment I won't forget.

I just shows you how domestic abuse and those kinds of cases—yes, there is one immediate victim—most likely the woman—but it is a whole family who is the victim. Kids who witness domestic abuse through their lives are so much more likely to get into crime themselves. Statistics have shown it. But it is even more than the family, it is the whole community, as that family who lost their dad and lost their husband would tell you if they were standing in here right now.

So I am so pleased we are finally moving on this. I thank Senator MURPHY. I thank Senator CORNYN and all those involved. I am also so grateful that my 10 years of work leading this bill with Representative DEBBIE DINGELL in the House has not gone for naught. We kept it moving. It is probably a sign for anyone that perseverance matters in this place. I am very pleased that it is part of the final negotiations, and it will make such a difference for saving lives.

I yield the floor.

RECESS

The PRESIDING OFFICER. Under the previous order, the Senate stands in recess until 2:15 p.m.

Thereupon, the Senate, at 12:52 p.m., recessed until 2:15 p.m. and reassembled when called to order by the Presiding Officer (Ms. SINEMA).

HONORING OUR PROMISE TO ADDRESS COMPREHENSIVE TOXICS ACT OF 2021—Continued

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The Senator from North Carolina.

TRIBUTE TO TED LEHMAN

Mr. TILLIS. Madam President, I come to the floor today to sadly announce the retirement—or not retirement—my chief of staff's decision to move on to another great opportunity, and I wanted to take a few minutes to talk about Ted Lehman and not only the 5 years he has been my chief of staff but the nearly 20 years he has been working in the Senate.

Before I start, though, he attended the University of Pennsylvania, where he got his undergrad, and then he went to Georgetown to get his law degree. He clerked for Thomas Hogan, who was then the chief judge of the DC District Court.

He came to the Senate about 20 years ago, in 2002. To give you some perspective, I didn't enter the legislature in North Carolina until 2007, so he has years of experience on me. He has knowledge of the Senate that I will never gain.

He started work with Senator Hatch. He worked for a couple of years with Senator Sessions, and then he worked for Senator GRASSLEY on the Judiciary Committee. He was the chief counsel of nominations and senior counsel for the Senate Judiciary Committee, and that is where I met Ted.

I remember vividly, when my chief of staff at the time, Ray Starling, told me that he was going to be moving back to North Carolina, I told him: Great. Now find your replacement.

It was later that day that he came to me and said: What about Ted Lehman?

I said: I think that is a fantastic idea.

Ted wasn't looking for a job, and I wondered whether or not he would be interested in working for a freshman Senator from the State of North Carolina. But he took that job, and he has done extraordinary work, not only in terms of the day-to-day institutional grind that a chief has to go through but his attention to staff—not only the DC staff but the North Carolina staff. I think he is well-regarded among the staff, and he is going to be sorely missed.

I also need to talk about Ted and his family. To say that it is in the Lehman blood is an understatement. His brother Dirksen served on the HELP Committee with Senator Jeffords. His brother Patrick is the legislative director to Senator SASSE. He knows a lot about this institution, and he knows a lot about its processes. The first, really, opportunity I got to see that in action was when he was responsible for moving Justice Gorsuch through the nominations process.

Ted has a great family—his wife Amy, his son Jackson, his oldest son, his oldest daughter, Emma Claire, Sallye, and a young son now. Now, Ted is not from North Carolina, and we have speculated as to why he named his son what he did. He may say it is related to some sort of family tradition, but I think it is no coincidence that he named his son ''Raleigh'' after our State's capitol.

Ted is an avid hunter, fisher, outdoorsman, baseball dad, soccer dad—all those sorts of things—and he gets the right balance. He understands that family is as important as work, and he figures out how to strike that balance. But there is very seldom a morning where he is not one of the first people in, and there are so many nights where I am the last person he sees before he goes home.

I appreciate his service. I am going to miss him.

Thank you, Ted.

I yield the floor.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The Senator from Rhode Island.

H.R. 3967

Mr. REED. Madam President, I rise today in support of the Sergeant First Class Heath Robinson Honoring our Promises to Address Comprehensive Toxics Act, also known as the Honoring our PACT Act.

Our Nation asks a great deal of our servicemembers and their families. We ask them to be ready to fight and to win against a wide range of security challenges across the globe. Our Armed Forces know and understand the threats they may face on the battlefield. Unfortunately, servicemembers also face threats that aren't as apparent—exposure to toxic materials. These exposures can result in rare and sometimes fatal medical conditions.

From exposure to Agent Orange to radiation from nuclear tests, veterans have carried an extra burden because of their service. It has too often been a struggle to recognize and address those impacts.

Now, a new generation is dealing with the long-term effects of toxic exposure. Indeed, during their service, up to 3½ million veterans have been exposed to toxic burn pits. As the name implies, burn pits are pits where all forms of waste, including toxic waste, are disposed of by burning. Our servicemembers lived and worked in close proximity to these burn pits, often without knowing the potential consequences to their long-term health or any way to avoid it.

Since 2009, the Department of Defense has recognized the harm burn

pits can cause. The health consequences are so serious that in the fiscal year 2022 National Defense Authorization Act, within that legislation, we included a provision that says that the only way the Department of Defense can now use a burn pit overseas is if the Secretary of Defense personally issues a waiver. It is an authority that cannot be delegated to anyone else in the Department.

The bill we have before us today would really honor our obligation to care for other veterans by acknowledging the injuries and illnesses they sustain in serving our country and providing them with treatment.

The bill would expand eligibility for VA healthcare for the 3½ million veterans who were exposed to burn pits. It would also eliminate the burden of proof for veterans for 23 conditions presumed to be caused by toxic exposure. It will create a new framework for the Secretary of Veterans Affairs to evaluate the science around burn pits and establish other presumptive conditions associated with toxic exposure. It will also provide significant resources for the VA to carry out the expansion of benefits in this bill, including provisions on staffing, retention, pay, and leasing of new VA facilities.

Every generation of Americans has had men and women who were willing to serve our country in uniform. As chairman of the Armed Services Committee, I have had the honor of traveling across the globe to meet with our deployed servicemembers, including numerous trips to Afghanistan and Iraq.

Our servicemembers and our veterans truly represent what is best in our country. We honor and venerate their heroism in combat, but too often in the past, we have overlooked and dismissed the long-term health effects of their service.

This is changing.

With this bill, we will do the right thing for our toxic-exposed and combat veterans and their families. We can ensure that they have access to the care and services they deserve and have earned.

I hope all of my colleagues will join me in supporting this important piece of legislation.

Before I yield the floor, I must recognize the extraordinary work of Senator JON TESTER and Senator JERRY MORAN, the chair and ranking member of the Veterans' Affairs Committee. This was an extraordinary effort. It was bipartisan. It was motivated by the recognition on both sides of the aisle of the service and sacrifice of thousands and thousands of men and women. But we would not be here today without the undaunted and unflagging dedication of JON TESTER and JERRY. I salute both of them.

I yield the floor.

I suggest the absence of a quorum.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The clerk will call the roll.

The senior assistant legislative clerk proceeded to call the roll.

Mr. MORAN. Madam President, I ask unanimous consent that the order for the quorum call be rescinded.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. Without objection, it is so ordered.

TRIBUTE TO C. CLYDE JONES

Mr. MORAN. Madam President, this afternoon, I want to recognize a longtime Manhattan, KS—known as the Little Apple—a Manhattan, KS, public servant, C. Clyde Jones, on his 100th birthday.

Before building his life in Manhattan, he grew up in West Virginia and then swore an oath to our Nation in 1943 to serve our country in the U.S. Navy during World World II.

Following his service, he returned to focus on his education, earning a bachelor's, master's, and doctorate concentrated on social science and history. After serving several universities in the South and Midwest, he received a phone call to come interview at Kansas State University. And while his initial reaction to living in the Sunflower State was less than thrilled, Kansans easily won him over when he visited. The beauty of the Flint Hills, where K-State is located, also didn't hurt. That was 60 years ago, and in that time, Clyde has left a tremendous impact both on Kansas State and the larger Manhattan community.

He was hired to head the business department within the College of Arts and Sciences; but with his leadership, it resulted in the transformation of the department into an accredited college. In 1962, he opened the Kansas State University College of Business as its first dean.

His involvement in campus life was all-encompassing, also serving as chair of the athletic council as it spearheaded the construction of the current football stadium, now known as Bill Snyder Family Stadium. It continues to welcome thousands of Wildcats to each Saturday's home game throughout the fall season.

His reach extended beyond campus as he invested in the larger community, serving on various community boards, including the United Way. He also worked as president of the Manhattan Area Chamber of Commerce. In 2001, the annual Chamber Volunteer of the Year award was renamed in his honor.

Clyde has also become a staunch advocate for Shepherd's Crossing, a local ministry focused on providing caring assistance to those in need of financial support. Over the 20 years since its founding, Clyde has held every position within the Shepherd's Crossing organization. Even today, he holds the title of chief development officer; and in this role, he has increased donations to support the work they are doing by hundreds of thousands of dollars.

Clyde's love and dedication to Manhattan has been demonstrated in everything he has done for over 60 years. Our community has been made better and stronger because of his countless hours of service.

Clyde, thank you for being an example of a solid, true, and faithful public servant. You are what I have in mind when I say we need more civics and less politics in our community, State, and Nation. I wish you the happiest of birthdays and hope that you can ring in 100 years surrounded by the ones you love. Know that there are many of us who love you.

Happy birthday, Clyde.

I yield the floor.

I suggest the absence of a quorum.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The clerk will call the roll.

The senior assistant legislative clerk proceeded to call the roll.

Mr. MARSHALL. Madam President, I ask unanimous consent that the order for the quorum call be rescinded.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. Without objection, it is so ordered.

UNANIMOUS CONSENT REQUEST—S. 3986

Mr. MARSHALL. Madam President, this past Saturday, I got to spend the whole morning with the East Central Kansas Model T Club back home. I even got to take a joy ride in a 1921 Model T. Among many stories, I learned Americans were paying only 21 cents a gallon when this car was made. And it wasn't until 1975, 54 years later, that gas had doubled from that price, jumping from 39 to 53 cents—54 years it took to double.

I don't have to remind anyone that, thanks to our President's energy policies and his reckless spending, he accomplished a doubling in less than 2 years. As we all know, gas is now over $5 a gallon, if you can believe it or not. We are seeing record prices that have gone now 16 days in a row without a single downtick.

And this is why I am here today to ask for unanimous consent to pass the Gas Prices Relief Act, which would bar any Federal agency from finalizing any rule or regulation that would make it harder to produce American fuels.

My legislation would send the right signal to American producers and investors. It would show them that the Congress sees the problem and that we are ready to address it. It would set us on a course to bring down prices at the pump, not with more reckless spending and more regulations, but by getting out of the way of American production and allowing them to power the world without more needlessly restrictive rules.

With this more than doubling of price, many families back home are telling me they are paying $50, up to $100 a week more for gasoline. And that is $2- to $400 a month, in case you are adding it up. And on top of that, their monthly utility bills have doubled.

I am sure this administration will propose more reckless spending to fix that problem, too. Unfortunately, Biden-flation is impacting many Kansas families to the tune of $6- to $700 a month. That is over $7,000 a year.

Now, why the increase, you might ask. Now, I am not an economist, but it looks to me like if you increase the regulations on a process, on a business, that is a surefire way to decrease the

supply. And as we all know, our President and his policies are ramping up regulations at every step of the American oil and gas business, all the while begging for help from other nations. Indeed, he is fulfilling his campaign promises to destroy American oil and gas.

Now, one more thought. As history teaches us, along with reckless spending, energy is always a leading indicator of inflation. If we don't get our arms around this energy crisis and reckless spending, we will never slow down inflation. But it appears our President and his party disagree with this, or else, simply stated, they don't care. Or maybe they want these high prices. It just seems like yesterday I was filling my truck up back home for less than $2 a gallon, and now, again, it is over $5 a gallon across most of the Nation.

Rising energy prices add inflationary pressure to everything. It is like a game of dominoes. When the diesel fuel powering our 18-wheelers are costing truckers 80 percent more than it did last year, they are going to have to pass on that rate to their consumers. When businesses are paying 30 percent more for their gas utilities, they are going to have to raise their prices to make up the difference. And Kansans, already paying more just to get to the store, are continually finding that what money they have left is getting them less and less every week.

You don't fix a supply-and-demand problem of this nature with price controls or artificial subsidies or more reckless spending. In reality, this is not very complicated. You could fix it by decreasing demand or increasing supply. Now, demand, unfortunately, is not decreasing, which is why we need this regulatory holiday in order to set American energy free.

On some level, the administration knows this and, hence, their knee-jerk decision to release a million barrels of oil from our Strategic Petroleum Reserve every day, reportedly without initially coordinating in a meaningful way with our partners overseas. Obviously, 1 million barrels a day won't cut it. In 2021, the United States consumed roughly nearly 20 million barrels a day. This release is truly a drop in the bucket.

The administration knows that the Strategic Petroleum Reserve releases are purely cosmetic, to try to convince the American people that they have solutions while they run off to beg foreign dictators and terrorists to produce more oil. Instead of looking within, instead of creating more Americans jobs, high-paying jobs, producing the cleanest fuel in the world, they continue their full frontal assault on American production and seek to enrich our enemies, like Venezuela and Iran.

But there has been a lot of talk on the left that they are not interfering with oil and gas production in the United States. These claims are simply untrue. On the campaign trail, President Biden promised to end the leasing of oil and gas production on Federal lands, and his climate czar recently said the administration ''remains absolutely committed to not moving forward with additional drilling on public lands.'' Most Presidents brag when they fulfill a campaign promise but apparently not when the results are this bad.

It is hard to imagine that this is not all by design. This administration is getting exactly what they want. In the President's own words, the world is currently going through an ''incredible transition,'' and he thinks we will ''be stronger and the world will be stronger and less reliant on fossil fuels when this is over.''

Well, the obvious question then is this: When—when will it be over? The Department of Energy has estimated that demand for oil and gas will increase through 2050. That is a simple fact. Yet we have a President who is perfectly willing to inflict pain on the people who elected him to force his climate policies—his costly climate policies—and ignore the economic reality that the American people are facing.

Now, why else would he propose a budget that gets rid of key tax provisions for the oil and gas industry? Why else would he promote policies that will make it more difficult and more expensive to drill? Does anyone think these policies are going to help the American people?

Let's talk about the stream of bad policies causing the crippling uncertainty that is making American producers hesitant to increase drilling.

Last November, the EPA started the process of updating methane regulations. While the proposed rule they put forward was criminally devoid of any details, their intent was clear: an increase in costly regulations that will harm the oil and national gas industry, run small businesses out of business, and further increase energy costs.

On February 18, by a completely partisan vote, FERC issued and made immediately effective two new policy statements that would have had disastrous implications for pipeline development in the U.S., pipelines critical to getting that oil to American consumers. Their off-the-deep-end proposal would have potentially put pipeline operators on the hook for mitigating the emissions of the end user of the product they transport. In other words, to get approval to build a pipeline, operators could have been forced to develop and pay for a way to mitigate the emissions caused by Americans driving to work every day or perhaps by Americans heating their homes or cooking their breakfast. Thankfully, in the face of fierce outcry from opponents on both sides of the aisle, they have temporarily pulled these changes back for further consideration. Though, that likely has more to do with the upcoming nomination process—the renomination process—for FERC Chairman Glick than it does with good energy policy.

On March 21, the SEC followed suit and proposed a rule that would require companies to disclose climate emission data, including greenhouse emissions, caused by their suppliers and their customers. This would require companies to calculate and disclose the emissions for how everyday Americans use their products, all in an effort to make doing business with American oil and gas producers seem even more risky and less deserving of financing.

And, finally, an issue that is at the top of mind of many producers in Kansas right now, the Fish and Wildlife Service is poised to list the lesser prairie-chicken as a threatened species. This is despite the incredible work being done by conservationists that have made the lesser prairie-chicken better protected now than ever. If the Fish and Wildlife Service goes through with this classification, it would have serious consequences for oil and gas producers in Kansas and severely limit their ability to increase production, not to mention the impact it will have on our utilities.

Once again, let me state, these reasons and more are why I am here today to ask unanimous consent to pass the Gas Prices Relief Act, which would bar any Federal agency from finalizing any rule regulation that would make it harder to produce American fuels. Our legislation would send the right signal to American producers and investors. It would show them that Congress sees the problem and that we are ready to address it. It would set us on course to bring down prices at the pump by getting out of the way and releasing American production and allowing them to power the world without more needlessly restrictive rules and regulations. Good energy policy will fix the current crisis, not more reckless spending.

Before I yield, I would like to turn the floor over to the Senator from Montana for his thoughts on the record gas prices we are facing and the need to pass our Gas Price Relief Act.

Mr. DAINES. I want to thank the Senator from Kansas for his work on this bill.

Madam President, the price at the pump has skyrocketed. Let's do a quick trip down memory lane. When President Biden was inaugurated, the weekly average price for gas was about $2.30 a gallon. In fact, when we introduced the bill that we are trying to pass today, the Gas Price Relief Act, that was on March 31 of this year, the weekly average was $4.02 a gallon. The weekly average today is $4.84. In fact, other studies show it is now at $5 and climbing. We think these numbers will keep going up. Most analysts agree. We may be facing $6-a-gallon gas by this summer.

I filled up my pickup in Belgrade, MT, Friday night. My wife and I pulled into a gas station. And when the tank was full, the price tag was $138.

The pain at the pump that Montana families are feeling today is because of

the Democrats' anti-American energy policies.

When President Biden killed the Keystone Pipeline 6 hours after being sworn in—by the way, that had tremendous benefits for the State of Montana. They help our impoverished Eastern Montana counties with tax revenues, not to mention providing nearly a million barrels of oil a day for the United States. By stopping and eliminating oil and gas leases, removing essential relief for small refiners, and then building an administration of, frankly, some far-left anti—anti—oil and natural gas ideologues, this administration has gone above and beyond to hinder traditional American energy development.

And what is the solution that we are hearing from President Biden? Turn to foreign dictators for more oil, tap into our oil reserves, beg OPEC to increase production, and perhaps the most out-of-touch solution I have heard, simply suggest families buy electric vehicles. I can tell you that won't work in a State like Montana.

The real solution is to unleash American energy and encourage American energy investment. This bill I have with Senator MARSHALL is simple. It prevents the Biden administration from imposing any new rules or regulations that would decrease oil, gas, or renewable fuel production, which would, therefore, increase gas prices of hard-working Montanans.

I am urging my colleagues across the aisle to think about hard-working families across this country, how are they trying to make ends meet, to think about their constituents who depend on affordable gas prices to get to work or drop kids off at school.

I am urging my colleagues across the aisle who say they support American energy development, and they want to lower gas costs, to support this bill.

We need to pass this bill for American families.

I yield back my time to the Senator from Kansas.

Mr. MARSHALL. Madam President, I would like to ask unanimous consent that the Committee on Energy and Natural Resources be discharged from further consideration of S. 3986 and the Senate proceed to its immediate consideration.

I further ask that the bill be considered read a third time and passed and that the motion to reconsider be made and laid upon the table.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. Is there objection?

Mr. WHITEHOUSE. Madam President, reserving the right to object.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The Senator from Rhode Island.

Mr. WHITEHOUSE. I have been listening with interest to my two distinguished colleagues discuss this measure, referring to it repeatedly as ''governing American energy.'' But, of course, what it really governs is fossil fuel energy. That is the intention here, and that is the result.

Let's start with a basic factual proposition, which is that the price of oil is set by oil companies.

In a market economy, the producer of a product chooses the price. And what has happened in this instance is that the oil industry has chosen to depart from market economics, to depart from the costs that were the same just a few years ago, and instead to follow upward the international cartel that our oil industry is a part of.

This international cartel has driven world oil prices extremely high. And American oil companies have chosen—have chosen—to follow that price, raise the prices at the pump, punish American drivers, in order to blow out their profits.

We know that this is true because the companies themselves are reporting unprecedented profits—massive profits. We know they are not tracking the cost of production at a reasonable profit because their profits have soared as they have chosen—chosen—to pursue this international cartel price and punish American drivers. It is their choice.

And then they have the colossal nerve to take their choice, what they have done to American drivers, and then start using that for leverage to try to get other fossil fuel industry prerogatives accomplished politically.

And let me say, don't be mad at the gas station owner. The gas station owner is not the one who is jacking up the prices. For a lot of gas station owners, they don't even make money on the gas. You have got to go in and buy a coffee or snacks to have them make money.

Your local gas station is not the problem with these prices. The problem is Chevron, Exxon, Marathon, all of the big oil companies that have chosen to drive gas prices through the roof so they can fill their pockets with profit, so they can prepare for the fact that their product has got an end point.

We can't keep polluting the Earth the way we are with the emissions of fossil fuel. I noticed that neither of my colleagues mentioned that this fossil fuel actually gets burned. We don't eat it; we burn it. And when we burn it, it emits CO_2 and other gases, and we are seeing the effect of that all over the planet.

Pollution increases. CO_2 levels continue to increase. We constantly set new records for CO_2 levels in the atmosphere. Heat increases. We are heating the ocean so fast—there is a new term that we have, a new term of measurement, a ''zettajoule.'' Do you know what a zettajoule is? A joule is a unit of heat energy measurement. A zettajoule is that unit with 21 zeros after it. It is an enormous number. All of the fossil fuel burned by all of the people across this entire planet amounts to less than half of a zettajoule of energy—all of it, less than half.

And for the price of that—because of the emissions, because of the pollution, because of the CO_2, because of the methane—we are heating up the planet so fast that every year 14 zettajoules of excess heat go into the ocean, where my fishermen in Rhode Island see their catches disappear, see their lives turned upside down, see fisheries that their fathers and their grandfathers fished completely upturned.

This comes home in Rhode Island. Our Coastal Resources Management Council predicts that all that ocean warming is going to raise sea levels so that in my lifetime we are going to start to see flooding. Things that are now part of our State are going to become islands. Warwick Neck becomes Warwick Neck Island. Bristol becomes Bristol Island. Poppasquash Point becomes Poppasquash Island. Newport divides into a mainland and an island.

We become the Rhode Island archipelago. We lose enormous amounts of our shoreline to sea level rise. Never mention—never mention that harm. So when you come here and say, we want to help more fossil fuel get burned, remember that on the other end of that are places like Rhode Island.

And if we want to have a conversation about how we solve price now and how we protect against emissions later, that is a conversation I am more than willing to have. But a one-sided conversation that is only about more burning, more pollution, more emissions, more of that for Rhode Island, I don't think so.

And it is not, of course, just Rhode Island. Other States are having unprecedented wildfires. They are having unprecedented droughts. We are seeing a planet whose basic operating systems are being changed by fossil fuel emissions. And until we grapple with that seriously, you can bet I will object—which I do.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The objection is heard.

UNANIMOUS CONSENT REQUEST—S. 4217

Mr. WHITEHOUSE. Madam President, I would actually ask, in response, that we pass a different measure, and I would ask unanimous consent that the Committee on Commerce, Science, and Transportation be discharged from further consideration of S. 4217, and the Senate proceed to its immediate consideration. I further ask that the bill be considered read a third time and passed and that the motions to reconsider be considered made and laid upon the table.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. Is there objection?

Mr. MARSHALL. Reserving the right to object.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The Senator from Kansas.

Mr. MARSHALL. Madam President, I think we should start calling electric cars coal-powered cars. We should start thinking about a cradle-to-grave environmental impact to some of the alternatives, but I want to reassure to my colleague, the folks on the other side of the aisle, that I want to leave this world cleaner, healthier, and safer than we found it.

But on the other hand, we can't create such high inflation with reckless

spending and energy policies that stifle American energy. I do believe that there is a balance. I do believe that there are opportunities, but we can't go from zero to 90 miles an hour overnight, nor can we throw the brakes on our current energy supply.

I grew up in the oil patch. I lived in the oil patch. The prices of oil are being driven up by the uncertainty created by this administration. Make no mistake about it, the price of oil is people who are thinking about investing, what will they get 2 years from now? It would take 2 years probably to see any type of return on investment from an oilfield exploration.

But this President and his policies, his regulations continue to create uncertainty and drive the price up for all Americans.

Just the thought of $5-a-gallon gasoline makes my heart shiver. The people I talk to back home, there is no conversation I am going to have without someone bringing up the price of gasoline right now.

And I am so proud that we are taking traditional energies, and we are making them cleaner; that we are using biofuels to help decrease the tailpipe emissions through E15 year round and higher ethanol as well. I am proud of the biodiesel that we are using as well.

I think that there are incredible opportunities out there, but inflation, reckless spending inflation, driving up the price of gasoline very purposefully is what this President has accomplished, and it is hurting people back home.

I yield the floor.

Mr. WHITEHOUSE. My colleague may care to object.

Mr. MARSHALL. So I object to Senator WHITEHOUSE.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The objection is heard.

Mr. WHITEHOUSE. Or at least to the motion I propounded anyway.

Mr. MARSHALL. Yes, I specifically object to the motion. My apologies.

Mr. WHITEHOUSE. Senator WHITEHOUSE, of course, as well, but I think the intention was to object to the measure.

I see that my friend Senator BARRASSO has joined us. I had mentioned zettajoules. I want to add one other figure. This is from a report by the corporate accounting and consulting firm, Deloitte Consulting, which has said that if we don't get ahead of this climate problem that my colleague seems so scrupulously interested in ignoring, the cost to society in the next five decades will be, if I remember correctly—the number is $178 trillion in economic harm across those years.

You want to talk about big numbers? And if we do get it right, if we grow up, treat this as a factual scientific problem and put in serious, real economic solutions, then the win side is $43 trillion.

So the swing is $220 trillion. You want to talk about big numbers? That is a big number. And it is going to depend on decisions we make now, and I hope we start making good decisions.

I yield the floor.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The Senator from Wyoming.

ENERGY

Mr. BARRASSO. Madam President, I come to the floor as I see my colleagues debating issues related to energy, and I come to the floor to also debate and discuss the issue of energy and, specifically, the need of the American people for more energy.

Because right now, America, in terms of energy, is running on empty. Gas prices have broken records day after day after day over the last several months. Inflation increased again last month to a new record 40-year high. Just this morning, we found out that inflation from producers is even higher than inflation for consumers. Wholesale prices are up by nearly 11 percent in the last year.

That means higher prices for people who grow our food, who build our buildings, and who work so hard to keep the lights on.

Inflation for producers means inflation for consumers tomorrow. After 13 months of this inflation crisis, there is still no light at the end of the tunnel. The average price of gasoline across the United States today is over $5 a gallon.

That is a big number. We just heard colleagues discussing big numbers. Five dollars a gallon is a big number for anyone who is driving a gas-powered car or a diesel-powered car or truck in America.

Gas prices are at an alltime high in all 50 States, and there is no end in sight. Experts tell us that the price of gas is going to continue to go higher. We may actually see $6 a gallon this summer across the country, and today, gas is already $6 a gallon in a number of locations.

Now, for most Americans, this is unthinkable. So what are families doing? Well, they are kind of buckling up for what may be a summer of financial suffering for the American people. For many, it means a summer of staying home. People are having to change the way they drive, the way they eat, the way they live. Family vacations are being canceled left and right. People are cutting back on shopping to the point that retail jobs disappeared last month, thousands and thousands of retail jobs.

Coronavirus caused one lockdown. Now we are headed into a new lockdown because people don't have the money to get out—get out to go to dinner, get out to go to a movie, get out to go on vacation. People are staying home because they can't afford to do anything else.

Many working families are being pushed to the breaking point. Savings have melted away. Household debt is now at a record high. More and more people are having to borrow money just to get through the end of the month. The purchasing power of the American people keeps going lower and lower and lower. That is providing very little relief—even for people who are getting raises, they are having a hard time keeping up and feel they are falling further behind.

Home energy costs are up and will continue to go up this summer. We hear that our energy grid is vulnerable for blackouts this summer. Democrats have been in power for over 17 months. They continue to do nothing to help the American people with this Biden-caused energy crisis.

Now, Joe Biden's Cabinet has been on tour, talking and trying to mislead the American people about the energy crisis. We saw Pete Buttigieg and Gina Raimondo. They said that Joe Biden is just an innocent bystander, just standing there, watching the world go by. Nothing he could do about it.

The Commerce Secretary last week said—and this was on a national news show—she said there isn't much that can be done to produce more energy. Treasury Secretary Janet Yellen said Joe Biden has ''done everything he can to bring down energy prices.'' Everything he can? This is a blatant, bold-faced lie to the American people.

Joe Biden and the Democrats have caused this American energy crisis. Joe Biden seemed to brag about it at first when, on his first day in office, he killed the Keystone XL Pipeline, killing 800,000 barrels of oil a day to the United States—more than we would have ever gotten from Putin. Joe Biden bragged about it, proud of himself. Stopped those oil and gas leases as well. What the President has done with the oil and gas leases was blatantly illegal and brutally punished working families in my home State of Wyoming.

You know, after 16 months in office, President Obama had held 44 oil and gas lease sales. Joe Biden? Not a single one.

If the Senator from Alaska were here, she would say that Joe Biden shut down oil and gas production in the Arctic. For leases that were out there, drilling applications, thousands and thousands are in limbo because the administration just wants them to sit there.

Now Joe Biden is furthering his attack on American energy. He is not just blocking new leases, he is even going after thousands of existing leases that were sold during previous administrations, the Obama and the Trump administrations.

After just 16 months in office—and the American people know this; I am not making any news here—Joe Biden is already the most anti-American energy President in American history. He has kept our energy production on lockdown, he has kept workers on the sideline, and he has kept energy buried in the ground. As a result, today, we are still producing 1 million fewer barrels of oil today and every single day than we were producing in America before the pandemic.

So, despite what the administration claims, Joe Biden could do things right now to actually produce more energy. First, instead of blocking all Federal land, he needs to hold Federal oil and gas lease sales. He should approve the 4,300 drilling applications that he is holding in limbo. Finally, instead of shutting down pipelines, he should approve more pipelines so we can transmit energy. He should speed up the pipeline approval process. Right now, it takes a lot longer to get approval to build a pipeline than it does to actually build a pipeline. But Joe Biden refuses to change his policies. That is why I say that Joe Biden actually wants high gas prices.

Democrats keep bragging about the so-called incredible transition. It is a transition that is strangling the American people. Joe Biden went on a late-night comedy show last week. He was asked about climate change. He said right now ''there's an opportunity to move more rapidly . . . to alternative energy.'' He seems to think everything is going according to plan.

The climate elitists want prices so high that people can't afford to buy gas. The economists call this demand destruction. Democrats are working to achieve demand destruction through supply destruction, and the result is economic destruction—a destruction of the standard of living for the American people—all because they want their climate ideology.

So Democrats have kept supply slow and low. They have driven up prices. Now the American people are forced to stay home.

Well, the Transportation Secretary continues to say: Just get an electric vehicle. Gas prices are no big deal.

The average electric vehicle costs over $55,000. The American people can barely afford groceries right now, let alone an electric vehicle. CNN ran a story recently about single mothers skipping meals so their kids can eat. I would say to the Secretary of Transportation: How are they going to afford the electric vehicle, let alone find a place to charge it?

Astonishing stories have been written in the press recently. People trying to drive electric vehicles from point A to point B said: Never again. Oh, no.

I have heard stories of someone renting an electric vehicle in Wyoming, driving it from one place to another, using a regular plug-in, coming back an hour later, and it had charged the battery enough extra in that full hour that they could go an additional 4 miles. That is what Joe Biden wants for America. That is his view of America—''stay at home'' Joe.

The Transportation Secretary refuses to admit that gas prices drive up the cost of other things like food, the cost of retail, the cost of almost everything.

Democrats tell us that we just need a little more wind energy, a little more solar power, and things would be great. So what is Joe Biden doing? He listens to them, and he uses wartime Executive powers to demand that we make more solar panels.

This is another dangerous Democrat delusion. We don't have high gas prices and high food prices because of a lack of solar panels; we have high gas prices and high food prices because of a lack of American gasoline, oil, energy.

Democrats keep repeating the talking points about renewable energy. Yet they never do the math. The most affordable and most reliable energy known to man is traditional energy—oil, natural gas, coal. Electric vehicles still use energy. This energy comes mostly, in this country, from natural gas and coal.

The only way to bring the price of gas down is to bring the supply of gas up. It is the one thing the Democrats refuse to do.

It is interesting to listen to some of Joe Biden's allies in the Senate who are threatening to make the Biden energy crisis even worse. They want to talk about bringing back their reckless tax-and-spending bill. This bill is more reckless today than it was last year. You put that kind of additional spending on the economy, that kind of additional debt—inflation today is a lot higher than it was the last time they forced this kind of money onto the economy. This will be adding fuel to the fire.

Then the Democrats are talking about raising taxes and specifically raising taxes on American energy. More taxes on American energy means higher prices at the pump. It is as simple as that. Higher prices at the pump means higher prices at the grocery store. Now isn't the time to raise taxes on the American people.

Janet Yellen was surprised. She said it last week. She talked to the New York Times. She said she was surprised at how negative people's opinion was of the economy. She said she was amazed at how pessimistic people were about the economy. How out of touch can one be for the Secretary of Treasury to say that at a time when there are the highest gas prices in the history of the country, food prices at an alltime high, and inflation at a 40-year high?

Over three out of four Americans think the country is heading in the wrong direction under Joe Biden and the Democrats. The American people have seen what 16 months of Democrat rule has done to them, and Janet Yellen is surprised at the pessimism and the negativity.

Record inflation, record gas prices, record debt, disappearing savings, empty shelves, labor shortages, a looming recession—it is long past time to change course. It is time to stop this reckless spending, unleash American energy. The American public cannot afford to pay the price, but they will make the Democrats pay the price come November.

I yield the floor.

I suggest the absence of a quorum.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The clerk will call the roll.

The bill clerk proceeded to call the roll.

(Mr. MURPHY assumed the Chair.)

(Mr. DURBIN assumed the Chair.)

Mr. BRAUN. Mr. President, I ask unanimous consent that the order for the quorum call be rescinded.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. Without objection, it is so ordered.

CELEBRATING THE 245TH ANNIVERSARY OF THE CREATION OF THE FLAG OF THE UNITED STATES AND EXPRESSING SUPPORT FOR THE PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE

Mr. BRAUN. Mr. President, this is one of the more enjoyable things of being a Senator, especially when I have some friends in from Southern Indiana up in the Gallery to see what we do here.

I rise today to offer a resolution expressing support for the Pledge of Allegiance as an expression of patriotism and honoring the 245th anniversary of the introduction of our United States flag.

Today we celebrate Flag Day, which was first established over 100 years ago by President Woodrow Wilson. As we pause to recognize all that our flag represents, let us also honor those who have sacrificed everything to defend it.

In 2002, Senator Tom Daschle raised a similar resolution with unanimous support from the Senate. It passed on the floor uneventfully. Today, I ask this body to reaffirm our support for the Pledge of Allegiance.

I also rise to honor a fellow Hoosier who knew the innate value of the Pledge of Allegiance to civic education. In 1969, Red Skelton, the American entertainer who was well-known for the program ''The Red Skelton Hour,'' wrote a speech on the importance of the pledge. Reflecting on his time in Vincennes, IN, he spoke about the values instilled by one of his high school teachers.

After the performance of the speech, CBS received 200,000 requests for copies. The speech would go on to be sold as a single by Columbia Records and performed at the White House for President Nixon. I think it would honor Mr. Skelton's memory and the importance of the Pledge of Allegiance if it were recited today on the Senate floor in the words of Mr. Red Skelton. I have done this 2 prior years too. This should never get old for anyone here or the American public in general.

When I was a small boy in Vincennes, [Indiana,] I heard, I think, one of the most outstanding speeches I ever heard in my life. I think it compares with the Sermon on the Mount, Lincoln's Gettysburg Address, and Socrates' Speech to the Students.

We had just finished reciting the Pledge of Allegiance, and he [Mr. Lasswell, the Principal of Vincennes High School] called us all together, and he says, ''Uh, boys and girls, I have been listening to you recite the Pledge of Allegiance all semester, and it seems that it has become monotonous to you. Or, could it be, you do not understand the meaning of

each word? If I may, I would like to recite the pledge, and give you a definition of each word:

I—Me, an individual; a committee of one.

Pledge—Dedicate all of my worldly good to give without self-pity.

Allegiance—My love and my devotion.

To the Flag—Our standard. ''Old Glory''; a symbol of courage. And wherever she waves, there is respect, because your loyalty has given her a dignity that shouts ''Freedom is everybody's job.''

Of the United—That means we have all come together.

States—Individual communities that have united into 48 great states

Remember the time when they didn't.

Forty-eight individual communities with pride and dignity and purpose; all divided by imaginary boundaries, yet united to a common cause, and that's love of country—

Of America.

And to the Republic—a Republic: A sovereign state in which power is invested into the representatives chosen by the people to govern; [us] and the government is the people; and it's from the people to the leaders, not from the leaders to the people.

For which it Stands.

One Nation—Meaning ''so blessed by God.''

[Under God]

Indivisible—Incapable of being divided.

With Liberty—Which is freedom; the right of power for one to live his own life without fears, threats, or any sort of retaliation.

And Justice—The principle and qualities of dealing fairly with others.

For All—For All. That means, boys and girls, it's as much your country as it is mine.

Afterward, Mr. Lasswell asked the students to recite the Pledge of Allegiance together, with newfound appreciation for the words.

I pledge allegiance to the flag of the United States of America, and to the Republic, for which it stands; one nation, indivisible, with liberty and justice for all.

Mr. Skelton concluded his speech by saying:

Since I was a small boy, two states have been added to our country, and two words have been added to the Pledge of Allegiance: ''Under God.'' Wouldn't it be a pity if someone said, ''That is a prayer''—and that it be eliminated from our schools, too?

Just as those students that day, Mr. Red Skelton included, recommitted to the meaning of the words of the Pledge of Allegiance, I call upon the U.S. Senate to recommit to these words as well.

There are times today that the words of the Pledge of Allegiance are tossed around without care. Other times, they are altered to remove what today is deemed offensive or antiquated. But Americans should not misuse or abuse our Pledge of Allegiance. The Pledge of Allegiance is meant to remind Americans of our guiding principles and inspire adherence to those ideas which make our country great: equality under the law, recognized rights to life, liberty, and the pursuit of happiness. This is why today, on National Flag Day, I am requesting unanimous consent from my colleagues that my resolution expressing support for the Pledge of Allegiance is passed.

Mr. President, I ask unanimous consent that the Senate proceed to the consideration of S. Res. 671, submitted earlier today; further, I ask unanimous consent that the resolution be agreed to, the preamble be agreed to, and that the motions to reconsider be considered made and laid upon the table with no intervening action or debate.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. Without objection, it is so ordered.

The resolution (S. Res. 671) was agreed to.

The preamble was agreed to.

(The resolution, with its preamble, is printed in today's RECORD under ''Submitted Resolutions.'')

Mr. BRAUN. I yield the floor.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The Senator from Indiana.

Mr. BRAUN. I suggest the absence of a quorum.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The clerk will call the roll.

The senior assistant legislative clerk proceeded to call the roll.

Mr. MORAN. Mr. President, I ask unanimous consent that the order for the quorum call be rescinded.

The PRESIDING OFFICER (Mr. MARKEY). Without objection, it is so ordered.

UNANIMOUS CONSENT REQUEST—H.R. 3967

Mr. MORAN. Mr. President, as we know, the Senate is currently considering the Sergeant First Class Heath Robinson Honoring our PACT Act. This bipartisan legislation is the most comprehensive toxic exposure bill ever considered for veterans.

Passing toxic exposure legislation has been a priority for Senator TESTER, the chairman of the committee, and for me, the ranking member, and we wanted to do it this Congress, and we are close to accomplishing that.

Last Congress, we were able to deliver landmark mental health legislation for veterans, and this Congress, we were committed to passing long-lasting solutions that will reform the VA's process by which veterans who were exposed to burn pits and Agent Orange receive their benefits and healthcare.

About a month ago, Senator TESTER and I announced a bipartisan agreement and introduced the historic Heath Robinson PACT Act. Part of the agreement between the chairman and me was that two amendments would be considered for this legislation.

I offered an amendment to strike the creation of a fund which would classify over $116 billion in discretionary costs associated with the bill as entitlement spending. I believe that this untested and unique way of classifying spending lessens congressional oversight at a time of massive debt and deficits, and it sets a bad precedent.

Senator LEE has an amendment requiring the Secretary to use science when evaluating presumptions established in the bill. That amendment has been filed.

Senator ERNST has an amendment requiring the Secretary to certify that with the resources and authorities provided through this bill, there won't be a negative consequence for veterans in the system.

There are at least three amendments proposing to offset the cost of the bill or at least a portion thereof with spending reductions elsewhere.

I am hopeful that in the days ahead, before final passage of this bill, we will let our colleagues be heard through an amendment process, pass or fail.

I have also hoped that the two amendments that I expected to be able to offer would be made in order. That hasn't been the case to date, and therefore I ask unanimous consent that it be made in order for the following amendments to be made pending to the substitute amendment No. 5051 by their sponsors or their designees: One, the Ernst amendment, Secretary of VA certification, No. 5072; two, the Lee amendment to modify the authority to create presumptions, No. 5048; the Johnson amendment to pay for COVID money, amendment No. 5055; the Paul amendment, to pay for this legislation from USAID, No. 5060; the Blackburn community care amendment, No. 5075; my amendment, the community care amendment, No. 5064; my amendment to strike section 805, No. 5063; the Marshall amendment on collective bargaining, No. 5071; the Murkowski amendment on appraisals for housing loans, No. 5069; and the Inhofe amendment concerning Camp Lejeune, No. 5094. I further ask that at a time to be determined by the majority leader, in consultation with the Republican leader, the Senate vote in relation to these amendments in the order listed; further, that upon disposition of the amendments listed, all postcloture time on the substitute amendment No. 5051 be expired and the remaining pending amendments be withdrawn, with the exception of the substitute amendment No. 5051, as amended, if amended, and that the Senate vote on adoption of the substitute amendment, as amended, if amended; and finally, that upon disposition of amendment No. 5051, as amended, if amended, the cloture motion with respect to the underlying bill, H.R. 3967, be withdrawn, the bill, as amended, if amended, be read a third time, and the Senate vote on passage of the bill, as amended, if amended, with 60 affirmative votes required for passage.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. Is there objection?

The Senator from Montana.

Mr. TESTER. Reserving the right to object, we are here on the cusp of doing something that really tells the fighting men and women who serve in our military all around the world that we have got your back.

We are here because of what I would say is a great working relationship between the ranking member, Senator MORAN, and myself. As I said in the VA Committee earlier, that relationship is going to continue regardless, and the reason is because, in this place, there is something that is missing, and it is called trust. And I trust Senator MORAN. We have been through this for the last year and a half and even longer.

When you were chairman of the committee, many of the bills that are in this package, you oversaw their passage out of committee.

But because negotiations continue and because I still believe, even though this process is very broken—we both know that—I still believe that we are going to be able to come to something that both of us can agree on with amendments through our leadership—by the way, we would agree on something anyway—but through our leadership. That is why I am objecting to your motion.

I object.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The objection is heard.

Mr. MORAN. Mr. President, I would conclude by encouraging the chairman of the Senate Committee on Veterans' Affairs to use his substantial level of influence with the leaders that he described as necessary to approve the consideration of these amendments.

He speaks of the word ''trust,'' and I have great trust in his ability to accomplish the desired outcome that I have.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The Senator from Montana.

Mr. TESTER. Mr. President, may I ask the ranking member of the Veterans' Affairs Committee a question?

The PRESIDING OFFICER. Through the Presiding Officer, you are allowed to do that.

Mr. TESTER. Mr. President, are you asking me to throw my weight around?

Mr. MORAN. Mr. President, may I make an inquiry of the Senator from Montana through the Chair?

The PRESIDING OFFICER. Yes, you may.

Mr. MORAN. Mr. President, if I answered the question, Mr. Chairman, would that be considered derogatory?

Perhaps it is a parliamentary inquiry.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. I think in Montana, it is considered a compliment.

Mr. MORAN. Mr. President, I suggest the absence of a quorum.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The clerk will call the roll.

The bill clerk proceeded to call the roll.

Mr. WHITEHOUSE. Mr. President, I ask unanimous consent that the order for the quorum call be rescinded.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. Without objection, it is so ordered.

The Senator from Rhode Island.

U.S. SUPREME COURT

Mr. WHITEHOUSE. Mr. President, I am here for the 15th time in my series of ''Scheme'' speeches to call attention to the rightwing donors' long-planned scheme to capture and control our Supreme Court.

What I will talk about today is that scheme's donor-funded doctrine factory and a case in which the ''Court that dark money built'' could weaponize dangerous, concocted doctrines to power up polluters and threaten the basic function of government.

Before I get into this, let me say that I detest and condemn violence or threatened violence against members of the Court, and I object even to protesters making a racket in Justices' neighborhoods. There is a lot to be angry about, but the solution is through democracy and laws, not violence and noise. The capture of the Court by secret and special interests is deadly serious under our laws, and we have to respond seriously under our laws. Neighborhood noise and violent threats don't help.

Let's remember that all three Trump Supreme Court Justices were actually chosen and then campaigned for by a dark money donor apparatus. Remember, the whole point of the scheme is to capture the Court so it will deliver big wins for the big rightwing donors, no matter how unpopular or radical those wins are. Remember that the donor elite behind the scheme spent hundreds of millions of dollars on an apparatus to capture the courts. It plotted for decades to seize this power and set up a system to get its hand-picked, extremist nominees onto the Bench. It instructs those Justices with coordinated flotillas of amicus briefs so the Justices know how they are supposed to rule. It is quite an operation.

But none of that works—none of that works if judges are following the law as it is. Existing legal precedents are a problem for the scheme. So, to accomplish its mission, a radical deconstruction of our American laws, the big donor elite need to destroy decades of legal precedent.

We got a preview in the looming effort, shown by the Alito leaked draft opinion, to destroy precedent protecting women's right to decide about abortion and relocate that right from women to State legislatures. That is just the scheme's opening act, a sop to one segment of its social issues base. The scheme is out to deconstruct American law and destroy established precedent across many areas of the law.

Now, if you are out to deconstruct American law and replace it with what the big donors want, you need some intellectual weaponry. You don't just need Justices who will do what you ask, you need legal theories. You need to give the Justices you put on the Court the intellectual artillery—the demolition theories—that will help them destroy the precedents and deconstruct our legal system.

So that is a problem.

But when you are spending more than half a billion dollars on such a scheme, you can find solutions. And sure enough, rightwing donor interests found solutions. It took time, but the whole scheme took time. It took a lot of money, but the whole scheme took a lot of money. It took patience and planning, but what a payoff when you succeed.

And now it is payday.

The first thing you do is erect an array of legal think tanks, phony institutes, the hothouses in which the deconstruction theories are grown; the factories, if you will, where doctrines are crafted, reverse-engineered from the results the big donors want so that willing, complicit Justices have the ideological weaponry for deconstruction of the law.

These think tanks do a couple of things. First, they nurture rightwing legal scholars to formulate bogus legal doctrines. They pay them comfortable salaries. They grant them nice titles. They cover their trips to conferences and symposia with fellow hothouse scholars. The whole thing apes regular academia, but this academia-resembling performance has a very different mission: It has deliverables.

Second, they systematically cheerlead for their new legal doctrines. They create an echo chamber of approval for their cultivated fringe ideas. Once the hothouse conjures a fringe idea, the hothouse bounces it among other so-called scholars and through other anonymously funded affiliate groups and through law school debate clubs and conservative conferences—also funded by secretive donors—and into flotillas of scripted amicus curiae briefs and ultimately, the prize, into legal opinions. They create a legitimization process, and of course they concoct or retool the desirable theories.

The legal theories are actually pretty easy to come up with. You reverse-engineer. You start with what big donor interests want and then work backward. And what lots of big donors want—especially fossil fuel companies—is to weaken and disable government regulation.

Government regulators stop all sorts of harmful corporate practices: pollution of our air, water, and climate; dangerous factory floor working conditions; crooked schemes that cheat investors; snake oil medications that don't cure disease; unsafe products; insurance policies that don't pay. The list is long. Demolishing that protective network of regulations protecting America's health, safety, and financial well-being is a scheme priority, and the destruction begins by pejoratively naming the Agencies whose work protects us the ''administrative state.''

There are many of these doctrine-growing hothouses. Two examples are the Cato Institute, originally founded by the Koch brothers, and the C. Boyden Gray Center for the Study of the Administrative State at George Mason University's Antonin Scalia Law School, of course. Both of these groups are funded to pump out and legitimize anti-regulatory fringe theories and talking points.

Think of them as factories for ideological artillery designed for the demolition of Federal Agencies' authority, particularly over polluters.

What do they manufacture? Well, the concocted doctrines fall into a few buckets. There is the so-called unitary executive theory, cooked up to argue

that safeguards set in place by Congress to protect Federal Agencies against political interference are unconstitutional.

Now, if you are a big donor and you paid big bucks to get your man in the White House, you want political interference by your guy in regulatory decisions.

Congress built safeguards against that for a very good reason. But a captured Court could disable Congress's ability to defend the Agencies that Congress itself created. This unitary executive legal theory was the pet theory of the Reagan administration. It was thoroughly debunked by serious scholars and rejected initially even by the Supreme Court. But the rightwing Court-capture apparatus has persistently kept this theory a Federalist Society cornerstone and diligently packed the Court with new Justices more amenable to this nonsense.

Other concocted doctrines also target Agencies. The so-called nondelegation doctrine is so radical and meritless that the Supreme Court dismissed it a century ago, except for rare cases that no longer exist where Congress might give Agencies power with no direction whatsoever.

This nondelegation idea has been retooled in the doctrine factories to target Agency regulation generally. Under this doctrine as retooled, the power is removed from Congress and given to unelected courts to decide how questions should be assigned by Congress to Federal Agencies. This gives big, regulated industries a big weapon to attack the Federal Government's ability to regulate problems that they cause, at a minimum allowing industries to tie public protection regulations up in years, even decades, of litigation.

Federalist Society Justices on the Court long clamored for the nondelegation doctrine, and as new Federalist Society Justices get added to the Court, it becomes more probable. Certainly the dark money front groups that provide instruction and encouragement to the Federalist Society Justices—they are in full clamor, using amicus curiae briefs to signal their wishes to the captured Court.

On now to yet another hothouse-grown doctrine, the major questions doctrine, which provides a similar weapons platform to assault public safety regulations. Where the nondelegation doctrine would require Congress to set more specific regulatory standards for Agencies to police, the major questions doctrine would let the unelected Court determine that some questions are just too big to regulate—too big to regulate at all.

Again, at a minimum, that lets big industries snarl Agency protections up in litigation. At worst, it forces Congress into detailed, complex questions that Congress already determined—already determined—should better be handled by expert Agencies.

Perhaps I should mention here how hard the Federalist Society Justices have worked to create avenues of corporate political influence, including anonymous, unlimited, corporate political spending, allowing corporate interests to blockade action in Congress; but while it is relevant here, that is a longer story for another day.

All of these concocted doctrines share the premise that Congress may not deploy Agency regulation against certain problems and that the power to grant Agencies authority to regulate in certain areas is, instead, to be decided by unelected courts—in present circumstances, decided by a captured Supreme Court with Members installed by big special interest money.

What could possibly go wrong?

All of these concocted doctrines overlook the robust oversight of Federal Agencies by the people's Representatives in Congress and by courts, tasked by Congress, with applying the Administrative Procedure Act. If an Agency were to go rogue, Congress can immediately intervene. Congress can reverse the decision of the Agency. Congress can change the underlying law the Agency enforces. Congress can redirect, defund, or even eliminate the errant Agency. Moreover, if Agencies don't follow the law as Congress directed or if the Agencies behave illogically or unfairly or don't give evidence proper consideration, there are avenues of legal relief in court.

But the donors behind the scheme don't want relief from improper or misguided Agency action. They want relief from lawful, legitimate, and correct Agency action. This is a power grab by regulated interests using the Court, and they can do it because of the scheme. It is not a bug that these doctrines threaten harm to an array of basic government functions; it is their purpose.

Let's go back to what the rightwing, corporate-funded propaganda machine likes to deride as the ''administrative state''—their little code word. What has really gone on in these Agencies? I will tell you what has gone on.

Over nonstop quarreling by big special interests, regulatory Agencies made life better. They made drinking water safer. They cleaned up smokestacks. They put airbags in cars and required better seatbelts. They protected us from contaminated food. They made medication safer and more effective—no more snake oil mysteries. They made financial markets safer places for retirement funds and college savings plans to grow. They made it harder for stockjobbers to sucker innocent investors. They required insurance policies to actually pay when an insured risk occurs. They put an end to people dying from disasters like boiler explosions that used to be a regular thing. Americans live longer; highways are no longer carnage; products are safer; markets are stronger; and the American economy is more robust. So, whenever you hear the phrase ''administrative state,'' it should ring in your head a little alarm bell that special interest mischief is afoot, which brings me to the ruling expected from the Supreme Court in a case called West Virginia v. EPA.

The fossil fuel interests behind the case are challenging the Federal Government's power to regulate greenhouse gas emissions from existing coal-fired power plants. Put simply, they want to make it harder to fight climate change. I can't think of a more important protection for the American people than a livable planet, and I can't think of a Member of Congress who has done more work to achieve those protections than the Presiding Officer, but the fossil fuel industry is desperate to continue to pollute for free.

The first thing to know about this case is that there is no case. The Constitution requires ''a case or controversy''—that is the language in the Constitution: ''a case or controversy'' before the Court can intervene—and, here, there is no case because there is no Agency rule to challenge. The Trump administration's rule, which was a sop to polluters, was thrown out—gone. The Obama-era rule is not being pursued—gone. Biden's EPA has announced that it is formulating a new, different rule that it has not yet produced. It is not out. There is no rule in place right now.

That does not seem to bother the scheme's new donor-selected majority. A few Republican States, bolstered and probably directed by an armada of rightwing, dark-money front groups, sued to challenge the EPA's authority, and the captured Court jumped right in.

Think about that for a moment.

With no actual rule to review, the Court is, apparently, going to decide this case based on what the Biden administration might do or issue some general observations about the EPA. Where I come from, there is a name for that. It is called an advisory opinion, and our Supreme Court is forbidden to do that under our Constitution.

This is actually a big deal at the heart of the separation of powers, but the Federalist Society Justices, packed onto the Court with fossil fuel dark money, are on a mission to deconstruct the administrative state. So why let the Constitution get in the way? Just throw out more precedent about case or controversy. What is one more smashed precedent in the captured Court's cascade of precedent demolition? The donors don't care. They are not finicky. They want results.

Fossil fuel is the political 800-pound gorilla in this country. The industry spent decades blocking climate action in Congress. It lurked behind this web of climate denial front groups that sowed false doubt about climate science. It was their job to mischaracterize the science. It is behind what watchdog group Influence Map calls the biggest climate-obstructing trade organization in Washington—the U.S. Chamber of Commerce. Boom.

It maintains its own trade group hitmen, like the American Petroleum Institute. It funnels secret money by the tens of millions into Republican super-PACs and other secret, partisan political spending fronts in a not-so-hostile takeover of the Republican Party, and it wrote some of the biggest checks to pay for the scheme, funneled through dark-money conduits like DonorsTrust and the Judicial Crisis Network.

When I say we now have the Court that dark money built, it is probably more accurate to say that we now have the Court that dark fossil fuel money built. So watch out for the six-Justice supermajority that is poised to rule in this no case ''case.''

It is no surprise that the amici—the amicus curiae, the so-called friends of the Court—gathered in this case read like a who's who of fossil fuel polluter front groups. The Competitive Enterprise Institute, for instance, produces hothouse attacks on the EPA's authority, and is funded by ExxonMobil, Murray Energy, the American Fuel and Petrochemical Manufacturers, the American Petroleum Institute, and the Koch brothers' political groups. Fossil fuel front groups, as amici and litigants, sing a harmonious chorus of ''unitary executive'' and ''nondelegation'' and ''major question''—all concocted doctrines targeting the administrative state they so resent.

Back before the takeover, here is what the Court said in a case called Mistretta.

The Court said this:

> In our increasingly complex society, replete with ever changing and more technical problems, Congress simply cannot do its job absent an ability to delegate power under broad general directives.

That is the language of the Court:

> In our increasingly complex society, replete with ever changing and more technical problems, Congress simply cannot do its job absent an ability to delegate power under broad general directives.

That is the precedent of the Court. That is the law of the land, and it is the law that special interests sent these Justices to the Court to deconstruct. So get ready.

To be continued.

I yield the floor.

I suggest the absence of a quorum.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The clerk will call the roll.

The legislative clerk proceeded to call the roll.

Ms. HASSAN. Mr. President, I ask unanimous consent that the order for the quorum call be rescinded.

The PRESIDING OFFICER (Mr. PETERS). Without objection, it is so ordered.

REMEMBERING JULIE BECKETT

Ms. HASSAN. Mr. President, I rise today to honor the incredible life and legacy of Julie Beckett, a champion for individuals who experience disabilities and for their families.

In 1978, Julie's daughter Katie was born, and 4 months later, Katie contracted a brain infection that left her paralyzed and on a ventilator. After 2 years of living in a hospital, Katie's family had reached the limit on their health insurance policy and applied for support through Medicaid but were told that Medicaid would not cover at-home care.

Julie and her husband, Mark, knew they did not want their daughter growing up in a hospital, especially when she could receive the care that she needed at home while also being with her loved ones.

Faced with uncertainty and with Federal officials who would not make an exception, Julie reached out to her Congressman. Julie noted that making this exception for her daughter would not only be good for her family but also that keeping her at home rather than at a hospital would cost the government far less money.

Julie's advocacy worked. Because she made the choice to speak up and share her story, Congress passed and President Reagan signed into law an exception to Medicaid rules that enabled Julie's family and many others to care for their loved ones at home.

Julie's work has had a profound impact on not just her own family but countless others, including my own. My son Ben experiences severe physical disabilities, and because of Julie's advocacy, he could grow up at home and with family. And because he was able to live at home, Ben had the opportunity to go to school, to learn, and make friends in our community.

The terrible reality is that before Julie, many children grew up in hospitals or in institutionalized care, instead of surrounded by the love and care of their families, siblings, and neighbors.

But my family's story is not unique. In the decades since, what is now known as the Katie Beckett waiver has changed hundreds of thousands of lives. More than half a million children have received these waivers and have been able to live, grow, and thrive at home.

Julie's story is an example of how one person can make a true difference in our democracy. And even after her successful work in securing this significant exception for Medicaid, Julie kept fighting for children who experienced disabilities. She helped lead a charge to expand coverage and fought against attempts to repeal the Affordable Care Act. And critically, she worked with families throughout the country to show them how they could be advocates as well.

Julie passed away last month, but her legacy will live on in the lives that she has changed and the advocacy that she helped to inspire. I am profoundly grateful for her work, and I join with people across the country in committing to carrying on her legacy of fighting to fully include people with disabilities in every facet of American life.

Mr. President, I yield the floor.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The Senator from New Hampshire.

ORDER OF PROCEDURE

Ms. HASSAN. Mr. President, I ask unanimous consent that at a time to be determined by the majority leader, in consultation with the Republican leader, and notwithstanding rule XXII, it be in order for Senator PAUL or his designee to make a motion to proceed to Calendar No. 397, S. Con. Res. 41 on Wednesday, June 15, 2022; further, if the motion to proceed is agreed to, the Senate resume consideration of Calendar No. 388, H.R. 3967, postcloture, and that upon disposition of the Calendar No. 388, H.R. 3967, the Senate resume consideration of Calendar No. 397, S. Con. Res. 41.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. Without objection, it is so ordered.

UNANIMOUS CONSENT—EXECUTIVE CALENDAR

Ms. HASSAN. Mr. President, I ask unanimous consent that notwithstanding rule XXII, at a time to be determined by the majority leader, in consultation with the Republican leader, the Senate proceed to executive session to consider Calendar No. 925, Alan M. Leventhal, to be Ambassador to the Kingdom of Denmark; that there be 10 minutes for debate equally divided in the usual form on the nomination; that upon the use or yielding back of time, the Senate vote on the nomination without intervening action or debate; that if confirmed, the motion to reconsider be considered made and laid upon the table; that any statements related to the nomination be printed in the Record; that the President be immediately notified of the Senate's action; and that the Senate resume legislative session.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. Without objection, it is so ordered.

STATE ANTITRUST ENFORCEMENT VENUE ACT OF 2021

Ms. HASSAN. Mr. President, I ask unanimous consent that the Senate proceed to the immediate consideration of Calendar No. 261, S. 1787.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The clerk will report the bill by title.

The senior assistant legislative clerk read as follows:

> A bill (S. 1787) to amend title 28 of the United States Code to prevent the transfer of actions arising under the antitrust laws in which a State is a complainant.

There being no objection, the Senate proceeded to consider the bill.

Ms. HASSAN. Mr. President, I ask unanimous consent that the Lee amendment which is at the desk be considered and agreed to, the bill, as amended, be considered read a third timed and passed, and that the motion to reconsider be considered made and laid upon the table.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. Without objection, it is so ordered.

The amendment (No. 5096) was agreed to, as follows:

(Purpose: To strike the retroactive effective date)

Strike section 3.

The bill (S. 1787), as amended, was ordered to be engrossed for a third reading, was read the third time, and passed as follows:

S. 1787

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives of the United States of America in Congress assembled,

SECTION 1. SHORT TITLE.

This Act may be cited as the ''State Antitrust Enforcement Venue Act of 2021''.

SEC. 2. AMENDMENTS.

Section 1407 of title 28 of the United States Code is amended—

(1) in subsection (g) by inserting ''or a State'' after ''United States'', and

(2) by striking subsection (h).

AIR AMERICA ACT OF 2021

Ms. HASSAN. Mr. President, I ask unanimous consent that the Senate proceed to the immediate consideration of Calendar No. 370, S. 407.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The clerk will report the bill by title.

The senior assistant legislative clerk read as follows:

A bill (S. 407) to provide redress to the employees of Air America.

There being no objection, the Senate proceeded to consider the bill, which had been reported from the Committee on Homeland Security and Governmental Affairs, with an amendment to strike all after the enacting clause and insert in lieu thereof the following:

SECTION 1. SHORT TITLE.

This Act may be cited as the ''Air America Act of 2022''.

SEC. 2. AIR AMERICA.

(a) FINDINGS.—Congress finds the following:

(1) Air America, Incorporated (referred to in this section as ''Air America'') and its related cover corporate entities were wholly owned and controlled by the United States Government and directed and managed by the Department of Defense, the Department of State, and the Central Intelligence Agency from 1950 to 1976.

(2) Air America, a corporation owned by the Government of the United States, constituted a ''Government corporation'', as defined in section 103 of title 5, United States Code.

(3) The service and sacrifice of the employees of Air America included—

(A) suffering a high rate of casualties in the course of employment;

(B) saving thousands of lives in search and rescue missions for downed United States airmen and allied refugee evacuations; and

(C) lengthy periods of service in challenging circumstances abroad.

(b) DEFINITIONS.—In this section—

(1) the term ''affiliated company'', with respect to Air America, includes Air Asia Company Limited, CAT Incorporated, Civil Air Transport Company Limited, and the Pacific Division of Southern Air Transport;

(2) the term ''qualifying service'' means service that—

(A) was performed by a United States citizen as an employee of Air America or an affiliated company during the period beginning on January 1, 1950, and ending on December 31, 1976; and

(B) is documented in the attorney-certified corporate records of Air America or any affiliated company;

(3) the term ''survivor'', with respect to an individual who performed qualifying service, means—

(A) a widow or widower of the individual who performed qualifying service; or

(B) an individual who, at any time during or since the period of qualifying service, was a dependent or child of the individual who performed qualifying service; and

(4) the terms ''widow'', ''widower'', ''dependent'', and ''child'' have the meanings given those terms in section 8341(a) of title 5, United States Code, except that that section shall be applied by substituting ''individual who performed qualifying service'' for ''employee or Member''.

(c) CREDITABLE SERVICE.—Any period of qualifying service shall be treated as creditable service for purposes of subchapter III of chapter 83 of title 5, United States Code.

(d) RIGHTS.—

(1) IN GENERAL.—An individual who performed qualifying service or a survivor of such an individual—

(A) shall be entitled to the rights, retroactive as applicable, provided to employees and their survivors for creditable service under the Civil Service Retirement System under subchapter III of chapter 83 of title 5, United States Code, with respect to that qualifying service; and

(B) may submit an application for benefits based on the qualifying service to the Office of Personnel Management not later than 2 years after the effective date under section 2(g) of this Act.

(2) INDIVIDUALS DECEASED BEFORE DATE OF ENACTMENT.—A survivor of an individual who performed qualifying service and became eligible, by reason of this Act, for benefits based on the qualifying service under subchapter III of chapter 83 of title 5, United States Code (but became deceased before the date of enactment of this Act)—

(A) may submit an application for benefits based on the qualifying service to the Office of Personnel Management not later than 2 years after the effective date under section 2(g) of this Act, disregarding any requirement that an employee have filed an application while living; and

(B) upon submission of the application under subparagraph (A), shall be eligible for a survivor annuity under section 8341 of title 5, United States Code, equal to 55 percent (or 50 percent if the deceased individual retired before October 11, 1962) of the self-only annuity (as defined in section 838.103 of title 5, Code of Federal Regulations (or any successor regulation)) that otherwise would have been paid to the deceased individual.

(e) DEDUCTION, CONTRIBUTION, AND DEPOSIT REQUIREMENTS.—The deposit of funds in the Treasury of the United States made by Air America in the form of a lump-sum payment apportioned in part to the Civil Service Disability and Retirement Fund in 1976 is deemed to satisfy the deduction, contribution, and deposit requirements under section 8334 of title 5, United States Code, with respect to all periods of qualifying service.

(f) RULE OF CONSTRUCTION.—Nothing in this Act shall be construed to set any type of precedent for purposes of civil service retirement credit with the Civil Service Retirement and Disability Fund or any successor fund.

(g) EFFECTIVE DATE.—This Act shall take effect on the date that is 30 days after the date of enactment of this Act.

Ms. HASSAN. Mr. President, I ask unanimous consent that the committee-reported substitute amendment be agreed to; that the bill, as amended, be considered read a third time and passed; and that the motion to reconsider be considered made and laid upon the table, with no intervening action or debate.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. Without objection, it is so ordered.

The committee-reported amendment in the nature of a substitute was agreed to.

The bill (S. 407), as amended, was ordered to be engrossed for a third reading, was read the third time, and passed.

EXPRESSING SUPPORT FOR THE DESIGNATION OF MAY 2022 AS STROKE AWARENESS MONTH

Ms. HASSAN. Mr. President, I ask unanimous consent that the Senate proceed to the consideration of S. Res. 672, submitted earlier today.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The clerk will report the resolution by title.

The senior assistant legislative clerk read as follows:

A resolution (S. Res. 672) expressing support for the designation of May 2022 as ''Stroke Awareness Month''.

There being no objection, the Senate proceeded to consider the resolution.

Ms. HASSAN. I ask unanimous consent that the resolution be agreed to, the preamble be agreed to, and the motions to reconsider be considered made and laid upon the table with no intervening action or debate.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. Without objection, it is so ordered.

The resolution (S. Res. 672) was agreed to.

The preamble was agreed to.

(The resolution, with its preamble, is printed in today's RECORD under ''Submitted Resolutions.'')

AUTHORIZING THE COMMITTEE ON RULES AND ADMINISTRATION TO PREPARE A REVISED EDITION OF THE STANDING RULES OF THE SENATE

Ms. HASSAN. Mr. President, I ask unanimous consent that the Senate proceed to the immediate consideration of S. Res. 673, which was submitted earlier today.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The clerk will report the resolution by title.

The senior assistant legislative clerk read as follows:

A resolution (S. Res. 673) authorizing the Committee on Rules and Administration to prepare a revised edition of the Standing Rules of the Senate as a Senate document.

There being no objection, the Senate proceeded to consider the resolution.

Ms. HASSAN. I further ask that the resolution be agreed to and that the motion to reconsider be considered made and laid upon the table with no intervening action or debate.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. Without objection, it is so ordered.

The resolution (S. Res. 673) was agreed to.

(The resolution is printed in today's RECORD under ''Submitted Resolutions.'')

MORNING BUSINESS

ADDITIONAL STATEMENTS

REMEMBERING NELSON W. MILNER, SR., AND CLARENCE R. MILNER, SR.

● Mr. BLUMENTHAL. Mr. President, I rise today with a heavy heart to pay tribute to Nelson W. Milner, Sr., and Clarence R. Milner, Sr. Both men were beloved relatives of former Hartford, CT, mayor Thirman L. Milner, the first elected African-American mayor in New England. They passed away earlier this year and leave extraordinary legacies of thoughtful, compassionate work.

Nelson was born in Hartford, CT, and was the brother of former Mayor Milner. Upon graduating from high school, he joined the Air Force, serving for 3 years. Stationed in Riverside, CA, Nelson remained in the State with his late wife, Arthurrine, following his service. In the 1980s, Nelson returned to Hartford in support of his brother's mayoral campaign.

Passionate about serving others, Nelson became an ordained deacon and taught Sunday school. He also played the keyboard with the East Hartford senior center band. Nelson focused his final years on strengthening his relationship with his family, including his 10 children, 5 stepchildren, and many grandchildren and great-grandchildren. He passed away on February 15, 2022, at the age of 90.

Nelson and Arthurrine's son, Clarence, was born in California. He would go on to have 10 children of his own, as well as 4 stepchildren, 41 grandchildren, and 7 great-grandchildren. Clarence dedicated his life to his Christian faith and volunteered as a firefighter. Just like his father, he moved back to Hartford to work on his uncle's mayoral campaign. In addition to supporting his uncle's successful bid to become the city's first African- American mayor, Clarence also committed himself to running several businesses.

Family was at the heart of everything Clarence did. He was inseparable from his identical twin, Carl, for many years. Clarence met his wife in Hartford and spent as much time as possible with all of his children and grandchildren. He passed away on January 11, 2022, at the age of 64.

My wife Cynthia and I extend our deepest sympathies to former Mayor Milner and all of Nelson and Clarence's loved ones. May their many wonderful memories of both men provide them solace and comfort in the days ahead. I hope my colleagues will join me in remembering Nelson W. Milner, Sr., and Clarence R. Milner, Sr.●

RECOGNIZING THE STEWART INDIAN SCHOOL CULTURAL CENTER AND MUSEUM

● Ms. CORTEZ MASTO. Mr. President, I come forward today to recognize the grand opening of the Stewart Indian School Cultural Center and Museum. Three miles south of Carson City, the Stewart Indian School opened in 1890 with the official purpose of addressing Indigenous education. In reality, students were made to forget their Native languages and were allowed little to no contact with family members for decades, thereby destroying important cultural and social connections. Today, Stewart Indian School is listed on the National Register of Historic Places and remains open as an important educational and historic landmark in Nevada.

After its closing in 1982, the State of Nevada assumed the property and began taking steps to reconcile its painful history with our community. Most notably, it returned 130 acres of land to the Washoe Tribe of Nevada and California. Since then, the Nevada Indian Commission has worked hard to preserve the history and stories of its alumni. In 2008, it helped establish a self-guided walking tour of the campus, and in 2015, it worked with the Nevada State Legislature to secure funding for a museum director and curator for the location. With the help of volunteers and staff, members of this museum have worked hard to record and display only some of the 30,000 Stewart Indian School alumni stories, with many members being alumni or descendants themselves.

On May 11 of this year, the U.S. Interior Department released the Federal Indian Boarding School Initiative Investigative Report that summarized the treatment of Indigenous children in over 400 boarding schools across the country. The report unveils heartbreaking findings. Many of these children were taken from their communities and were forced to attend these schools. While there, they often faced rampant emotional, sexual, and physical abuse. The report also makes it clear that, from the beginning, these schools were designed to strip children of their Indigenous identities. The resulting trauma impacted families for generations, and some parents went as far as refusing to teach their children their Native language or ways of life for fear that they too would be severely punished in school for expressing themselves. Stewart Indian School stands here today as one of these former 408 boarding schools.

I would like to commend the efforts of the Nevada Indian Commission, of museum directors and staff, and of alumni and their descendants who have made the official grand opening of the Stewart Indian School Cultural Center and Museum possible. It is important that we recognize the history of our community and acknowledge the testimonies of all those who continue to endure the pain and loss that resulted from decades of separation and cultural erasure. Finally, thank you to all of those who bravely shared and publicized their stories so that we may learn a bit more and work to never forget.●

TRIBUTE TO CAROLE JOHNSON

● Mr. DAINES. Mr. President, today I have the distinct honor of recognizing Carole Johnson of Mineral County for her dedication to the Forest Service and her 50-plus years of public service to the people of Montana.

Raised in Superior, MT, Carole graduated from Montana State University—''Go Cats!''—and joined the U.S. Forest Service in 1971. Carole started as a seasonal recreational employee on the Superior Ranger District of the Lolo National Forest and has since worked in nearly every facet of the Forest Service including firefighting, logistics, silviculture, surveying, mining, and conservation education. In 2015, Carole was named Superior District ranger, the post she held until retiring earlier this spring. According to most accounts, at the time of her retirement, Carole was the longest tenured federal employee in the State of Montana.

Anyone who knows Carole will tell you that she exemplifies the definition of a public servant. For more than 50 years, she served her community with unmatched institutional knowledge and professionalism. She has been a voice of reason in debates over public lands management emphasizing that forest management and conservation go hand in hand. As district ranger, Carole worked tirelessly to increase the timber output on the Superior District to help benefit the local economy and support wildfire mitigation in the community.

Outside of her role with the Forest Service, Carole is active in her community. She serves on many boards including the Mineral Community Hospital Board, Mineral Fair Board and the Glacier Country Tourism Board. Through her commitment to public service, it is clear that Carole has long been a well-respected and beloved member of the Mineral County community.

It is my honor to recognize Carole for her dedication to the Forest Service and her 50-plus years of public service to the great State of Montana. Carole, thank you for your many years of public service and commitment to improving our public lands and forests. I wish you all the best in your retirement. You make Montana proud.●

TRIBUTE TO KAREN GOODE

● Mrs. HYDE-SMITH. Mr. President, it is an honor to pay tribute today to Ms. Karen Goode, who has retired after 47 years of dedicated public service with the U.S. Department of Veterans Affairs Regional Office in Jackson, MS. Since becoming a U.S. Senator in 2018, I have come to appreciate Ms. Goode who has earned consistent high praise from my State office staff responsible for assisting veterans with their VA claims. Karen's knowledge, responsiveness, reliability, and trustworthiness have enabled me to serve Mississippi's

veterans better and more effectively, and I am very thankful to her for that.

Karen began her career with the VA in 1975 in a clerical position with the finance department. A GS–3 at the time she was hired, Karen is retiring as a GS–13 supervisory veterans service representative, which is evidence of her meritorious work leading to continual promotions throughout her Federal civil service career. In the process, she acquired the knowledge and skill sets for processing all claims for compensation, pension, education, vocational, and rehabilitation. Ms. Goode's thorough understanding of the claims review process, along with her excellent management skills, propelled her into key senior leadership roles that led her to supervising seven different employee teams over her VA career.

Ms. Goode's high degree of professionalism earned her multiple special recognitions. At the recommendation of the veterans service center manager, Karen in 2006 served as the representative for the southern area on a quality assurance detail HELP team in Washington, DC. In 2012, at the completion of a designated special project as quality team coach, Karen obtained Lean Six Sigma Green Belt designation.

Even though Congress writes the laws regarding veterans' benefits, it is up to teams set up within the VA to review veterans' claims and determine if they are eligible for benefits. It can be a complex and lengthy process, which I highly respect. Covering a broad range of benefit categories, I understand the effectiveness in which VA team member groups review and process claims can differ greatly. Despite exercising most of her leadership away from the public eye, Mississippi's veterans are fortunate to have been served by Ms. Karen Goode for so many years working in this capacity. She has been unwavering in her commitment to ensuring that Mississippi's veterans receive the benefits to which they are entitled under the law.

In conclusion, I am incredibly grateful to Ms. Karen Goode for dedicating her career to serving those who have served our country. I commend her for her many accomplishments, and I send her my best wishes for an enjoyable retirement.●

TRIBUTE TO DANA TOTMAN

Mr. KING. Mr. President, today I wish to recognize Dana Totman for his 22 years of service at Avesta Housing and congratulate him on a well-deserved retirement. Under his leadership, Avesta Housing became northern New England's largest housing nonprofit and transformed the lives of individuals and families across Maine. Dana has been a tireless advocate for affordable housing and made it clear how drastically it improves lives and strengthens communities.

While Dana cares about the bricks and mortar that become the homes of many, he cares most about the people who get to call these places home. It is these individuals who drive his passion. The Maine Affordable Housing Coalition, created by Dana, exemplifies his vision by giving those in need a voice and the ability to advocate for themselves.

During the 2009 recession, Dana found a creative way to increase the supply of affordable homes through the development of a $50 million bond proposal. Known as the Green Affordable Housing Bond, this allowed low-income Mainers to obtain affordable, energy-efficient homes, and created jobs in the construction, architectural, and engineering sectors. Subsequently, when Maine seniors needed a voice for their growing housing needs, Dana created and promoted the $15 million Maine Affordable Housing Bond, the effort garnered support from 69 percent of Maine voters—one of the largest margin wins of a State bond initiative.

Throughout his career, Dana navigated through the many obstacles and challenges Avesta Housing faced. His humility and quiet demeanor brought people and organizations together to demonstrate how affordable housing significantly strengthens communities' well-being. His ability to work closely with neighbors, listen to concerns, and understand the whole picture, furthered Avesta Housing's mission of giving everyone, regardless of socioeconomic status, age, or race, a chance to have a home.

Dana was raised on a Topsham dairy farm, and later lived in Brunswick, where he and his wife raised their two sons and were members of the school community as parents. Dana also volunteered to coach soccer and baseball teams, imparting many life lessons to the kids. He continues to mentor young people, inspiring future generations to dedicate their lives to giving back to their communities.

Maine's business community has recognized Dana multiple times over the years for his exceptional leadership and contributions to equitable housing in Maine. It is a privilege to join with his colleagues, friends, and the people of Maine in recognizing Dana for demonstrating innovation, true excellence in his work, and unwavering compassion to those seeking—and finding—a home.●

MESSAGES FROM THE HOUSE

At 11:04 a.m., a message from the House of Representatives, delivered by Mrs. Alli, one of its reading clerks, announced that the House has passed the following bill, without amendment:

S. 3580. An act to amend title 46, United States Code, with respect to prohibited acts by ocean common carriers or marine terminal operators, and for other purposes.

The message further announced that the House has passed the following bills, in which it requests the concurrence of the Senate:

H.R. 2020. An act to provide for an online repository for certain reporting requirements for recipients of Federal disaster assistance, and for other purposes.

H.R. 6270. An act to direct the Secretary of Transportation to establish a pilot program to provide grants related to advanced air mobility infrastructure, and for other purposes.

ENROLLED BILL SIGNED

At 3:51 p.m., a message from the House of Representatives, delivered by Mrs. Cole, one of its reading clerks, announced that the Speaker has signed thefollowing enrolled bill:

S. 3580. An act to amend title 46, United States Code, with respect to prohibited acts by ocean common carriers or marine terminal operators, and for other purposes.

The enrolled bill was subsequently signed by the President pro tempore (Mr. LEAHY).

MEASURES REFERRED

The following bill was read the first and the second times by unanimous consent, and referred as indicated:

H.R. 2020. An act to provide for an online repository for certain reporting requirements for recipients of Federal disaster assistance, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Homeland Security and Governmental Affairs.

EXECUTIVE AND OTHER COMMUNICATIONS

The following communications were laid before the Senate, together with accompanying papers, reports, and documents, and were referred as indicated:

EC–4292. A communication from the Senior Congressional Liaison, Bureau of Consumer Financial Protection, transmitting, pursuant to law, the report of a rule entitled ''Equal Credit Opportunity (Regulation B); Revocations or Unfavorable Changes to the Terms of Existing Credit Arrangements'' (12 CFR Part 1002) received in the Office of the President of the Senate on June 9, 2022; to the Committee on Banking, Housing, and Urban Affairs.

EC–4293. A communication from the General Counsel of the Federal Housing Finance Agency, transmitting, pursuant to law, the report of a rule entitled ''Enterprise Regulatory Capital Framework - Public Disclosures for the Standardized Approach'' (RIN2590–AB18) received in the Office of the President of the Senate on June 8, 2022; to the Committee on Banking, Housing, and Urban Affairs.

EC–4294. A communication from the General Counsel of the Federal Housing Finance Agency, transmitting, pursuant to law, the report of a rule entitled ''Affordable Housing Program - Technical Revisions'' (RIN2590–AB08) received in the Office of the President of the Senate on June 8, 2022; to the Committee on Banking, Housing, and Urban Affairs.

EC–4295. A communication from the Secretary of the Treasury, transmitting, pursuant to law, a six-month periodic report on the national emergency that was declared in Executive Order 13466 with respect to North Korea; to the Committee on Banking, Housing, and Urban Affairs.

EC–4296. A communication from the Secretary of the Treasury, transmitting, pursuant to law, a six-month periodic report on the national emergency that was declared in Executive Order 13851 with respect to Nicaragua; to the Committee on Banking, Housing, and Urban Affairs.

EC–4297. A communication from the Secretary of the Treasury, transmitting, pursuant to law, a six-month periodic report on the national emergency that was declared in Executive Order 13219 with respect to the Western Balkans; to the Committee on Banking, Housing, and Urban Affairs.

EC–4298. A communication from the Chairman of the Appraisal Subcommittee, Federal Financial Institutions Examination Council, transmitting, pursuant to law, the Appraisal Subcommittee's 2021 Annual Report; to the Committee on Banking, Housing, and Urban Affairs.

EC–4299. A communication from the Deputy General Counsel for Operations, Department of Housing and Urban Development, transmitting, pursuant to law, a report relative to a vacancy in the position of Assistant Secretary for Housing and Federal Housing Commissioner, Department of Housing and Urban Development, received in the Office of the President of the Senate on June 8, 2022; to the Committee on Banking, Housing, and Urban Affairs.

EC–4300. A communication from the President and Chair of the Export-Import Bank, transmitting, pursuant to law, the Uniform Resource Locator (URL) for the Bank's Annual Performance Plan for fiscal year 2023 , and the Annual Performance Report for fiscal year 2021; to the Committee on Banking, Housing, and Urban Affairs.

EC–4301. A communication from the Assistant General Counsel for Legislation, Regulation and Energy Efficiency, Department of Energy, transmitting, pursuant to law, the report of a rule entitled ''Energy Conservation Program: Test Procedures for Direct Heating Equipment'' (RIN1904–AE30) received in the Office of the President of the Senate on June 9, 2022; to the Committee on Energy and Natural Resources.

REPORTS OF COMMITTEES

The following reports of committees were submitted:

By Mr. MENENDEZ, from the Committee on Foreign Relations, without amendment and with a preamble:

S. Con. Res. 40. A concurrent resolution welcoming the Prime Minister of Greece to the United States for an address to a joint meeting of Congress.

By Mr. MENENDEZ, from the Committee on Foreign Relations, with an amendment in the nature of a substitute and with an amended preamble:

S. Res. 124. A resolution celebrating the heritage of Romani Americans.

S. Res. 394. A resolution recognizing the 25th anniversary of Radio Free Asia and its mission to provide an independent source of news to closed societies in Asia.

S. Res. 458. A resolution recognizing the 75th anniversary of the establishment of the United Nations Children's Fund.

By Mr. MENENDEZ, from the Committee on Foreign Relations, without amendment and with an amended preamble:

S. Res. 540. A resolution supporting the goals of International Women's Day.

By Mr. MENENDEZ, from the Committee on Foreign Relations, without amendment and with a preamble:

S. Res. 568. A resolution supporting the goals and ideals of ''Countering International Parental Child Abduction Month'' and expressing the sense of the Senate that Congress should raise awareness of the harm caused by international parental child abduction.

By Mr. MENENDEZ, from the Committee on Foreign Relations, with an amendment in the nature of a substitute and with an amended preamble:

S. Res. 589. A resolution recognizing, honoring, and commending the women of Ukraine who have contributed to the fight for freedom and the defense of Ukraine.

By Mr. MENENDEZ, from the Committee on Foreign Relations, with an amendment in the nature of a substitute and with a preamble:

S. Res. 638. A resolution commending the Government and people of the Republic of Moldova for their heroic efforts to support Ukrainian refugees fleeing President Putin's illegal war against Ukraine.

By Mr. MENENDEZ, from the Committee on Foreign Relations, without amendment and with an amended preamble:

S. Res. 646. A resolution expressing the Senate's support for Finland and Sweden's accession into the North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO) and the expedited ratification of accession protocols.

By Mr. MENENDEZ, from the Committee on Foreign Relations, with an amendment in the nature of a substitute:

S. 1160. A bill to prioritize efforts of the Department of State to combat international trafficking in covered synthetic drugs and new psychoactive substances, and for other purposes.

By Mr. DURBIN, from the Committee on the Judiciary, with an amendment in the nature of a substitute:

S. 2151. A bill to amend the Omnibus Crime Control and Safe Streets Act of 1968 to provide that COPS grant funds may be used for local law enforcement recruits to attend schools or academies if the recruits agree to serve in precincts of law enforcement agencies in their communities.

By Mr. MENENDEZ, from the Committee on Foreign Relations, with an amendment in the nature of a substitute:

S. 3211. A bill to continue the whole-of-government approach to ending global wildlife poaching and trafficking by permanently reauthorizing the activities of the Presidential Task Force on Wildlife Trafficking, and for other purposes.

By Mr. DURBIN, from the Committee on the Judiciary, with an amendment in the nature of a substitute:

S. 3635. A bill to amend the Omnibus Crime Control and Safe Streets Act of 1968 to authorize public safety officer death benefits to officers suffering from post-traumatic stress disorder or acute stress disorder, and for other purposes.

S. 3860. A bill to establish a grant program to provide assistance to local governments with fewer than 200 law enforcement officers, and for other purposes.

By Mr. MENENDEZ, from the Committee on Foreign Relations, with an amendment in the nature of a substitute:

S. 3861. A bill to require the Secretary of State to submit annual reports to Congress on the assistance provided to Somaliland and to conduct a feasibility study, in coordination with the Secretary of Defense, on establishing a security partnership with Somaliland, without recognizing Somaliland as an independent state.

S. 3895. A bill to extend and authorize annual appropriations for the United States Commission on International Religious Freedom through fiscal year 2024.

By Mr. DURBIN, from the Committee on the Judiciary, with an amendment in the nature of a substitute:

S. 4003. A bill to amend the Omnibus Crime Control and Safe Streets Act of 1968 to provide for training on alternatives to use of force, de-escalation, and mental and behavioral health and suicidal crises.

S. 4007. A bill to require the Attorney General to propose a program for making treatment for post-traumatic stress disorder and acute stress disorder available to public safety officers, and for other purposes.

By Mr. MENENDEZ, from the Committee on Foreign Relations, with an amendment in the nature of a substitute:

S. 4171. A bill to reauthorize the Trafficking Victims Protection Act of 2000, and for other purposes.

By Mr. MENENDEZ, from the Committee on Foreign Relations, without amendment:

H.R. 4250. An act to amend the State Department Basic Authorities Act of 1956 to provide for rewards for the arrest or conviction of certain foreign nationals who have committed genocide or war crimes, and for other purposes.

H.R. 7276. An act to direct the President to submit to Congress a report on United States Government efforts to collect, analyze, and preserve evidence and information related to war crimes and other atrocities committed during the full-scale Russian invasion of Ukraine since February 24, 2022, and for other purposes.

EXECUTIVE REPORTS OF COMMITTEE

The following executive reports of nominations were submitted:

By Mr. MANCHIN for the Committee on Energy and Natural Resources.

*David Applegate, of Pennsylvania, to be Director of the United States Geological Survey.

*Evelyn Wang, of Massachusetts, to be Director of the Advanced Research Projects Agency-Energy, Department of Energy.

*Carmen G. Cantor, of Puerto Rico, to be an Assistant Secretary of the Interior.

*Nomination was reported with recommendation that it be confirmed subject to the nominee's commitment to respond to requests to appear and testify before any duly constituted committee of the Senate.

INTRODUCTION OF BILLS AND JOINT RESOLUTIONS

The following bills and joint resolutions were introduced, read the first and second times by unanimous consent, and referred as indicated:

By Mr. OSSOFF (for himself and Mr. CRAMER):

S. 4388. A bill to amend title 10, United States Code, to waive cost-sharing under the TRICARE program for three mental health outpatient visits per year, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Armed Services.

By Mr. SCOTT of South Carolina (for himself and Ms. ROSEN):

S. 4389. A bill to provide for the abolition of certain United Nations groups, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Foreign Relations.

By Mr. HICKENLOOPER:

S. 4390. A bill to require summary approval information with respect to certain approved drugs and biological products; to the Committee on Health, Education, Labor, and Pensions.

By Mr. CASSIDY:

S. 4391. A bill to establish rules for export certification of devices manufactured outside of the United States; to the Committee on Health, Education, Labor, and Pensions.

By Ms. DUCKWORTH:

S. 4392. A bill to require the Secretary of Defense to carry out a pilot program on the use of sustainable aviation fuel by the Department of Defense; to the Committee on Armed Services.

By Mr. GRASSLEY (for himself, Mr. BARRASSO, Mr. DAINES, Mr.

LANKFORD, Mr. YOUNG, and Mr. CASSIDY):

S. 4393. A bill to amend the Internal Revenue Code of 1986 to modify the maximum capital gains tax rate, to modify the tax on net investment income, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Finance.

By Mr. RUBIO (for himself and Mr. SCOTT of Florida):

S. 4394. A bill to modify the minimum required weight of orange juice soluble solids; to the Committee on Health, Education, Labor, and Pensions.

By Mr. SCOTT of Florida (for himself and Mr. LUJÁN):

S. 4395. A bill to allow grantees under the HIV Health Care Services Program to allocate a portion of such funding for services to individuals at risk of acquiring HIV; to the Committee on Health, Education, Labor, and Pensions.

By Ms. DUCKWORTH:

S. 4396. A bill to require the Secretary of Defense to conduct a study on providing benefits under TRICARE Reserve Select and the TRICARE dental program to members of the Selected Reserve and their dependents; to the Committee on Armed Services.

By Mr. LANKFORD:

S. 4397. A bill to authorize the Secretary of Defense to build capacity for counter-unmanned aircraft systems operations; to the Committee on Foreign Relations.

By Mr. WHITEHOUSE (for himself, Ms. WARREN, Mr. MARKEY, Mr. BROWN, Mr. SANDERS, and Ms. KLOBUCHAR):

S. 4398. A bill to allow Juvenile Justice and Delinquency Prevention Program assistance be used to reduce racial and ethnic disparities, and for other purposes; to the Committee on the Judiciary.

By Mr. BROWN (for himself, Ms. COLLINS, Mr. MANCHIN, and Mr. SCOTT of Florida):

S. 4399. A bill to require the purchase of domestically made flags of the United States of America for use by the Federal Government; to the Committee on Homeland Security and Governmental Affairs.

By Mr. BURR (for himself and Mr. CASEY):

S. 4400. A bill to amend the Internal Revenue Code of 1986 to allow for special rollovers to Roth IRAs from long-term qualified tuition programs; to the Committee on Finance.

By Mr. RUBIO (for himself and Mr. COTTON):

S. 4401. A bill to modify the Freedom of Information Act, and for other purposes; to the Committee on the Judiciary.

By Mr. BOOKER:

S. 4402. A bill to direct the Attorney General to establish a grant program to establish, implement, and administer the violent incident clearance and technology investigative method, and for other purposes; to the Committee on the Judiciary.

By Mr. CORNYN (for himself, Mr. COONS, and Mr. KENNEDY):

S. 4403. A bill to amend the Higher Education Act of 1965 to provide for a civics and history education program; to the Committee on Health, Education, Labor, and Pensions.

By Ms. ERNST (for herself, Mr. MANCHIN, Mr. DAINES, Mrs. BLACKBURN, Mr. SCOTT of Florida, Mr. KING, and Mr. PETERS):

S. 4404. A bill to authorize certain actions to address domestic industrial base shortfalls, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Banking, Housing, and Urban Affairs.

SUBMISSION OF CONCURRENT AND SENATE RESOLUTIONS

The following concurrent resolutions and Senate resolutions were read, and referred (or acted upon), as indicated:

By Mr. KING (for himself and Ms. COLLINS):

S. Res. 670. A resolution encouraging the Secretary of the Air Force to designate the Maine Air National Guard 101st Air Refueling Wing as a center of excellence for additive manufacturing technology; to the Committee on Armed Services.

By Mr. BRAUN (for himself, Mr. GRASSLEY, Mr. CASSIDY, Mr. CRUZ, Mr. MARSHALL, Mr. RISCH, Mr. SCOTT of Florida, Mr. MORAN, Mrs. HYDE-SMITH, Mr. BOOZMAN, Mr. TILLIS, Mr. HAGERTY, Mr. INHOFE, Mr. HOEVEN, and Mr. LEE):

S. Res. 671. A resolution celebrating the 245th anniversary of the creation of the flag of the United States and expressing support for the Pledge of Allegiance; considered and agreed to.

By Mr. LUJÁN (for himself, Mr. BRAUN, Mr. VAN HOLLEN, and Mr. RUBIO):

S. Res. 672. A resolution expressing support for the designation of May 2022 as ''Stroke Awareness Month''; considered and agreed to.

By Ms. KLOBUCHAR (for herself and Mr. BLUNT):

S. Res. 673. A resolution authorizing the Committee on Rules and Administration to prepare a revised edition of the Standing Rules of the Senate as a Senate document; considered and agreed to.

By Mr. MENENDEZ (for himself and Mr. RISCH):

S. Res. 674. A resolution celebrating the 75th anniversary of the Marshall Plan and recognizing the role of the Marshall Plan as the foundation of a transatlantic community committed to the preservation of peace, prosperity, and democracy; to the Committee on Foreign Relations.

ADDITIONAL COSPONSORS

S. 467

At the request of Ms. MURKOWSKI, the name of the Senator from Maryland (Mr. VAN HOLLEN) was added as a cosponsor of S. 467, a bill to amend the Public Health Service Act to establish a program to improve the identification, assessment, and treatment of patients in hospital emergency departments who are at risk of suicide, and for other purposes.

S. 749

At the request of Ms. HASSAN, the names of the Senator from Virginia (Mr. KAINE) and the Senator from North Carolina (Mr. TILLIS) were added as cosponsors of S. 749, a bill to amend the Internal Revenue Code of 1986 to enhance tax benefits for research activities.

S. 809

At the request of Mr. MERKLEY, the name of the Senator from Minnesota (Ms. KLOBUCHAR) was added as a cosponsor of S. 809, a bill to encourage and facilitate efforts by States and other stakeholders to conserve and sustain the western population of monarch butterflies, and for other purposes.

S. 1116

At the request of Mr. CARPER, the names of the Senator from Oregon (Mr. WYDEN) and the Senator from Minnesota (Ms. SMITH) were added as cosponsors of S. 1116, a bill to amend chapter 81 of title 5, United States Code, to create a presumption that a disability or death of a Federal employee in fire protection activities caused by any of certain diseases is the result of the performance of such employees duty, and for other purposes.

S. 1151

At the request of Mr. BLUMENTHAL, the name of the Senator from New Jersey (Mr. BOOKER) was added as a cosponsor of S. 1151, a bill to amend title 38, United States Code, to provide for a presumption of service connected disability for certain veterans who served in Palomares, Spain, and for other purposes.

S. 1378

At the request of Ms. COLLINS, the name of the Senator from Colorado (Mr. HICKENLOOPER) was added as a cosponsor of S. 1378, a bill to amend the Animal Welfare Act to allow for the retirement of certain animals used in Federal research, and for other purposes.

S. 1388

At the request of Mr. GRASSLEY, the name of the Senator from Oklahoma (Mr. LANKFORD) was added as a cosponsor of S. 1388, a bill to require the Federal Trade Commission to study the role of intermediaries in the pharmaceutical supply chain and provide Congress with appropriate policy recommendations, and for other purposes.

S. 1489

At the request of Mr. MENENDEZ, the name of the Senator from Wyoming (Mr. BARRASSO) was added as a cosponsor of S. 1489, a bill to amend the Inspector General Act of 1978 to establish an Inspector General of the Office of the United States Trade Representative, and for other purposes.

S. 1530

At the request of Mr. SANDERS, the name of the Senator from Massachusetts (Mr. MARKEY) was added as a cosponsor of S. 1530, a bill to amend the Child Nutrition Act of 1966 and the Richard B. Russell National School Lunch Act to make breakfasts and lunches free for all children, and for other purposes.

S. 1532

At the request of Mr. KAINE, the name of the Senator from Montana (Mr. TESTER) was added as a cosponsor of S. 1532, a bill to provide a work opportunity tax credit for military spouses and to provide for flexible spending arrangements for childcare services for uniformed services families.

S. 1544

At the request of Mr. GRASSLEY, the name of the Senator from Maryland (Mr. VAN HOLLEN) was added as a cosponsor of S. 1544, a bill to amend title XIX of the Social Security Act to streamline enrollment under the Medicaid program of certain providers

across State lines, and for other purposes.

S. 2280

At the request of Mr. YOUNG, the name of the Senator from Montana (Mr. DAINES) was added as a cosponsor of S. 2280, a bill to provide PreCheck to certain severely injured or disabled veterans, and for other purposes.

S. 2340

At the request of Mr. MENENDEZ, the name of the Senator from Virginia (Mr. KAINE) was added as a cosponsor of S. 2340, a bill to improve the safety and security of the Federal judiciary.

S. 2569

At the request of Mrs. GILLIBRAND, the name of the Senator from Illinois (Ms. DUCKWORTH) was added as a cosponsor of S. 2569, a bill to enhance the rights of domestic workers, and for other purposes.

S. 2920

At the request of Mr. WARNOCK, the name of the Senator from California (Mr. PADILLA) was added as a cosponsor of S. 2920, a bill to provide downpayment assistance to first-generation homebuyers to address multigenerational inequities in access to homeownership and to narrow and ultimately close the racial homeownership gap in the United States, and for other purposes.

S. 3021

At the request of Ms. SINEMA, the names of the Senator from Arkansas (Mr. COTTON), the Senator from Mississippi (Mr. WICKER), the Senator from North Dakota (Mr. CRAMER), the Senator from Alaska (Ms. MURKOWSKI) and the Senator from Arkansas (Mr. BOOZMAN) were added as cosponsors of S. 3021, a bill to provide non-medical counseling services for military families.

S. 3091

At the request of Mr. OSSOFF, the name of the Senator from New Mexico (Mr. HEINRICH) was added as a cosponsor of S. 3091, a bill to amend the Internal Revenue Code of 1986 to establish the advanced solar manufacturing production credit.

S. 3293

At the request of Mr. TESTER, the name of the Senator from Georgia (Mr. OSSOFF) was added as a cosponsor of S. 3293, a bill to expand access of veterans to mental health care from the Department of Veterans Affairs, and for other purposes.

S. 3318

At the request of Mr. COTTON, the name of the Senator from Oklahoma (Mr. LANKFORD) was added as a cosponsor of S. 3318, a bill to deter foreign financial institutions from providing banking services for the benefit of foreign terrorist organizations and from facilitating or promoting payments for acts of terrorism.

S. 3421

At the request of Mr. RISCH, the names of the Senator from Connecticut (Mr. BLUMENTHAL) and the Senator from Nebraska (Mr. SASSE) were added as cosponsors of S. 3421, a bill to clarify that section 107 of the Countering America's Adversaries Through Sanctions Act applies sanctions with respect to unmanned combat aerial vehicles following a 2019 change by the United Nations providing additional clarity to the United Nations Register of Conventional Arms.

S. 3607

At the request of Mr. WHITEHOUSE, the names of the Senator from Georgia (Mr. WARNOCK) and the Senator from Maryland (Mr. VAN HOLLEN) were added as cosponsors of S. 3607, a bill to award a Congressional gold medal, collectively, to the First Rhode Island Regiment, in recognition of their dedicated service during the Revolutionary War.

S. 3909

At the request of Mr. KAINE, the names of the Senator from California (Mrs. FEINSTEIN), the Senator from Montana (Mr. TESTER) and the Senator from New Jersey (Mr. BOOKER) were added as cosponsors of S. 3909, a bill to amend the Internal Revenue Code of 1986 to make employers of spouses of military personnel eligible for the work opportunity credit.

S. 4105

At the request of Mr. BROWN, the names of the Senator from North Dakota (Mr. HOEVEN), the Senator from Montana (Mr. TESTER) and the Senator from Missouri (Mr. BLUNT) were added as cosponsors of S. 4105, a bill to treat certain liquidations of new motor vehicle inventory as qualified liquidations of LIFO inventory for purposes of the Internal Revenue Code of 1986.

S. 4111

At the request of Mr. HOEVEN, the names of the Senator from Idaho (Mr. CRAPO) and the Senator from Idaho (Mr. RISCH) were added as cosponsors of S. 4111, a bill to support research and State management efforts relating to chronic wasting disease, and for other purposes.

S. 4120

At the request of Mr. REED, the names of the Senator from Idaho (Mr. CRAPO) and the Senator from Pennsylvania (Mr. CASEY) were added as cosponsors of S. 4120, a bill to maximize discovery, and accelerate development and availability, of promising childhood cancer treatments, and for other purposes.

S. 4127

At the request of Mr. KENNEDY, the name of the Senator from Maryland (Mr. VAN HOLLEN) was added as a cosponsor of S. 4127, a bill to amend the Securities Exchange Act of 1934 to address disclosures by directors, officers, and principal stockholders of foreign private issuers, and for other purposes.

S. 4161

At the request of Mrs. GILLIBRAND, the name of the Senator from New Jersey (Mr. BOOKER) was added as a cosponsor of S. 4161, a bill to establish effluent limitations guidelines and standards and water quality criteria for perfluoroalkyl and polyfluoroalkyl substances under the Federal Water Pollution Control Act, and for other purposes.

S. 4171

At the request of Mr. MENENDEZ, the name of the Senator from Delaware (Mr. COONS) was added as a cosponsor of S. 4171, a bill to reauthorize the Trafficking Victims Protection Act of 2000, and for other purposes.

S. 4182

At the request of Ms. BALDWIN, the name of the Senator from New York (Mrs. GILLIBRAND) was added as a cosponsor of S. 4182, a bill to direct the Secretary of Labor to issue an occupational safety and health standard that requires covered employers within the health care and social service industries to develop and implement a comprehensive workplace violence prevention plan, and for other purposes.

S. 4202

At the request of Ms. COLLINS, the name of the Senator from Oklahoma (Mr. INHOFE) was added as a cosponsor of S. 4202, a bill to require an annual budget estimate for the initiatives of the National Institutes of Health pursuant to reports and recommendations made under the National Alzheimer's Project Act.

S. 4278

At the request of Mrs. FEINSTEIN, the name of the Senator from Oregon (Mr. MERKLEY) was added as a cosponsor of S. 4278, a bill to amend title 18, United States Code, to prohibit the purchase of certain firearms by individuals under 21 years of age, and for other purposes.

S. 4293

At the request of Ms. CANTWELL, the name of the Senator from Indiana (Mr. BRAUN) was added as a cosponsor of S. 4293, a bill to prevent unfair and deceptive acts or practices and the dissemination of false information related to pharmacy benefit management services for prescription drugs, and for other purposes.

S. 4359

At the request of Mr. OSSOFF, the names of the Senator from Florida (Mr. RUBIO), the Senator from Utah (Mr. ROMNEY), the Senator from North Carolina (Mr. TILLIS), the Senator from Arkansas (Mr. BOOZMAN), the Senator from Tennessee (Mrs. BLACKBURN), the Senator from Florida (Mr. SCOTT), the Senator from North Carolina (Mr. BURR), the Senator from Washington (Mrs. MURRAY), the Senator from California (Mrs. FEINSTEIN) and the Senator from Alabama (Mr. SHELBY) were added as cosponsors of S. 4359, a bill to designate the regional office of the Department of Veterans Affairs in metropolitan Atlanta as the ''Senator Johnny Isakson Department of Veterans Affairs Atlanta Regional Office'', and for other purposes.

S. 4369

At the request of Mr. MARSHALL, the names of the Senator from North Dakota (Mr. CRAMER), the Senator from Missouri (Mr. HAWLEY), the Senator from Oklahoma (Mr. LANKFORD) and the Senator from Idaho (Mr. CRAPO) were added as cosponsors of S. 4369, a bill to allow States and local educational agencies to use any remaining COVID–19 elementary and secondary school emergency relief funds for school security measures.

S. 4376

At the request of Mr. COTTON, the name of the Senator from Arkansas (Mr. BOOZMAN) was added as a cosponsor of S. 4376, a bill to amend title 18, United States Code, relating to sentencing of armed career criminals.

S.J. RES. 20

At the request of Mr. DAINES, the names of the Senator from Iowa (Mr. GRASSLEY) and the Senator from Wyoming (Mr. BARRASSO) were added as cosponsors of S.J. Res. 20, a joint resolution proposing an amendment to the Constitution of the United States authorizing the Congress to prohibit the physical desecration of the flag of the United States.

STATEMENTS ON INTRODUCED BILLS AND JOINT RESOLUTIONS

By Mr. GRASSLEY (for himself, Mr. BARRASSO, Mr. DAINES, Mr. LANKFORD, Mr. YOUNG, and Mr. CASSIDY):

S. 4393. A bill to amend the Internal Revenue Code of 1986 to modify the maximum capital gains tax rate, to modify the tax on net investment income, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Finance.

Mr. GRASSLEY. Mr. President, I come to the floor to tell my colleagues about a bill I am introducing today to encourage savings. To set the stage for the necessity of that bill, I am going to speak for a minute about the obstacles that this administration's economic policies—particularly inflation—have put in that give need for such legislation.

On Friday, we learned that inflation surged to 8.6 percent, a new 40-year high for inflation. Inflation is the No. 1 concern that I hear from Iowans as I do my 99-county tour throughout the State over the course of a year. I hear how rising prices, particularly for food and energy, are cutting into budgets, making it difficult to make ends meet.

Moreover, I hear from Iowans who are concerned that inflation is eating into their savings. That gets to the purpose of the legislation I am going to soon talk about. This is particularly true for seniors who are living on fixed budgets and are dependent on their savings and investment income to keep their heads above water.

Yet President Biden and congressional Democrats continue to ignore the damage done by their reckless tax-and-spending agenda. Sadly, their solution for inflation is just more of the same old Democratic tax-and-spend agenda. We still hear rumors that there may be some version of Build Back Better. Just think. If that original version of Build Back Better had passed, we would have had another $4.5 trillion in additional spending feeding the fires of inflation. Thank God for 50 Republicans and Senator MANCHIN that that has not happened.

Several Democrats have argued for hiking taxes to combat inflation. However, their proposed tax hikes on job creators would suppress business investment, lowering productivity. This would be counterproductive at a time when consumers' demands far outpace supply. We need more production, not less, to combat unchecked inflation.

Moreover, the proposed Democratic tax hikes would be passed on to the middle class in the form of lower wages and higher prices. These tax hikes would further squeeze a middle class that is already enduring the worst of inflation.

I just complimented Senator MANCHIN for putting a stop to Build Back Better. When it comes to some of the original tax policies we have heard from the Democrats, we can thank Senator SINEMA, another Democrat, for stepping in and bringing at least some common sense to tax policy, even though it wasn't a complete change of that tax policy. Raising taxes on job creation isn't the only misguided tax proposal. While many consumer products are in short supply, ill-conceived Democratic proposals are not.

In addition to reckless tax hikes on businesses broadly, Democrats have proposed providing consumer gas rebates, forgiving student loan debt, imposing windfall profit taxes on oil and gas, and implementing price controls. None of these proposals would help tamp down inflation. Instead, they would only make things worse—much worse.

Instead of providing relief, gas rebates would increase demand, driving prices higher. Forgiving student loans would have a similar effect and would be horribly counterproductive and, at the same time, would be very unfair to those students who have already paid off their student loans.

Yet you don't have to take CHUCK GRASSLEY's word for it. Prominent Democratic economist Larry Summers has said that student debt cancelation would be ''regressive, uncertainty creating, untargeted and inappropriate at a time when the economy is [already] overheated.''

Windfall profit taxes and price controls may be the worst of all of the proposals.

That should have been learned from the Nixon administration when he froze prices and wages. It was a disaster—part of the cause of the great inflation of the 1970s. There were disastrous consequences then as a result of what happened in the 1970s. Anyone who lived through that time can tell you how these policies made things worse by reducing supply. The result was of rampant shortages, most notably with gas lines all around the block.

When addressing inflation, Congress must be guided by the principle: First, do no harm. The Democrats' proposal has failed this principle miserably.

The fact of the matter is that, once the inflation fire gets started, it is hard to put out. Just think: Just a few months ago, inflation was transitory, and then it got up to 6 percent, 7 percent, 8.3 percent. Then somebody said last month that it was going to cool off, but it is up to 8.6 percent. The Federal Reserve is best suited for reining in inflation given its control over the money supply.

As Milton Friedman said:

Inflation is always and everywhere a monetary phenomenon.

This doesn't mean Congress is helpless when it comes to responding to inflation. The most important thing that Congress can do is stop spending like drunken sailors. Even better would be to trim the budget to eliminate unnecessary spending.

Congress can also provide targeted inflation relief. However, it must be done in a way that won't add to our growing debt or further fuel the flames of inflation. One way to do this is by providing targeted inflation relief that incentivizes and rewards taxpayers who save rather than spend.

With today's high inflation, many in the middle class could see most or even all of their savings and investment gains wiped out by the inflation that is upon us. Yet, even though middle class savers may be losing money in real terms, they are still taxed on all gains and interest income as if inflation doesn't exist. This creates a perverse incentive that encourages taxpayers to consume today rather than to save today. This can push up the demand for goods and services, forcing prices higher and further fueling inflation.

To help counter the current bias in favor of consumption, I now come to my proposal, a proposal subjecting most middle class savings and investment income to zero tax.

Now, this isn't a silver bullet in the fight against inflation. Ultimately, the Federal Reserve will have to do the heavy lifting. However, unlike counterproductive Democrat policies, my proposals would incentivize and reward saving. As a result, it would get relief to the middle class without further fueling consumer demand or reducing production and supply.

The title of the bill is the ''Middle-Class Savings and Investment Act.'' Under that bill, taxpayers in the 22-percent individual income tax bracket and lower would pay zero tax on their long-term capital gains and dividend income. Moreover, my proposal would allow individuals to exclude a reasonable amount of interest income from tax. For 2022, the combination of those proposals means an individual with a taxable income of below $89,075 or a

married couple below $178,150 would largely be able to save tax-free.

In addition to exempting the middle class from the tax on most of their savings and investment income, my proposal would enhance and expand the saver's credit. This provides a tax credit to low- to middle-income taxpayers who contribute to a tax-favored retirement account. My proposal would increase the maximum credit amount by $500 for married taxpayers and expand eligibility to more taxpayers.

Finally, my proposal would address a massive marriage penalty that is gradually catching ever more taxpayers by surprise thanks just simply to inflation. Under ObamaCare, Democrats imposed a new 3.8-percent tax on investment income of taxpayers earning over $200,000 single or $250,000 married. Congress never indexed these thresholds for inflation; thus, given current inflation, it is likely it won't be long before millions of middle-class taxpayers find themselves squarely within the grasp of that marriage penalty. To prevent this, I index the income threshold for this tax to inflation. Moreover, I eliminate the marriage penalty by raising the threshold for married taxpayers to twice that for single earners.

Of course, any relief provided must be fully paid for to ensure that we aren't just adding unsustainable debt and deficits. This is why my proposal is fully paid for by extending the $10,000 cap on State and local tax deductions beyond the current scheduled expiration at the end of 2025.

The SALT deduction is a highly regressive tax subsidy that primarily benefits high-income taxpayers. According to the nonpartisan Joint Committee on Taxation, more than half of the benefits from lifting the SALT cap would go to those making over $1 million a year. Extending the current cap on SALT—an otherwise highly regressive tax benefit—to provide immediate inflation relief to the middle class should be a no-brainer to all of my colleagues.

I urge Members on both sides of the aisle to support this proposal.

SUBMITTED RESOLUTIONS

SENATE RESOLUTION 670—ENCOURAGING THE SECRETARY OF THE AIR FORCE TO DESIGNATE THE MAINE AIR NATIONAL GUARD 101ST AIR REFUELING WING AS A CENTER OF EXCELLENCE FOR ADDITIVE MANUFACTURING TECHNOLOGY

Mr. KING (for himself and Ms. COLLINS) submitted the following resolution; which was referred to the Committee on Armed Services:

S. RES. 670

Whereas the 101st Air Refueling Wing is home to four technicians certified to print airworthy parts, two-thirds of the entire uniformed force of certified technicians;

Whereas the 101st Air Refueling Wing is the only Air National Guard unit capable of printing airworthy parts, while also fielding the technicians certified to print airworthy parts;

Whereas the 101st Air Refueling Wing has created eight different tools for six different maintenance shops, enhancing aircrew maintenance efficiency and increasing aircraft readiness;

Whereas the 101st Air Refueling Wing has modeled and provided three training aids allowing complete comprehensive drill status guardsmen training, resulting in increased technician competency, and superior aircraft maintenance repairs;

Whereas the 101st Air Refueling Wing has the ability to model and prove a well-fitting part before machining, allowing for easier identification of errors, and preventing the duplication of non-usable parts, increasing aircraft readiness and reducing material waste and cost;

Whereas the 101st Air Refueling Wing is the only Air National Guard unit to have an authorized polymer printer in their possession;

Whereas the 101st Air Refueling Wing partners with the University of Maine Advanced Structures and Composites Department;

Whereas this allows both organizations to share the best practices and emerging technologies, while also allowing the 101st to perform strength testing of part candidates and receive feedback for redesign options;

Whereas the 101st Air Refueling Wing has created five jigs or fixtures which significantly aid aircrews in making repairs, while also decreasing aircraft downtime and repair inaccuracy;

Whereas the 101st Air Refueling Wing has modeled five aircraft parts as proofs of design before machining replacement parts, successfully identifying model errors and reducing material waste and cost; and

Whereas the Army Reserve 75th Innovation Command requested that the 101st Air Refueling Wing model and produce five parts as a pilot program connecting units with additive manufacturing stations capable of supporting modeling and printing requests: Now, therefore, be it

Resolved, That the Senate encourages the Secretary of the Air Force to designate the Maine Air National Guard 101st Air Refueling Wing at Bangor Air National Guard Base as a center of excellence for additive manufacturing technology.

SENATE RESOLUTION 671—CELEBRATING THE 245TH ANNIVERSARY OF THE CREATION OF THE FLAG OF THE UNITED STATES AND EXPRESSING SUPPORT FOR THE PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE

Mr. BRAUN (for himself, Mr. GRASSLEY, Mr. CASSIDY, Mr. CRUZ, Mr. MARSHALL, Mr. RISCH, Mr. SCOTT of Florida, Mr. MORAN, Mrs. HYDE-SMITH, Mr. BOOZMAN, Mr. TILLIS, Mr. HAGERTY, Mr. INHOFE, Mr. HOEVEN, and Mr. LEE) submitted the following resolution; which was considered and agreed to:

S. RES. 671

Whereas on June 14, 1777, the Continental Congress approved the design of a flag of the United States;

Whereas, over the years, the flag of the United States has preserved the standards of the original design comprised of alternating red and white stripes accompanied by a union consisting of white stars on a field of blue;

Whereas, on May 30, 1916, President Woodrow Wilson issued Presidential Proclamation 1335, an announcement asking the people of the United States to observe June 14 as Flag Day;

Whereas, on August 3, 1949, President Harry Truman signed into law House Joint Resolution 170, 81st Congress, a joint resolution designating June 14 of each year as Flag Day;

Whereas, on August 21, 1959, President Dwight Eisenhower issued Executive Order 10834 (24 Fed. Reg. 6865), an order establishing the most recent design of the flag of the United States;

Whereas the Pledge of Allegiance was written by Francis Bellamy, a Baptist minister, and first published in the September 8, 1892, issue of The Youth's Companion;

Whereas, in 1954, Congress added the words ''under God'' to the Pledge of Allegiance;

Whereas, for more than 60 years, the Pledge of Allegiance has included references to the United States flag, to the United States having been established as a union ''under God'', and to the United States being dedicated to securing ''liberty and justice for all'';

Whereas, in 1954, Congress believed it was acting constitutionally when it revised the Pledge of Allegiance;

Whereas the United States was founded on principles of religious freedom by the Founders, many of whom were deeply religious;

Whereas the First Amendment to the Constitution of the United States embodies principles intended to guarantee freedom of religion through the free exercise thereof and by prohibiting the Government from establishing a religion;

Whereas patriotic songs, engravings on United States legal tender, and engravings on Federal buildings also contain general references to ''God'';

Whereas, in Elk Grove Unified School District v. Newdow, 542 U.S. 1 (2004), the Supreme Court of the United States overturned the decision of the United States Court of Appeals for the Ninth Circuit in Newdow v. U.S. Congress, 328 F.3d 466 (9th Cir. 2003), a case in which the Ninth Circuit concluded that recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance by a public school teacher violated the Establishment Clause of the First Amendment to the Constitution of the United States;

Whereas the United States Court of Appeals for the Ninth Circuit subsequently concluded that—

(1) the previous opinion of that court in Newdow v. U.S. Congress, 328 F.3d 466 (9th Cir. 2003) was no longer binding precedent;

(2) case law from the Supreme Court of the United States concerning the Establishment Clause of the First Amendment to the Constitution of the United States had subsequently changed after the decision in Elk Grove Unified School District v. Newdow, 542 U.S. 1 (2004); and

(3) Congress, in passing the new version of the Pledge of Allegiance, had established a secular purpose for the use of the term ''under God''; and

Whereas, in light of those conclusions, the United States Court of Appeals for the Ninth Circuit upheld the recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance by public school teachers: Now, therefore, be it

Resolved, That the Senate—

(1) celebrates the 245th anniversary of the creation of the flag of the United States;

(2) recognizes that the Pledge of Allegiance has been a valuable part of life for the people of the United States for generations; and

(3) affirms that the Pledge of Allegiance is a constitutional expression of patriotism, and strongly defends the constitutionality of the Pledge of Allegiance.

SENATE RESOLUTION 672—EXPRESSING SUPPORT FOR THE DESIGNATION OF MAY 2022 AS ''STROKE AWARENESS MONTH''

Mr. LUJÁN (for himself, Mr. BRAUN, Mr. VAN HOLLEN, and Mr. RUBIO) submitted the following resolution; which was considered and agreed to:

S. RES. 672

Whereas stroke, also known as a cerebrovascular accident, is an acute neurological injury that occurs when the blood supply to a part of the brain is interrupted by a clot in the artery or a burst of the artery;

Whereas stroke is a medical emergency that can cause permanent neurological damage, or even death, if not promptly diagnosed and treated;

Whereas, in the United States, stroke is now the fifth leading cause of death;

Whereas, in the United States, someone has a stroke every 40 seconds, and someone dies of stroke every 3.5 minutes;

Whereas approximately 795,000 people in the United States have a stroke each year;

Whereas the stroke-related costs in the United States came to nearly $53,000,000,000 between 2017 and 2018, including the cost of healthcare services, medicines to treat stroke, and missed days of work;

Whereas stroke is a leading cause of serious long-term disability;

Whereas those disabilities may require ongoing physical, occupational, speech-language, and other therapy and surgeries;

Whereas the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention advises that the most effective stroke treatments are available only if the stroke is recognized and diagnosed within 3 hours of the first symptoms and recommends the public be familiar with and use the mnemonic F.A.S.T. to identify the signs and symptoms of stroke;

Whereas the F.A.S.T. mnemonic describes the symptoms of stroke, the methods for assessing those symptoms, and the actions to take in response to those symptoms and stands for—

(1) face drooping, observable when the person smiles and one side of the face droops;

(2) arm weakness, observable when both arms are raised and one arm drifts downward;

(3) speech difficulty, observable when asking the person to repeat a simple phrase and the speech is slurred or strange; and

(4) time to call 9–1–1, if any of these symptoms are present; and

Whereas the permanent health concerns and treatments resulting from stroke have a considerable impact on children, families, and society: Now, therefore, be it

Resolved, That the Senate—

(1) supports the designation of May 2022 as ''Stroke Awareness Month'' to increase awareness and education so that people in the United States know their risk factors and obtain treatment early;

(2) encourages the people of the United States to support the efforts, programs, services, and advocacy of organizations that work to enhance public awareness of stroke; and

(3) encourages continued coordination and cooperation between government, researchers, families, and the public to improve prognoses by increasing access to timely treatments for individuals who suffer strokes.

SENATE RESOLUTION 673—AUTHORIZING THE COMMITTEE ON RULES AND ADMINISTRATION TO PREPARE A REVISED EDITION OF THE STANDING RULES OF THE SENATE AS A SENATE DOCUMENT

Ms. KLOBUCHAR (for herself and Mr. BLUNT) submitted the following resolution; which was considered and agreed to:

S. RES. 673

Resolved,

SECTION 1. PRINTING THE STANDING RULES OF THE SENATE.

(a) AUTHORIZATIONS.—The Committee on Rules and Administration shall prepare a revised edition of the Standing Rules of the Senate and such standing rules shall be printed as a Senate document.

(b) ADDITIONAL COPIES.—In addition to the usual number, 1,750 additional copies shall be printed for use by the Committee on Rules and Administration.

SENATE RESOLUTION 674—CELEBRATING THE 75TH ANNIVERSARY OF THE MARSHALL PLAN AND RECOGNIZING THE ROLE OF THE MARSHALL PLAN AS THE FOUNDATION OF A TRANSATLANTIC COMMUNITY COMMITTED TO THE PRESERVATION OF PEACE, PROSPERITY, AND DEMOCRACY

Mr. MENENDEZ (for himself and Mr. RISCH) submitted the following resolution; which was referred to the Committee on Foreign Relations:

S. RES. 674

Whereas, after World War II, the infrastructure, factories, and cities of Europe were in ruins and the people of Europe were in danger of famine and destitution;

Whereas, in a commencement address on June 5, 1947, at Harvard University, then-Secretary of State George C. Marshall proposed the framework of the Economic Recovery Program (commonly known as the ''Marshall Plan'');

Whereas, in his address, Secretary Marshall declared that the Marshall Plan would be successful only with ''foresight, and a willingness on the part of our people to face up to the vast responsibility which history has clearly placed upon our country'';

Whereas a bipartisan coalition of Congress overwhelmingly approved the Marshall Plan through the passage of the Economic Cooperation Act of 1948, which was signed by President Harry Truman on April 3, 1948;

Whereas, in that Act, Congress acknowledged that the ''intimate economic and other relationships between the United States and the nations of Europe'' and recognized that peace and general welfare on the European continent are in the national interest of the United States;

Whereas the Marshall Plan helped rebuild a battered Europe, restore peace and political stability, and reinforce democracy across the continent;

Whereas, under the Marshall Plan, the United States extended an offer of aid to all countries in Europe, without prejudice, including to the then-Union of Soviet Socialist Republics;

Whereas the Marshall Pan served as the foundation for transatlantic engagement and cooperation, which led to the establishment of the Organization for Economic Cooperation and Development (OECD) and the North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO);

Whereas continued Euro-Atlantic integration and cooperation are key to the protection of peace and transatlantic values;

Whereas the brutal and unprovoked invasion of Ukraine by Vladimir Putin, launched on February 24, 2022, threatens the peace and principles at the core of the transatlantic community;

Whereas continued transatlantic cooperation is vital to holding Vladimir Putin to account for his war of choice against the Ukrainian people, and supporting Ukraine as it defends its sovereignty and territorial integrity amidst unconscionable war crimes committed by the Armed Forces of the Russian Federation;

Whereas the United States, in cooperation with its allies and partners, is committed to helping rebuild and protect the democratic Government of Ukraine;

Whereas direct investment in the United States by European countries exceeds trillions of dollars annually, which is a direct result of the prosperous economy in Europe that was aided by investments of the United States; and

Whereas the German Marshall Fund of the United States, which celebrates its 50th anniversary in 2022, was established with a gift from Germany to express appreciation for the support the United States provided to Europe in the aftermath of World War II: Now, therefore, be it

Resolved, That the Senate—

(1) celebrates the 75th anniversary of the Economic Recovery Program (commonly known as the ''Marshall Plan'');

(2) recognizes the role of the Marshall Plan in founding a transatlantic community committed to the preservation of peace, prosperity, and democracy;

(3) reaffirms that cooperation with allies and partners in the transatlantic community to protect shared values and principles is in the national interest of the United States; and

(4) congratulates the German Marshall Fund of the United States on its 50th anniversary and expresses appreciation for its work to champion cooperation between the United States and allies and partners in Europe.

AMENDMENTS SUBMITTED AND PROPOSED

SA 5095. Mr. MORAN submitted an amendment intended to be proposed to amendment SA 5051 proposed by Mr. TESTER (for himself and Mr. MORAN) to the bill H.R. 3967, to improve health care and benefits for veterans exposed to toxic substances, and for other purposes; which was ordered to lie on the table.

SA 5096. Ms. HASSAN (for Mr. LEE) proposed an amendment to the bill S. 1787, to amend title 28 of the United States Code to prevent the transfer of actions arising under the antitrust laws in which a State is a complainant.

TEXT OF AMENDMENTS

SA 5095. Mr. MORAN submitted an amendment intended to be proposed to amendment SA 5051 proposed by Mr. TESTER (for himself and Mr. MORAN) to the bill H.R. 3967, to improve health care and benefits for veterans exposed to toxic substances, and for other purposes; which was ordered to lie on the table; as follows:

Beginning on page 118, strike line 9 and all that follows through page 120, line 7, and insert the following:

''(c) AUTHORIZATION OF APPROPRIATIONS.—(1) There is authorized to be appropriated to the Fund for fiscal year 2023 and each subsequent fiscal year such sums as are necessary, pursuant to the limitation in paragraph (2), to increase funding, over the fiscal year 2021 level, for investment in—

''(A) the delivery of veterans' health care associated with exposure to environmental hazards in the active military, naval, air, or space service in programs administered by the Under Secretary for Health;

''(B) any expenses incident to the delivery of veterans' health care and benefits associated with exposure to environmental hazards in the active military, naval, air, or space service, including administrative expenses, such as information technology and claims processing and appeals, and excluding leases as authorized or approved under section 8104 of this title; and

''(C) medical and other research relating to exposure to environmental hazards.

''(2) LIMITATION.—For the period of fiscal years 2023 through 2031, amounts authorized to be appropriated to the Fund may not exceed a cumulative total of $116,800,000,000.

''(d) BUDGET SCOREKEEPING.—(1) Immediately upon enactment of the Sergeant First Class Heath Robinson Honoring our Promise to Address Comprehensive Toxics Act of 2022, expenses authorized to be appropriated to the Fund in subsection (c) shall be estimated for fiscal year 2023 through fiscal year 2031 and treated as budget authority that is considered to be direct spending—

''(A) in the baseline for purposes of section 257 of the Balanced Budget and Emergency Deficit Control Act of 1985 (2 U.S.C. 907);

''(B) by the Chairman of the Committee on the Budget of the Senate and the Chair of the Committee on the Budget of the House of Representatives, as appropriate, for purposes of budget enforcement in the Senate and the House of Representatives;

''(C) under the Congressional Budget Act of 1974 (2 U.S.C. 621 et seq.), including in the reports required by section 308(b) of such Act (2 U.S.C. 639); and

''(D) for purposes of the Statutory Pay-As-You-Go Act of 2010 (2 U.S.C. 931 et seq.).

''(2)(A) Except as provided in subparagraph (B), amounts appropriated to the Fund for fiscal years 2023 through 2031 pursuant to this section shall be counted as direct spending under the Congressional Budget and Impoundment Control Act of 1974 (2 U.S.C. 621 et seq.) and any other Act.

''(B) Any amounts appropriated to the Fund in excess of the amount specified under subsection (c)(2) shall be scored as discretionary budget authority and outlays for any estimate of an appropriations Act.''.

SA 5096. Ms. HASSAN (for Mr. LEE) proposed an amendment to the bill S. 1787, to amend title 28 of the United States Code to prevent the transfer of actions arising under the antitrust laws in which a State is a complainant; as follows:

Strike section 3.

AUTHORITY FOR COMMITTEES TO MEET

Mr. REED. Mr. President, I have 14 requests for committees to meet during today's session of the Senate. They have the approval of the Majority and Minority Leaders.

Pursuant to rule XXVI, paragraph 5(a), of the Standing Rules of the Senate, the following committees are authorized to meet during today's session of the Senate:

COMMITTEE ON BANKING, HOUSING, AND URBAN AFFAIRS

The Committee on Banking, Housing, and Urban Affairs is authorized to meet during the session of the Senate on Tuesday, June 14, 2022, at 10 a.m., to conduct a hearing.

COMMITTEE ON ENERGY AND NATURAL RESOURCES

The Committee on Energy and Natural Resources is authorized to meet during the session of the Senate on Tuesday, June 14, 2022, at 10 a.m., to conduct a business meeting.

COMMITTEE ON FINANCE

The Committee on Finance is authorized to meet during the session of the Senate on Tuesday, June 14, 2022, at 10 a.m., to conduct a hearing.

COMMITTEE ON HEALTH, EDUCATION, LABOR, AND PENSIONS

The Committee on Health, Education, Labor, and Pensions is authorized to meet during the session of the Senate on Tuesday, June 14, 2022, at 10 a.m., to conduct a business meeting.

COMMITTEE ON THE JUDICIARY

The Committee on the Judiciary is authorized to meet during the session of the Senate on Tuesday, June 14, 2022, at 2:30 p.m., to conduct a hearing.

COMMITTEE ON VETERANS' AFFAIRS

The Committee on Veterans' Affairs is authorized to meet during the session of the Senate on Tuesday, June 14, 2022, at 3 p.m., to conduct a hearing.

SELECT COMMITTEE ON INTELLIGENCE

The Select Committee on Intelligence is authorized to meet during the session of the Senate on Tuesday, June 14, 2022, at 2:30 p.m., to conduct a closed hearing.

SUBCOMMITTEE ON AIRLAND

The Subcommittee on Airland of the Committee on Armed Services is authorized to meet during the session of the Senate on Tuesday, June 14, 2022, at 5:30 p.m., to conduct a closed business meeting.

SUBCOMMITTEE ON CYBERSECURITY

The Subcommittee on Cybersecurity of the Committee on Armed Services is authorized to meet during the session of the Senate on Tuesday, June 14, 2022, at 2 p.m., to conduct a closed business meeting.

SUBCOMMITTEE ON EMERGING THREATS AND CAPABILITIES

The Subcommittee on Emerging Threats and Capabilities of the Committee on Armed Services is authorized to meet in closed session during the session of the Senate on Tuesday, June 14, 2022, at 11 a.m., to conduct a closed business meeting.

SUBCOMMITTEE ON EMERGING THREATS AND SPENDING OVERSIGHT

The Subcommittee on Emerging Threats and Spending Oversight of the Committee on Homeland Security and Governmental Affairs is authorized to meet during the session of the Senate on Tuesday, June 14, 2022, at 2:30 p.m., to conduct a hearing.

SUBCOMMITTEE ON PERSONNEL

The Subcommittee on Personnel of the Committee on Armed Services is authorized to meet during the session of the Senate on Tuesday, June 14, 2022, at 3:30 p.m., to conduct a business meeting.

SUBCOMMITTEE ON READINESS AND MANAGEMENT SUPPORT

The Subcommittee on Readiness and Management Support of the Committee on Armed Services is authorized to meet during the session of the Senate on Tuesday, June 14, 2022, at 9:30 a.m., to conduct a business meeting.

SUBCOMMITTEE ON SEAPOWER

The Subcommittee on Sea power of the Committee on Armed Services is authorized to meet during the session of the Senate on Tuesday, June 14, 2022, at 5 p.m., to conduct a closed business meeting.

ORDERS FOR WEDNESDAY, JUNE 15, 2022

Ms. HASSAN. Mr. President, I ask unanimous consent that when the Senate completes its business today, it adjourn until 10 a.m. on Wednesday, June 15; that following the prayer and pledge, the morning hour be deemed expired, the Journal of proceedings be approved to date, the time for the two leaders be reserved for their use later in the day, and morning business be closed; that upon the conclusion of morning business, the Senate resume consideration of Calendar No. 388, H.R. 3967; further, that all time during adjournment, recess, morning business, and leader remarks count postcloture, and that all time be considered expired at 11:45 a.m.; further, that at 5:15 p.m. the Senate execute the orders with respect to the motion to proceed to Calendar No. 397, S. Con. Res. 41, and the Leventhal nomination, in the order listed.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. Without objection, it is so ordered.

Ms. HASSAN. For information of Senators, there will be two votes at 11:45 a.m. and two votes at 5:15 p.m.

ADJOURNMENT UNTIL 10 A.M. TOMORROW

Ms. HASSAN. Mr. President, if there is no further business to come before the Senate, I ask that it stand adjourned under the previous order.

There being no objection, the Senate, at 6:55 p.m., adjourned until Wednesday, June 15, 2022, at 10 a.m.

EXTENSIONS OF REMARKS

HONORING JAMES M. SHURE FOR HIS LIFETIME OF SERVICE TO THE COMMUNITY

HON. ROSA L. DeLAURO

OF CONNECTICUT

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Tuesday, June 14, 2022

Ms. DELAURO. Madam Speaker, it is with great pleasure that I rise today to join Jewish Family Services as well as the many family, friends, and community leaders who have gathered to pay tribute to a special member of our community and a man I am honored to call my friend, James M. Shure. Better known as Jimmy throughout the community, he was born and raised in New Haven, Connecticut, spending a lifetime giving back to the city and its residents.

Jimmy grew up in the Westville section of New Haven, the son of a much beloved local funeral director. His father, Robert, opened the Robert E. Shure Funeral Home on George Street in 1939, quickly becoming known throughout New Haven's Jewish community for his compassion and dedication in planning burial services for their loved ones. As successful as he was, Robert did not encourage Jimmy to follow in his footsteps and take over the family business—in fact, he was determined that Jimmy would not do so. Following his father's advice, Jimmy sought to follow another path, attending college and graduate school where he earned an advanced degree in English Literature.

Shortly after completing his Ph.D., Jimmy found himself harkening back to his childhood memories of overhearing the late-night and weekend phone conversations when distraught families called his father to seek help and reassurance. He recalled friends telling him about the important role Robert had played in honoring others' lives. He knew his dad's work mattered and soon realized that he would much rather serve the community than teach in a classroom. So, despite his father's initial disappointment, Jimmy attended mortuary school and began working at the family funeral home, taking over the day-to-day operations when Robert retired in 1975. For nearly five decades, Jimmy has helped families navigate one of the most difficult of life's trials—saying goodbye—ensuring that the time-honored customs and traditions of the Jewish faith are kept with understanding and comfort.

Jimmy's compassion and support of the community goes beyond his professional life. He also dedicates his time and energies to strengthening the reach and capabilities of non-profit organizations like Jewish Family Services. He understands the difference they can make in the lives of others and has made it a personal mission to ensure that these organizations have the resources necessary to meet the needs of the community.

In the Jewish tradition, it is taught that one should give tzedakah because they want to, not because they have to and that everyone has a responsibility to help those suffering from poverty. Through his professional work as well as his personal philanthropy, Jimmy has exemplified that lesson, setting a standard of generosity to which we should all strive. At this evening's annual Spring celebration, a yearly event that marks the renewed commitment of the organization to its mission, Jewish Family Services is honoring Jimmy for his dedicated service. I am honored to join them in extending my heartfelt thanks and sincere appreciation to James M. Shure for all of his good work on behalf of our community. Mazel Tov.

HONORING DALE MOORE

HON. TRACEY MANN

OF KANSAS

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Tuesday, June 14, 2022

Mr. MANN. Madam Speaker, I rise today to recognize a great Kansan, Dale Moore, and to congratulate him on his retirement from a career of dedicated service to farmers, ranchers, and agricultural producers.

Dale grew up on a livestock, hay, and grain farm in Copeland, KS, which lies in my district—the Big First. He went to Fort Hays State University, worked for Kansas Pork Producers Council, the National Cattlemen's Beef Association, and Senator Pat Roberts. In 2001, President Bush appointed Dale to serve as the Chief of Staff at USDA, after which he served as the Legislative Director for the House Agriculture Committee. Most recently, Dale has been serving as Executive Vice President at the American Farm Bureau Federation, where his presence will be deeply missed.

Dale has tirelessly advocated for agriculture for more than 40 years, and he never forgot his southwest Kansas roots or the values he learned there: hard work, others before self, and personal responsibility. I am grateful for Dale's leadership and service, and I offer him, his wife Faith, and their family my best wishes as they begin this new adventure. Congratulations to Dale.

HONORING AND CELEBRATING THE 230TH ANNIVERSARY OF JEFFERSON COUNTY, TENNESSEE

HON. DIANA HARSHBARGER

OF TENNESSEE

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Tuesday, June 14, 2022

Mrs. HARSHBARGER. Madam Speaker, I rise to recognize the historic celebration of Jefferson County's 230th anniversary. On June 11, 1792, Governor William Blount, by ordinance formed Jefferson County, originally a part of North Carolina. Later, when Tennessee became a state in 1796, Jefferson County became a part of the state and three other counties have since been fanned out of the original land of Jefferson County.

On July 23, 1792, the first County Court of Jefferson County was organized at the home of Jeremiah Mathews, and the county court selected a distinguished committee to locate a county seat which became Dandridge, in honor of President George Washington's wife, Martha Dandridge Custis Washington; America's first, First Lady.

The famed frontiersman Davy Crockett found his way to Jefferson County and in 1806 was married to Polly Finley at the Finley's homeplace after meeting at a harvest dance and the folk hero sold his rifle in 1806 to post a marriage bond. He and Polly had two children while in Jefferson County and lived here until 1811. Davy Crockett also served two terms in the United States House of Representatives, from 1827 to 1831.

This beautiful county is nestled at the foothills of the Great Smoky Mountains and is home to 2 TVA lakes and both Cherokee Dam and Douglas Dam were built in record time to support the WWII emergency.

Home to Carson-Newman University, Bush Beans, the world's largest supplier of baked beans, along with many other notable businesses and industries, century farms, and five incorporated cities or towns including Dandridge, Jefferson City, New Market, White Pine, and Baneberry. Jefferson County is home of the Patriots of Jefferson County High School in beautiful Dumplin Valley and continues to be a great place to live, work, and raise a family.

HONORING THE LIONS CLUB OF NEW HAVEN ON THEIR CENTENNIAL ANNIVERSARY

HON. ROSA L. DeLAURO

OF CONNECTICUT

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Tuesday, June 14, 2022

Ms. DELAURO. Madam Speaker, it gives me great pleasure to rise today to extend my very best wishes to the members of the New Haven Lions Club as they gather to celebrate the 100th Anniversary of this extraordinary community organization. Over the course of its history, the New Haven Lions Club has enabled its members to contribute to our community in a positive and meaningful way. Indeed, in the last century, members of the New Haven Lions Club have helped to shape the very character of our community.

Founded in February of 1922, the New Haven Lions Club was only the second such club started in New England. From the very beginning, member's work in the community concentrated on assistance to local blind persons and underprivileged children. In its earliest years, Lions would repair radios for the blind and transport them to and from local meetings as well donate dinners and presents to needy families during the holidays. Over time, the Lions club has expanded both its membership and its activities on behalf of those in need.

● This "bullet" symbol identifies statements or insertions which are not spoken by a Member of the Senate on the floor.

Matter set in this typeface indicates words inserted or appended, rather than spoken, by a Member of the House on the floor.

Today, the New Haven Lions Club can be very proud of the invaluable contributions their members have made both through their efforts to not only assist the blind, the founding mission of the Lions, but in the many ways they make a difference in our community. From Camp Cedarcrest, a forty-two-acre facility located in Orange, Connecticut that began its operations in 1928 and provides a recreational space to thousands of young people and adults each summer season to their participation in Pediatric and Adult Screening events, Special Olympics ''Opening Eyes'', Veterans Stand Down, and bell ringing on behalf of the Salvation Army, New Haven Lions are improving the quality of life for countless members of our community.

Over the course of their one-hundred-year history, New Haven Lions have raised and distributed over $950,000 to assist the blind and have participated in service activities that have benefitted those with diabetes, the physically and mentally challenged, and the hearing impaired. Their members have focused their time and energies on working to address environmental issues, improve community welfare, and promote international understating. Organizations like the Fidelco Guide Dog Foundation, CT Radio Information System, the CT Food Bank, Columbus House, Clifford Beers, and the Ronald McDonald House are just a few of the local service organizations who have benefitted from their generosity and dedication.

The New Haven Lions have had an extraordinary impact on our community, and we cannot thank them enough for all of their good work. As they celebrate their 100th anniversary, I am proud to stand to congratulate them on this remarkable milestone and to extend my deepest thanks and appreciation to members past and present for their outstanding efforts on behalf of our community. I have no doubt that they will continue to do so for many more years to come.

CONGRATULATING THE WINNEBAGO HIGH SCHOOL TRACK TEAM FOR THEIR WINS AT THE IHSA STATE CHAMPIONSHIP

HON. CHERI BUSTOS

OF ILLINOIS

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Tuesday, June 14, 2022

Mrs. BUSTOS. Madam Speaker, I rise today to recognize senior Owen Lightfoot, sophomore Supreme Muhammad, sophomore Eden Trotter-Krahn and senior Michael Cunningham of Winnebago High School, who won both the Illinois High School Athletic Association Class 1A State 4x100 meter relay and 4x200 meter relay.

Owen, Supreme, Eden and Michael together won the 4x100 relay with a time of 42.92 seconds and the 4x200 relay with a time of 1 minute and 28.48 seconds. As a former athlete, I commend them for their determination and attitude. They are an example of the importance of dedication and a strong work ethic. I am proud to see them represent Winnebago so well throughout the state and the country with their talent and passion.

It is because of student leaders such as Owen, Supreme, Eden and Michael that I am especially proud to serve Illinois' 17th Congressional District. Madam Speaker, I would like to again formally congratulate Owen Lightfoot, Supreme Muhammad, Eden Trotter-Krahn and Michael Cunningham for their state title in the 4x100 meter relay and 4x200 meter relay.

RECOGNIZING THE HAYWARD ROTARY CLUB

HON. ERIC SWALWELL

OF CALIFORNIA

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Tuesday, June 14, 2022

Mr. SWALWELL. Madam Speaker, I rise to recognize the Hayward Rotary Club, which will celebrate 100 years of serving the Hayward community on Thursday, June 23, 2022.

Hayward Rotary, of which I'm a proud member, was founded in the early 1920s when Hayward business owners regularly started to meet for lunch. Believing Hayward needed a service club, they petitioned their local Rotary District for sponsorship, and on June 23, 1922, Hayward Rotary was established.

Hayward Rotary's first official action as a club was to sponsor the local Boy Scouts troop. During the Great Depression, the club partnered with the Lions and 20 to 30 clubs to create an annual Halloween party at the Hayward Plunge to provide a safe place for children to have fun. They also initiated an annual Christmas party for underprivileged children. During World War II, the club sent clothing and goods to war-torn regions in Europe and helped finance and staff listening posts in the Hayward Hills.

In 1957, Hayward Rotary funded benches at Hayward bus stops, many of which are still in use today. At that same time, the club helped develop Interact Clubs at Hayward high schools to instill the importance of service into the next generation. They also created ''Let's Go Fishing,'' an annual picnic for disabled children in the community. Recognizing the importance of community spaces, they supported the construction of the Tea House in Hayward. Honoring their commitment to supporting international causes, the club oversaw the shipment of 75 tons of textbooks to schools in Pakistan in 1974 and began their Polio Plus Program in the 1980s.

In 1990, the club officially incorporated the Hayward Rotary Foundation to help fund community programs. From 1994 to 1995, the club supported the construction of The Silva Pediatric Clinic, a full-service pediatric facility, and later expanded to add a full-service dental clinic.

In celebration of its 75th anniversary, Hayward Rotary partnered with the Hayward Unified School District to create the Hayward Community Technology Center at the Hayward Adult Education School in 1994. In 1999 they created the Newmann Park in the heart of downtown to replace an empty lot left by a building fire. The club also carried out its ''Field of Dreams'' project to improve lighting, provide scoreboards, and update facilities at Hayward high schools. In 2003, the club started its annual ''Back-to-School Child Spree,'' where it helped 100 children get the supplies needed for the upcoming school year.

Hayward Rotary has remained one of the premier service clubs in Hayward. During its tenure, the club has contributed over $3 million and hundreds of thousands of service hours to civic improvements and community programs in Hayward and across the globe. It continues to grow its Club Foundation Endowment and the Rotary International Foundation to allow for the completion of more successful community service projects in the future.

For 100 years, Hayward Rotary has been pivotal in developing the robust community of Hayward. Hayward Rotary's accomplishments have truly exemplified its ''Service above Self'' motto. I join the club in celebrating its legacy and wish it many more productive years to come.

HONORING COMMUNITY HEALTH CENTER, INC. ON THE CELEBRATION OF THEIR 50TH ANNIVERSARY

HON. ROSA L. DeLAURO

OF CONNECTICUT

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Tuesday, June 14, 2022

Ms. DELAURO. Madam Speaker, it gives me great pleasure to rise today to join all of those gathered in congratulating the Community Health Center, Inc. on their 50th anniversary. This is a remarkable milestone for this outstanding organization, and I am proud to recognize their invaluable contributions to our community.

Health care is a right, not a privilege. It is a simple motto and the fundamental basis of the establishment of Community Health Center, Inc. Fifty years ago, a group of students from Wesleyan University joined with community activists in Middletown—drawn together through a shared vision for affordable, accessible and responsive health care—to create a free clinic to meet the needs of the community. Fueled by idealism and a deep belief that patients should be the cornerstone of whatever was created, the Community Health Center, Inc. was born. Today, five decades later, CHC is one of the largest Federally Qualified Health Centers in the nation, serving 145,000 people in Connecticut at more than 240 locations

Other communities were inspired by CHC's ideas, and it has grown steadily, establishing clinics for the underserved throughout Connecticut, which provide comprehensive, team-based medical, dental, and behavioral health services. CHC also created school-based clinics and is now the largest school-based care provider in Connecticut, offering medical, dental and behavioral health care to children and making care more accessible for thousands of hard-working families.

Home to the Weitzman Institute, an innovative center of research, education, and policy development, CHC has developed and implemented national training programs for Nurse Practitioners and Medical Assistants. CHC has also been a pioneer in telehealth, keeping its patients connected and healthy during the pandemic, and creating a company providing specialty e-consults for underserved patients.

In 2020, as our nation faced the greatest health crisis in a generation, CHC got to work, providing care and distributing resources throughout the communities they serve. CHC provided one of the most comprehensive and innovative campaigns against Covid–19 in the country, creating testing and vaccination sites

both at drive-through mass vaccine sites and at stores, malls, and places of worship. CHC's tireless efforts to equitably distribute the vaccine to all members of the community received national and international recognition, including from the White House.

CHC's restless drive to innovate, dating back to the spirit of its founders in 1972, and its unwavering belief that healthcare is a right and not a privilege, has driven the organization's remarkable contributions in the last half century. I could not be more proud to join the Middletown community in celebrating this very special anniversary with the Community Health Center, Inc. Their outstanding dedication and commitment to ensuring, that everyone—regardless of circumstance—has access to affordable, quality health care serves as an example to us all. I am honored to extend my heartfelt congratulations and very best wishes to President and CEO, Mark Masselli, Margaret Flinter, Senior Vice President and Clinical Director, and the entire CHC family on this very special occasion. As we say in Italian—C'ent Anni.

JOHN WALSH

HON. DONALD NORCROSS

OF NEW JERSEY

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Tuesday, June 14, 2022

Mr. NORCROSS. Madam Speaker, I rise today to honor United States Staff Sergeant (SSG), Mr. John Walsh of Cherry Hill, New Jersey who dedicated 50 years of his life to his community and our country.

SSG Walsh was born in Chicago, Illinois, enlisting in the Illinois National Guard in 1961. He completed his basic infantry training at Ft. Leonard Wood, where he was awarded a Sharpshooter Rifle Badge.

SSG Walsh was also trained in Air Defense as a Radar Fire Control Crewman at Fort Bliss, Texas. He served our country for 6 more years, attaining the rank of Staff Sergeant.

Continuing his dedication and service to his community and country, SSG Walsh is involved locally, serving his neighbors and fellow veterans as the Senior Vice Commander of the American Legion 372.

Staff Sergeant Walsh also serves as a Lieutenant of the Regional Rehab Unit for the Cherry Hill Fire Department which provides support and offers food to the Firefighters responding to multiple alarm fires. In addition, he volunteers with the local food pantry and with the St. Mary's Roman Catholic Church in Cherry Hill, New Jersey.

SSG John Walsh is married to his wife Kay, and is the proud father of four children and grandfather to thirteen grandchildren.

Madam Speaker, I ask you to join me in honoring SSG John Walsh, of Cherry Hill, New Jersey, a resident dedicated to his community, country and to those who have bravely served and defended the United States of America.

PERSONAL EXPLANATION

HON. SCOTT FITZGERALD

OF WISCONSIN

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Tuesday, June 14, 2022

Mr. FITZGERALD. Madam Speaker, due to unforeseen travel delays, I was unable to be recorded for votes on Monday, June 13, 2022. Had I been present, I would have voted: YEA on Roll Call No. 256; YEA on Roll Call No. 257; and YEA on Roll Call No. 258.

HONORING LUISA CANESTRI HOWARD ON THE OCCASION OF HER RETIREMENT

HON. ROSA L. DeLAURO

OF CONNECTICUT

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Tuesday, June 14, 2022

Ms. DELAURO. Madam Speaker, it is with great pleasure that I rise today during National Nurses Week to join the VA Connecticut Healthcare System in extending my heartfelt congratulations to Luisa Canestri Howard. Luisa is not only a special part of the VA Connecticut family, she is also one of my closest cousins and I am so proud to have the opportunity to recognize her for her outstanding career in nursing.

Luisa began her career at the West Haven VA in January of 1982. Luisa had a special place in her heart for our nation's veterans and she wanted to use her talents to help improve their lives and support their healthcare needs. Her first station was as a staff nurse on G 5 East which was a medical floor. She then moved to a staff nurse on the Medical ICU, then worked in Cardiology research. After that she became the Nurse Manager of the Specialty Clinics. As a staff nurse Luisa held certifications in Medical Surgical nursing and in Research Nursing. In 2007 she was awarded the Nightingale award for excellence in nursing and in 2009 she was awarded the VISN1 Distinguished Federal Manager Award.

IN 2013 Luisa started her current role as Nurse Manager of Case Management where she became responsible for the day-to-day operations of the unit. Luisa has provided remarkable leadership, encouragement, and instruction to those who have served in her department. Her colleagues say ''Luisa is a true veteran advocate who always does the right thing in every situation. She is a true mentor to our nurses and provides unwavering support to all members of our team and especially to our veterans.''

For the last forty years, Luisa has dedicated her professional career and personal compassion to nursing and providing the best possible care for our veterans. I can clearly remember my aunt talking about how she always dreamed of being a nurse but for many reasons was unable to achieve that dream. Luisa became the nurse her mother always wanted to be, fulfilling that dream, and exceeding all her mother's brightest wishes. It is so fitting that her retirement comes during National Nurses Week so that we may pay tribute to Luisa Canestri Howard and the remarkable career she has led. I wish her all the best for many more years of health and happiness as she begins this new life chapter.

HONORING DR. ALEX JOHNSON

HON. SHONTEL M. BROWN

OF OHIO

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Tuesday, June 14, 2022

Ms. BROWN of Ohio. Madam Speaker, I rise today to honor Dr. Alex Johnson, who will soon be retiring after nearly a decade of service as Cuyahoga Community College's President.

Dr. Johnson retires a pillar of the Cleveland community. His deep commitment to Tri-C's students and forward-thinking leadership helped shape graduates who were prepared for a lifetime of success in Northeast Ohio.

After becoming President of Tri-C in 2014, Dr. Johnson shared his vision for pushing Tri-C into the future by making degree programs, workforce training opportunities and personal enrichment classes more accessible to Northeast Ohioans. As a result, Tri-C continues to expand opportunity through high-quality education and skills training right here in the Greater Cleveland area.

Under Dr. Johnson's leadership, Tri-C's Nursing, Creative Arts, Public Safety, Hospitality Management, Information Technology and Manufacturing programs were reorganized to provide training and pathways for students entering some of the most in-demand career fields. He also spearheaded new investments in workforce training, like the College's Transportation Innovation Center in Euclid, as well as new programs aimed at uplifting those in low-income and distressed areas across the region.

During Dr. Johnson's tenure, Tri-C produced a record number of graduates and increased its graduation rates. It is hard to overstate the impact of this legacy. More students are graduating from Tri-C with the skills and information they need for a lifetime of success. Meanwhile, our workforce grows stronger thanks to the fact that around 85 percent of Tri-C graduates stay and work in the region.

Even in the most trying moments, Dr. Johnson's leadership proved to be crucial. Throughout the tumult of the COVID–19 pandemic, Dr. Johnson served as a steady hand at the helm, ensuring students' continued success. Tri-C successfully transitioned to an on line learning and working environment and scaled its technology capabilities to maintain the school's promise to its students.

Dr. Johnson oversaw an era of growth, adaptation, and modernization at Tri-C, all while remaining committed to the school's core mission of delivering affordable higher education, providing equitable job opportunities, and ensuring successful degree completion. He helped to forge Tri-C into a vanguard of our local community and a model for community colleges nationwide.

Dr. Johnson's legacy is one of true distinction. His tenure as Tri-C president represents the culmination ofa 40-year career in higher education. Beyond his contributions in the classroom, Dr. Johnson has also been an active and leading member of the Cleveland community. He has served on various boards, including the United Way of Greater Cleveland, Northeast Ohio Council on Higher Education, Rock and Roll Hall of Fame and Museum, Ideastream, Playhouse Square, MAGNET, Team NEO, and the Greater Cleveland Partnership.

As a Tri-C graduate and the Representative for Ohio's Eleventh District, I deeply appreciate Dr. Johnson's extraordinary leadership, unparalleled vision, and lasting accomplishments. His legacy will only continue to grow through the countless students, teachers, and administrators he impacted.

On behalf of the people of Ohio's Eleventh Congressional District, I would like to thank Dr. Alex Johnson for his years of service as Tri-C's President and congratulate him on his retirement.

RECOGNIZING DR. RONALD A. PAUL

HON. JAMIE RASKIN

OF MARYLAND

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Tuesday, June 14, 2022

Mr. RASKIN. Madam Speaker, I rise today to recognize the thoughtful and visionary leadership of Dr. Ronald A. Paul, the outgoing President of the Jewish Community Relations Council (JCRC) of Greater Washington. During the last two years of the pandemic, Ron's compassionate and energetic leadership enabled the JCRC to render essential service not just to the Jewish Community but to the broader community during an excruciatingly hard time for so many people. Dr. Paul has served the people of Montgomery County, Maryland and beyond with relentless energy and enormous distinction. I am proud to be his Congressman and his friend.

For decades, Dr. Paul has dedicated countless hours as a key member of numerous executive committees and boards of local and national non-profit organizations. He served as Chair of the United Jewish Endowment Fund, Chair of the Endowment for the Jewish Agency for Israel of North America and the boards of the Jewish Council for the Aging, and the Anti-Defamation League.

But these commitments are not even his full-time job. For over four decades, Dr. Paul has worked as a renowned obstetrician-gynecologist while serving our community in numerous volunteer and leadership roles. His comprehensive approach to health care and inspirational leadership are deserving of the highest recognition and praise. Ron has been named one of Washingtonian magazine's Top Doctors.

Additionally, Dr. Paul and his loving wife, Toni, have dedicated themselves to serving survivors of the Holocaust in our community, and I want to give special recognition to Toni for founding the local Café Europa, a nationwide social program for survivors that has grown around the world since it was founded two decades ago.

Holocaust remembrance and education have been near and dear to Ron during his term as JCRC President, along with community security, and education and public health advocacy. His dedication to Maryland's Jewish community serves as an example for us all of what it means to be an engaged American citizen. I hope that the House will join me in celebrating Dr. Paul's enduring contributions.

CELEBRATING THE 20TH ANNIVERSARY OF THE SPRINGS LEARNING CENTER

HON. ROSA L. DeLAURO

OF CONNECTICUT

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Tuesday, June 14, 2022

Ms. DELAURO. Madam Speaker, in a year which marks the 200th anniversary of the Dominican Sisters ministry in United States, the Dominican Sisters of Peace, who make their home in City of New Haven, are marking a special milestone—the 20th Anniversary of the Springs Learning Center. Over the course of the last two decades, the Center has become an invaluable resource to our community, and, in particular to the immigrants who have chosen to make the Greater New Haven area their home.

Education has always been a core component of the work of the Dominican Sisters of Peace. Indeed, they have provided educational and pastoral services in New Haven since 1901 in elementary, secondary, and college programs. Recognizing the growing adult literacy and English as a Second Language needs in the community, the Dominican Sisters opened Springs Learning Center in 2002 to continue their educational mission in the Fair Haven area.

Since opening its doors just twenty years ago, the Springs Learning Center has helped over one thousand learners improve their English language skills—and all with the assistance of over one hundred volunteer tutors, come of whom have been with the Center since the very beginning. These dedicated tutors have opened new doors of opportunity to those they have served, helping them to boost their employment and business development prospects, enhance their contributions to the community, and assist them in their pursuit of citizenship.

As the child of an immigrant, I understand the challenges these families can face as they try to acclimate to a new community and a new country. My father, Ted DeLauro, came to this country as a child and when his teachers and fellow classmates made fun of him for not immediately understanding the English language, he left school. He was just in 7th grade at the time. He was self-taught but never forgot his struggles and he dedicated much of his time as an adult helping other Italian immigrants translate documents and to learn the language. I can remember the visible relief and gratitude of each person and family he helped—it is that same remarkable gift that the Dominican Sisters and the volunteers at the Springs Learning Center give to each immigrant who seeks their help.

It is an honor for me to rise today to extend my sincere congratulations to the Dominican Sisters of Peace and the many volunteers and supporters of the Springs Learning Center as they celebrate their 20th Anniversary. My heartfelt thanks for their invaluable service, and very best wishes for many more years of success.

RECOGNIZING THE ILLINI BLUFFS HIGH SCHOOL SOFTBALL TEAM AS IHSA CLASS 1A STATE CHAMPIONS

HON. CHERI BUSTOS

OF ILLINOIS

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Tuesday, June 14, 2022

Mrs. BUSTOS. Madam Speaker, I rise today to recognize the Illini Bluffs High School Softball Team as Illinois High School Association (IHSA) Class 1A State Champions.

The Illini Bluffs Softball team is no stranger to excelling when it comes to competition. The team has continued the legacy of competing in and winning the Class 1A State Championship for the second year in a row. The team now has two titles in Class 1A and are only one of two teams to do so since 2010. They are also the only team to have had a no-hitter finish in a State Title game since 1999. As a former student athlete, I commend them for their hard work and dedication.

I am incredibly proud to serve Illinois' 17th Congressional District and the student athletes of Illini Bluffs High School. Madam Speaker, I would like to formally congratulate Illini Bluffs again on winning the Illinois High School Association Class 1A State Championships for Softball.

PERSONAL EXPLANATION

HON. PATRICK T. McHENRY

OF NORTH CAROLINA

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Tuesday, June 14, 2022

Mr. MCHENRY. Madam Speaker, due to a family emergency, I was unable to vote on June 13, 2022.

Had I been present, I would have voted NAY on Roll Call No. 256; YEA on Roll Call No. 257; and YEA on Roll Call No. 258.

CELEBRATING THE 50TH ANNIVERSARY OF CHAPEL HAVEN SCHLEIFER CENTER

HON. ROSA L. DeLAURO

OF CONNECTICUT

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Tuesday, June 14, 2022

Ms. DELAURO. Madam Speaker, it is with great pleasure that I rise today to join the residents, families, administration, and supporters of Chapel Haven Schleifer Center as they mark the 50th Anniversary of this very special organization.

In 1972 a group of parents who shared the challenges of caring for adult children with varying levels of social and developmental disabilities banded together to try to find a solution to a common goal. As the late Jerry Rossman, one of the Center's co-founders, once described, they wanted ''a place where our kids could live and learn their independence and then go home.'' Since they could not find an existing program to meet their needs, the opened the Chapel Haven Schleifer Center as a private non-profit special needs agency. The Center was opened on Chapel Street in New Haven, Connecticut with 6 students, 2 staff, and a dog.

As word of the program's success spread and enrolled adults chose to make New Haven their lifelong home, the agency began to expand and needed to move to a larger campus. Today, Chapel Haven Schleifer Center occupies a flourishing campus on Whalley Avenue and serves over two-hundred fifty adults, ranging in age from eighteen to seventy, who are living with Down Syndrome, autism, intellectual disabilities, Asperger Syndrome and more.

The program's mission is to empower adults with social and developmental disabilities to live independent and self-determined lives. A new $41.5 million capital campaign has resulted in state-of-the-art residential, teaching and community spaces, including the addition of a senior living facility, allowing senior members of the community to continue to live among friends and with independence.

Chapel Haven Schleifer Center has been recognized locally and nationally with a myriad of awards and commendations. The deep partnerships they have built within the New Haven community, particularly in Westville community which they call home, have enabled the Chapel Haven Schleifer Center to create a safe, nurturing environment where their clients and residents can thrive. It is my honor to stand today to extend my deepest thanks and appreciation to the dedication administration and staff as well supporters of Chapel Haven for all that they do to ensure the success of this very special organization. Congratulations and Happy 50th Anniversary.

HONORING THE LIFE AND SERVICE OF COMMUNITY LEADER AND PUBLIC SERVANT SYLVIA SASS

HON. MARILYN STRICKLAND

OF WASHINGTON

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Tuesday, June 14, 2022

Ms. STRICKLAND. Madam Speaker, I rise today to honor the life and service of Sylvia Sass, an extraordinary public servant and community leader in Washington State.

Since she was young, Sylvia Sass has been committed to overcoming obstacles. When Sylvia was 15, she applied for a sales position at a local shoe store where the store manager told her that they didn't hire women to sell shoes. She was given a trial period where she received no pay and, in the end, sold more shoes than the assistant manager. This same tenacity led Sylvia to become one of Tacoma's leading figures while serving her local and national community, raising a family, and owning a business.

So it was no surprise in 1956, when Tacoma's Mayor needed help rebuilding international relations around the world in the aftermath of World War II, that he turned to Sylvia Sass. She became the mayor's representative for President Eisenhower's Town Affiliation Association, today Sister Cities International. Sylvia was a vital player in the early development of the organization and was appointed Washington State Coordinator for Sister Cities International. She attended regional meetings and represented SCI at annual League of Cities meetings with mayors from across the country. She was even one of twelve people selected as delegates to have lunch with President Eisenhower. To this day, she remains active as an honorary board member and is known as the First Lady of Sister Cities International.

In addition to her work with SCI, Sylvia has been a dedicated community leader in Tacoma and Pierce County for decades, founding the Lakewood Alacoma Club, a non-profit center for recovering alcoholics, receiving a volunteer award from the National Association for Mental Illness, and serving on the University Place Parks and Recreation Commission. In 2011, as former Tacoma Mayor, I declared March 1 as Sylvia B. Sass Day to recognize the amazing service and work she has done for the city of Tacoma.

Madam Speaker, Sylvia Sass exemplifies hard work, perseverance, and selfless service to others. She is a deeply respected member of our community and has profoundly impacted her region, country, and the world for decades. I am proud to call her my friend.

HONORING JUNETEENTH AS A NATIONAL HOLIDAY

HON. BARRY LOUDERMILK

OF GEORGIA

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Tuesday, June 14, 2022

Mr. LOUDERMILK. Madam Speaker, I rise today to honor the upcoming Juneteenth National Holiday, a day in which we celebrate the freedom of African Americans.

On January 1, 1863, President Abraham Lincoln issued the Emancipation Proclamation, proclaiming freedom for more than 3.5 million enslaved African Americans. On June 19, 1865, more than two years later, enslaved Americans in Galveston, Texas, received the notice from U.S. General Gordon Granger that stated, ''The people of Texas are informed that, in accordance with a proclamation from the Executive of the United States, all slaves are free.'' In 1866, black Americans celebrated the first of many annual celebrations of Juneteenth on June 19. Beginning with a proclamation in 1938 and legislation in 1979, Texas became the first state to make Juneteenth an official holiday. More than half of the United States have, in recent years, recognized Juneteenth in some capacity, including Georgia. I have been a part of this celebration for the past several years, speaking at local ceremonies; and I appreciate the history of this commemoration.

I further believe it is important to celebrate freedom and liberty at every opportunity, which is why I supported S. 475, Juneteenth National Independence Day Act, when it came up for a vote in Congress in 2021. This national holiday is a celebration of freedom, and should be recognized by all Americans; as well as a day where we remember the moral stain that slavery had on our country. On behalf of the 11th Congressional District, and the United States House of Representatives, I join others throughout America in recognizing the freedom and individual liberty that Juneteenth represents.

HONORING IRWIN GARFINKEL, PHD. ON THE OCCASION OF HIS RETIREMENT

HON. ROSA L. DeLAURO

OF CONNECTICUT

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Tuesday, June 14, 2022

Ms. DELAURO. Madam Speaker, it is with great pleasure that I rise today to join family, friends, and colleagues in extending my very best wishes to Dr. Irwin Garfinkel on the occasion of his retirement. To say that he has left an indelible mark does not do justice to the impact that his professional contributions as a social worker and economist have made over the course of his career. There is no one that has done more to bring to the forefront of public debate the realities of poverty and its impact on families, children, and our communities. Dr. Garfinkel's volume of work has been extraordinary and we, as policy makers and as a society, have been fortunate to have benefitted from his knowledge and expertise.

In a career that has spanned more than six decades, Dr. Garfinkel has dedicated countless hours to better understanding poverty, wealth, and the welfare state and how they shape communities and societies. Some of his earliest work was in Wisconsin, as the director of the Institute for Policy Research and later as the principle investigator of the Wisconsin Child Support Study where his research on child support and welfare helped to shape legislation not only in Wisconsin, but other states, within the U.S. Congress, and in other countries like Great Britain, Australia, and Sweden.

Dr. Garfinkel is also the author of over two hundred articles and sixteen books or edited volumes on poverty, income transfers, program evaluation, single-parent families and child support, and the welfare state. In fact, his book ''Wealth and Welfare States: Is America Laggard or Leader'' and paper ''Welfare State Myths and Measurement'' take on widespread mistruths about poverty and the poor. Dr. Garfinkel went on to become a co-founding director of the Center on Poverty and Social Policy and spent decades at Columbia University where he was the Mitchell I. Ginsberg Professor of Contemporary Urban Problems and the co-founding director of the Columbia Population Research Center—the only such center to be funded by the National Institute of Child Health and Human Development to have been founded within a school of social work.

Throughout his career, Dr. Garfinkel has demonstrated a remarkable commitment to not only combatting poverty, but to understanding its sources—to look at the root causes and then look at how social and public policy could help families to break its cyclical nature. I have a deep respect and admiration for the work he has done.

I want to extend a special note of thanks to Dr. Garfinkel for the guidance and counsel he has given to me over the years, particularly with my work on expanding the child tax credit. That single public policy lifted half of American children out of poverty, and it did so because of the foundation of research and study that Irv provided. Passed and signed into law as part of the American Rescue Plan, we witnessed the economic benefit this policy had for families—especially the poor—and that is why we must continue the effort to make the expanded child tax credit permanent.

Today, as we mark Dr. Garfinkel's retirement, it is my hope that he knows that his commitment to ending poverty—from the research centers he has founded to his unparalleled catalog of work—will most certainly stand as a legacy that will continue to inspire new generations of social workers, economists, policy makers and advocates. It is with my deepest thanks and appreciation that I rise today to extend my heartfelt congratulations to Dr. Irwin Garfinkel on his retirement, and wish him many more years of health and happiness as he begins this new life chapter.

RECOGNITION OF THE EGYPT-U.S. PARTNERSHIP

HON. C. A. DUTCH RUPPERSBERGER

OF MARYLAND

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Tuesday, June 14, 2022

Mr. RUPPERSBERGER. Madam Speaker, I rise today to recognize the fruitful United States-Egypt partnership. The year 2022 marks 100 years of diplomatic relations between our two nations. As co-chair of the U.S. House of Representatives' Friends of Egypt Caucus, I believe it is of paramount importance that we commemorate this partnership rooted in shared commitments to peace, stability and prosperity. As such, I include in the RECORD this Newsweek article, entitled ''Let's Continue to Strengthen the Egypt-U.S. Partnership'' published on April 18, 2022, and penned by Ambassador of Egypt to the United States, Mr. Motaz Zahran. In this piece, Ambassador Zahran details how cooperation between the U.S. and Egypt has bolstered multilateral support for Ukraine, strengthened counterterrorism efforts in the Middle East and enabled COVID–19 care to reach vulnerable populations.

As President Joe Biden and leaders on Capitol Hill manage the geopolitical crisis in Ukraine, the Egypt-U.S. national security partnership recently came into the national spotlight. In the U.S. Congress, an overwhelming majority of U.S. decision makers once again recognized the importance of strategic allies such as Egypt and approved the sale of aircrafts and military hardware that will allow Egypt and the U.S. to undertake missions in the interests of both countries, working toward achieving stability in the Middle East and North Africa.

This latest sale debated in Congress specifically concentrated on C-130 military transport airplanes. Egypt already possesses a fleet of those airframes previously obtained from the U.S. However, like all military hardware, those airplanes have a shelf life and need constant refurbishment and replacement. It is therefore logical to be looking at our partners in the U.S. for that, especially given the central role the C-130 plays in our common interests.

Egyptian C-130s carried 35,000 Egyptian troops to stand shoulder-to-shoulder with American troops liberating Kuwait during the 1990s. In 2003, the same fleet carried an Egyptian field hospital to Bagram airbase in Afghanistan, providing medical services to both the alliance personnel as well as Afghan people. The fleet of C-130 have carried Egyptian peacekeepers deployed to some of the most dangerous hotspots in the world at a great danger to themselves, and unfortunately with several causalities including most recently in Mali a few short weeks ago. The C-130s have also allowed us to provide urgently needed humanitarian assistance to disaster zones in Sudan, Somalia and deliver masks and personal protection gears to the U.S. medical community during the worse days of the outbreak of COVID–19. We hope to do more as we replenish our fleet. But those aircrafts are not the only fruits of cooperation between our two militaries.

The Egyptian military is also actively involved in supporting the safe passage of U.S. naval vessels through the Suez Canal. One of our core responsibilities is to safeguard navigation in the Suez Canal—through which 12 percent of global trade flows. Our commitment to providing maritime security extends to the Mediterranean and Red Seas, where we actively work with partners to safeguard the flow of commerce.

The depth of the Egypt-U.S. military partnership is exemplified by Exercise Bright Star, which witnesses hundreds of U.S. military personnel join their Egyptian counterparts in what is regarded as the most significant biennial military exercise in the Middle East and Mediterranean region. Egypt, the U.S. and our allies are ready to respond swiftly to crises in the region together because of these exercises.

Egypt has committed itself to being a secure and stable country despite the turmoil in nearby states. The Egyptian military has been successful in fighting terrorist offshoots of ISIS and acts as a deterrent force against would-be aggressors. Civil conflict has plagued Yemen, Syria and Libya while Egypt remains a stable and prosperous country. Moreover, our stability and security has enabled us to play a leading role in pushing for elections in Libya and calling for the expulsion of foreign mercenaries who only cause chaos and suffering.

The Egyptian government has taken substantial strides to advance and promote human rights. In the past few months, Egypt launched its first ever National Strategy for Human Rights, a blueprint that puts forward a comprehensive approach to advance human rights. Laws advancing women's rights and providing opportunities for their equal participation in civic society have been introduced—we are moving forward and setting an example for the region. The State of Emergency, which was necessary to quell terrorism in the country, has been suspended. This is in large part due to the successful cooperation between Egypt and the U.S. in disrupting terrorist networks on our borders. New laws that facilitate the work of local and foreign NGOs operating in Egypt, as well as moves to promote religious freedom, will build a pluralistic civil society that is secure and stable for all Egyptians. Egypt's rock-solid commitment to its people resonates and reverberates at each crossroad.

In an era of great power competition, instability in Eastern Europe, tensions in the Indo-Pacific region and proliferation concerns in the Middle East, we welcome the bipartisan support of the U.S. Congress as work to replenish our aging military equipment.

TRIBUTE TO DR. C. WARREN DERRICK, JR.

HON. JAMES E. CLYBURN

OF SOUTH CAROLINA

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Tuesday, June 14, 2022

Mr. CLYBURN. Madam Speaker, I rise today to pay tribute to Dr. C. Warren Derrick, Jr. Born in Mullins, SC and raised in Marion. Dr. Derrick was the eldest son of Helen and Warren Derrick, Sr. After graduating from Marion High School as president of the student body in 1954, he entered Wofford College where he was a member of Blue Key and President of Kappa Sigma fraternity. He graduated in 1958.

Deciding on a career in medicine, he matriculated at the Medical College of South Carolina, graduating in 1962. While in medical school, he married Ann Marie Berry of Spartanburg.

After completing a rotating internship at Greenville Memorial Hospital, he was inducted into the U.S. Army as a Captain in the Medical Corps and stationed in Nuremberg, Germany. He served for 2 years as Battalion Surgeon for the 34th Artillery, 2nd AC. He was discharged in 1965 and accepted a position with Western Michigan University in Kalamazoo, Michigan as a physician in their student health center for one year. In 1966, he started a 2-year pediatric residency at the University of Alabama Medical Center in Birmingham, Alabama which was followed by a 3-year fellowship in pediatric infectious disease at the Children's Hospital of Alabama.

Upon the completion of his fellowship, he was appointed Assistant Professor of Pediatrics. He rose to Associate Professor in 1975 and served as Director of Outpatient Services at the Children's Hospital. It was during their 10 years in Birmingham that their 3 children were born.

Dr. Derrick returned to South Carolina and accepted a position with Sumter Pediatrics in Sumter in January 1977. After 10 months in private practice, he was offered, and he accepted, a faculty position with the fledgling new medical school in Columbia as Professor of Pediatrics and Chair of the Department of Pediatrics, University of South Carolina School of Medicine—a position he was to hold for the next 29 years.

During his tenure with Children's Hospital and the medical school, he was instrumental in the growth and development of the pediatric department and establishment of the state's first free-standing children's hospital. Under his leadership, the department developed a national reputation for its educational excellence and patient care. He retired in 2007.

His many honors include distinguished alumni/service awards from the Children's Hospital of Alabama, USC School of Medicine, and Wofford College; The Presidential Merit Award, MUSC; William Weston Distinguished Service Award, Department of Pediatrics, USC School of Medicine; and the Order of the Palmetto, State of South Carolina.

He was predeceased by Ann, his wife of 58 years. Surviving are his 3 children: Andrea Derrick Truitt (Chip), Hope Derrick (Marc Turner), and Scott Derrick (Melissa); six grandchildren: Abby, Shelby, and Rachel Truitt; Ethan and Emery Turner; and Tripp Derrick, all of Columbia. He is also survived by his brother Bill Derrick (Jo) of Myrtle Beach and was predeceased by his sister, Susan Derrick of Palatka, Florida.

Madam Speaker, I ask that you and our colleagues join me in celebrating the life and legacy of Dr. C. Warren Derrick, Jr.

HONORING THE GIRL FRIENDS, INC.—NEW HAVEN CHAPTER ON THE CELEBRATION OF THEIR 90TH ANNIVERSARY

HON. ROSA L. DeLAURO

OF CONNECTICUT

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Tuesday, June 14, 2022

Ms. DELAURO. Madam Speaker, it is with great pride that I rise today to extend my heartfelt congratulations to the New Haven Chapter of Girl Friends, Inc. as they celebrate their 90th Anniversary at their annual Kentucky Derby Luncheon. The oldest African American female service organization in New Haven, the New Haven Girl Friends is a unique organization within our community.

Chartered just five years after the national organization, the New Haven Girl Friends have been a center of service and community for African American women in our community. Their work to promote friendship, social interaction, charitable and cultural activities has enriched our community and the lives of its residents. From their success in housing all visiting members at the organization's 1942 Conclave and integrating the Taft Hotel in downtown New Haven to their generous support of projects like the Smithsonian National Museum of African American History and Culture as well as the NAACP and The Girl Friends Fund Scholarship program, the New Haven Girl Friends have left an indelible mark on our community.

Each year on the weekend of the Kentucky Derby, members gather in fellowship to raise funds for scholarships that are awarded annually to students throughout Greater New Haven and Hartford as well as to benefit local community-based programs, the nonprofit Girl Friends Fund Foundation and other initiatives of the New Haven Chapter. Their mission has been to actively engage the community and their goals are rooted in the understanding that our communities thrive when every member contributes to its success. The members of the New Haven Girl Friends include some of our communities most prominent social advocates—many of whom dedicate both their professional and personal lives to public service. These women stand as role models for us all, but particularly for our young people. They inspire us with their deep commitment to community and compassion for others.

It is my great honor to rise today to extend my sincere thanks and appreciation to the members of the New Haven Chapter of Girl Friends, Inc. for their innumerable and invaluable contributions to our community. It is my honor to congratulate you on your 90th Anniversary and, as we say in Italian, C'ent Anni—to another hundred years.

CONGRATULATING NICHOLAS PATRICK FOR HIS WIN AT THE IHSA STATE CHAMPIONSHIPS IN TENNIS

HON. CHERI BUSTOS

OF ILLINOIS

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Tuesday, June 14, 2022

Mrs. BUSTOS. Madam Speaker, I rise today to recognize Nicholas Patrick, a freshman from Alleman Catholic High School, who won the Illinois High School Athletic Association Class 1A State tennis title.

Nicholas won the 1A state tennis title in singles, becoming the first Quad Cities area IHSA boys state tennis champion since 1996. As a former athlete, I commend him for his determination and attitude. Nicholas is an example of the importance of dedication and a strong work ethic. I am proud to see him represent Rock Island so well throughout the state and the country with his talent and passion.

It is because of student leaders such as Nicholas that I am especially proud to serve Illinois' 17th Congressional District. Madam Speaker, I would like to again formally congratulate Nicholas Patrick on his Class 1A State title in tennis.

CONGRATULATING JAMES RASMUSSEN ON HIS RETIREMENT AFTER MANY YEARS OF SERVICE AS A STRONG COMMUNITY LEADER

HON. ADAM SMITH

OF WASHINGTON

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Tuesday, June 14, 2022

Mr. SMITH of Washington. Madam Speaker, I rise to congratulate James Rasmussen on his retirement. James has served as a strong community leader working on environmental, habitat, and community issues along the Duwamish River.

My staff and I have had the pleasure of working with James for several years. He has played an important role serving his community as part of the Duwamish Tribe and the Duwamish River Community Coalition.

James has been an extremely effective advocate for the cleanup of the Duwamish River. He has also been a fierce supporter of the river's nearby communities and has served as a tireless and committed advocate for decades in our region. His efforts and dedication have been invaluable in support of the protection of the Duwamish River. His work will help to ensure that the river is restored for future generations.

Madam Speaker, I sincerely thank and commend James Rasmussen for spending his career focused on the protection and cleanup of the Duwamish River. I congratulate him on a well-deserved retirement.

HONORING RICHARD SMITH OF MILFORD, CONNECTICUT FOR HIS OUTSTANDING SERVICE TO HIS COMMUNITY

HON. ROSA L. DeLAURO

OF CONNECTICUT

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Tuesday, June 14, 2022

Ms. DELAURO. Madam Speaker, it is with great pleasure that I rise today to join family, friends, and community leaders to extend my deepest thanks and appreciation to Richard Smith of Milford, Connecticut for his outstanding and invaluable contributions to our community.

A graduate of Yale University and Trinity College, where he majored in political science with concentrations in American government and public policy respectively, Rich has always held a firm commitment to giving back to his community. He sought ways in which he could use his passion for government and public policy to make a difference, enrich the community, and improve the quality of life for others. Having spent a number of his high school years volunteering on various local campaigns, he became a member of his local town committee where he has spent decades supporting local candidates and driving policy agendas. Dedicating his time and energies to the committee and its work, he took on several leadership positions, including serving as its chairman for a record-breaking eighteen years.

As much as politics is his passion, public service is the moral compass by which Rich is guided. He has volunteered countless hours to serving both the City of Milford and the State of Connecticut. Appointed by the Mayor, he has served for a number of years as a member of the Regional Water Authority's Representative Policy Board which is charged with the appointment of the five members to serve on the Regional Water Authority; the approval of land sales, rate increases, bond sales and any capital project with a cost in excess of $2 million; the appointment of the Office of Consumer Affairs as well as the external auditor; and the ratification of the appointment of the chief executive officer. For the last decade he has served as a member of the Milford Police Commission, also serving as its chairman for several terms. In 2017, he was nominated to a five-year term by then Governor Dannell Malloy to serve on Connecticut's Judicial Review Council as one of six citizen members. Established in 1976, the Judicial Review Council is charged with investigating and acting on allegations of misconduct within the state's judicial system. In every facet of his service to the community, Rich has leveraged his appreciation and excitement for politics and government into making a real difference in the lives of others.

I have had the privilege of knowing and working with Rich for many years now and consider myself fortunate to have a friend like him in my corner. His leadership and vision have left an indelible mark that will continue to inspire generations of new community leaders for years to come. I am honored to rise today to extend my heartfelt thanks and appreciation to Richard Smith for his outstanding service to the community and his dedicated work on behalf of others. I wish him as well as his wife, Michelle, and daughters Melissa, Meghan, and Rebecca, all the best for many more years of health and happiness.

DEPARTMENT OF JUSTICE SURVEY ON REMEDYING THE EFFECT OF DISCRIMINATION IN FEDERAL CONTRACTING

HON. CAROLYN B. MALONEY

OF NEW YORK

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Tuesday, June 14, 2022

Mrs. CAROLYN B. MALONEY of New York. Madam Speaker, I include in the RECORD the executive summary of a report by the Department of Justice (DOJ) titled "The Compelling

Interest to Remedy the Effects of Discrimination in Federal Contracting: A Survey of Recent Evidence.'' The DOJ summary and associated report illustrate how systemic discrimination continues to create barriers for women- and minority-owned businesses to fairly compete for federal contracts and how federal contracting programs can respond to, address, and remedy the harmful effects of discrimination.

[From the U.S. Department of Justice, May 16, 2022]

THE COMPELLING INTEREST TO REMEDY THE EFFECTS OF DISCRIMINATION IN FEDERAL CONTRACTING: A SURVEY OF RECENT EVIDENCE—EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

On January 27, 2022, the Department of Justice posted a notice in the Federal Register announcing the publication of a Department of Justice report surveying the evidence supporting the use of race- and sex-conscious contracting programs by the federal government in order to remedy the effects of discrimination.

This report is third in a series created by the Department of Justice since the Supreme Court determined that federal race-conscious contracting programs must meet the strict scrutiny standard of review to survive a constitutional challenge based on the Equal Protection Clause in Adarand Constructors, Inc. v. Peña, 515 U.S. 200, 227 (1995). Each report has compiled and summarized the evidence of discriminatory barriers that businesses owned by women and people of color face that impede participation in government contracting. Both previous reports have been cited in federal court as evidence that there is a compelling governmental interest in programs that support the ability of businesses owned by people of color to compete on an equal basis. Strict scrutiny is the most exacting standard of review, and it requires, among other things, evidence supporting the conclusion that such measures are necessary to further the compelling governmental interest in remedying the effects of past and present racial discrimination. If a program contains affirmative measures based on sex, those measures are subject to the somewhat lower standard of intermediate scrutiny. That standard demands that any gender-based preference be substantially related to an important governmental objective.

In assessing whether race- and sex-conscious government contracting programs could continue to survive heightened levels of judicial review, the Department of Justice reviewed hundreds of state and local disparity studies, dozens of congressional hearings and related testimony, government reports on public contracting, academic and expert reports on public and federal contracting, academic and government reports on financial data related to small businesses, and recent case law related to Equal Protection challenges to government contracting and grant programs. The disparity studies, congressional hearings, and academic reports contain both quantitative and qualitative evidence of the persistence of discrimination and its lingering effects in the public and private sector.

The Department of Justice report determines that there is a strong basis in evidence, both quantitative and qualitative, of the continued pervasiveness of discriminatory barriers that impede the full and fair participation of businesses owned by women or people of color in government contracting. The evidence discussed in this report supports the compelling interest in the continued use of federal programs that contain remedial measures to eliminate discriminatory barriers to contracting opportunities for businesses owned by minorities and an important state interest in the continued use of federal programs that contain remedial measures to eliminate discriminatory barriers to contracting opportunities for businesses owned for women.

Both the qualitative and quantitative evidence shows the various ways discrimination hinders the ability of minority- and women-owned businesses to compete equitably for government contracts. While this discrimination can take many forms, primary obstacles include: (1) discrimination limiting access to capital; (2) discrimination by procurement agencies and prime contractors, (3) exclusion from business networks, and (4) discrimination in lending and by bonding companies and suppliers.

In assessing the current public contracting environment faced by minority- and women-owned businesses, the Department of Justice reviewed over 200 disparity studies from state and local jurisdictions in 34 different states and the District of Columbia. Disparity studies are quantitative demographic analysis of public procurement contracting utilization as compared to local business availability categorized by the race or sex of the owner. The review of these studies shows that there continues to be substantial disparities between the availability of minority- and women-owned businesses and the utilization of such businesses in state and local government procurement in all areas of the country and at all levels of procurement. The overwhelming majority of these studies showed significant under-utilization of minority- and women-owned businesses in almost every sector of public procurement. The report cited to an overview of these disparity studies conducted by the Minority Business Development Agency in 2016, which found that the studies indicated significant contracting disparities for minority business enterprises that were pervasive across different ethnic and racial groups, industries, and geographies. Shockingly, the median value for the observed disparities was just 19%, indicating that minority businesses were being utilized at less than one-fifth of their availability in a given marketplace.

The report also reviewed federal government small business contracting. In 2017, just 9.8% of federal spending on contracts went to minority-owned businesses. The same year, woman-owned businesses received only 5% of federal prime contract awards. Even when comparing businesses and controlling for the industry in which the firm did business, business age, business size (both in terms of average number of employees and annual receipts), business form, and security clearance, the likelihood of minority-owned businesses receiving a federal contract versus similar businesses is still lower than non-minority-owned businesses.

Overwhelmingly, the disparity studies and reports also present evidence linking disparities in contracting to discriminatory factors. In the private financial sector, historic barriers and private discrimination has limited the ability of minority business owners to accumulate assets and wealth. Minority-owned businesses are two to three times more likely to be denied credit, more likely to avoid applying for loans based on the belief they will be turned down, and more likely to receive smaller loans and pay higher interest rates on the loans they do receive. Minority- and women-owned firms not only receive smaller loans at higher interest rates than firms owned by White males, but they also get smaller equity investments.

In the bonding arena, both quantitative and qualitative evidence shows that bonding requirements disproportionately affect businesses owned by women or people of color. 83% of minority- and women-owned businesses identified bonding requirements as a specific barrier to the ability to obtain contracts. A number of recent studies show that minority-owned firms are significantly more likely to face difficulties in obtaining required bonds compared with majority-owned firms.

The evidence presented in the report indicates that the barriers that have impeded the growth and success of minority- and women-owned businesses continue to exist and that government contracting preference programs ameliorate the effects of public and private discrimination. For example, a 2017 disparity study prepared for the Los Angeles County Metropolitan Transportation Authority compared the participation of minority- and women-owned businesses on contracts that contained goals to encourage utilization of minority- and women-owned businesses as opposed to contracts that did not contain such goals. The results showed that on contracts without goals, minority- and women-owned firms earned only 53 cents on the dollar, but on contracts with goals, such firms earned 96 cents on the dollar—almost what would be expected given the availability of such firms in the marketplace.

The federal government currently operates two main contracting programs with race and/or sex-conscious elements: the SBA Section 8(a) business development program and the Department of Transportation Disadvantaged Business Enterprise program. All federal departments and major independent agencies participate in the SSA's Section 8(a) business development program, which offers a variety of assistance, including set-aside federal government contracts to socially and economically disadvantaged businesses. In Fiscal Year 2019, the federal government awarded $30.4 billion to 8(a) firms.

Appendices of 219 state and local disparity studies, 45 relevant academic and government studies, and 28 Congressional hearings are included with the report. The Federal Register notice announcing the report may be found at 87 FR 4955, and the report itself is publicly available at the Department of Justice.

DONALD BORDEN

HON. DONALD NORCROSS

OF NEW JERSEY

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Tuesday, June 14, 2022

Mr. NORCROSS. Madam Speaker, I rise today to honor educator Donald A. Borden of Blackwood, New Jersey.

Donald A. Borden began his long scholastic career teaching both special and general education, while volunteering his time coaching numerous varsity sports. Additionally, he taught for many years as an adjunct professor at Camden County College.

He went on to his first of many administrative positions when he became the Assistant Principal of Audubon High School, followed by his time as Principal of the Mansion Avenue Elementary School. Mr. Borden holds a master's degree in educational leadership from Rowan University, a bachelor's degree from Glassboro State College and has been and continues to be a strong supporter of South Jersey schools and universities.

Soon after, Mr. Borden became the Principal of Audubon Junior-Senior High School, where he worked closely with Camden County College to provide both remediation and credit-bearing course offerings to students. Mr.

Borden was promoted to superintendent of the Audubon Public School District in Camden County from 2006 to 2013, where he served as an officer of the Camden County Superintendent's Roundtable and solidified the district's financial footing while increasing diversity through the implementation of the school-choice program.

In 2015, Mr. Borden would go on to become Executive Vice President at Camden County College. On April 5, 2016, Mr. Borden was appointed as Camden County College's fifth president. During his tenure as president, Mr. Borden has served as the Chair of the New Jersey Council of County Colleges' Presidents and served as Chair of the Campus Safety Committee for the State of New Jersey's President's Council.

Today, Mr. Borden continues to uphold his commitment to the educational community by serving on committees charged with increasing dual credit opportunities for high school students. He was also selected by The Institute for Citizens and Scholars as a Fellow, representing New Jersey to explore best practices in higher education.

Madam Speaker, I ask you to join me in honoring Donald A. Borden, a resident dedicated to his community and to the advancement of educational opportunity.

HONORING THE LIFE AND SERVICE OF JERRY YOUNG

HON. DIANA HARSHBARGER

OF TENNESSEE

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Tuesday, June 14, 2022

Mrs. HARSHBARGER. Madam Speaker, I rise to recognize Mr. Jerry Young of Tennessee's 1st Congressional District. Mr. Young currently serves as President of the Tennessee College of Applied Technology in Morristown. He was named President in May 2017 and since that time, TCAT of Morristown has seen technical training opportunities expand for all residents in the college's ten county service area. The college has added dual enrollment opportunities for high school students in seven counties and completed a fourteen-million-dollar advanced manufacturing training center that will be the hub of workforce development in the region.

Before beginning his career with the Tennessee Board of Regents, he served in the U.S. Navy as an Electronics Technician for 5 years. For 3 of those years, he was deployed for overseas operations where he was awarded a Naval Expeditionary Medal, Battle Efficiency Medal, Good Conduct Medal, Marksmanship Medal and two Naval Sea Service Ribbons. After leaving the Navy, he worked as an engineer while earning his Master of Arts degree from the University of the Cumberlands, a Bachelor of Science degree from Excelsior College and an Electronics Technician from the Great Lakes (IL) Naval Training Center.

His career in technical education began in 1988 as the senior instructor in the Electronics Technology Program at the Crossville campus. He served as Vice President there from 2005 until his appointment as President in 2014. As President, he took on many initiatives to expand the school's capabilities through new program development. During his three-year tenure there, the school's enrollment increased by 30 percent, maintained an 85 percent completion rate and an 85 percent placement rate. He has been recognized as the Technical Teacher of the Year in Tennessee, Technical Teacher of the Year by the American Technical Education Associations' Gulf Coast region and nominated for national honors.

Jerry and his wife, Gail reside in the Morristown area, and they have two daughters, Jennifer Young Albertson and Dr. Emilie Young Bee as well as three grandchildren. He is an active supporter of Shriners Hospitals for Children and enjoys traveling America's rural highways on his motorcycle.

Madam Speaker, Mr. Jerry Young has been an outstanding leader and promoter of training for technical jobs and a valuable contributor to workforce development in East Tennessee, and I proudly honor him.

HONORING BISHOP'S ORCHARDS AS THEY CELEBRATE THEIR 150-YEAR (+1) ANNIVERSARY

HON. ROSA L. DeLAURO

OF CONNECTICUT

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Tuesday, June 14, 2022

Ms. DELAURO. Madam Speaker, it is with great pleasure that I rise today to join the community of Guilford, Connecticut and families across state in extending my heartfelt congratulations to Bishop's Orchards, and the Bishop family, as they celebrate the 150th Anniversary of this unique community treasure. While navigating the covid pandemic may have delayed the celebration one-year, we are all excited and proud to join with them as they celebrate this very special occasion.

Connecticut has a long and proud history in agriculture and our famous fruit orchards have become a highlighted attraction for visitors. From picking your own fruits and vegetables to learning the intricacies of the perfect apple cider, our orchards offer a unique view into one of our nation's oldest industries. Today, the descendants of brothers Albert and Gene Bishop preserve this New England treasure while expanding the business to meet the needs of today's consumers. With three hundred acres lined with apple, peach, and pear trees, the Bishops continue to work hard to ensure the success of the orchards.

Generation after generation, the Bishop family have recognized the importance of preserving the natural beauty of the orchard and its surrounding properties. They were one of the first of our local farmers to initiate an integrated pest management program, significantly reducing the pesticides and chemicals used in the orchards. They have converted a parcel of their property to a solar farm, utilizing renewable energy to run the farm and its accompanying market and winery. It is through these kinds of innovations that Bishop's Orchards remains a respected leader in Connecticut's agricultural community.

Located on the shores of the Long Island Sound, Bishop Orchards captures the very spirit of New England. Owned and operated by now the 6th generation of Bishops, this remarkable family and their orchard have been fixtures of the Guilford community for more than 400 years. From the quintessential ''little red barn'' to the bustling market, and from the acres of orchards to the newest addition of winemaking, Bishop's Orchards is a destination for Connecticut families. It is my honor to stand today to extend my heartfelt congratulations to Bishop's on their sesquicentennial anniversary, and as we say in Italian—C'ent Anni—to another hundred.

RECOGNIZING THE ROCKRIDGE HIGH SCHOOL SOFTBALL TEAM ON WINNING THE IHSA 2A STATE CHAMPIONSHIP

HON. CHERI BUSTOS

OF ILLINOIS

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Tuesday, June 14, 2022

Mrs. BUSTOS. Madam Speaker, I rise today to recognize the Rockridge High School Girls Softball team for their win at the Illinois High School Association (IHSA) State Championships.

The unbeaten Rockridge Rockets won 64 games before competing in IHSA State Championship game. The ladies took a chance on their winning streak and came back from a 4–0 deficit with grit and determination. The Rockridge Rockets are the first team in IHSA history to finish as undefeated State Champions in back-to-back seasons. The team never gave up and accomplished a goal they set out for themselves at the beginning of the season. As a former athlete, I commend their hard work and dedication to their team.

The Rockets athletic success is remarkable. I am incredibly proud to serve Illinois' 17th Congressional District and student-athletes. Madam Speaker, I would like to formally congratulate the Rockridge Rockets again on winning the Illinois High School Association 2A State Championships for Softball.

Daily Digest

Senate

Chamber Action

Routine Proceedings, pages S2919–S2945

Measures Introduced: Seventeen bills and five resolutions were introduced, as follows: S. 4388–4404, and S. Res. 670–674. **Pages S2939–40**

Measures Reported:

H.R. 4250, to amend the State Department Basic Authorities Act of 1956 to provide for rewards for the arrest or conviction of certain foreign nationals who have committed genocide or war crimes.

H.R. 7276, to direct the President to submit to Congress a report on United States Government efforts to collect, analyze, and preserve evidence and information related to war crimes and other atrocities committed during the full-scale Russian invasion of Ukraine since February 24, 2022.

S. Res. 124, celebrating the heritage of Romani Americans, with an amendment in the nature of a substitute and with an amended preamble.

S. Res. 394, recognizing the 25th anniversary of Radio Free Asia and its mission to provide an independent source of news to closed societies in Asia, with an amendment in the nature of a substitute and with an amended preamble.

S. Res. 458, recognizing the 75th anniversary of the establishment of the United Nations Children's Fund, with an amendment in the nature of a substitute and with an amended preamble.

S. Res. 540, supporting the goals of International Women's Day, and with an amended preamble.

S. Res. 568, supporting the goals and ideals of "Countering International Parental Child Abduction Month" and expressing the sense of the Senate that Congress should raise awareness of the harm caused by international parental child abduction.

S. Res. 589, recognizing, honoring, and commending the women of Ukraine who have contributed to the fight for freedom and the defense of Ukraine, with an amendment in the nature of a substitute and with an amended preamble.

S. Res. 638, commending the Government and people of the Republic of Moldova for their heroic efforts to support Ukrainian refugees fleeing President Putin's illegal war against Ukraine, with an amendment in the nature of a substitute.

S. Res. 646, expressing the Senate's support for Finland and Sweden's accession into the North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO) and the expedited ratification of accession protocols, and with an amended preamble.

S. 1160, to prioritize efforts of the Department of State to combat international trafficking in covered synthetic drugs and new psychoactive substances, with an amendment in the nature of a substitute.

S. 2151, to amend the Omnibus Crime Control and Safe Streets Act of 1968 to provide that COPS grant funds may be used for local law enforcement recruits to attend schools or academies if the recruits agree to serve in precincts of law enforcement agencies in their communities, with an amendment in the nature of a substitute.

S. 3211, to continue the whole-of-government approach to ending global wildlife poaching and trafficking by permanently reauthorizing the activities of the Presidential Task Force on Wildlife Trafficking, with an amendment in the nature of a substitute.

S. 3635, to amend the Omnibus Crime Control and Safe Streets Act of 1968 to authorize public safety officer death benefits to officers suffering from post-traumatic stress disorder or acute stress disorder, with an amendment in the nature of a substitute.

S. 3860, to establish a grant program to provide assistance to local governments with fewer than 200 law enforcement officers, with an amendment in the nature of a substitute.

S. 3861, to require the Secretary of State to submit annual reports to Congress on the assistance provided to Somaliland and to conduct a feasibility study, in coordination with the Secretary of Defense, on establishing a security partnership with Somaliland, without recognizing Somaliland as an independent state, with an amendment in the nature of a substitute.

S. 3895, to extend and authorize annual appropriations for the United States Commission on International Religious Freedom through fiscal year 2024, with an amendment in the nature of a substitute.

S. 4003, to amend the Omnibus Crime Control and Safe Streets Act of 1968 to provide for training on alternatives to use of force, de-escalation, and mental and behavioral health and suicidal crises, with an amendment in the nature of a substitute.

S. 4007, to require the Attorney General to propose a program for making treatment for post-traumatic stress disorder and acute stress disorder available to public safety officers, with an amendment in the nature of a substitute.

S. 4171, to reauthorize the Trafficking Victims Protection Act of 2000, with an amendment in the nature of a substitute.

S. Con. Res. 40, welcoming the Prime Minister of Greece to the United States for an address to a joint meeting of Congress. **Page S2939**

Measures Passed:

245th Anniversary of the Flag of the United States: Senate agreed to S. Res. 671, celebrating the 245th anniversary of the creation of the flag of the United States and expressing support for the Pledge of Allegiance. **Pages S2931–35**

State Antitrust Enforcement Venue Act: Senate passed S. 1787, to amend title 28 of the United States Code to prevent the transfer of actions arising under the antitrust laws in which a State is a complainant, after agreeing to the following amendment proposed thereto: **Pages S2935–36**

Hassan (for Lee) Amendment No. 5096, to strike the retroactive effective date. **Pages S2935–36**

Air America Act: Senate passed S. 407, to provide redress to the employees of Air America, after agreeing to the committee amendment in the nature of a substitute. **Page S2936**

Stroke Awareness Month: Senate agreed to S. Res. 672, expressing support for the designation of May 2022 as "Stroke Awareness Month". **Page S2936**

Standing Rules of the Senate: Senate agreed to S. Res. 673, authorizing the Committee on Rules and Administration to prepare a revised edition of the Standing Rules of the Senate as a Senate document. **Page S2936**

Measures Considered:

Honoring Our Pact Act—Agreement: Senate continued consideration of H.R. 3967, to improve health care and benefits for veterans exposed to toxic substances, taking action on the following amendments proposed thereto: **Pages S2919–31**

Pending:

Tester/Moran Amendment No. 5051, in the nature of a substitute. **Page S2919**

Schumer Amendment No. 5065 (to Amendment No. 5051), to add an effective date. **Page S2919**

Schumer Amendment No. 5076 (to the text proposed to be stricken by Amendment No. 5051), to add an effective date. **Page S2919**

A unanimous-consent agreement was reached providing for further consideration of the bill at approximately 10 a.m., on Wednesday, June 15, 2022; that all time during adjournment, recess, morning business, and Leader remarks count post-cloture on the bill; that all post-cloture time be considered expired at 11:45 a.m.; and that at 5:15 p.m., Senate execute the orders with respect to the motion to proceed to consideration of S. Con. Res. 41, setting forth the congressional budget for the United States Government for fiscal year 2023 and setting forth the appropriate budgetary levels for fiscal years 2024 through 2032, and the nomination of Alan M. Leventhal, of Massachusetts, to be Ambassador to the Kingdom of Denmark, in the order listed. **Page S2945**

Concurrent Resolution on the Budget—Agreement: A unanimous-consent agreement was reached providing that at a time to be determined by the Majority Leader, in consultation with the Republican Leader, and notwithstanding Rule XXII, it be in order for Senator Paul or his designee to make a motion to proceed to consideration of S. Con. Res. 41, setting forth the congressional budget for the United States Government for fiscal year 2023 and setting forth the appropriate budgetary levels for fiscal years 2024 through 2032, on Wednesday, June 15, 2022; that if the motion to proceed is agreed to, Senate resume consideration of H.R. 3967, to improve health care and benefits for veterans exposed to toxic substances, post-cloture; and that upon disposition of H.R. 3967, Senate resume consideration of S. Con. Res. 41. **Page S2935**

Leventhal Nomination—Agreement: A unanimous-consent-time agreement was reached providing that notwithstanding Rule XXII, at a time to be determined by the Majority Leader, in consultation with the Republican Leader, Senate begin consideration of the nomination of Alan M. Leventhal, of Massachusetts, to be Ambassador to the Kingdom of Denmark, that there be ten minutes for debate equally divided in the usual form on the nomination; and that upon the use or yielding back of time, Senate vote on confirmation of the nomination, without intervening action or debate. **Page S2935**

Messages from the House: **Page S2938**

Measures Referred: **Page S2938**

Executive Communications: **Pages S2938–39**

Executive Reports of Committees: **Page S2939**

Additional Cosponsors: **Pages S2940–42**

Statements on Introduced Bills/Resolutions: Pages S2942–44

Additional Statements: Pages S2937–38

Amendments Submitted: Pages S2944–45

Authorities for Committees to Meet: Page S2945

Adjournment: Senate convened at 11 a.m. and adjourned at 6:55 p.m., until 10 a.m. on Wednesday, June 15, 2022. (For Senate's program, see the remarks of the Acting Majority Leader in today's Record on page S2945.)

Committee Meetings

(Committees not listed did not meet)

APPROPRIATIONS: INTELLIGENCE COMMUNITY

Committee on Appropriations: Subcommittee on Defense concluded a closed hearing to examine proposed budget estimates and justification for fiscal year 2023 for the Intelligence Community, after receiving testimony from Avril Haines, Director of National Intelligence; William J. Burns, Director, Central Intelligence Agency; and General Paul M. Nakasone, Director, National Security Agency, Department of Defense.

APPROPRIATIONS: TREASURY TFI AND FINCEN

Committee on Appropriations: Subcommittee on Financial Services and General Government concluded a hearing to examine proposed budget estimates and justification for fiscal year 2023 for the Treasury Office of Terrorism and Financial Intelligence and the Treasury Financial Crimes Enforcement Network, after receiving testimony from Wally Adeyemo, Deputy Secretary of the Treasury.

BUSINESS MEETING

Committee on Armed Services: Subcommittee on Readiness and Management Support approved for full committee consideration those provisions which fall under the subcommittee's jurisdiction of the proposed National Defense Authorization Act for fiscal year 2023.

BUSINESS MEETING

Committee on Armed Services: Subcommittee on Emerging Threats and Capabilities approved for full committee consideration those provisions which fall under the subcommittee's jurisdiction of the proposed National Defense Authorization Act for fiscal year 2023.

BUSINESS MEETING

Committee on Armed Services: Subcommittee on Cybersecurity approved for full committee consideration those provisions which fall under the subcommittee's jurisdiction of the proposed National Defense Authorization Act for fiscal year 2023.

BUSINESS MEETING

Committee on Armed Services: Subcommittee on Personnel approved for full committee consideration those provisions which fall under the subcommittee's jurisdiction of the proposed National Defense Authorization Act for fiscal year 2023.

BUSINESS MEETING

Committee on Armed Services: Subcommittee on Seapower approved for full committee consideration those provisions which fall under the subcommittee's jurisdiction of the proposed National Defense Authorization Act for fiscal year 2023.

BUSINESS MEETING

Committee on Armed Services: Subcommittee on Airland approved for full committee consideration those provisions which fall under the subcommittee's jurisdiction of the proposed National Defense Authorization Act for fiscal year 2023.

INDEX FUND VOTING PROCESS

Committee on Banking, Housing, and Urban Affairs: Committee concluded a hearing to examine the index fund voting process, including S. 4241, to amend the Investment Advisers Act of 1940 to require investment advisers for passively managed funds to arrange for pass-through voting of proxies for certain securities, after receiving testimony from Senator Sullivan; John C. Coates IV, Harvard Law School, Cambridge, Massachusetts; and Caleb N. Griffin, University of Arkansas School of Law, Fayetteville.

BUSINESS MEETING

Committee on Energy and Natural Resources: Committee ordered favorably reported the nominations of David Applegate, of Pennsylvania, to be Director of the United States Geological Survey, and Carmen G. Cantor, of Puerto Rico, to be an Assistant Secretary, both of the Department of the Interior, and Evelyn Wang, of Massachusetts, to be Director of the Advanced Research Projects Agency-Energy, Department of Energy.

EXTREME DROUGHT

Committee on Energy and Natural Resources: Committee concluded a hearing to examine short term and long term solutions to extreme drought in the western United States, after receiving testimony from

Camille Calimlim Touton, Commissioner, Bureau of Reclamation, Department of the Interior; Charles V. Stern, Specialist in Natural Resources Policy, Congressional Research Service, Library of Congress; John J. Entsminger, Southern Nevada Water Authority, Las Vegas; Maurice Hall, Environmental Defense Fund, Sacramento, California; and Patrick O'Toole, Family Farm Alliance, Savery, Wyoming.

SOUTH DAKOTA V. WAYFAIR

Committee on Finance: Committee concluded a hearing to examine the impact of South Dakota v. Wayfair on small businesses and remote sales, after receiving testimony from James R. McTigue, Jr., Director, Tax Policy and Administration, Government Accountability Office; John E. Hennessey, Littleton Coin Company, Inc., Littleton, New Hampshire; Michelle Huie, VIM and VIGR Compression Legwear, Missoula, Montana; Craig Johnson, Streamlined Sales Tax Governing Board, Westby, Wisconsin; and Diane L. Yetter, Sales Tax Institute, Chicago, Illinois.

GOVERNMENT EFFICIENCY AND EFFECTIVENESS

Committee on Homeland Security and Governmental Affairs: Subcommittee on Emerging Threats and Spending Oversight concluded an oversight hearing to examine the findings and recommendations of GAO's 2022 report on duplication, overlap, fragmentation and opportunities to achieve financial benefits, after receiving testimony from Gene L. Dodaro, Comptroller General of the United States, Government Accountability Office.

BUSINESS MEETING

Committee on Health, Education, Labor, and Pensions: Committee ordered favorably reported the following business items:

S. 4348, to amend the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act to revise and extend the user-fee programs for prescription drugs, medical devices, generic drugs, and biosimilar biological products, with an amendment in the nature of a substitute;

S. 958, to amend the Public Health Service Act to expand the allowable use criteria for new access points grants for community health centers, with an amendment in the nature of a substitute;

S. 4353, to amend the Employee Retirement Income Security Act of 1974 and the Internal Revenue Code of 1986 to improve retirement plan provisions, with amendments;

H.R. 1193, to amend title IV of the Public Health Service Act to direct the Director of the National Institutes of Health, in consultation with the Director of the National Heart, Lung, and Blood Institute, to establish a program under which the Director of the National Institutes of Health shall support or conduct research on valvular heart disease; and

S. 4052, to reauthorize a program for early detection, diagnosis, and treatment regarding deaf and hard-of-hearing newborns, infants, and young children, with an amendment in the nature of a substitute.

WORKFORCE AND ECONOMY

Committee on the Judiciary: Subcommittee on Immigration, Citizenship, and Border Safety concluded a hearing to examine strengthening our workforce and economy through higher education and immigration, after receiving testimony from former Representative Mia Love, Utah State University Center for Growth and Opportunity, Logan; Bernard A. Burrola, Association of Public and Land-grant Universities, Washington, D.C.; and Dalia Larios, Harvard Medical School, Boston, Massachusetts.

DEPARTMENT OF VETERANS AFFAIRS BUDGET

Committee on Veterans' Affairs: Committee concluded a hearing to examine the President's proposed budget request for fiscal year 2023 and proposed budget estimates for fiscal year 2024 for the Department of Veterans Affairs, after receiving testimony from Denis McDonough, Secretary of Veterans Affairs; and Roscoe Butler, Paralyzed Veterans of America, Shane Liermann, Disabled American Veterans, and Patrick Murray, Veterans of Foreign Wars, all of Washington, D.C.

INTELLIGENCE

Select Committee on Intelligence: Committee held closed hearings on intelligence matters, receiving testimony from officials of the intelligence community.

Committee recessed subject to the call.

House of Representatives

Chamber Action

Public Bills and Resolutions Introduced: 19 public bills, H.R. 8049–8067; and 3 resolutions, H. Res. 1173–1175, were introduced. **Pages H5545–46**

Additional Cosponsors: **Pages H5547–48**

Reports Filed: Reports were filed today as follows:

H.R. 6933, to amend the Energy Policy Act of 2005 to require reporting relating to certain cost-share requirements (H. Rept. 117–367);

H.R. 4140, to make improvements with respect to the pricing of cattle in the United States, and for other purposes, with an amendment (H. Rept. 117–368); and

H.R. 3588, to coordinate Federal research and development efforts focused on modernizing mathematics in STEM education through mathematical and statistical modeling, including data-driven and computational thinking, problem, project, and performance-based learning and assessment, interdisciplinary exploration, and career connections, and for other purposes (H. Rept. 117–369). **Page H5545**

Speaker: Read a letter from the Speaker wherein she appointed Representative Cárdenas to act as Speaker pro tempore for today. **Page H5489**

Recess: The House recessed at 10:35 a.m. and reconvened at 12 noon. **Page H5493**

Committee Elections: The House agreed to H. Res. 1173, electing Members to certain standing committees of the House of Representatives. **Page H5493**

Recovering America's Wildlife Act: The House passed H.R. 2773, to amend the Pittman-Robertson Wildlife Restoration Act to make supplemental funds available for management of fish and wildlife species of greatest conservation need as determined by State fish and wildlife agencies, by a yea-and-nay vote of 231 yeas to 190 nays, Roll No. 267.

Pages H5507–30

Rejected the Fulcher motion to recommit the bill to the Committee on Natural Resources by a yea-and-nay vote of 202 yeas to 220 nays, Roll No. 266.

Pages H5528–29

Pursuant to the Rule, an amendment in the nature of a substitute consisting of the text of Rules Committee Print 117–47, modified by the amendment printed in part C of H. Rept. 117–366, shall be considered as adopted, in lieu of the amendment in the nature of a substitute recommended by the Committee on Natural Resources now printed in the bill. **Pages H5507–10**

Agreed to:

Dingell en bloc amendment No. 1 consisting of the following amendments printed in part D of H. Rept. 117–366: Cherfilus-McCormick (No. 1) that encourages the use of innovative technologies in wildlife management and conservation; Jackson Lee (No. 3) that instructs the Secretary of Interior to report on contracts, subcontracts, and grant money allocated to or received by minority-serving educational institutions and minority-owned businesses; Schrier (No. 6) that allows funds to be used for conservation infrastructure projects that protect and conserve habitat for species of greatest conservation need; and Scott (GA) (No. 7) that allows funds to be used for conservation and restoration of native pollinator species (by a yea-and-nay vote of 276 yeas to 147 nays with one answering "present", Roll No. 262); **Pages H5520–22, H5525–26**

Dingell en bloc amendment No. 2 consisting of the following amendments printed in part D of H. Rept. 117–366: Bentz (No. 2) that imposes a 1.85% administrative spending cap on portions of Title III; and Tiffany (No. 8) that requires 0.5% of the funds from this bill be provided to the Department of Interior's Office of Inspector General to oversee this program (by a yea-and-nay vote of 412 yeas to 8 nays, Roll No. 263);

Pages H5522–23, H5526–27

Kildee amendment (No. 4 printed in part D of H. Rept. 117–366) that expands conservation activities eligible for funding under the Endangered Species Recovery and Habitat Conservation Legacy Fund to include efforts to manage, control, and prevent invasive species and disease (by a yea-and-nay vote of 231 yeas to 189 nays, Roll No. 264); and

Pages H5523–24, H5527–28

Butterfield amendment (No. 5 printed in part D of H. Rept. 117–366) that allows non-profit organizations to be eligible to receive competitive grant funds through the Wildlife Conservation and Restoration Subaccount (by a yea-and-nay vote of 216 yeas to 206 nays, Roll No. 265).

Pages H5524–25, H5528

H. Res. 1170, the rule providing for consideration of the bills (H.R. 2543), (H.R. 2773), and (H.R. 7606) was agreed to by a yea-and-nay vote of 218 yeas to 204 nays, Roll No. 260, after the previous question was ordered by a yea-and-nay vote of 216 yeas to 199 nays, Roll No. 259. **Pages H5499–H5506**

Suspensions: The House agreed to suspend the rules and pass the following measure: Supreme Court Police Parity Act of 2022: S. 4160, to amend title 40,

United States Code, to grant the Supreme Court of the United States security-related authorities equivalent to the legislative and executive branches, by a ⅔ yea-and-nay vote of 396 yeas to 27 nays, Roll No. 261. **Pages H5495–99, H5506–07**

Suspensions—Proceedings Resumed: The House agreed to suspend the rules and pass the following measures. Consideration began Monday, June 13th. Advanced Air Mobility Coordination and Leadership Act: S. 516, amended, to plan for and coordinate efforts to integrate advanced air mobility aircraft into the national airspace system, by a ⅔ yea-and-nay vote of 380 yeas to 30 nays, Roll No. 268; and **Pages H5530–31**

Small State and Rural Rescue Act: H.R. 7211, to amend the Robert T. Stafford Disaster Relief and Emergency Assistance Act, review a final rule of the Federal Emergency Management Agency, by a ⅔ yea-and-nay vote of 396 yeas to 14 nays, Roll No. 269. **Pages H5531–32**

Oath of Office—Twenty-Second Congressional District of California: Representative-elect Connie Conway presented herself in the well of the House and was administered the Oath of Office by the Speaker. Earlier, the Clerk of the House transmitted a copy of a letter received from Ms. Jana M. Lean, Chief, Elections Division, California Secretary of State, indicating that, according to the preliminary results of the Special Election held June 7, 2022, the Honorable Connie Conway was elected Representative to Congress for the Twenty-Second Congressional District, State of California. **Pages H5532, H5545**

Whole Number of the House: The Speaker announced to the House that, in light of the administration of the oath to the gentlewoman from California, the whole number of the House is 429. **Page H5533**

Discharge Petition: Representative Mullin presented to the Clerk a motion to discharge the Committees on Energy and Commerce, Transportation and Infrastructure, and Natural Resources from the consideration of the bill (H.R. 575) entitled, a bill to establish a more uniform, transparent, and modern process to authorize the construction, connection, operation, and maintenance of international border-crossing facilities for the import and export of oil and natural gas and the transmission of electricity, which was referred to said committees January 28th, 2021 (Discharge Petition No. 15).

Quorum Calls—Votes: Eleven yea-and-nay votes developed during the proceedings of today and appear on pages H5505, H5506, H5506–07, H5526, H5526–27, H5527–28, H5528, H5529, H5529–30, H5530–31, and H5531.

Adjournment: The House met at 10 a.m. and adjourned at 8:33 p.m.

Committee Meetings

A 2022 REVIEW OF THE FARM BILL: STAKEHOLDER PERSPECTIVES ON NON-SNAP USDA NUTRITION PROGRAMS

Committee on Agriculture: Full Committee held a hearing entitled ''A 2022 Review of the Farm Bill: Stakeholder Perspectives on Non-SNAP USDA Nutrition Programs''. Testimony was heard from public witnesses.

HOW THE AMERICAN RESCUE PLAN SAVED LIVES AND THE U.S. ECONOMY

Committee on the Budget: Full Committee held a hearing entitled ''How the American Rescue Plan Saved Lives and the U.S. Economy''. Testimony was heard from public witnesses.

EXAMINING THE POLICIES AND PRIORITIES OF THE U.S. DEPARTMENT OF LABOR

Committee on Education and Labor: Full Committee held a hearing entitled ''Examining the Policies and Priorities of the U.S. Department of Labor''. Testimony was heard from Martin J. Walsh, Secretary, Department of Labor.

PROTECTING AMERICA'S CONSUMERS: BIPARTISAN LEGISLATION TO STRENGTHEN DATA PRIVACY AND SECURITY

Committee on Energy and Commerce: Subcommittee on Consumer Protection and Commerce held a hearing entitled ''Protecting America's Consumers: Bipartisan Legislation to Strengthen Data Privacy and Security''. Testimony was heard from public witnesses.

THE ADMINISTRATION'S FY23 BUDGET REQUEST FOR THE PEACE CORPS, DEVELOPMENT FINANCE CORPORATION, AND MILLENNIUM CHALLENGE CORPORATION

Committee on Foreign Affairs: Full Committee held a hearing entitled ''The Administration's FY23 Budget Request for the Peace Corps, Development Finance Corporation, and Millennium Challenge Corporation''. Testimony was heard from Alice Albright, Chief Executive Officer, Millennium Challenge Corporation; Scott Nathan, Chief Executive Officer, U.S. International Development Finance Corporation; and Carol Spahn, Chief Executive Officer, Peace Corps.

INVESTING IN THE FUTURE: A REVIEW OF THE FISCAL YEAR 2023 BUDGET REQUEST FOR THE FEDERAL EMERGENCY MANAGEMENT AGENCY

Committee on Homeland Security: Subcommittee on Emergency Preparedness, Response, and Recovery held a hearing entitled "Investing in the Future: A Review of the Fiscal Year 2023 Budget Request for the Federal Emergency Management Agency". Testimony was heard from Deanne Criswell, Administrator, Federal Emergency Management Agency, Department of Homeland Security.

REVIEWING DHS'S TARGETED VIOLENCE AND TERRORISM PREVENTION GRANT PROGRAM

Committee on Homeland Security: Subcommittee on Oversight, Management, and Accountability held a hearing entitled "Reviewing DHS's Targeted Violence and Terrorism Prevention Grant Program". Testimony was heard from Paul Kim, Deputy District Attorney, Los Angeles County, California; Lieutenant Colonel Chris Kelenske, Commander, State Police, Michigan; and public witnesses.

LEGISLATIVE MEASURES

Committee on Natural Resources: Subcommittee on National Parks, Forests, and Public Lands held a hearing on H.R. 1548, the "Native Plant Species Pilot Program Act of 2021"; H.R. 4658, the "Beilenson Trailhead Designation Act"; H.R. 6364, to amend the Delaware Water Gap National Recreation Area Improvement Act to extend the exception to the closure of certain roads within the Recreation Area for local businesses, and for other purposes; H.R. 6442, the "PACTS Act"; H.R. 7496, to direct the Secretary of the Interior to install a plaque at the peak of Ram Head in the Virgin Islands National Park on St. John, United States Virgin Islands, to commemorate the slave rebellion that began on St. John in 1733; H.R. 7615, the "LODGE Act"; H.R. 7693, the "National Park Foundation Reauthorization Act of 2022"; and H.R. 7592, the "Valley Forge Park Realignment Permit and Promise Act". Testimony was heard from Representatives Cartwright, Lieu, Fulcher, Plaskett, and Moore of Utah; Lena McDowall, Deputy Director, Management and Administration, National Park Service, Department of the Interior; Patrice Horstman, Chair, Board of Supervisors, Coconino County, Arizona; and public witnesses.

EXAMINING FEDERAL EFFORTS TO PREVENT, DETECT, AND PROSECUTE PANDEMIC RELIEF FRAUD TO SAFEGUARD FUNDS FOR ALL ELIGIBLE AMERICANS

Committee on Oversight and Reform: Select Subcommittee on the Coronavirus Crisis held a hearing entitled "Examining Federal Efforts to Prevent, Detect, and Prosecute Pandemic Relief Fraud to Safeguard Funds for All Eligible Americans". Testimony was heard from Kevin Chambers, Director for COVID–19 Fraud Enforcement, Department of Justice; Roy D. Dotson, Jr., Acting Special Agent in Charge, National Pandemic Fraud Recovery Coordinator, U.S. Secret Service, Department of Homeland Security; Michael Horowitz, Chair, Pandemic Response Accountability Committee, Council of the Inspectors General on Integrity and Efficiency; and Hannibal Ware, Inspector General, U.S. Small Business Administration.

MISCELLANEOUS MEASURES

Committee on Oversight and Reform: Full Committee began a markup on H.R. 4176, the "LGBTQ Data Inclusion Act"; H.R. 5815, the "Honest Census Communications Act"; H.R. 7951, the "Telework Metrics and Cost Savings Act"; H.R. 7941, to permit the District of Columbia to Transmit Acts of the District to Congress in Electronic Form; H.R. 6218, to designate the facility of the United States Postal Service located at 317 Blattner Drive in Avon, Minnesota, as the "W.O.C. Kort Miller Plantenberg Post Office"; H.R. 6220, to designate the facility of the United States Postal Service located at 100 3rd Avenue Northwest in Perham, Minnesota, as the "Charles P. Nord Post Office"; H.R. 6221, to designate the facility of the United States Postal Service located at 155 Main Avenue West in Winsted, Minnesota, as the "James A. Rogers Jr. Post Office"; H.R. 7518, to designate the facility of the United States Postal Service located at 23200 John R Road in Hazel Park, Michigan, as the "Roy E. Dickens Post Office"; H.R. 7519, to designate the facility of the United States Postal Service located at 2050 South Boulevard in Bloomfield Township, Michigan, as the "Dr. Ezra S. Parke Post Office Building"; and H.R. 7899, to designate the facility of the United States Postal Service located at 75 Commerce Drive in Grayslake, Illinois, as the Army Specialist "Joseph "Joey" W. Dimock II Post Office Building".

WHAT'S THE FORECAST: A LOOK AT THE FUTURE OF WEATHER RESEARCH

Committee on Science, Space, and Technology: Subcommittee on Environment held a hearing entitled "What's the Forecast: A Look at the Future of

Weather Research''. Testimony was heard from public witnesses.

ARE GOVERNMENTWIDE CONTRACTS HELPING OR HURTING SMALL CONTRACTORS

Committee on Small Business: Full Committee held a hearing entitled ''Are Governmentwide Contracts Helping or Hurting Small Contractors?''. Testimony was heard from public witnesses.

EXAMINING FREIGHT RAIL SAFETY

Committee on Transportation and Infrastructure: Subcommittee on Railroads, Pipelines, and Hazardous Materials held a hearing entitled ''Examining Freight Rail Safety''. Testimony was heard from Amit Bose, Administrator, Federal Railroad Administration, Department of Transportation; Thomas B. Chapman, Member, National Transportation Safety Board; and public witnesses.

NATIONAL RECONNAISSANCE OFFICE AND NATIONAL GEOSPATIAL INTELLIGENCE AGENCY BUDGET HEARING

Permanent Select Committee on Intelligence: Full Committee held a hearing entitled ''National Reconnaissance Office and National Geospatial Intelligence Agency Budget Hearing''. This hearing was closed.

STATE PERSPECTIVES ON CUTTING METHANE POLLUTION

Select Committee on the Climate Crisis: Full Committee held a hearing entitled ''State Perspectives on Cutting Methane Pollution''. Testimony was heard from Michelle Lujan Grisham, Governor, New Mexico; and Mark Gordon, Governor, Wyoming.

Joint Meetings

No joint committee meetings were held.

NEW PUBLIC LAWS

(For last listing of Public Laws, see DAILY DIGEST, *p. D630)*

H.R. 3525, to establish the Commission to Study the Potential Creation of a National Museum of Asian Pacific American History and Culture. Signed on June 13, 2022. (Public Law 117–40)

COMMITTEE MEETINGS FOR WEDNESDAY, JUNE 15, 2022

(Committee meetings are open unless otherwise indicated)

Senate

Committee on Appropriations: Subcommittee on Labor, Health and Human Services, and Education, and Related Agencies, to hold hearings to examine proposed budget estimates and justification for fiscal year 2023 for the Department of Labor, 9:30 a.m., SD–138.

Committee on Armed Services: closed business meeting to markup the proposed National Defense Authorization Act for fiscal year 2023, 9:30 a.m., SR–222.

Committee on Environment and Public Works: to hold hearings to examine S. 2194, to authorize the Secretary of the Interior, through the Coastal Program of the United States Fish and Wildlife Service, to work with willing partners and provide support to efforts to assess, protect, restore, and enhance important coastal areas that provide fish and wildlife habitat on which Federal trust species depend, an original bill entitled, ''the Strengthening Coastal Communities Act'', S. 3069, to reauthorize the Great Lakes Fish and Wildlife Restoration Act of 1990, and S. 3767, to amend the Water Infrastructure Improvements for the Nation Act to reauthorize Delaware River Basin conservation programs, 10 a.m., SD–406.

Committee on Finance: Subcommittee on International Trade, Customs, and Global Competitiveness, to hold hearings to examine supply chain resiliency, focusing on alleviating backlogs and strengthening long-term security, 3 p.m., SD–215.

Committee on Foreign Relations: to receive a closed briefing on Iran's nuclear program and U.S. strategy, 10:30 a.m., SVC–217.

Committee on the Judiciary: to hold hearings to examine protecting America's children from gun violence, 10 a.m., SD–226.

Subcommittee on Competition Policy, Antitrust, and Consumer Rights, to hold hearings to examine the impact of consolidation on families and consumers, focusing on baby formula and beyond, 2:30 p.m., SD–226.

Select Committee on Intelligence: to receive a closed briefing on certain intelligence matters, 2:30 p.m., SVC–217.

United States Senate Caucus on International Narcotics Control: to hold an oversight hearing to examine the Office of National Drug Control Policy and its 2022 National Drug Control Strategy, 2 p.m., SD–608.

House

Committee on Agriculture, Full Committee, hearing entitled ''The Role of Climate Research in Supporting Agricultural Resiliency'', 10 a.m., 1300 Longworth and Zoom.

Committee on Appropriations, Subcommittee on Defense, markup on the FY 2023 Defense Appropriations Bill, 9:30 a.m., H–140 Capitol. This markup is closed.

Subcommittee on Legislative Branch, markup on the FY 2023 Legislative Branch Appropriations Bill, 11 a.m., 2359 Rayburn.

Subcommittee on Military Construction, Veterans Affairs, and Related Agencies, markup on the FY 2023 Military Construction, Veterans Affairs, and Related Agencies Appropriations Bill, 1 p.m., 2359 Rayburn.

Subcommittee on Agriculture, Rural Development, Food and Drug Administration, and Related Agencies, markup on the FY 2023 Agriculture, Rural Development, Food and Drug Administration, and Related Agencies Appropriations Bill, 2:30 p.m., 2359 Rayburn.

Committee on Energy and Commerce, Subcommittee on Communications and Technology, markup on H.R. 4275, the ''Ensuring Phone and Internet Access for SNAP Recipients Act of 2021''; H.R. 4990, the ''ITS Codification Act''; H.R. 5400, the ''Preventing Disruptions to Universal Service Funds Act''; H.R. 5486, the ''SMART Act''; H.R. 7132, the ''Safe Connections Act of 2022''; H.R. 7624, the ''Spectrum Innovation Act of 2022''; and H.R. 7783, the ''Extending America's Spectrum Auction Leadership Act of 2022'', 10:15 a.m., 2123 Rayburn and Webex.

Committee on Homeland Security, Subcommittee on Intelligence and Counterterrorism, hearing entitled ''Current Status of ISIS and al Qaeda'', 10 a.m., Webex. A portion of this hearing may be closed.

Committee on the Judiciary, Full Committee, markup on H.R. 282, the ''Territorial Judgeship Retirement Equity Act of 2021''; H.R. 3034, to amend title 28, United States Code, to provide an additional place for holding court for the Western District of Washington, and for other purposes; H.R. 6538, the ''Active Shooter Alert Act of 2022''; H.R. 5768, the ''VICTIM Act of 2021''; H.R. 7181, the ''Human Trafficking Prevention Act of 2022''; and H.R. 3285, the ''21st Century President Act'', 10 a.m., 2141 Rayburn and Zoom.

Committee on Natural Resources, Full Committee, markup on H.R. 263, the ''Big Cat Public Safety Act''; H.R. 5444, the ''Truth and Healing Commission on Indian Boarding School Policies Act''; H.R. 6063, to provide for the equitable settlement of certain Indian land disputes regarding land in Illinois, and for other purposes; H.R. 6181, the ''Samish Indian Nation Land Reaffirmation Act''; H.R. 6337, the ''Biking on Long-Distance Trails Act''; H.R. 6707, the ''Advancing Equality for Wabanaki Nations Act''; H.R. 6734, the ''Keep America's Refuges Operational Act of 2022''; H.R. 7002, the ''Gateway Solidarity Act''; H.R. 7025, the ''Advancing Human Rights-Centered International Conservation Act of 2022''; H.R. 7075, the ''Ukrainian Independence Park Act of 2022''; and S. 789, the ''RESPECT Act'', 10 a.m., 1324 Longworth and Webex.

Committee on Oversight and Reform, Subcommittee on Economic and Consumer Policy, hearing entitled ''Seresto Flea and Tick Collars: Examining Why a Product Linked to More than 2,500 Pet Deaths Remains on the Market'', 2 p.m., 2154 Rayburn and Zoom.

Committee on Rules, Subcommittee on Legislative and Budget Process, hearing entitled ''Tools to Combat Gun Trafficking and Reduce Gun Violence in Our Communities'' [Original Jurisdiction Hearing], 11:30 a.m., H–313 Capitol.

Committee on Transportation and Infrastructure, Full Committee, markup on H.R 7321, the ''Safe Aircraft Maintenance Standards Act''; legislation on the American Aerospace Supply Chain Resiliency, Innovation, and Advancement Act of 2022; H.R. 1468, the ''Securities and Exchange Commission Real Estate Leasing Authority Revocation Act''; H.R. 7789, the ''Planning for Animal Wellness Act''; H.R. 5774, the ''Expediting Disaster Recovery Act''; and General Services Administration's Capital Investment and Leasing Program Resolutions, 10 a.m., 2167 Rayburn and Zoom.

Committee on Veterans' Affairs, Subcommittee on Economic Opportunity, hearing entitled ''Reviewing President Biden's Strategy to Reduce Veteran Suicide by Addressing Economic Risk Factors'', 9:30 a.m., HVC–210 and Zoom.

Committee on Ways and Means, Full Committee, hearing entitled ''The Burnout Epidemic and What Working Women Need for A Stronger Economy'', 10 a.m., 1100 Longworth and Webex.

Permanent Select Committee on Intelligence, Full Committee, hearing entitled ''Central Intelligence Agency Budget Hearing'', 10 a.m., HVC–304 Hearing Room. This hearing is closed.

Next Meeting of the **SENATE**

10 a.m., Wednesday, June 15

Senate Chamber

Program for Wednesday: Senate will continue consideration of H.R. 3967, Honoring our PACT Act, and vote on adoption of Tester/Moran Amendment No. 5051, in the nature of a substitute, and on the motion to invoke cloture on the bill, at 11:45 a.m.

At 5:15 p.m., Senate will vote on or in relation to the motion to proceed to consideration of S. Con. Res. 41, Concurrent Resolution on the Budget, and on confirmation of the nomination of Alan M. Leventhal, of Massachusetts, to be Ambassador to the Kingdom of Denmark.

Next Meeting of the **HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES**

10 a.m., Wednesday, June 15

House Chamber

Program for Wednesday: Consideration of H.R. 2543—Financial Services Racial Equity, Inclusion, and Economic Justice Act.

Extensions of Remarks, as inserted in this issue

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